Lucrecio · *De rerum natura*

Texto en latín y traducción inglesa alineados por pasaje; cada sección de la traducción figura una sola vez, junto al primer pasaje que abarca.

Fuente: Perseus Digital Library (Tufts University), urn:cts:latinLit:phi0550.phi001. Texto crítico y traducción tomados sin cambios de los archivos TEI del repositorio.

Licencia CC BY-SA 4.0 (se comparte con la misma licencia). Edición de lectura generada por Vitruvius Digital Library (Diego Kurilo), 2026. Lectura en línea: https://diegoalonsok-png.github.io/vitruvius-digital-library/lector-clasico.html?obra=phi0550.phi001

Locus	Latín	Traducción inglesa
1.1	1 Aeneadum genetrix, hominum divomque voluptas, 2 alma Venus, caeli subter labentia signa 3 quae mare navigerum, quae terras frugiferentis 4 concelebras, per te quoniam genus omne animantum 5 concipitur visitque exortum lumina solis: 6 te, dea, te fugiunt venti, te nubila caeli 7 adventumque tuum, tibi suavis daedala tellus 8 summittit flores, tibi rident aequora ponti 9 placatumque nitet diffuso lumine caelum. 10 nam simul ac species patefactast verna diei 11 et reserata viget genitabilis aura favoni, 12 aeriae primum volucris te, diva, tuumque 13 significant initum perculsae corda tua vi. 15 inde ferae pecudes persultant pabula laeta 14 et rapidos tranant amnis: ita capta lepore 16 te sequitur cupide quo quamque inducere pergis. 17 denique per maria ac montis fluviosque rapacis 18 frondiferasque domos avium camposque virentis 19 omnibus incutiens blandum per pectora amorem 20 efficis ut cupide generatim saecla propagent. 21 quae quoniam rerum naturam sola gubernas 22 nec sine te quicquam dias in luminis oras 23 exoritur neque fit laetum neque	Mother of Rome, delight of Gods and men, Dear Venus that beneath the gliding stars Makest to teem the many-voyaged main And fruitful lands- for all of living things Through thee alone are evermore conceived, Through thee are risen to visit the great sun- Before thee, Goddess, and thy coming on, Flee stormy wind and massy cloud away, For thee the daedal Earth bears scented flowers, For thee waters of the unvexed deep Smile, and the hollows of the serene sky Glow with diffused radiance for thee! For soon as comes the springtime face of day, And procreant gales blow from the West unbarred, First fowls of air, smit to the heart by thee, Foretoken thy approach, O thou Divine, And leap the wild herds round the happy fields Or swim the bounding torrents. Thus amain, Seized with the spell, all creatures follow thee Whithersoever thou walkest forth to lead, And thence through seas and mountains and swift streams, Through leafy homes of birds and greening plains, Kindling the lure of love in every breast, Thou bringest the eternal generations forth, Kind after kind. And since 'tis thou alone Guidest the Cosmos, and without thee naught Is risen to reach the shining shores of light, Nor aught of joyful or of lovely born, Thee do I crave co-partner in that verse Which I presume on Nature to compose And, too, the selfsame power might end alike All things, were they not still together held By matter eternal, shackled through its parts, Now more, now less. A touch might be enough To cause destruction. For the slightest force Would loose the weft of things wherein no part Were of imperishable stock. But now Because the fastenings of primordial parts Are

	amabile quicquam, 24 te sociam studeo scribendis versibus esse, 25 quos ego de rerum natura pangere conor 26 Memmiadae nostro, quem tu, dea, tempore in omni 27 omnibus ornatum voluisti excellere rebus. 28 quo magis aeternum da dictis, diva, leporem. 29 effice ut interea fera moenera militiai 30 per maria ac terras omnis sopita quiescant;	put together diversely and stuff Is everlasting, things abide the same Unhurt and sure, until some power comes on Strong to destroy the warp and woof of each: Nothing returns to naught; but all return At their collapse to primal forms of stuff. Lo, the rains perish which Ether-father throws Down to the bosom of Earth-mother; but then Upsprings the shining grain, and boughs are green Amid the trees, and trees themselves wax big And lade themselves with fruits; and hence in turn The race of man and all the wild are fed; Hence joyful cities thrive with boys and girls; And leafy woodlands echo with new birds; Hence cattle, fat and drowsy, lay their bulk Along the joyous pastures whilst the drops Of white ooze trickle from distended bags; Hence the young scamper on their weakling joints Along the tender herbs, fresh hearts afrisk With warm new milk. Thus naught of what so seems Perishes utterly, since Nature ever Upbuilds one thing from other, suffering naught But yet creation's neither crammed nor blocked About by body: there's in things a void- Which to have known will serve thee many a turn, Nor will not leave thee wandering in doubt, Forever searching in the sum of all, And losing faith in these pronouncements mine. There's place intangible, a void and room. For were it not, things could in nowise move; Since body's property to block and check Would work on all and at an times the same. Thus naught could evermore push forth and go, Since naught elsewhere would yield a starting place. But now through oceans, lands, and heights of heaven, By divers causes and in divers modes, Before our eyes we mark how much may move, Which, finding not a void, would fail deprived Of stir and motion; nay, would then have been Nowise begot at all, since matter, then, Had staid at rest, its parts together crammed. Then too, however solid objects seem, They yet are formed of matter mixed with void: In rocks and caves the watery moisture seeps, And beady drops stand out like plenteous tears; And food finds way through every frame that lives; The trees increase and yield the season's fruit Because their food throughout the whole is poured,

		Even from the deepest roots, through trunks and boughs; And voices pass the solid walls and fly Reverberant through shut doorways of a house; And stiffening frost seeps inward to our bones. Right here I am compelled a question to expound, Forestalling something certain folk suppose, Lest it avail to lead thee off from truth: Waters (they say) before the shining breed Of the swift scaly creatures somehow give, And straightway open sudden liquid paths, Because the fishes leave behind them room To which at once the yielding billows stream. Thus things among themselves can yet be moved, And change their place, however full the Sum- Received opinion, wholly false forsooth. For where can scaly creatures forward dart, Save where the waters give them room? Again, Where can the billows yield a way, so long As ever the fish are powerless to go? Thus either all bodies of motion are deprived, Or things contain admixture of a void Where each thing gets its start in moving on. Lastly, where after impact two broad bodies Suddenly spring apart, the air must crowd The whole new void between those bodies formed; But air, however it stream with hastening gusts, Can yet not fill the gap at once- for first It makes for one place, ere diffused through all. And then, if haply any think this comes, When bodies spring apart, because the air Somehow condenses, wander they from truth: For then a void is formed, where none before; And, too, a void is filled which was before.
1.31	31 nam tu sola potes tranquilla pace iuvare 32 mortalis, quoniam belli fera moenera Mavors 33 armipotens regit, in gremium qui saepe tuum se 34 reiicit aeterno devictus vulnere amoris, 35 atque ita suspiciens tereti cervice reposta 36 pascit amore avidos inhians in te, dea, visus 37 eque tuo pendet resupini spiritus ore. 38 hunc tu, diva, tuo recubantem corpore sancto 39 circum fusa super, suavis ex ore loquellas	For Memmius mine, whom thou hast willed to be Peerless in every grace at every hour- Wherefore indeed, Divine one, give my words Immortal charm. Lull to a timely rest O'er sea and land the savage works of war, For thou alone hast power with public peace To aid mortality; since he who rules The savage works of battle, puissant Mars, How often to thy bosom flings his strength O'ermastered by the eternal wound of love- And there, with eyes and full throat backward thrown, Gazing, my Goddess, open-mouthed at thee, Pastures on love his greedy sight, his breath Hanging upon thy lips. Him thus reclined Fill with thy holy body, round, above! Pour from those lips soft

	40 funde petens placidam Romanis, incluta, pacem; 41 nam neque nos agere hoc patriai tempore iniquo 42 possumus aequo animo nec Memmi clara propago 43 talibus in rebus communi desse saluti. 44 omnis enim per se divum natura necessest 45 immortali aevo summa cum pace fruatur 46 semota ab nostris rebus seiunctaque longe; 47 nam privata dolore omni, privata periclis, 48 ipsa suis pollens opibus, nihil indiga nostri, 49 nec bene promeritis capitur nec tangitur ira. 50 Quod super est, vacuas auris animumque sagacem 51 semotum a curis adhibe veram ad rationem, 52 ne mea dona tibi studio disposta fideli, 53 intellecta prius quam sint, contempta relinquas. 54 nam tibi de summa caeli ratione deumque 55 disserere incipiam et rerum primordia pandam, 56 unde omnis natura creet res, auctet alatque, 57 quove eadem rursum natura perempta resolvat, 58 quae nos materiem et genitalia corpora rebus 59 reddunda in ratione vocare et semina rerum 60 appellare suemus et haec eadem usurpare	syllables to win Peace for the Romans, glorious Lady, peace! For in a season troublous to the state Neither may I attend this task of mine With thought untroubled, nor mid such events The illustrious scion of the Memmian house Neglect the civic cause. And for the rest, summon to judgments true, Unbusied ears and singleness of mind Withdrawn from cares; lest these my gifts, arranged For thee with eager service, thou disdain Before thou comprehendest: since for thee I prove the supreme law of Gods and sky, And the primordial germs of things unfold, Whence Nature all creates, and multiplies And fosters all, and whither she resolves Each in the end when each is overthrown. This ultimate stock we have devised to name Procreant atoms, matter, seeds of things, Or primal bodies, as primal to the world. To come to birth but through some other's death. . . . . And now, since I have taught that things cannot Be born from nothing, nor the same, when born, To nothing be recalled, doubt not my words, Because our eyes no primal germs perceive; For mark those bodies which, though known to be In this our world, are yet invisible: The winds infuriate lash our face and frame, Unseen, and swamp huge ships and rend the clouds, Or, eddying wildly down, bestrew the plains With mighty trees, or scour the mountain tops With forest-crackling blasts. Thus on they rave With uproar shrill and ominous moan. The winds, 'Tis clear, are sightless bodies sweeping through The sea, the lands, the clouds along the sky, Vexing and whirling and seizing all amain; And forth they flow and pile destruction round, Even as the water's soft and supple bulk Becoming a river of abounding floods, Which a wide downpour from the lofty hills Swells with big showers, dashes headlong down Fragments of woodland and whole branching trees; Nor can the solid bridges bide the shock As on the waters whelm: the turbulent stream, Strong with a hundred rains, beats round the piers, Crashes with havoc, and rolls beneath its waves Down-toppled masonry and ponderous stone, Hurling away whatever would oppose. Even so must move the blasts of all the

		winds, Which but for voids for bodies to go through 'Tis clear could happen in nowise at all. Again, why see we among objects some Of heavier weight, but of no bulkier size? Indeed, if in a ball of wool there be As much of body as in lump of lead, The two should weigh alike, since body tends To load things downward, while the void abides, By contrary nature, the imponderable. Therefore, an object just as large but lighter Declares infallibly its more of void; Even as the heavier more of matter shows, And how much less of vacant room inside. That which we're seeking with sagacious quest Exists, infallibly, commixed with things- The void, the invisible inane.
1.61	61 corpora prima, quod ex illis sunt omnia primis. 62 Humana ante oculos foede cum vita iaceret 63 in terris oppressa gravi sub religione, 64 quae caput a caeli regionibus ostendebat 65 horribili super aspectu mortalibus instans, 66 primum Graius homo mortalis tollere contra 67 est oculos ausus primusque obsistere contra; 68 quem neque fama deum nec fulmina nec minitanti 69 murmure compressit caelum, sed eo magis acrem 70 inritat animi virtutem, effringere ut arta 71 naturae primus portarum claustra cupiret. 72 ergo vivida vis animi pervicit et extra 73 processit longe flammantia moenia mundi 74 atque omne immensum peragravit mente animoque, 75 unde refert nobis victor quid possit oriri, 76 quid nequeat, finita potestas denique cuique 77 qua nam sit ratione atque alte terminus haerens. 78 quare religio pedibus subiecta vicissim 79 opteritur, nos exaequat victoria caelo. 80 Illud in his rebus vereor, ne forte rearis	Whilst human kind Throughout the lands lay miserably crushed Before all eyes beneath Religion- who Would show her head along the region skies, Glowering on mortals with her hideous face- A Greek it was who first opposing dared Raise mortal eyes that terror to withstand, Whom nor the fame of Gods nor lightning's stroke Nor threatening thunder of the ominous sky Abashed; but rather chafed to angry zest His dauntless heart to be the first to rend The crossbars at the gates of Nature old. And thus his will and hardy wisdom won; And forward thus he fared afar, beyond The flaming ramparts of the world, until He wandered the unmeasurable All. Whence he to us, a conqueror, reports What things can rise to being, what cannot, And by what law to each its scope prescribed, Its boundary stone that clings so deep in Time. Wherefore Religion now is under foot, And us his victory now exalts to heaven. I fear perhaps thou deemest that we fare An impious road to realms of thought profane; But 'tis that same religion oftener far Hath bred the foul impieties of men: As once at Aulis, the elected chiefs, Foremost of heroes, Danaan counsellors, Defiled Diana's altar, virgin queen, With Agamemnon's daughter, foully slain. She felt the chaplet round her maiden locks And fillets, fluttering down on either cheek, And at the altar marked her grieving sire, The priests beside him who concealed the knife, And all the folk in tears at sight of her. With a dumb terror and a sinking knee She dropped;

	81 impia te rationis inire elementa viamque 82 indugredi sceleris. quod contra saepius illa 83 religio peperit scelerosa atque impia facta. 84 Aulide quo pacto Triviai virginis aram 85 Iphianassai turparunt sanguine foede 86 ductores Danaum delecti, prima virorum. 87 cui simul infula virgineos circum data comptus 88 ex utraque pari malarum parte profusast, 89 et maestum simul ante aras adstare parentem 90 sensit et hunc propter ferrum celare ministros	nor might avail her now that first 'Twas she who gave the king a father's name. They raised her up, they bore the trembling girl On to the altar- hither led not now With solemn rites and hymeneal choir, But sinless woman, sinfully foredone, A parent felled her on her bridal day, Making his child a sacrificial beast To give the ships auspicious winds for Troy: Such are the crimes to which Religion leads. Which, when they spread, like to a mighty flood, Hither or thither, drive things on before And hurl to ground with still renewed assault, Or sometimes in their circling vortex seize And bear in cones of whirlwind down the world: The winds are sightless bodies and naught else- Since both in works and ways they rival well The mighty rivers, the visible in form. Then too we know the varied smells of things Yet never to our nostrils see them come; With eyes we view not burning heats, nor cold, Nor are we wont men's voices to behold. Yet these must be corporeal at the base, Since thus they smite the senses: naught there is Save body, having property of touch. And raiment, hung by surf-beat shore, grows moist, The same, spread out before the sun, will dry; Yet no one saw how sank the moisture in, Nor how by heat off-driven. Thus we know, That moisture is dispersed about in bits Too small for eyes to see. Another case: A ring upon the finger thins away Along the under side, with years and suns; The drippings from the eaves will scoop the stone; The hooked ploughshare, though of iron, wastes Amid the fields insidiously. We view The rock-paved highways worn by many feet; And at the gates the brazen statues show Their right hands leaner from the frequent touch Of wayfarers innumerable who greet.
1.91	91 aspectuque suo lacrimas effundere civis, 92 muta metu terram genibus summissa petebat. 93 nec miserae prodesse in tali tempore quibat, 94 quod patrio princeps donarat nomine regem; 95 nam sublata virum manibus tremibundaque ad aras 96 deductast, non ut sollemni more	And there shall come the time when even thou, Forced by the soothsayer's terror-tales, shalt seek To break from us. Ah, many a dream even now Can they concoct to rout thy plans of life, And trouble all thy fortunes with base fears. I own with reason: for, if men but knew Some fixed end to ills, they would be strong By some device unconquered to withstand Religions and the menacings of seers. But now nor skill

	sacrorum 97 perfecto posset claro comitari Hymenaeo, 98 sed casta inceste nubendi tempore in ipso 99 hostia concideret mactatu maesta parentis, 100 exitus ut classi felix faustusque daretur. 101 tantum religio potuit suadere malorum. 102 Tutemet a nobis iam quovis tempore vatum 103 terriloquis victus dictis desciscere quaeres. 104 quippe etenim quam multa tibi iam fingere possunt 105 somnia, quae vitae rationes vertere possint 106 fortunasque tuas omnis turbare timore! 107 et merito; nam si certam finem esse viderent 108 aerumnarum homines, aliqua ratione valerent 109 religionibus atque minis obsistere vatum. 110 nunc ratio nulla est restandi, nulla facultas, 111 aeternas quoniam poenas in morte timendum. 112 ignoratur enim quae sit natura animai, 113 nata sit an contra nascentibus insinuetur 114 et simul intereat nobiscum morte dirempta 115 an tenebras Orci visat vastasque lacunas 116 an pecudes alias divinitus insinuet se, 117 Ennius ut noster cecinit, qui primus amoeno 118 detulit ex Helicone perenni fronde coronam, 119 per gentis Italas hominum quae clara clueret; 120 etsi praeterea tamen esse Acherusia templa	nor instrument is theirs, Since men must dread eternal pains in death. For what the soul may be they do not know, Whether 'tis born, or enter in at birth, And whether, snatched by death, it die with us, Or visit the shadows and the vasty caves Of Orcus, or by some divine decree Enter the brute herds, as our Ennius sang, Who first from lovely Helicon brought down A laurel wreath of bright perennial leaves, Renowned forever among the Italian clans. Yet Ennius too in everlasting verse Proclaims those vaults of Acheron to be, Though thence, he said, nor souls nor bodies fare, But only phantom figures, strangely wan, And tells how once from out those regions rose Old Homer's ghost to him and shed salt tears And with his words unfolded Nature's source. Then be it ours with steady mind to clasp The purport of the skies- the law behind The wandering courses of the sun and moon; To scan the powers that speed all life below; But most to see with reasonable eyes Of what the mind, of what the soul is made, And what it is so terrible that breaks On us asleep, or waking in disease, Until we seem to mark and hear at hand Dead men whose bones earth bosomed long ago. We see how wearing-down hath minished these, But just what motes depart at any time, The envious nature of vision bars our sight. Lastly whatever days and nature add Little by little, constraining things to grow In due proportion, no gaze however keen Of these our eyes hath watched and known. No more Can we observe what's lost at any time, When things wax old with eld and foul decay, Or when salt seas eat under beetling crags. Thus Nature ever by unseen bodies works. Be builded up for plenishing the world. But mark: infallibly a fixed bound Remaineth stablished 'gainst their breaking down; Since we behold each thing soever renewed, And unto all, their seasons, after their kind, Wherein they arrive the flower of their age.
1.121	121 Ennius aeternis exponit versibus edens, 122 quo neque permaneant animae neque corpora nostra, 123 sed quaedam simulacra modis pallentia miris;	I know how hard it is in Latian verse To tell the dark discoveries of the Greeks, Chiefly because our pauper-speech must find Strange terms to fit the strangeness of the thing; Yet worth of thine and the expected joy Of thy sweet

	124 unde sibi exortam semper florentis Homeri 125 commemorat speciem lacrimas effundere salsas 126 coepisse et rerum naturam expandere dictis. 127 qua propter bene cum superis de rebus habenda 128 nobis est ratio, solis lunaeque meatus 129 qua fiant ratione, et qua vi quaeque gerantur 130 in terris, tunc cum primis ratione sagaci 131 unde anima atque animi constet natura videndum, 132 et quae res nobis vigilantibus obvia mentes 133 terrificet morbo adfectis somnoque sepultis, 134 cernere uti videamur eos audireque coram, 135 morte obita quorum tellus amplectitur ossa. 136 Nec me animi fallit Graiorum obscura reperta 137 difficile inlustrare Latinis versibus esse, 138 multa novis verbis praesertim cum sit agendum 139 propter egestatem linguae et rerum novitatem; 140 sed tua me virtus tamen et sperata voluptas 141 suavis amicitiae quemvis efferre laborem 142 suadet et inducit noctes vigilare serenas 143 quaerentem dictis quibus et quo carmine demum 144 clara tuae possim praepandere lumina menti, 145 res quibus occultas penitus convisere possis. 146 hunc igitur terrorem animi tenebrasque necessest 147 non radii solis neque lucida tela diei 148 discutiant, sed naturae species ratioque. 149 Principium cuius hinc nobis exordia sumet, 150 nullam rem e nihilo gigni divinitus umquam.	friendship do persuade me on To bear all toil and wake the clear nights through, Seeking with what of words and what of song I may at last most gloriously uncloud For thee the light beyond, wherewith to view The core of being at the centre hid. This terror, then, this darkness of the mind, Not sunrise with its flaring spokes of light, Nor glittering arrows of morning can disperse, But only Nature's aspect and her law, Which, teaching us, hath this exordium: Nothing from nothing ever yet was born. Fear holds dominion over mortality Only because, seeing in land and sky So much the cause whereof no wise they know, Men think Divinities are working there. Meantime, when once we know from nothing still Nothing can be create, we shall divine More clearly what we seek: those elements From which alone all things created are, And how accomplished by no tool of Gods. Suppose all sprang from all things: any kind Might take its origin from any thing, No fixed seed required. Men from the sea Might rise, and from the land the scaly breed, And, fowl full fledged come bursting from the sky; The horned cattle, the herds and all the wild Would haunt with varying offspring tilth and waste; Nor would the same fruits keep their olden trees, But each might grow from any stock or limb By chance and change. Indeed, and were there not For each its procreant atoms, could things have Each its unalterable mother old? But, since produced from fixed seeds are all, Each birth goes forth upon the shores of light From its own stuff, from its own primal bodies. And all from all cannot become, because In each resides a secret power its own. Again, why see we lavished o'er the lands At spring the rose, at summer heat the corn, The vines that mellow when the autumn lures, If not because the fixed seeds of things At their own season must together stream, And new creations only be revealed When the due times arrive and pregnant earth Safely may give unto the shores of light Her tender progenies? But if from naught Were their becoming, they would spring abroad Suddenly, unforeseen, in alien months, With no primordial germs, to be preserved From procreant unions at

		an adverse hour.
1.151	151 quippe ita formido mortalis continet omnis, 152 quod multa in terris fieri caeloque tuentur, 153 quorum operum causas nulla ratione videre 154 possunt ac fieri divino numine rentur. 156 quas ob res ubi viderimus nil posse creari 157 de nihilo, tum quod sequimur iam rectius inde 158 perspiciemus, et unde queat res quaeque creari 155 et quo quaeque modo fiant opera sine divom. 159 Nam si de nihilo fierent, ex omnibus rebus 160 omne genus nasci posset, nil semine egeret. 161 e mare primum homines, e terra posset oriri 162 squamigerum genus et volucres erumpere caelo; 163 armenta atque aliae pecudes, genus omne ferarum, 164 incerto partu culta ac deserta tenerent. 165 nec fructus idem arboribus constare solerent, 166 sed mutarentur, ferre omnes omnia possent. 167 quippe ubi non essent genitalia corpora cuique, 168 qui posset mater rebus consistere certa? 169 at nunc seminibus quia certis quaeque creantur, 170 inde enascitur atque oras in luminis exit, 171 materies ubi inest cuiusque et corpora prima; 172 atque hac re nequeunt ex omnibus omnia gigni, 173 quod certis in rebus inest secreta facultas. 174 Praeterea cur vere rosam, frumenta calore, 175 vites autumno fundi suadente videmus, 176 si non, certa suo quia tempore semina rerum 177 cum confluxerunt, patefit quod cumque creatur, 178 dum tempestates adsunt et vivida tellus 179 tuto res teneras effert in luminis	

	oras? 180 quod si de nihilo fierent, subito exorerentur	
1.181	181 incerto spatio atque alienis partibus anni, 182 quippe ubi nulla forent primordia, quae genitali 183 concilio possent arceri tempore iniquo. 184 Nec porro augendis rebus spatio foret usus 185 seminis ad coitum, si e nilo crescere possent; 186 nam fierent iuvenes subito ex infantibus parvis 187 e terraque exorta repente arbusta salirent. 188 quorum nil fieri manifestum est, omnia quando 189 paulatim crescunt, ut par est semine certo, 190 crescentesque genus servant; ut noscere possis 191 quicque sua de materia grandescere alique. 192 Huc accedit uti sine certis imbribus anni 193 laetificos nequeat fetus submittere tellus 194 nec porro secreta cibo natura animantum 195 propagare genus possit vitamque tueri; 196 ut potius multis communia corpora rebus 197 multa putes esse, ut verbis elementa videmus, 198 quam sine principiis ullam rem existere posse. 199 Denique cur homines tantos natura parare 200 non potuit, pedibus qui pontum per vada possent 201 transire et magnos manibus divellere montis 202 multaque vivendo vitalia vincere saecla, 203 si non, materies quia rebus reddita certast 204 gignundis, e qua constat quid possit oriri? 205 nil igitur fieri de nilo posse fatendumst, 206 semine quando opus est rebus, quo quaeque creatae 207 aeris in teneras possint proferrier auras. 208 Postremo quoniam incultis	Nor on the mingling of the living seeds Would space be needed for the growth of things Were life an increment of nothing: then The tiny babe forthwith would walk a man, And from the turf would leap a branching tree- Wonders unheard of; for, by Nature, each Slowly increases from its lawful seed, And through that increase shall conserve its kind. Whence take the proof that things enlarge and feed From out their proper matter. Thus it comes That earth, without her seasons of fixed rains, Could bear no produce such as makes us glad, And whatsoever lives, if shut from food, Prolongs its kind and guards its life no more. Thus easier 'tis to hold that many things Have primal bodies in common (as we see The single letters common to many words) Than aught exists without its origins. Moreover, why should Nature not prepare Men of a bulk to ford the seas afoot, Or rend the mighty mountains with their hands, Or conquer Time with length of days, if not Because for all begotten things abides The changeless stuff, and what from that may spring Is fixed forevermore? Lastly we see How far the tilled surpass the fields untilled And to the labour of our hands return Their more abounding crops; there are indeed Within the earth primordial germs of things, Which, as the ploughshare turns the fruitful clods And kneads the mould, we quicken into birth. Else would ye mark, without all toil of ours, Spontaneous generations, fairer forms.

	praestare videmus 209 culta loca et manibus melioris reddere fetus, 210 esse videlicet in terris primordia rerum	
1.211	211 quae nos fecundas vertentes vomere glebas 212 terraique solum subigentes cimus ad ortus; 213 quod si nulla forent, nostro sine quaeque labore 214 sponte sua multo fieri meliora videres. 215 Huc accedit uti quicque in sua corpora rursum 216 dissoluat natura neque ad nihilum interemat res. 217 nam siquid mortale e cunctis partibus esset, 218 ex oculis res quaeque repente erepta periret; 219 nulla vi foret usus enim, quae partibus eius 220 discidium parere et nexus exsolvere posset. 221 quod nunc, aeterno quia constant semine quaeque, 222 donec vis obiit, quae res diverberet ictu 223 aut intus penetret per inania dissoluatque, 224 nullius exitium patitur natura videri. 225 Praeterea quae cumque vetustate amovet aetas, 226 si penitus peremit consumens materiem omnem, 227 unde animale genus generatim in lumina vitae 228 redducit Venus, aut redductum daedala tellus 229 unde alit atque auget generatim pabula praebens? 230 unde mare ingenuei fontes externaque longe 231 flumina suppeditant? unde aether sidera pascit? 232 omnia enim debet, mortali corpore quae sunt, 233 infinita aetas consumpse ante acta diesque. 234 quod si in eo spatio atque ante acta aetate fuere 235 e quibus haec rerum consistit summa refecta, 236 inmortali sunt natura praedita certe. 237 haud igitur possunt ad nilum	

	quaeque reverti. 238 Denique res omnis eadem vis causaque volgo 239 conficeret, nisi materies aeterna teneret, 240 inter se nexus minus aut magis indupedita;	
1.241	241 tactus enim leti satis esset causa profecto, 242 quippe ubi nulla forent aeterno corpore, quorum 243 contextum vis deberet dissolvere quaeque. 244 at nunc, inter se quia nexus principiorum 245 dissimiles constant aeternaque materies est, 246 incolumi remanent res corpore, dum satis acris 247 vis obeat pro textura cuiusque reperta. 248 haud igitur redit ad nihilum res ulla, sed omnes 249 discidio redeunt in corpora materiai. 250 postremo pereunt imbres, ubi eos pater aether 251 in gremium matris terrai praecipitavit; 252 at nitidae surgunt fruges ramique virescunt 253 arboribus, crescunt ipsae fetuque gravantur. 254 hinc alitur porro nostrum genus atque ferarum, 255 hinc laetas urbes pueris florere videmus 256 frondiferasque novis avibus canere undique silvas, 257 hinc fessae pecudes pinguis per pabula laeta 258 corpora deponunt et candens lacteus umor 259 uberibus manat distentis, hinc nova proles 260 artubus infirmis teneras lasciva per herbas 261 ludit lacte mero mentes perculsa novellas. 262 haud igitur penitus pereunt quaecumque videntur, 263 quando alit ex alio reficit natura nec ullam 264 rem gigni patitur nisi morte adiuta aliena. 265 Nunc age, res quoniam docui non posse creari 266 de nihilo neque item genitas ad nil	

	revocari, 267 ne qua forte tamen coeptes diffidere dictis, 268 quod nequeunt oculis rerum primordia cerni, 269 accipe praeterea quae corpora tute necessest 270 confiteare esse in rebus nec posse videri.	
1.271	271 Principio venti vis verberat incita corpus 272 ingentisque ruit navis et nubila differt, 273 inter dum rapido percurrens turbine campos 274 arboribus magnis sternit montisque supremos 275 silvifragis vexat flabris: ita perfurit acri 276 cum fremitu saevitque minaci murmure pontus. 277 sunt igitur venti ni mirum corpora caeca, 278 quae mare, quae terras, quae denique nubila caeli 279 verrunt ac subito vexantia turbine raptant, 280 nec ratione fluunt alia stragemque propagant 281 et cum mollis aquae fertur natura repente 282 flumine abundanti, quam largis imbribus auget 283 montibus ex altis magnus decursus aquai 284 fragmina coniciens silvarum arbustaque tota, 285 nec validi possunt pontes venientis aquai 286 vim subitam tolerare: ita magno turbidus imbri 287 molibus incurrit validis cum viribus amnis, 288 dat sonitu magno stragem volvitque sub undis 289 grandia saxa, ruit qua quidquid fluctibus obstat. 290 sic igitur debent venti quoque flamina ferri, 291 quae vel uti validum cum flumen procubuere 292 quam libet in partem, trudunt res ante ruuntque 293 impetibus crebris, inter dum vertice torto 294 corripiunt rapidique rotanti turbine portant. 295 quare etiam atque etiam sunt venti	

	corpora caeca, 296 quandoquidem factis et moribus aemula magnis 297 amnibus inveniuntur, aperto corpore qui sunt. 298 Tum porro varios rerum sentimus odores 299 nec tamen ad naris venientis cernimus umquam 300 nec calidos aestus tuimur nec frigora quimus	
1.301	301 usurpare oculis nec voces cernere suemus; 302 quae tamen omnia corporea constare necessest 303 natura, quoniam sensus inpellere possunt; 304 tangere enim et tangi, nisi corpus, nulla potest res. 305 Denique fluctifrago suspensae in litore vestis 306 uvescunt, eaedem dispansae in sole serescunt. 307 at neque quo pacto persederit umor aquai 308 visumst nec rursum quo pacto fugerit aestu. 309 in parvas igitur partis dispergitur umor, 310 quas oculi nulla possunt ratione videre. 311 quin etiam multis solis redeuntibus annis 312 anulus in digito subter tenuatur habendo, 313 stilicidi casus lapidem cavat, uncus aratri 314 ferreus occulte decrescit vomer in arvis, 315 strataque iam volgi pedibus detrita viarum 316 saxea conspicimus; tum portas propter aena 317 signa manus dextras ostendunt adtenuari 318 saepe salutantum tactu praeterque meantum. 319 haec igitur minui, cum sint detrita, videmus. 320 sed quae corpora decedant in tempore quoque, 321 invida praeclusit speciem natura videndi. 322 Postremo quae cumque dies naturaque rebus 323 paulatim tribuit moderatim crescere cogens, 324 nulla potest oculorum acies	

	contenta tueri, 325 nec porro quae cumque aevo macieque senescunt, 326 nec, mare quae impendent, vesco sale saxa peresa 327 quid quoque amittant in tempore cernere possis. 328 corporibus caecis igitur natura gerit res. 329 Nec tamen undique corporea stipata tenentur 330 omnia natura; namque est in rebus inane.	
1.331	331 quod tibi cognosse in multis erit utile rebus 332 nec sinet errantem dubitare et quaerere semper 333 de summa rerum et nostris diffidere dictis. 334 qua propter locus est intactus inane vacansque. 335 quod si non esset, nulla ratione moveri 336 res possent; namque officium quod corporis exstat, 337 officere atque obstare, id in omni tempore adesset 338 omnibus; haud igitur quicquam procedere posset, 339 principium quoniam cedendi nulla daret res. 340 at nunc per maria ac terras sublimaque caeli 341 multa modis multis varia ratione moveri 342 cernimus ante oculos, quae, si non esset inane, 343 non tam sollicito motu privata carerent 344 quam genita omnino nulla ratione fuissent, 345 undique materies quoniam stipata quiesset. 346 Praeterea quamvis solidae res esse putentur, 347 hinc tamen esse licet raro cum corpore cernas. 348 in saxis ac speluncis permanat aquarum 349 liquidus umor et uberibus flent omnia guttis. 350 dissipat in corpus sese cibus omne animantum; 351 crescunt arbusta et fetus in tempore fundunt, 352 quod cibus in totas usque ab radicibus imis 353 per truncos ac per ramos	

	diffunditur omnis. 354 inter saepta meant voces et clausa domorum 355 transvolitant, rigidum permanat frigus ad ossa. 356 quod nisi inania sint, qua possent corpora quaeque 357 transire, haud ulla fieri ratione videres. 358 Denique cur alias aliis praestare videmus 359 pondere res rebus nihilo maiore figura? 360 nam si tantundemst in lanae glomere quantum	
1.361	361 corporis in plumbo est, tantundem pendere par est, 362 corporis officiumst quoniam premere omnia deorsum, 363 contra autem natura manet sine pondere inanis. 364 ergo quod magnumst aeque leviusque videtur, 365 ni mirum plus esse sibi declarat inanis; 366 at contra gravius plus in se corporis esse 367 dedicat et multo vacui minus intus habere. 368 est igitur ni mirum id quod ratione sagaci 369 quaerimus, admixtum rebus, quod inane vocamus. 370 Illud in his rebus ne te deducere vero 371 possit, quod quidam fingunt, praecurrere cogor. 372 cedere squamigeris latices nitentibus aiunt 373 et liquidas aperire vias, quia post loca pisces 374 linquant, quo possint cedentes confluere undae; 375 sic alias quoque res inter se posse moveri 376 et mutare locum, quamvis sint omnia plena. 377 scilicet id falsa totum ratione receptumst. 378 nam quo squamigeri poterunt procedere tandem, 379 ni spatium dederint latices? concedere porro 380 quo poterunt undae, cum pisces ire nequibunt? 381 aut igitur motu privandumst corpora quaeque 382 aut esse admixtum dicundumst	

	rebus inane, 383 unde initum primum capiat res quaeque movendi. 384 Postremo duo de concursu corpora lata 385 si cita dissiliant, nempe aer omne necessest, 386 inter corpora quod fiat, possidat inane. 387 is porro quamvis circum celerantibus auris 388 confluat, haud poterit tamen uno tempore totum 389 compleri spatium; nam primum quemque necessest 390 occupet ille locum, deinde omnia possideantur.	
1.391	391 quod si forte aliquis, cum corpora dissiluere, 392 tum putat id fieri quia se condenseat aer, 393 errat; nam vacuum tum fit quod non fuit ante 394 et repletur item vacuum quod constitit ante, 395 nec tali ratione potest denserier aer 396 nec, si iam posset, sine inani posset, opinor, 397 ipse in se trahere et partis conducere in unum. 398 Qua propter, quamvis causando multa moreris, 399 esse in rebus inane tamen fateare necessest. 400 multaque praeterea tibi possum commemorando 401 argumenta fidem dictis conradere nostris. 402 verum animo satis haec vestigia parva sagaci 403 sunt, per quae possis cognoscere cetera tute. 404 namque canes ut montivagae persaepe ferai 405 naribus inveniunt intectas fronde quietes, 406 cum semel institerunt vestigia certa viai, 407 sic alid ex alio per te tute ipse videre 408 talibus in rebus poteris caecasque latebras 409 insinuare omnis et verum protrahere inde. 410 quod si pigraris paulumve recesseris ab re, 411 hoc tibi de plano possum	

	promittere, Memmi: 412 usque adeo largos haustus e fontibus magnis 413 lingua meo suavis diti de pectore fundet, 414 ut verear ne tarda prius per membra senectus 415 serpat et in nobis vitai claustra resolvat, 416 quam tibi de quavis una re versibus omnis 417 argumentorum sit copia missa per auris. 418 Sed nunc ut repetam coeptum pertexere dictis, 419 omnis ut est igitur per se natura duabus 420 constitit in rebus; nam corpora sunt et inane,	
1.421	421 haec in quo sita sunt et qua diversa moventur. 422 corpus enim per se communis dedicat esse 423 sensus; cui nisi prima fides fundata valebit, 424 haut erit occultis de rebus quo referentes 425 confirmare animi quicquam ratione queamus. 426 tum porro locus ac spatium, quod inane vocamus, 427 si nullum foret, haut usquam sita corpora possent 428 esse neque omnino quoquam diversa meare; 429 id quod iam supera tibi paulo ostendimus ante. 430 praeterea nihil est quod possis dicere ab omni 431 corpore seiunctum secretumque esse ab inani, 432 quod quasi tertia sit numero natura reperta. 433 nam quod cumque erit, esse aliquid debebit id ipsum 434 augmine vel grandi vel parvo denique, dum sit; 435 cui si tactus erit quamvis levis exiguusque, 436 corporis augebit numerum summamque sequetur; 437 sin intactile erit, nulla de parte quod ullam 438 rem prohibere queat per se transire meantem, 439 scilicet hoc id erit, vacuum quod inane vocamus. 440 Praeterea per se quod cumque erit,	

	aut faciet quid 441 aut aliis fungi debebit agentibus ipsum 442 aut erit ut possint in eo res esse gerique. 443 at facere et fungi sine corpore nulla potest res 444 nec praebere locum porro nisi inane vacansque. 445 ergo praeter inane et corpora tertia per se 446 nulla potest rerum in numero natura relinqui, 447 nec quae sub sensus cadat ullo tempore nostros 448 nec ratione animi quam quisquam possit apisci. 449 Nam quae cumque cluent, aut his coniuncta duabus 450 rebus ea invenies aut horum eventa videbis.	
1.451	451 coniunctum est id quod nusquam sine permitiali 452 discidio potis est seiungi seque gregari, 453 pondus uti saxis, calor ignis, liquor aquai, 454 tactus corporibus cunctis, intactus inani. 455 servitium contra paupertas divitiaeque, 456 libertas bellum concordia cetera quorum 457 adventu manet incolumis natura abituque, 458 haec soliti sumus, ut par est, eventa vocare. 459 tempus item per se non est, sed rebus ab ipsis 460 consequitur sensus, transactum quid sit in aevo, 461 tum quae res instet, quid porro deinde sequatur; 462 nec per se quemquam tempus sentire fatendumst 463 semotum ab rerum motu placidaque quiete. 464 denique Tyndaridem raptam belloque subactas 465 Troiiugenas gentis cum dicunt esse, videndumst 466 ne forte haec per se cogant nos esse fateri, 467 quando ea saecla hominum, quorum haec eventa fuerunt, 468 inrevocabilis abstulerit iam praeterita aetas; 469 namque aliud terris, aliud	

	regionibus ipsis 470 eventum dici poterit quod cumque erit actum. 471 denique materies si rerum nulla fuisset 472 nec locus ac spatium, res in quo quaeque geruntur, 473 numquam Tyndaridis forma conflatus amore 474 ignis Alexandri Phrygio sub pectore gliscens 475 clara accendisset saevi certamina belli 476 nec clam durateus Troiianis Pergama partu 477 inflammasset equos nocturno Graiiugenarum; 478 perspicere ut possis res gestas funditus omnis 479 non ita uti corpus per se constare neque esse 480 nec ratione cluere eadem qua constet inane,	
1.481	481 sed magis ut merito possis eventa vocare 482 corporis atque loci, res in quo quaeque gerantur. 483 Corpora sunt porro partim primordia rerum, 484 partim concilio quae constant principiorum. 485 sed quae sunt rerum primordia, nulla potest vis 486 stinguere; nam solido vincunt ea corpore demum. 487 etsi difficile esse videtur credere quicquam 488 in rebus solido reperiri corpore posse. 489 transit enim fulmen caeli per saepta domorum 490 clamor ut ac voces, ferrum candescit in igni 491 dissiliuntque fero ferventi saxa vapore; 492 cum labefactatus rigor auri solvitur aestu, 493 tum glacies aeris flamma devicta liquescit; 494 permanat calor argentum penetraleque frigus, 495 quando utrumque manu retinentes pocula rite 496 sensimus infuso lympharum rore superne. 497 usque adeo in rebus solidi nihil esse videtur. 498 sed quia vera tamen ratio	

	naturaque rerum 499 cogit, ades, paucis dum versibus expediamus 500 esse ea quae solido atque aeterno corpore constent, 501 semina quae rerum primordiaque esse docemus, 502 unde omnis rerum nunc constet summa creata. 503 Principio quoniam duplex natura duarum 504 dissimilis rerum longe constare repertast, 505 corporis atque loci, res in quo quaeque geruntur, 506 esse utramque sibi per se puramque necessest. 507 nam qua cumque vacat spatium, quod inane vocamus, 508 corpus ea non est; qua porro cumque tenet se 509 corpus, ea vacuum nequaquam constat inane. 510 sunt igitur solida ac sine inani corpora prima.	
1.511	511 Praeterea quoniam genitis in rebus inanest, 512 materiem circum solidam constare necessest; 513 nec res ulla potest vera ratione probari 514 corpore inane suo celare atque intus habere, 515 si non, quod cohibet, solidum constare relinquas. 516 id porro nihil esse potest nisi materiai 517 concilium, quod inane queat rerum cohibere. 518 materies igitur, solido quae corpore constat, 519 esse aeterna potest, cum cetera dissoluantur. 520 Tum porro si nil esset quod inane vocaret, 521 omne foret solidum; nisi contra corpora certa 522 essent quae loca complerent quae cumque tenerent 523 omne quod est spatium, vacuum constaret inane. 524 alternis igitur ni mirum corpus inani 525 distinctum, quoniam nec plenum naviter extat 526 nec porro vacuum; sunt ergo corpora certa, 527 quae spatium pleno possint	

	distinguere inane. 528 haec neque dissolui plagis extrinsecus icta 529 possunt nec porro penitus penetrata retexi 530 nec ratione queunt alia temptata labare; 531 id quod iam supra tibi paulo ostendimus ante. 532 nam neque conlidi sine inani posse videtur 533 quicquam nec frangi nec findi in bina secando 534 nec capere umorem neque item manabile frigus 535 nec penetralem ignem, quibus omnia conficiuntur. 536 et quo quaeque magis cohibet res intus inane, 537 tam magis his rebus penitus temptata labascit. 538 ergo si solida ac sine inani corpora prima 539 sunt ita uti docui, sint haec aeterna necessest. 540 Praeterea nisi materies aeterna fuisset,	
1.541	541 antehac ad nihilum penitus res quaeque redissent 542 de nihiloque renata forent quae cumque videmus. 543 at quoniam supra docui nil posse creari 544 de nihilo neque quod genitumst ad nil revocari, 545 esse inmortali primordia corpore debent, 546 dissolui quo quaeque supremo tempore possint, 547 materies ut subpeditet rebus reparandis. 548 sunt igitur solida primordia simplicitate 549 nec ratione queunt alia servata per aevom 550 ex infinito iam tempore res reparare. 551 denique si nullam finem natura parasset 552 frangendis rebus, iam corpora materiai 553 usque redacta forent aevo frangente priore, 554 ut nihil ex illis a certo tempore posset 555 conceptum summum aetatis pervadere finem. 556 nam quidvis citius dissolvi posse	

	videmus 557 quam rursus refici; qua propter longa diei 558 infinita aetas ante acti temporis omnis 559 quod fregisset adhuc disturbans dissoluensque, 560 numquam relicuo reparari tempore posset. 561 at nunc ni mirum frangendi reddita finis 562 certa manet, quoniam refici rem quamque videmus 563 et finita simul generatim tempora rebus 564 stare, quibus possint aevi contingere florem. 565 Huc accedit uti, solidissima materiai 566 corpora cum constant, possint tamen omnia reddi, 567 mollia quae fiunt, aer aqua terra vapores, 568 quo pacto fiant et qua vi quaeque gerantur, 569 admixtum quoniam semel est in rebus inane. 570 at contra si mollia sint primordia rerum,	
1.571	571 unde queant validi silices ferrumque creari, 572 non poterit ratio reddi; nam funditus omnis 573 principio fundamenti natura carebit. 574 sunt igitur solida pollentia simplicitate, 575 quorum condenso magis omnia conciliatu 576 artari possunt validasque ostendere viris. 577 porro si nullast frangendis reddita finis 578 corporibus, tamen ex aeterno tempore quaeque 579 nunc etiam superare necessest corpora rebus, 580 quae non dum clueant ullo temptata periclo. 581 at quoniam fragili natura praedita constant, 582 discrepat aeternum tempus potuisse manere 583 innumerabilibus plagis vexata per aevom. 584 Denique iam quoniam generatim reddita finis 585 crescendi rebus constat vitamque	

	tenendi, 586 et quid quaeque queant per foedera naturai, 587 quid porro nequeant, sancitum quando quidem extat, 588 nec commutatur quicquam, quin omnia constant 589 usque adeo, variae volucres ut in ordine cunctae 590 ostendant maculas generalis corpore inesse, 591 inmutabilis materiae quoque corpus habere 592 debent ni mirum; nam si primordia rerum 593 commutari aliqua possent ratione revicta, 594 incertum quoque iam constet quid possit oriri, 595 quid nequeat, finita potestas denique cuique 596 qua nam sit ratione atque alte terminus haerens, 597 nec totiens possent generatim saecla referre 598 naturam mores victum motusque parentum. 599 Tum porro quoniam est extremum quodque cacumen 600 corporis illius, quod nostri cernere sensus	
1.601	601 iam nequeunt, id ni mirum sine partibus extat 602 et minima constat natura nec fuit umquam 603 per se secretum neque post hac esse valebit, 604 alterius quoniamst ipsum pars primaque et una, 605 inde aliae atque aliae similes ex ordine partes 606 agmine condenso naturam corporis explent; 607 quae quoniam per se nequeunt constare, necessest 608 haerere unde queant nulla ratione revelli. 609 sunt igitur solida primordia simplicitate, 610 quae minimis stipata cohaerent partibus arte. 611 non ex illorum conventu conciliata, 612 sed magis aeterna pollentia simplicitate, 613 unde neque avelli quicquam neque deminui iam 614 concedit natura reservans semina rebus.	

	615 Praeterea nisi erit minimum, parvissima quaeque 616 corpora constabunt ex partibus infinitis, 617 quippe ubi dimidiae partis pars semper habebit 618 dimidiam partem nec res praefiniet ulla. 619 ergo rerum inter summam minimamque quod escit, 620 nil erit ut distet; nam quamvis funditus omnis 621 summa sit infinita, tamen, parvissima quae sunt, 622 ex infinitis constabunt partibus aeque. 623 quod quoniam ratio reclamat vera negatque 624 credere posse animum, victus fateare necessest 625 esse ea quae nullis iam praedita partibus extent 626 et minima constent natura. quae quoniam sunt, 627 illa quoque esse tibi solida atque aeterna fatendum. 628 Denique si minimas in partis cuncta resolvi 629 cogere consuesset rerum natura creatrix, 630 iam nihil ex illis eadem reparare valeret	
1.631	631 propterea quia, quae nullis sunt partibus aucta, 632 non possunt ea quae debet genitalis habere 633 materies, varios conexus pondera plagas 634 concursus motus, per quas res quaeque geruntur. 635 Quapropter qui materiem rerum esse putarunt 636 ignem atque ex igni summam consistere solo, 637 magno opere a vera lapsi ratione videntur. 638 Heraclitus init quorum dux proelia primus, 639 clarus ob obscuram linguam magis inter inanis 640 quamde gravis inter Graios, qui vera requirunt; 641 omnia enim stolidi magis admirantur amantque, 642 inversis quae sub verbis latitantia cernunt, 643 veraque constituunt quae belle tangere possunt	

	644 auris et lepido quae sunt fucata sonore. 645 Nam cur tam variae res possent esse, requiro, 646 ex uno si sunt igni puroque creatae? 647 nil prodesset enim calidum denserier ignem 648 nec rare fieri, si partes ignis eandem 649 naturam quam totus habet super ignis haberent. 650 acrior ardor enim conductis partibus esset, 651 languidior porro disiectis disque supatis. 652 amplius hoc fieri nihil est quod posse rearis 653 talibus in causis, ne dum variantia rerum 654 tanta queat densis rarisque ex ignibus esse. 655 Id quoque: si faciant admixtum rebus inane, 656 denseri poterunt ignes rarique relinqui; 657 sed quia multa sibi cernunt contraria quae sint 658 et fugitant in rebus inane relinquere purum, 659 ardua dum metuunt, amittunt vera viai 660 nec rursum cernunt exempto rebus inane	
1.661	661 omnia denseri fierique ex omnibus unum 662 corpus, nil ab se quod possit mittere raptim, 663 aestifer ignis uti lumen iacit atque vaporem, 664 ut videas non e stipatis partibus esse. 665 Quod si forte alia credunt ratione potesse 666 ignis in coetu stingui mutareque corpus, 667 scilicet ex nulla facere id si parte reparcent, 668 occidet ad nihilum ni mirum funditus ardor 669 omnis et e nihilo fient quae cumque creantur; 670 nam quod cumque suis mutatum finibus exit, 671 continuo hoc mors est illius quod fuit ante. 672 proinde aliquid superare necesse est incolume ollis,	

	673 ne tibi res redeant ad nilum funditus omnes 674 de nihiloque renata vigescat copia rerum. 675 Nunc igitur quoniam certissima corpora quaedam 676 sunt, quae conservant naturam semper eandem, 677 quorum abitu aut aditu mutatoque ordine mutant 678 naturam res et convertunt corpora sese, 679 scire licet non esse haec ignea corpora rerum. 680 nil referret enim quaedam decedere, abire 681 atque alia adtribui mutarique ordine quaedam, 682 si tamen ardoris naturam cuncta tenerent; 683 ignis enim foret omnimodis quod cumque crearet. 684 verum, ut opinor, itast: sunt quaedam corpora, quorum 685 concursus motus ordo positura figurae 686 efficiunt ignis mutatoque ordine mutant 687 naturam neque sunt igni simulata neque ulli 688 praeterea rei quae corpora mittere possit 689 sensibus et nostros adiectu tangere tactus. 690 dicere porro ignem res omnis esse neque ullam	
1.691	691 rem veram in numero rerum constare nisi ignem, 692 quod facit hic idem, perdelirum esse videtur. 693 nam contra sensus ab sensibus ipse repugnat 694 et labefactat eos, unde omnia credita pendent, 695 unde hic cognitus est ipsi quem nominat ignem; 696 credit enim sensus ignem cognoscere vere, 697 cetera non credit, quae nilo clara minus sunt. 698 quod mihi cum vanum tum delirum esse videtur; 699 quo referemus enim? quid nobis certius ipsis 700 sensibus esse potest, qui vera ac falsa notemus? 701 Praeterea quare quisquam magis omnia tollat	

	702 et velit ardoris naturam linquere solam, 703 quam neget esse ignis, aliam tamen esse relinquat? 704 aequa videtur enim dementia dicere utrumque. 705 Quapropter qui materiem rerum esse putarunt 706 ignem atque ex igni summam consistere posse, 707 et qui principium gignundis aera rebus 708 constituere aut umorem qui cumque putarunt 709 fingere res ipsum per se terramve creare 710 omnia et in rerum naturas vertier omnis, 711 magno opere a vero longe derrasse videntur. 712 adde etiam qui conduplicant primordia rerum 713 aera iungentes igni terramque liquori, 714 et qui quattuor ex rebus posse omnia rentur 715 ex igni terra atque anima procrescere et imbri. 716 quorum Acragantinus cum primis Empedocles est, 717 insula quem triquetris terrarum gessit in oris, 718 quam fluitans circum magnis anfractibus aequor 719 Ionium glaucis aspargit virus ab undis 720 angustoque fretu rapidum mare dividit undis	
1.721	721 Aeoliae terrarum oras a finibus eius. 722 hic est vasta Charybdis et hic Aetnaea minantur 723 murmura flammarum rursum se colligere iras, 724 faucibus eruptos iterum vis ut vomat ignis 725 ad caelumque ferat flammai fulgura rursum. 726 quae cum magna modis multis miranda videtur 727 gentibus humanis regio visendaque fertur 728 rebus opima bonis, multa munita virum vi, 729 nil tamen hoc habuisse viro praeclarius in se 730 nec sanctum magis et mirum carumque videtur.	

	731 carmina quin etiam divini pectoris eius 732 vociferantur et exponunt praeclara reperta, 733 ut vix humana videatur stirpe creatus. 734 Hic tamen et supra quos diximus inferiores 735 partibus egregie multis multoque minores, 736 quamquam multa bene ac divinitus invenientes 737 ex adyto tam quam cordis responsa dedere 738 sanctius et multo certa ratione magis quam 739 Pythia quae tripodi a Phoebi lauroque profatur, 740 principiis tamen in rerum fecere ruinas 741 et graviter magni magno cecidere ibi casu. 742 Primum quod motus exempto rebus inani 743 constituunt et res mollis rarasque relinquunt 744 aera solem ignem terras animalia frugis 745 nec tamen admiscent in eorum corpus inane; 746 deinde quod omnino finem non esse secandis 747 corporibus facient neque pausam stare fragori 748 nec prorsum in rebus minimum consistere quicquam, 749 cum videamus id extremum cuiusque cacumen 750 esse quod ad sensus nostros minimum esse videtur,	
1.751	751 conicere ut possis ex hoc, quae cernere non quis 752 extremum quod habent, minimum consistere rerum. 753 Huc accedit item, quoniam primordia rerum 754 mollia constituunt, quae nos nativa videmus 755 esse et mortali cum corpore, funditus ut qui 756 debeat ad nihilum iam rerum summa reverti 757 de nihiloque renata vigescere copia rerum; 758 quorum utrumque quid a vero iam distet habebis. 759 Deinde inimica modis multis sunt atque veneno	

	760 ipsa sibi inter se; quare aut congressa peribunt 761 aut ita diffugient, ut tempestate coacta 762 fulmina diffugere atque imbris ventosque videmus. 763 Denique quattuor ex rebus si cuncta creantur 764 atque in eas rursum res omnia dissoluuntur, 765 qui magis illa queunt rerum primordia dici 766 quam contra res illorum retroque putari? 767 alternis gignuntur enim mutantque colorem 768 et totam inter se naturam tempore ab omni. 769 770 sin ita forte putas ignis terraeque coire 771 corpus et aerias auras roremque liquoris, 772 nil in concilio naturam ut mutet eorum, 773 nulla tibi ex illis poterit res esse creata, 774 non animans, non exanimo cum corpore, ut arbos; 775 quippe suam quicque in coetu variantis acervi 776 naturam ostendet mixtusque videbitur aer 777 cum terra simul et quodam cum rore manere. 778 at primordia gignundis in rebus oportet 779 naturam clandestinam caecamque adhibere, 780 emineat ne quid, quod contra pugnet et obstet	
1.781	781 quo minus esse queat proprie quodcumque creatur. 782 Quin etiam repetunt a caelo atque ignibus eius 783 et primum faciunt ignem se vertere in auras 784 aeris, hinc imbrem gigni terramque creari 785 ex imbri retroque a terra cuncta reverti, 786 umorem primum, post aera, deinde calorem, 787 nec cessare haec inter se mutare, meare 788 a caelo ad terram, de terra ad sidera mundi. 789 quod facere haud ullo debent	

	primordia pacto. 790 immutabile enim quiddam superare necessest, 791 ne res ad nihilum redigantur funditus omnes; 792 nam quod cumque suis mutatum finibus exit, 793 continuo hoc mors est illius quod fuit ante. 794 quapropter quoniam quae paulo diximus ante 795 in commutatum veniunt, constare necessest 796 ex aliis ea, quae nequeant convertier usquam, 797 ne tibi res redeant ad nilum funditus omnis; 798 quin potius tali natura praedita quaedam 799 corpora constituas, ignem si forte crearint, 800 posse eadem demptis paucis paucisque tributis, 801 ordine mutato et motu, facere aeris auras, 802 sic alias aliis rebus mutarier omnis? 803 'At manifesta palam res indicat' inquis 'in auras 804 aeris e terra res omnis crescere alique; 805 et nisi tempestas indulget tempore fausto 806 imbribus, ut tabe nimborum arbusta vacillent, 807 solque sua pro parte fovet tribuitque calorem, 808 crescere non possint fruges arbusta animantis.' 809 scilicet et nisi nos cibus aridus et tener umor 810 adiuvet, amisso iam corpore vita quoque omnis	
1.811	811 omnibus e nervis atque ossibus exsoluatur; 812 adiutamur enim dubio procul atque alimur nos 813 certis ab rebus, certis aliae atque aliae res. 814 ni mirum quia multa modis communia multis 815 multarum rerum in rebus primordia mixta 816 sunt, ideo variis variae res rebus aluntur. 817 atque eadem magni refert primordia saepe 818 cum quibus et quali positura	Now let us also take for scrutiny The homeomeria of Anaxagoras, So called by Greeks, for which our pauper-speech Yieldeth no name in the Italian tongue, Although the thing itself is not o'erhard For explanation. First, then, when he speaks Of this homeomeria of things, he thinks Bones to be sprung from littlest bones minute, And from minute and littlest flesh all flesh, And blood created out of drops of blood, Conceiving gold compact of grains of gold, And earth concreted out of bits of earth, Fire made of fires, and water out of waters, Feigning the like with all the

	contineantur 819 et quos inter se dent motus accipiantque; 820 namque eadem caelum mare terras flumina solem 821 constituunt, eadem fruges arbusta animantis, 822 verum aliis alioque modo commixta moventur. 823 quin etiam passim nostris in versibus ipsis 824 multa elementa vides multis communia verbis, 825 cum tamen inter se versus ac verba necessest 826 confiteare et re et sonitu distare sonanti. 827 tantum elementa queunt permutato ordine solo; 828 at rerum quae sunt primordia, plura adhibere 829 possunt unde queant variae res quaeque creari. 830 Nunc et Anaxagorae scrutemur homoeomerian 831 quam Grai memorant nec nostra dicere lingua 832 concedit nobis patrii sermonis egestas, 833 sed tamen ipsam rem facilest exponere verbis. 834 principio, rerum quam dicit homoeomerian, 835 ossa videlicet e pauxillis atque minutis 836 ossibus hic et de pauxillis atque minutis 837 visceribus viscus gigni sanguenque creari 838 sanguinis inter se multis coeuntibus guttis 839 ex aurique putat micis consistere posse 840 aurum et de terris terram concrescere parvis,	rest of stuff. Yet he concedes not any void in things, Nor any limit to cutting bodies down. Wherefore to me he seems on both accounts To err no less than those we named before.
1.841	841 ignibus ex ignis, umorem umoribus esse, 842 cetera consimili fingit ratione putatque. 843 nec tamen esse ulla de parte in rebus inane 844 concedit neque corporibus finem esse secandis. 845 quare in utraque mihi pariter ratione videtur 846 errare atque illi, supra quos diximus ante. 847 Adde quod inbecilla nimis	

	primordia fingit; 848 si primordia sunt, simili quae praedita constant 849 natura atque ipsae res sunt aequeque laborant 850 et pereunt, neque ab exitio res ulla refrenat. 851 nam quid in oppressu valido durabit eorum, 852 ut mortem effugiat, leti sub dentibus ipsis? 853 ignis an umor an aura? quid horum? sanguen an ossa? 854 nil ut opinor, ubi ex aequo res funditus omnis 855 tam mortalis erit quam quae manifesta videmus 856 ex oculis nostris aliqua vi victa perire. 857 at neque reccidere ad nihilum res posse neque autem 858 crescere de nihilo testor res ante probatas. 859 Praeterea quoniam cibus auget corpus alitque, 860 scire licet nobis venas et sanguen et ossa 860a * * * 861 sive cibos omnis commixto corpore dicent 862 esse et habere in se nervorum corpora parva 863 ossaque et omnino venas partisque cruoris, 864 fiet uti cibus omnis et aridus et liquor ipse 865 ex alienigenis rebus constare putetur, 866 ossibus et nervis sanieque et sanguine mixto. 867 Praeterea quae cumque e terra corpora crescunt, 868 si sunt in terris, terram constare necessest 869 ex alienigenis, quae terris exoriuntur.	
1.870	870 transfer item, totidem verbis utare licebit: 871 in lignis si flamma latet fumusque cinisque, 872 ex alienigenis consistant ligna necessest, 873 874 ex alienigenis, quae lignis exoriuntur. 875 Linquitur hic quaedam latitandi copia tenvis, 876 id quod Anaxagoras sibi sumit, ut	

	omnibus omnis 877 res putet inmixtas rebus latitare, sed illud 878 apparere unum, cuius sint plurima mixta 879 et magis in promptu primaque in fronte locata. 880 quod tamen a vera longe ratione repulsumst; 881 conveniebat enim fruges quoque saepe, minaci 882 robore cum in saxi franguntur, mittere signum 883 sanguinis aut aliquid, nostro quae corpore aluntur. 884 cum lapidi in lapidem terimus, manare cruorem 885 consimili ratione herbis quoque saepe decebat, 886 et latices dulcis guttas similique sapore 887 mittere, lanigerae quali sunt ubere lactis, 888 scilicet et glebis terrarum saepe friatis 889 herbarum genera et fruges frondesque videri 890 dispertita inter terram latitare minute, 891 postremo in lignis cinerem fumumque videri, 892 cum praefracta forent, ignisque latere minutos. 893 quorum nil fieri quoniam manifesta docet res, 894 scire licet non esse in rebus res ita mixtas, 895 verum semina multimodis inmixta latere 896 multarum rerum in rebus communia debent. 897 'At saepe in magnis fit montibus' inquis 'ut altis 898 arboribus vicina cacumina summa terantur 899 inter se validis facere id cogentibus austris,	
1.900	900 donec flammai fulserunt flore coorto.' 901 scilicet et non est lignis tamen insitus ignis, 902 verum semina sunt ardoris multa, terendo 903 quae cum confluxere, creant incendia silvis. 904 quod si facta foret silvis abscondita flamma, 905 non possent ullum tempus celarier	

	ignes, 906 conficerent volgo silvas, arbusta cremarent. 907 iamne vides igitur, paulo quod diximus ante, 908 permagni referre eadem primordia saepe 909 cum quibus et quali positura contineantur 910 et quos inter se dent motus accipiantque, 911 atque eadem paulo inter se mutata creare 912 ignes et lignum? quo pacto verba quoque ipsa 913 inter se paulo mutatis sunt elementis, 914 cum ligna atque ignes distincta voce notemus. 915 Denique iam quae cumque in rebus cernis apertis 916 si fieri non posse putas, quin materiai 917 corpora consimili natura praedita fingas, 918 hac ratione tibi pereunt primordia rerum: 919 fiet uti risu tremulo concussa cachinnent 920 et lacrimis salsis umectent ora genasque. 921 Nunc age, quod super est, cognosce et clarius audi. 922 nec me animi fallit quam sint obscura; sed acri 923 percussit thyrso laudis spes magna meum cor 924 et simul incussit suavem mi in pectus amorem 925 Musarum, quo nunc instinctus mente vigenti 926 avia Pieridum peragro loca nullius ante 927 trita solo. iuvat integros accedere fontis 928 atque haurire iuvatque novos decerpere flores 929 insignemque meo capiti petere inde coronam,	
1.930	930 unde prius nulli velarint tempora Musae; 931 primum quod magnis doceo de rebus et artis 932 religionum animum nodis exsolvere pergo, 933 deinde quod obscura de re tam lucida pango 934 carmina musaeo contingens cuncta	

	lepore. 935 id quoque enim non ab nulla ratione videtur; 936 sed vel uti pueris absinthia taetra medentes 937 cum dare conantur, prius oras pocula circum 938 contingunt mellis dulci flavoque liquore, 939 ut puerorum aetas inprovida ludificetur 940 labrorum tenus, interea perpotet amarum 941 absinthi laticem deceptaque non capiatur, 942 sed potius tali facto recreata valescat, 943 sic ego nunc, quoniam haec ratio plerumque videtur 944 tristior esse quibus non est tractata, retroque 945 volgus abhorret ab hac, volui tibi suaviloquenti 946 carmine Pierio rationem exponere nostram 947 et quasi musaeo dulci contingere melle, 948 si tibi forte animum tali ratione tenere 949 versibus in nostris possem, dum perspicis omnem 950 naturam rerum, qua constet compta figura. 951 Sed quoniam docui solidissima materiai 952 corpora perpetuo volitare invicta per aevom, 953 nunc age, summai quaedam sit finis eorum 954 necne sit, evolvamus; item quod inane repertumst 955 seu locus ac spatium, res in quo quaeque gerantur, 956 pervideamus utrum finitum funditus omne 957 constet an immensum pateat vasteque profundum. 958 Omne quod est igitur nulla regione viarum 959 finitumst; namque extremum debebat habere.	
1.960	960 extremum porro nullius posse videtur 961 esse, nisi ultra sit quod finiat, ut videatur 962 quo non longius haec sensus natura sequatur. 963 nunc extra summam quoniam nihil	

	esse fatendum, 964 non habet extremum, caret ergo fine modoque. 965 nec refert quibus adsistas regionibus eius; 966 usque adeo, quem quisque locum possedit, in omnis 967 tantundem partis infinitum omne relinquit. 968 Praeterea si iam finitum constituatur 969 omne quod est spatium, si quis procurrat ad oras 970 ultimus extremas iaciatque volatile telum, 971 id validis utrum contortum viribus ire 972 quo fuerit missum mavis longeque volare, 973 an prohibere aliquid censes obstareque posse? 974 alterutrum fatearis enim sumasque necessest. 975 quorum utrumque tibi effugium praecludit et omne 976 cogit ut exempta concedas fine patere. 977 nam sive est aliquid quod probeat efficiatque 978 quo minus quo missum est veniat finique locet se, 979 sive foras fertur, non est a fine profectum. 980 hoc pacto sequar atque, oras ubi cumque locaris 981 extremas, quaeram: quid telo denique fiet? 982 fiet uti nusquam possit consistere finis 983 effugiumque fugae prolatet copia semper. 984 Praeterea spatium summai totius omne 985 undique si inclusum certis consisteret oris 986 finitumque foret, iam copia materiai 987 undique ponderibus solidis confluxet ad imum 988 nec res ulla geri sub caeli tegmine posset 989 nec foret omnino caelum neque lumina solis,	
1.990	990 quippe ubi materies omnis cumulata iaceret 991 ex infinito iam tempore subsidendo. 992 at nunc ni mirum requies data	

	principiorum 993 corporibus nullast, quia nil est funditus imum, 994 quo quasi confluere et sedes ubi ponere possint. 995 semper in adsiduo motu res quaeque geruntur 996 partibus in cunctis, infernaque suppeditantur 997 ex infinito cita corpora materiai. 998 Postremo ante oculos res rem finire videtur; 999 aer dissaepit collis atque aera montes, 1000 terra mare et contra mare terras terminat omnis; 1001 omne quidem vero nihil est quod finiat extra. 1002 est igitur natura loci spatiumque profundi, 1003 quod neque clara suo percurrere fulmina cursu 1004 perpetuo possint aevi labentia tractu 1005 nec prorsum facere ut restet minus ire meando; 1006 usque adeo passim patet ingens copia rebus 1007 finibus exemptis in cunctas undique partis. 1008 Ipsa modum porro sibi rerum summa parare 1009 ne possit, natura tenet, quae corpus inane 1010 et quod inane autem est finiri corpore cogit, 1011 ut sic alternis infinita omnia reddat, 1012 aut etiam alterutrum, nisi terminet alterum eorum, 1013 simplice natura pateat tamen inmoderatum, 1014 nec mare nec tellus neque caeli lucida templa 1015 nec mortale genus nec divum corpora sancta 1016 exiguum possent horai sistere tempus; 1017 nam dispulsa suo de coetu materiai 1018 copia ferretur magnum per inane soluta, 1019 sive adeo potius numquam concreta creasset	
1.1020	1020 ullam rem, quoniam cogi disiecta nequisset. 1021 nam certe neque consilio primordia rerum	

	1022 ordine se suo quaeque sagaci mente locarunt 1023 nec quos quaeque darent motus pepigere profecto 1024 sed quia multa modis multis mutata per omne 1025 ex infinito vexantur percita plagis, 1026 omne genus motus et coetus experiundo 1027 tandem deveniunt in talis disposituras, 1028 qualibus haec rerum consistit summa creata, 1029 et multos etiam magnos servata per annos 1030 ut semel in motus coniectast convenientis, 1031 efficit ut largis avidum mare fluminis undis 1032 integrent amnes et solis terra vapore 1033 fota novet fetus summissaque gens animantum 1034 floreat et vivant labentis aetheris ignes. 1035 quod nullo facerent pacto, nisi materiai 1036 ex infinito suboriri copia posset, 1037 unde amissa solent reparare in tempore quaeque. 1038 nam vel uti privata cibo natura animantum 1039 diffluit amittens corpus, sic omnia debent 1040 dissolui simul ac defecit suppeditare 1041 materies aliqua ratione aversa viai. 1042 nec plagae possunt extrinsecus undique summam 1043 conservare omnem, quae cumque est conciliata. 1044 cudere enim crebro possunt partemque morari, 1045 dum veniant aliae ac suppleri summa queatur; 1046 inter dum resilire tamen coguntur et una 1047 principiis rerum spatium tempusque fugai 1048 largiri, ut possint a coetu libera ferri. 1049 quare etiam atque etiam suboriri multa necessest,	
1.1050	1050 et tamen ut plagae quoque possint suppetere ipsae, 1051 infinita opus est vis undique materiai.	And in these problems, shrink, my Memmius, far From yielding faith to that notorious talk: That all things inward to the centre press; And thus

	1052 Illud in his rebus longe fuge credere, Memmi, 1053 in medium summae quod dicunt omnia niti 1054 atque ideo mundi naturam stare sine ullis 1055 ictibus externis neque quoquam posse resolvi 1056 summa atque ima, quod in medium sint omnia nixa, 1057 ipsum si quicquam posse in se sistere credis, 1058 et quae pondera sunt sub terris omnia sursum 1059 nitier in terraque retro requiescere posta, 1060 ut per aquas quae nunc rerum simulacra videmus; 1061 et simili ratione animalia suppa vagari 1062 contendunt neque posse e terris in loca caeli 1063 reccidere inferiora magis quam corpora nostra 1064 sponte sua possint in caeli templa volare; 1065 illi cum videant solem, nos sidera noctis 1066 cernere et alternis nobiscum tempora caeli 1067 dividere et noctes parilis agitare diebus. 1068 sed vanus stolidis haec * * * 1069 amplexi quod habent perv * * * 1070 nam medium nihil esse potest * * * 1071 infinita; neque omnino, si iam medium sit, 1072 possit ibi quicquam consistere * * * 1073 quam quavis alia longe ratione * * * 1074 omnis enim locus ac spatium, quod inane vocamus, 1075 per medium, per non medium, concedere debet 1076 aeque ponderibus, motus qua cumque feruntur. 1077 nec quisquam locus est, quo corpora cum venerunt, 1078 ponderis amissa vi possint stare in inani; 1079 nec quod inane autem est ulli subsistere debet,	the nature of the world stands firm With never blows from outward, nor can be Nowhere disparted- since all height and depth Have always inward to the centre pressed (If thou art ready to believe that aught Itself can rest upon itself); or that The ponderous bodies which be under earth Do all press upwards and do come to rest Upon the earth, in some way upside down, Like to those images of things we see At present through the waters. They contend, With like procedure, that all breathing things Head downward roam about, and yet cannot Tumble from earth to realms of sky below, No more than these our bodies wing away Spontaneously to vaults of sky above; That, when those creatures look upon the sun, We view the constellations of the night; And that with us the seasons of the sky They thus alternately divide, and thus Do pass the night coequal to our days, But a vain error has given these dreams to fools, Which they've embraced with reasoning perverse For centre none can be where world is still Boundless, nor yet, if now a centre were, Could aught take there a fixed position more Than for some other cause 'tmight be dislodged. For all of room and space we call the void Must both through centre and non-centre yield Alike to weights where'er their motions tend. Nor is there any place, where, when they've come, Bodies can be at standstill in the void, Deprived of force of weight; nor yet may void Furnish support to any,- nay, it must, True to its bent of nature, still give way. Thus in such manner not at all can things Be held in union, as if overcome By craving for a centre.
1.1080	1080 quin, sua quod natura petit, concedere pergat. 1081 haud igitur possunt tali ratione teneri	But besides, Seeing they feign that not all bodies press To centre inward, rather only those Of earth and water (liquid of the sea, And the big billows

	1082 res in concilium medii cuppedine victae. 1083 Praeterea quoniam non omnia corpora fingunt 1084 in medium niti, sed terrarum atque liquoris 1086 umorem ponti magnasque e montibus undas, 1085 et quasi terreno quae corpore contineantur, 1087 at contra tenuis exponunt aeris auras 1088 et calidos simul a medio differrier ignis, 1089 atque ideo totum circum tremere aethera signis 1090 et solis flammam per caeli caerula pasci, 1091 quod calor a medio fugiens se ibi conligat omnis, 1092 nec prorsum arboribus summos frondescere ramos 1093 posse, nisi a terris paulatim cuique cibatum 1094 1095 1096 1097 1098 1099 1100 1101 1102 ne volucri ritu flammarum moenia mundi 1103 diffugiant subito magnum per inane soluta 1104 et ne cetera consimili ratione sequantur 1105 neve ruant caeli tonitralia templa superne 1106 terraque se pedibus raptim subducat et omnis 1107 inter permixtas rerum caelique ruinas 1108 corpora solventes abeat per inane profundum, 1109 temporis ut puncto nihil extet reliquiarum	from the mountain slopes, And whatsoever are encased, as 'twere, In earthen body), contrariwise, they teach How the thin air, and with it the hot fire, Is borne asunder from the centre, and how, For this all ether quivers with bright stars, And the sun's flame along the blue is fed (Because the heat, from out the centre flying, All gathers there), and how, again, the boughs Upon the tree-tops could not sprout their leaves, Unless, little by little, from out the earth For each were nutriment... . . . . Lest, after the manner of the winged flames, The ramparts of the world should flee away, Dissolved amain throughout the mighty void, And lest all else should likewise follow after, Aye, lest the thundering vaults of heaven should burst And splinter upward, and the earth forthwith Withdraw from under our feet, and all its bulk, Among its mingled wrecks and those of heaven, With slipping asunder of the primal seeds, Should pass, along the immeasurable inane, Away forever, and, that instant, naught Of wrack and remnant would be left, beside The desolate space, and germs invisible. For on whatever side thou deemest first The primal bodies lacking, lo, that side Will be for things the very door of death: Wherethrough the throng of matter all will dash, Out and abroad. These points, if thou wilt ponder, Then, with but paltry trouble led along... . . . . For one thing after other will grow clear, Nor shall the blind night rob thee of the road, To hinder thy gaze on nature's Farthest-forth. Thus things for things shall kindle torches new.
1.1110	1110 desertum praeter spatium et primordia caeca. 1111 nam qua cumque prius de parti corpora desse 1112 constitues, haec rebus erit pars ianua leti, 1113 hac se turba foras dabit omnis materiai. 1114 Haec sic pernosces parva perductus opella;	

	1115 namque alid ex alio clarescet nec tibi caeca 1116 nox iter eripiet, quin ultima naturai 1117 pervideas: ita res accendent lumina rebus.	
2.1	1 Suave, mari magno turbantibus aequora ventis 2 e terra magnum alterius spectare laborem; 3 non quia vexari quemquamst iucunda voluptas, 4 sed quibus ipse malis careas quia cernere suavest. 6 suave etiam belli certamina magna tueri 5 per campos instructa tua sine parte pericli; 7 sed nihil dulcius est, bene quam munita tenere 8 edita doctrina sapientum templa serena, 9 despicere unde queas alios passimque videre 10 errare atque viam palantis quaerere vitae, 11 certare ingenio, contendere nobilitate, 12 noctes atque dies niti praestante labore 13 ad summas emergere opes rerumque potiri. 14 o miseras hominum mentes, o pectora caeca! 15 qualibus in tenebris vitae quantisque periclis 16 degitur hoc aevi quod cumquest! nonne videre 17 nihil aliud sibi naturam latrare, nisi ut qui 18 corpore seiunctus dolor absit, mente fruatur 19 iucundo sensu cura semota metuque? 20 ergo corpoream ad naturam pauca videmus 21 esse opus omnino: quae demant cumque dolorem, 22 delicias quoque uti multas substernere possint 23 gratius inter dum, neque natura ipsa requirit, 24 si non aurea sunt iuvenum simulacra per aedes 25 lampadas igniferas manibus retinentia dextris, 26 lumina nocturnis epulis ut suppeditentur,	'Tis sweet, when, down the mighty main, the winds Roll up its waste of waters, from the land To watch another's labouring anguish far, Not that we joyously delight that man Should thus be smitten, but because 'tis sweet To mark what evils we ourselves be spared; 'Tis sweet, again, to view the mighty strife Of armies embattled yonder o'er the plains, Ourselves no sharers in the peril; but naught There is more goodly than to hold the high Serene plateaus, well fortressed by the wise, Whence thou may'st look below on other men And see them ev'rywhere wand'ring, all dispersed In their lone seeking for the road of life; Rivals in genius, or emulous in rank, Pressing through days and nights with hugest toil For summits of power and mastery of the world. O wretched minds of men! O blinded hearts! In how great perils, in what darks of life Are spent the human years, however brief!- O not to see that nature for herself Barks after nothing, save that pain keep off, Disjoined from the body, and that mind enjoy Delightsome feeling, far from care and fear! Therefore we see that our corporeal life Needs little, altogether, and only such As takes the pain away, and can besides Strew underneath some number of delights. More grateful 'tis at times (for nature craves No artifice nor luxury), if forsooth But if thou believe That the primordial germs of things can stop, And in their stopping give new motions birth, Afar thou wanderest from the road of truth. For since they wander through the void inane, All the primordial germs of things must needs Be borne along, either by weight their own, Or haply by another's blow without. For, when, in their incessancy so oft They meet and clash, it comes to pass amain They leap asunder, face to face: not strange- Being most hard, and solid in their weights, And naught opposing motion, from behind. And that more clearly thou perceive how all These mites of matter are darted round

	27 nec domus argento fulget auroque renidet 28 nec citharae reboant laqueata aurataque templa, 29 cum tamen inter se prostrati in gramine molli 30 propter aquae rivum sub ramis arboris altae	about, Recall to mind how nowhere in the sum Of All exists a bottom,- nowhere is A realm of rest for primal bodies; since (As amply shown and proved by reason sure) Space has no bound nor measure, and extends Unmetered forth in all directions round. Since this stands certain, thus 'tis out of doubt No rest is rendered to the primal bodies Along the unfathomable inane; but rather, Inveterately plied by motions mixed, Some, at their jamming, bound aback and leave Huge gaps between, and some from off the blow Are hurried about with spaces small between. And all which, brought together with slight gaps, In more condensed union bound aback, Now what the speed to matter's atoms given Thou mayest in few, my Memmius, learn from this: When first the dawn is sprinkling with new light The lands, and all the breed of birds abroad Flit round the trackless forests, with liquid notes Filling the regions along the mellow air, We see 'tis forthwith manifest to man How suddenly the risen sun is wont At such an hour to overspread and clothe The whole with its own splendour; but the sun's Warm exhalations and this serene light Travel not down an empty void; and thus They are compelled more slowly to advance, Whilst, as it were, they cleave the waves of air; Nor one by one travel these particles Of the warm exhalations, but are all Entangled and enmassed, whereby at once Each is restrained by each, and from without Checked, till compelled more slowly to advance. But the primordial atoms with their old Simple solidity, when forth they travel Along the empty void, all undelayed By aught outside them there, and they, each one Being one unit from nature of its parts, Are borne to that one place on which they strive Still to lay hold, must then, beyond a doubt, Outstrip in speed, and be more swiftly borne Than light of sun, and over regions rush, Of space much vaster, in the self-same time The sun's effulgence widens round the sky. In these affairs We wish thee also well aware of this: The atoms, as their own weight bears them down Plumb through the void, at scarce determined times, In scarce determined places, from their course

		Decline a little- call it, so to speak, Mere changed trend. For were it not their wont Thuswise to swerve, down would they fall, each one, Like drops of rain, through the unbottomed void; And then collisions ne'er could be nor blows Among the primal elements; and thus Nature would never have created aught. But, if perchance be any that believe The heavier bodies, as more swiftly borne Plumb down the void, are able from above To strike the lighter, thus engendering blows Able to cause those procreant motions, far From highways of true reason they retire. For whatsoever through the waters fall, Or through thin air, must quicken their descent, Each after its weight- on this account, because Both bulk of water and the subtle air By no means can retard each thing alike, But give more quick before the heavier weight; But contrariwise the empty void cannot, On any side, at any time, to aught Oppose resistance, but will ever yield, True to its bent of nature. Wherefore all, With equal speed, though equal not in weight, Must rush, borne downward through the still inane.
2.31	31 non magnis opibus iucunde corpora curant, 32 praesertim cum tempestas adridet et anni 33 tempora conspergunt viridantis floribus herbas. 34 nec calidae citius decedunt corpore febres, 35 textilibus si in picturis ostroque rubenti 36 iacteris, quam si in plebeia veste cubandum est. 37 quapropter quoniam nihil nostro in corpore gazae 38 proficiunt neque nobilitas nec gloria regni, 39 quod super est, animo quoque nil prodesse putandum; 40 si non forte tuas legiones per loca campi 41 fervere cum videas belli simulacra cientis, 42 subsidiis magnis et opum vi constabilitas, 43 ornatas armis stlattas pariterque animatas, 44 his tibi tum rebus timefactae religiones 45 effugiunt animo pavidae mortisque	There be no golden images of boys Along the halls, with right hands holding out The lamps ablaze, the lights for evening feasts, And if the house doth glitter not with gold Nor gleam with silver, and to the lyre resound No fretted and gilded ceilings overhead, Yet still to lounge with friends in the soft grass Beside a river of water, underneath A big tree's boughs, and merrily to refresh Our frames, with no vast outlay- most of all If the weather is laughing and the times of the year Besprinkle the green of the grass around with flowers. Nor yet the quicker will hot fevers go, If on a pictured tapestry thou toss, Or purple robe, than if 'tis thine to lie Upon the poor man's bedding. Wherefore, since Treasure, nor rank, nor glory of a reign Avail us naught for this our body, thus Reckon them likewise nothing for the mind: Save then perchance, when thou beholdest forth Thy legions swarming round the Field of Mars, Rousing a mimic warfare- either side Strengthened with large auxiliaries and horse, Alike equipped with arms, alike inspired; Or save when also thou

	timores 46 tum vacuum pectus lincunt curaque solutum. 47 quod si ridicula haec ludibriaque esse videmus, 48 re veraque metus hominum curaeque sequaces 49 nec metuunt sonitus armorum nec fera tela 50 audacterque inter reges rerumque potentis 51 versantur neque fulgorem reverentur ab auro 52 nec clarum vestis splendorem purpureai, 53 quid dubitas quin omnis sit haec rationis potestas, 54 omnis cum in tenebris praesertim vita laboret? 55 nam vel uti pueri trepidant atque omnia caecis 56 in tenebris metuunt, sic nos in luce timemus 57 inter dum, nihilo quae sunt metuenda magis quam 58 quae pueri in tenebris pavitant finguntque futura. 59 hunc igitur terrorem animi tenebrasque necessest 60 non radii solis neque lucida tela diei	beholdest forth Thy fleets to swarm, deploying down the sea: For then, by such bright circumstance abashed, Religion pales and flees thy mind; O then The fears of death leave heart so free of care. But if we note how all this pomp at last Linked by their own all inter-tangled shapes,- These form the irrefragable roots of rocks And the brute bulks of iron, and what else Is of their kind... The rest leap far asunder, far recoil, Leaving huge gaps between: and these supply For us thin air and splendour-lights of the sun. And many besides wander the mighty void- Cast back from unions of existing things, Nowhere accepted in the universe, And nowise linked in motions to the rest. And of this fact (as I record it here) An image, a type goes on before our eyes Present each moment; for behold whenever The sun's light and the rays, let in, pour down Across dark halls of houses: thou wilt see The many mites in many a manner mixed Amid a void in the very light of the rays, And battling on, as in eternal strife, And in battalions contending without halt, In meetings, partings, harried up and down. From this thou mayest conjecture of what sort The ceaseless tossing of primordial seeds Amid the mightier void- at least so far As small affair can for a vaster serve, And by example put thee on the spoor Of knowledge. For this reason too 'tis fit Thou turn thy mind the more unto these bodies Which here are witnessed tumbling in the light: Namely, because such tumblings are a sign . . . . . Nor to pursue the atoms one by one, To see the law whereby each thing goes on. But some men, ignorant of matter, think, Opposing this, that not without the gods, In such adjustment to our human ways, Can nature change the seasons of the years, And bring to birth the grains and all of else To which divine Delight, the guide of life, Persuades mortality and leads it on, That, through her artful blandishments of love, It propagate the generations still, Lest humankind should perish. When they feign That gods have stablished all things but for man, They seem in all ways mightily to lapse From reason's truth: for ev'n if ne'er I knew What seeds primordial are, yet would I

		dare This to affirm, ev'n from deep judgment based Upon the ways and conduct of the skies- This to maintain by many a fact besides- That in no wise the nature of the world For us was builded by a power divine- So great the faults it stands encumbered with: The which, my Memmius, later on, for thee We will clear up. Now as to what remains Concerning motions we'll unfold our thought. Thus ne'er at all have heavier from above Been swift to strike the lighter, gendering strokes Which cause those divers motions, by whose means Nature transacts her work. And so I say, The atoms must a little swerve at times- But only the least, lest we should seem to feign Motions oblique, and fact refute us there. For this we see forthwith is manifest: Whatever the weight, it can't obliquely go, Down on its headlong journey from above, At least so far as thou canst mark; but who Is there can mark by sense that naught can swerve At all aside from off its road's straight line? Again, if ev'r all motions are co-linked, And from the old ever arise the new In fixed order, and primordial seeds Produce not by their swerving some new start Of motion to sunder the covenants of fate, That cause succeed not cause from everlasting, Whence this free will for creatures o'er the lands, Whence is it wrested from the fates,- this will Whereby we step right forward where desire Leads each man on, whereby the same we swerve In motions, not as at some fixed time, Nor at some fixed line of space, but where The mind itself has urged? For out of doubt In these affairs 'tis each man's will itself That gives the start, and hence throughout our limbs Incipient motions are diffused. Again, Dost thou not see, when, at a point of time,
2.61	61 discutiant, sed naturae species ratioque. 62 Nunc age, quo motu genitalia materiai 63 corpora res varias gignant genitasque resolvant 64 et qua vi facere id cogantur quaeque sit ollis 65 reddita mobilitas magnum per inane meandi, 66 expediam: tu te dictis praebere memento.	Is but a drollery and a mocking sport, And of a truth man's dread, with cares at heels, Dreads not these sounds of arms, these savage swords But among kings and lords of all the world Mingles undaunted, nor is overawed By gleam of gold nor by the splendour bright Of purple robe, canst thou then doubt that this Is aught, but power of thinking?- when, besides The whole of life but labours in the dark. For just as children tremble and fear all In the viewless

	67 nam certe non inter se stipata cohaeret 68 materies, quoniam minui rem quamque videmus 69 et quasi longinquo fluere omnia cernimus aevo 70 ex oculisque vetustatem subducere nostris, 71 cum tamen incolumis videatur summa manere 72 propterea quia, quae decedunt corpora cuique, 73 unde abeunt minuunt, quo venere augmine donant. 74 illa senescere, at haec contra florescere cogunt, 75 nec remorantur ibi. sic rerum summa novatur 76 semper, et inter se mortales mutua vivunt. 77 augescunt aliae gentes, aliae minuuntur, 78 inque brevi spatio mutantur saecla animantum 79 et quasi cursores vitai lampada tradunt. 80 Si cessare putas rerum primordia posse 81 cessandoque novos rerum progignere motus, 82 avius a vera longe ratione vagaris. 83 nam quoniam per inane vagantur, cuncta necessest 84 aut gravitate sua ferri primordia rerum 85 aut ictu forte alterius. nam cum cita saepe 86 obvia conflixere, fit ut diversa repente 87 dissiliant; neque enim mirum, durissima quae sint 88 ponderibus solidis neque quicquam a tergibus obstet. 89 et quo iactari magis omnia materiai 90 corpora pervideas, reminiscere totius imum	dark, so even we at times Dread in the light so many things that be No whit more fearsome than what children feign, Shuddering, will be upon them in the dark. This terror then, this darkness of the mind, Not sunrise with its flaring spokes of light, Nor glittering arrows of morning can disperse, But only nature's aspect and her law. That motions also of the primal stuff Secret and viewless lurk beneath, behind. For thou wilt mark here many a speck, impelled By viewless blows, to change its little course, And beaten backwards to return again, Hither and thither in all directions round. Lo, all their shifting movement is of old, From the primeval atoms; for the same Primordial seeds of things first move of self, And then those bodies built of unions small And nearest, as it were, unto the powers Of the primeval atoms, are stirred up By impulse of those atoms' unseen blows, And these thereafter goad the next in size: Thus motion ascends from the primevals on, And stage by stage emerges to our sense, Until those objects also move which we Can mark in sunbeams, though it not appears What blows do urge them. The bars are opened, how the eager strength Of horses cannot forward break as soon As pants their mind to do? For it behooves That all the stock of matter, through the frame, Be roused, in order that, through every joint, Aroused, it press and follow mind's desire; So thus thou seest initial motion's gendered From out the heart, aye, verily, proceeds First from the spirit's will, whence at the last 'Tis given forth through joints and body entire. Quite otherwise it is, when forth we move, Impelled by a blow of another's mighty powers And mighty urge; for then 'tis clear enough All matter of our total body goes, Hurried along, against our own desire- Until the will has pulled upon the reins And checked it back, throughout our members all; At whose arbitrament indeed sometimes The stock of matter's forced to change its path, Throughout our members and throughout our joints, And, after being forward cast, to be Reined up, whereat it settles back again. So seest thou not, how, though external force Drive men before, and

		often make them move, Onward against desire, and headlong snatched, Yet is there something in these breasts of ours Strong to combat, strong to withstand the same?- Wherefore no less within the primal seeds Thou must admit, besides all blows and weight, Some other cause of motion, whence derives And brazen bars, which, budging hard in locks, Do grate and scream. But what are liquid, formed Of fluid body, they indeed must be Of elements more smooth and round- because Their globules severally will not cohere: To suck the poppy-seeds from palm of hand Is quite as easy as drinking water down, And they, once struck, roll like unto the same. But that thou seest among the things that flow Some bitter, as the brine of ocean is, Is not the least a marvel... For since 'tis fluid, smooth its atoms are And round, with painful rough ones mixed therein; Yet need not these be held together hooked: In fact, though rough, they're globular besides, Able at once to roll, and rasp the sense. And that the more thou mayst believe me here, That with smooth elements are mixed the rough (Whence Neptune's salt astringent body comes), There is a means to separate the twain, And thereupon dividedly to see How the sweet water, after filtering through So often underground, flows freshened forth Into some hollow; for it leaves above The primal germs of nauseating brine, Since cling the rough more readily in earth. Lastly, whatso thou markest to disperse Upon the instant- smoke, and cloud, and flame- Must not (even though not all of smooth and round) Be yet co-linked with atoms intertwined,
2.91	91 nil esse in summa, neque habere ubi corpora prima 92 consistant, quoniam spatium sine fine modoquest 93 inmensumque patere in cunctas undique partis 94 pluribus ostendi et certa ratione probatumst. 95 quod quoniam constat, ni mirum nulla quies est 96 reddita corporibus primis per inane profundum, 97 sed magis adsiduo varioque exercita motu 98 partim intervallis magnis confulta	This power in us inborn, of some free act.- Since naught from nothing can become, we see. For weight prevents all things should come to pass Through blows, as 'twere, by some external force; But that man's mind itself in all it does Hath not a fixed necessity within, Nor is not, like a conquered thing, compelled To bear and suffer,- this state comes to man From that slight swervement of the elements In no fixed line of space, in no fixed time. That thus they can, without together cleaving, So pierce our body and so bore the rocks. Whatever we see... Given to senses,

	resultant, 99 pars etiam brevibus spatiis vexantur ab ictu. 100 et quae cumque magis condenso conciliatu 101 exiguis intervallis convecta resultant, 102 indupedita suis perplexis ipsa figuris, 103 haec validas saxi radices et fera ferri 104 corpora constituunt et cetera de genere horum. 105 paucula quae porro magnum per inane vagantur, 106 cetera dissiliunt longe longeque recursant 107 in magnis intervallis; haec aera rarum 108 sufficiunt nobis et splendida lumina solis. 109 multaque praeterea magnum per inane vagantur, 110 conciliis rerum quae sunt reiecta nec usquam 111 consociare etiam motus potuere recepta. 112 Cuius, uti memoro, rei simulacrum et imago 113 ante oculos semper nobis versatur et instat. 114 contemplator enim, cum solis lumina cumque 115 inserti fundunt radii per opaca domorum: 116 multa minuta modis multis per inane videbis 117 corpora misceri radiorum lumine in ipso 118 et vel ut aeterno certamine proelia pugnas 119 edere turmatim certantia nec dare pausam, 120 conciliis et discidiis exercita crebris;	that thou must perceive They're not from linked but pointed elements. Immune from peril and immune from pain, Themselves abounding in riches of their own, Needing not us, they are not touched by wrath They are not taken by service or by gift. Truly is earth insensate for all time; But, by obtaining germs of many things, In many a way she brings the many forth Into the light of sun. And here, whoso Decides to call the ocean Neptune, or The grain-crop Ceres, and prefers to abuse The name of Bacchus rather than pronounce The liquor's proper designation, him Let us permit to go on calling earth Mother of Gods, if only he will spare To taint his soul with foul religion. And hold all heaven from the lands away.
2.121	121 conicere ut possis ex hoc, primordia rerum 122 quale sit in magno iactari semper inani. 123 dum taxat, rerum magnarum parva potest res 124 exemplare dare et vestigia notitiai. 125 Hoc etiam magis haec animum te advertere par est 126 corpora quae in solis radiis turbare videntur, 127 quod tales turbae motus quoque materiai	

	128 significant clandestinos caecosque subesse. 129 multa videbis enim plagis ibi percita caecis 130 commutare viam retroque repulsa reverti 131 nunc huc nunc illuc in cunctas undique partis. 132 scilicet hic a principiis est omnibus error. 133 prima moventur enim per se primordia rerum, 134 inde ea quae parvo sunt corpora conciliatu 135 et quasi proxima sunt ad viris principiorum, 136 ictibus illorum caecis inpulsa cientur, 137 ipsaque proporro paulo maiora lacessunt. 138 sic a principiis ascendit motus et exit 139 paulatim nostros ad sensus, ut moveantur 140 illa quoque, in solis quae lumine cernere quimus 141 nec quibus id faciant plagis apparet aperte. 142 Nunc quae mobilitas sit reddita materiai 143 corporibus, paucis licet hinc cognoscere, Memmi. 144 primum aurora novo cum spargit lumine terras 145 et variae volucres nemora avia pervolitantes 146 aera per tenerum liquidis loca vocibus opplent, 147 quam subito soleat sol ortus tempore tali 148 convestire sua perfundens omnia luce, 149 omnibus in promptu manifestumque esse videmus. 150 at vapor is, quem sol mittit, lumenque serenum	
2.151	151 non per inane meat vacuum; quo tardius ire 152 cogitur, aerias quasi dum diverberat undas; 153 nec singillatim corpuscula quaeque vaporis 154 sed complexa meant inter se conque globata; 155 qua propter simul inter se retrahuntur et extra 156 officiuntur, uti cogantur tardius ire. 157 at quae sunt solida primordia	

	simplicitate, 158 cum per inane meant vacuum nec res remoratur 159 ulla foris atque ipsa suis e partibus unum, 160 unum, in quem coepere, locum conixa feruntur, 161 debent ni mirum praecellere mobilitate 162 et multo citius ferri quam lumina solis 163 multiplexque loci spatium transcurrere eodem 164 tempore quo solis pervolgant fulgura caelum. 164a * * * 165 nec persectari primordia singula quaeque, 166 ut videant qua quicque geratur cum ratione. 167 At quidam contra haec, ignari materiai, 168 naturam non posse deum sine numine reddunt 169 tanto opere humanis rationibus atmoderate 170 tempora mutare annorum frugesque creare 171 et iam cetera, mortalis quae suadet adire 172 ipsaque deducit dux vitae dia voluptas 173 et res per Veneris blanditur saecla propagent, 174 ne genus occidat humanum. quorum omnia causa 175 constituisse deos cum fingunt, omnibus rebus 176 magno opere a vera lapsi ratione videntur. 177 nam quamvis rerum ignorem primordia quae sint, 178 hoc tamen ex ipsis caeli rationibus ausim 179 confirmare aliisque ex rebus reddere multis,	
2.180	180 nequaquam nobis divinitus esse creatam 181 naturam mundi: tanta stat praedita culpa. 182 quae tibi posterius, Memmi, faciemus aperta; 183 nunc id quod super est de motibus expediemus. 184 Nunc locus est, ut opinor, in his illud quoque rebus 185 confirmare tibi, nullam rem posse sua vi	

	186 corpoream sursum ferri sursumque meare. 187 ne tibi dent in eo flammarum corpora frudem; 188 sursus enim versus gignuntur et augmina sumunt 189 et sursum nitidae fruges arbustaque crescunt, 190 pondera, quantum in se est, cum deorsum cuncta ferantur. 191 nec cum subsiliunt ignes ad tecta domorum 192 et celeri flamma degustant tigna trabesque, 193 sponte sua facere id sine vi subiecta putandum est. 194 quod genus e nostro com missus corpore sanguis 195 emicat exultans alte spargitque cruorem. 196 nonne vides etiam quanta vi tigna trabesque 197 respuat umor aquae? nam quo magis ursimus altum 198 derecta et magna vi multi pressimus aegre, 199 tam cupide sursum removet magis atque remittit, 200 plus ut parte foras emergant exiliantque. 201 nec tamen haec, quantum est in se, dubitamus, opinor, 202 quin vacuum per inane deorsum cuncta ferantur. 203 sic igitur debent flammae quoque posse per auras 204 aeris expressae sursum succedere, quamquam 205 pondera, quantum in se est, deorsum deducere pugnent. 206 nocturnasque faces caeli sublime volantis 207 nonne vides longos flammarum ducere tractus 208 in quas cumque dedit partis natura meatum? 209 non cadere in terras stellas et sidera cernis?	
2.210	210 sol etiam caeli de vertice dissipat omnis 211 ardorem in partis et lumine conserit arva; 212 in terras igitur quoque solis vergitur ardor. 213 transversosque volare per imbris fulmina cernis, 214 nunc hinc nunc illinc abrupti nubibus ignes	

	215 concursant; cadit in terras vis flammea volgo. 216 Illud in his quoque te rebus cognoscere avemus, 217 corpora cum deorsum rectum per inane feruntur 218 ponderibus propriis, incerto tempore ferme 219 incertisque locis spatio depellere paulum, 220 tantum quod momen mutatum dicere possis. 221 quod nisi declinare solerent, omnia deorsum 222 imbris uti guttae caderent per inane profundum 223 nec foret offensus natus nec plaga creata 224 principiis; ita nihil umquam natura creasset. 225 Quod si forte aliquis credit graviora potesse 226 corpora, quo citius rectum per inane feruntur, 227 incidere ex supero levioribus atque ita plagas 228 gignere, quae possint genitalis reddere motus, 229 avius a vera longe ratione recedit. 230 nam per aquas quae cumque cadunt atque aera rarum, 231 haec pro ponderibus casus celerare necessest 232 propterea quia corpus aquae naturaque tenvis 233 aeris haud possunt aeque rem quamque morari, 234 sed citius cedunt gravioribus exsuperata; 235 at contra nulli de nulla parte neque ullo 236 tempore inane potest vacuum subsistere rei, 237 quin, sua quod natura petit, concedere pergat; 238 omnia qua propter debent per inane quietum 239 aeque ponderibus non aequis concita ferri.	
2.240	240 haud igitur poterunt levioribus incidere umquam 241 ex supero graviora neque ictus gignere per se, 242 qui varient motus, per quos natura gerat res. 243 quare etiam atque etiam paulum inclinare necessest 244 corpora; nec plus quam minimum,	

	ne fingere motus 245 obliquos videamur et id res vera refutet. 246 namque hoc in promptu manifestumque esse videmus, 247 pondera, quantum in se est, non posse obliqua meare, 248 ex supero cum praecipitant, quod cernere possis; 249 sed nihil omnino recta regione viai 250 declinare quis est qui possit cernere sese? 251 Denique si semper motu conectitur omnis 252 et vetere exoritur motus novus ordine certo 253 nec declinando faciunt primordia motus 254 principium quoddam, quod fati foedera rumpat, 255 ex infinito ne causam causa sequatur, 256 libera per terras unde haec animantibus exstat, 257 unde est haec, inquam, fatis avolsa voluntas, 258 per quam progredimur quo ducit quemque voluptas, 259 declinamus item motus nec tempore certo 260 nec regione loci certa, sed ubi ipsa tulit mens? 261 nam dubio procul his rebus sua cuique voluntas 262 principium dat et hinc motus per membra rigantur. 263 nonne vides etiam patefactis tempore puncto 264 carceribus non posse tamen prorumpere equorum 265 vim cupidam tam de subito quam mens avet ipsa? 266 omnis enim totum per corpus materiai 267 copia conciri debet, concita per artus 268 omnis ut studium mentis conixa sequatur; 269 ut videas initum motus a corde creari	
2.270	270 ex animique voluntate id procedere primum, 271 inde dari porro per totum corpus et artus. 272 nec similest ut cum inpulsi procedimus ictu 273 viribus alterius magnis magnoque coactu;	Nor ever was the stock of stuff more crammed, Nor ever, again, sundered by bigger gaps: For naught gives increase and naught takes away; On which account, just as they move to-day, The elemental bodies moved of old And shall the same hereafter evermore. And what was wont to be begot of old Shall

	274 nam tum materiem totius corporis omnem 275 perspicuumst nobis invitis ire rapique, 276 donec eam refrenavit per membra voluntas. 277 iamne vides igitur, quamquam vis extera multos 278 pellat et invitos cogat procedere saepe 279 praecipitesque rapi, tamen esse in pectore nostro 280 quiddam quod contra pugnare obstareque possit? 281 cuius ad arbitrium quoque copia materiai 282 cogitur inter dum flecti per membra per artus 283 et proiecta refrenatur retroque residit. 284 quare in seminibus quoque idem fateare necessest, 285 esse aliam praeter plagas et pondera causam 286 motibus, unde haec est nobis innata potestas, 287 de nihilo quoniam fieri nihil posse videmus. 288 pondus enim prohibet ne plagis omnia fiant 289 externa quasi vi; sed ne res ipsa necessum 290 intestinum habeat cunctis in rebus agendis 291 et devicta quasi cogatur ferre patique, 292 id facit exiguum clinamen principiorum 293 nec regione loci certa nec tempore certo. 294 Nec stipata magis fuit umquam materiai 295 copia nec porro maioribus intervallis; 296 nam neque adaugescit quicquam neque deperit inde. 297 qua propter quo nunc in motu principiorum 298 corpora sunt, in eodem ante acta aetate fuere 299 et post haec semper simili ratione ferentur,	be begotten under selfsame terms And grow and thrive in power, so far as given To each by Nature's changeless, old decrees. The sum of things there is no power can change, For naught exists outside, to which can flee Out of the world matter of any kind, Nor forth from which a fresh supply can spring, Break in upon the founded world, and change Whole nature of things, and turn their motions about.
2.300	300 et quae consuerint gigni gignentur eadem 301 condicione et erunt et crescent vique valebunt, 302 quantum cuique datum est per foedera naturai.	

	303 nec rerum summam commutare ulla potest vis; 304 nam neque quo possit genus ullum materiai 305 effugere ex omni quicquam est extra, neque in omne 306 unde coorta queat nova vis inrumpere et omnem 307 naturam rerum mutare et vertere motus. 308 Illud in his rebus non est mirabile, quare, 309 omnia cum rerum primordia sint in motu, 310 summa tamen summa videatur stare quiete, 311 praeter quam siquid proprio dat corpore motus. 312 omnis enim longe nostris ab sensibus infra 313 primorum natura iacet; qua propter, ubi ipsa 314 cernere iam nequeas, motus quoque surpere debent; 315 praesertim cum, quae possimus cernere, celent 316 saepe tamen motus spatio diducta locorum. 317 nam saepe in colli tondentes pabula laeta 318 lanigerae reptant pecudes, quo quamque vocantes 319 invitant herbae gemmantes rore recenti, 320 et satiati agni ludunt blandeque coruscant; 321 omnia quae nobis longe confusa videntur 322 et velut in viridi candor consistere colli. 323 praeterea magnae legiones cum loca cursu 324 camporum complent belli simulacra cientes, 325 fulgor ubi ad caelum se tollit totaque circum 326 aere renidescit tellus supterque virum vi 327 excitur pedibus sonitus clamoreque montes 328 icti reiectant voces ad sidera mundi 329 et circum volitant equites mediosque repente	
2.330	330 tramittunt valido quatientes impete campos; 331 et tamen est quidam locus altis montibus, unde 332 stare videntur et in campis	

	consistere fulgor. 333 Nunc age, iam deinceps cunctarum exordia rerum 334 qualia sint et quam longe distantia formis, 335 percipe, multigenis quam sint variata figuris; 336 non quo multa parum simili sint praedita forma, 337 sed quia non volgo paria omnibus omnia constant. 338 nec mirum; nam cum sit eorum copia tanta, 339 ut neque finis, uti docui, neque summa sit ulla, 340 debent ni mirum non omnibus omnia prorsum 341 esse pari filo similique adfecta figura. 342 Praeterea genus humanum mutaeque natantes 343 squamigerum pecudes et laeta armenta feraeque 344 et variae volucres, laetantia quae loca aquarum 345 concelebrant circum ripas fontisque lacusque, 346 et quae pervolgant nemora avia pervolitantes, 347 quorum unum quidvis generatim sumere perge; 348 invenies tamen inter se differre figuris. 349 nec ratione alia proles cognoscere matrem 350 nec mater posset prolem; quod posse videmus 351 nec minus atque homines inter se nota cluere. 352 nam saepe ante deum vitulus delubra decora 353 turicremas propter mactatus concidit aras 354 sanguinis expirans calidum de pectore flumen; 355 at mater viridis saltus orbata peragrans 356 novit humi pedibus vestigia pressa bisulcis, 357 omnia convisens oculis loca, si queat usquam 358 conspicere amissum fetum, completque querellis 359 frondiferum nemus adsistens et crebra revisit	
2.360	360 ad stabulum desiderio perfixa iuvenci, 361 nec tenerae salices atque herbae	

	rore vigentes 362 fluminaque ulla queunt summis labentia ripis 363 oblectare animum subitamque avertere curam, 364 nec vitulorum aliae species per pabula laeta 365 derivare queunt animum curaque levare; 366 usque adeo quiddam proprium notumque requirit. 367 praeterea teneri tremulis cum vocibus haedi 368 cornigeras norunt matres agnique petulci 369 balantum pecudes; ita, quod natura resposcit, 370 ad sua quisque fere decurrunt ubera lactis. 371 Postremo quodvis frumentum non tamen omne 372 quidque suo genere inter se simile esse videbis, 373 quin intercurrat quaedam distantia formis. 374 concharumque genus parili ratione videmus 375 pingere telluris gremium, qua mollibus undis 376 litoris incurvi bibulam pavit aequor harenam. 377 quare etiam atque etiam simili ratione necessest, 378 natura quoniam constant neque facta manu sunt 379 unius ad certam formam primordia rerum, 380 dissimili inter se quaedam volitare figura. 381 Perfacile est animi ratione exsolvere nobis 382 quare fulmineus multo penetralior ignis 383 quam noster fluat e taedis terrestribus ortus; 384 dicere enim possis caelestem fulminis ignem 385 subtilem magis e parvis constare figuris 386 atque ideo transire foramina quae nequit ignis 387 noster hic e lignis ortus taedaque creatus. 388 praeterea lumen per cornum transit, at imber 389 respuitur. quare, nisi luminis illa minora	
2.390	390 corpora sunt quam de quibus est	

	liquor almus aquarum? 391 et quamvis subito per colum vina videmus 392 perfluere, at contra tardum cunctatur olivom, 393 aut quia ni mirum maioribus est elementis 394 aut magis hamatis inter se perque plicatis, 395 atque ideo fit uti non tam diducta repente 396 inter se possint primordia singula quaeque 397 singula per cuiusque foramina permanare. 398 Huc accedit uti mellis lactisque liquores 399 iucundo sensu linguae tractentur in ore; 400 at contra taetra absinthi natura ferique 401 centauri foedo pertorquent ora sapore; 402 ut facile agnoscas e levibus atque rutundis 403 esse ea quae sensus iucunde tangere possunt, 404 at contra quae amara atque aspera cumque videntur, 405 haec magis hamatis inter se nexa teneri 406 proptereaque solere vias rescindere nostris 407 sensibus introituque suo perrumpere corpus. 408 omnia postremo bona sensibus et mala tactu 409 dissimili inter se pugnant perfecta figura; 410 ne tu forte putes serrae stridentis acerbum 411 horrorem constare elementis levibus aeque 412 ac musaea mele, per chordas organici quae 413 mobilibus digitis expergefacta figurant; 414 neu simili penetrare putes primordia forma 415 in nares hominum, cum taetra cadavera torrent, 416 et cum scena croco Cilici perfusa recens est 417 araque Panchaeos exhalat propter odores; 418 neve bonos rerum simili constare colores 419 semine constituas, oculos qui	

	pascere possunt,	
2.420	420 et qui conpungunt aciem lacrimareque cogunt 421 aut foeda specie foedi turpesque videntur. 422 omnis enim, sensus quae mulcet cumque, tibi res 423 haut sine principiali aliquo levore creatast; 424 at contra quae cumque molesta atque aspera constat, 425 non aliquo sine materiae squalore repertast. 426 Sunt etiam quae iam nec levia iure putantur 427 esse neque omnino flexis mucronibus unca, 428 sed magis angellis paulum prostantibus, ut quae 429 titillare magis sensus quam laedere possint, 430 fecula iam quo de genere est inulaeque sapores. 431 Denique iam calidos ignis gelidamque pruinam 432 dissimili dentata modo conpungere sensus 433 corporis, indicio nobis est tactus uterque. 434 tactus enim, tactus, pro divum numina sancta, 435 corporis est sensus, vel cum res extera sese 436 insinuat, vel cum laedit quae in corpore natast 437 aut iuvat egrediens genitalis per Veneris res, 438 aut ex offensu cum turbant corpore in ipso, 439 semina confundunt inter se concita sensum; 440 ut si forte manu quamvis iam corporis ipse 441 tute tibi partem ferias atque experiare. 442 qua propter longe formas distare necessest 443 principiis, varios quae possint edere sensus. 444 Denique quae nobis durata ac spissa videntur, 445 haec magis hamatis inter sese esse necessest 446 et quasi ramosis alte compacta teneri. 447 in quo iam genere in primis adamantina saxa 448 prima acie constant ictus	

	contemnere sueta 449 et validi silices ac duri robora ferri	
2.450	450 aeraque quae claustris restantia vociferantur. 451 illa quidem debent e levibus atque rutundis 452 esse magis, fluvido quae corpore liquida constant. 453 namque papaveris haustus itemst facilis quod aquarum; 454 nec retinentur enim inter se glomeramina quaeque 455 et perculsus item proclive volubilis exstat. 456 omnia postremo quae puncto tempore cernis 457 diffugere ut fumum nebulas flammasque, necessest, 458 si minus omnia sunt e levibus atque rotundis, 459 at non esse tamen perplexis indupedita, 460 pungere uti possint corpus penetrareque saxa, 461 nec tamen haerere inter se; quod cumque videmus 462 sensibus dentatum, facile ut cognoscere possis 463 non e perplexis, sed acutis esse elementis. 464 sed quod amara vides eadem quae fluvida constant, 465 sudor uti maris est, minime mirabile debet 465a * * * 466 nam quod fluvidus est, e levibus atque rotundis 467 est, sed levibus sunt hamata admixta doloris 468 corpora. nec tamen haec retineri hamata necessust: 469 scilicet esse globosa tamen, cum squalida constent, 470 provolvi simul ut possint et laedere sensus. 471 et quo mixta putes magis aspera levibus esse 472 principiis, unde est Neptuni corpus acerbum, 473 est ratio secernendi seorsumque videndi, 474 umor dulcis ubi per terras crebrius idem 475 percolatur, ut in foveam fluat ac mansuescat; 476 linquit enim supera taetri primordia viri, 477 aspera quo magis in terris	

	haerescere possint. 478 Quod quoniam docui, pergam conectere rem quae	
2.479	479 ex hoc apta fidem ducat, primordia rerum 480 finita variare figurarum ratione. 481 quod si non ita sit, rursum iam semina quaedam 482 esse infinito debebunt corporis auctu. 483 namque in eadem una cuiusvis iam brevitate 484 corporis inter se multum variare figurae 485 non possunt. fac enim minimis e partibus esse 486 corpora prima tribus, vel paulo pluribus auge; 487 nempe ubi eas partis unius corporis omnis, 488 summa atque ima locans, transmutans dextera laevis, 489 omnimodis expertus eris, quam quisque det ordo 490 formai speciem totius corporis eius, 491 quod super est, si forte voles variare figuras, 492 addendum partis alias erit. inde sequetur, 493 adsimili ratione alias ut postulet ordo, 494 si tu forte voles etiam variare figuras. 495 ergo formarum novitatem corporis augmen 496 subsequitur. quare non est ut credere possis 497 esse infinitis distantia semina formis, 498 ne quaedam cogas inmani maximitate 499 esse, supra quod iam docui non posse probari. 500 iam tibi barbaricae vestes Meliboeaque fulgens 501 purpura Thessalico concharum tacta colore, 502 aurea pavonum ridenti imbuta lepore 503 saecla novo rerum superata colore iacerent 504 et contemptus odor smyrnae mellisque sapores, 505 et cycnea mele Phoebeaque daedala chordis 506 carmina consimili ratione oppressa silerent;	

	507 namque aliis aliud praestantius exoreretur. 508 cedere item retro possent in deteriores	
2.509	509 omnia sic partis, ut diximus in melioris; 510 namque aliis aliud retro quoque taetrius esset 511 naribus auribus atque oculis orisque sapori. 512 quae quoniam non sunt, sed rebus reddita certa 513 finis utrimque tenet summam, fateare necessest 514 materiem quoque finitis differe figuris. 515 denique ab ignibus ad gelidas hiemum usque pruinas 516 finitumst retroque pari ratione remensumst. 517 omnis enim calor ac frigus mediique tepores 518 interutrasque iacent explentes ordine summam. 519 ergo finita distant ratione creata, 520 ancipiti quoniam mucroni utrimque notantur, 521 hinc flammis illinc rigidis infesta pruinis. 522 Quod quoniam docui, pergam conectere rem quae 523 ex hoc apta fidem ducat, primordia rerum, 524 inter se simili quae sunt perfecta figura, 525 infinita cluere. etenim distantia cum sit 526 formarum finita, necesse est quae similes sint 527 esse infinitas aut summam materiai 528 finitam constare, id quod non esse probavi. 528a * * * 529 versibus ostendam corpuscula materiai 530 ex infinito summam rerum usque tenere 531 undique protelo plagarum continuato. 532 nam quod rara vides magis esse animalia quaedam 533 fecundamque magis naturam cernis in illis, 534 at regione locoque alio terrisque remotis 535 multa licet genere esse in eo numerumque repleri; 536 sicut quadripedum cum primis esse	

	videmus 537 in genere anguimanus elephantos, India quorum	
2.538	538 milibus e multis vallo munitur eburno, 539 ut penitus nequeat penetrari: tanta ferarum 540 vis est, quarum nos perpauca exempla videmus. 541 sed tamen id quoque uti concedam, quam lubet esto 542 unica res quaedem nativo corpore sola, 543 cui similis toto terrarum non sit, in orbi; 544 infinita tamen nisi erit vis materiai, 545 unde ea progigni possit concepta, creari 546 non poterit neque, quod super est, procrescere alique. 547 quippe etenim sumant alii finita per omne 548 corpora iactari unius genitalia rei, 549 unde ubi qua vi et quo pacto congressa coibunt 550 materiae tanto in pelago turbaque aliena? 551 non, ut opinor, habent rationem conciliandi: 552 sed quasi naufragiis magnis multisque coortis 553 disiactare solet magnum mare transtra cavernas 554 antemnas prorem malos tonsasque natantis, 555 per terrarum omnis oras fluitantia aplustra 556 ut videantur et indicium mortalibus edant, 557 infidi maris insidias virisque dolumque 558 ut vitare velint, neve ullo tempore credant, 559 subdola cum ridet placidi pellacia ponti, 560 sic tibi si finita semel primordia quaedam 561 constitues, aevom debebunt sparsa per omnem 562 disiectare aestus diversi materiai, 563 numquam in concilium ut possint compulsa coire 564 nec remorari in concilio nec crescere adaucta; 565 quorum utrumque palam fieri manifesta docet res, 566 et res progigni et genitas procrescere posse.	

	567 esse igitur genere in quovis primordia rerum	
2.568	568 infinita palam est, unde omnia suppeditantur. 569 Nec superare queunt motus itaque exitiales 570 perpetuo neque in aeternum sepelire salutem, 571 nec porro rerum genitales auctificique 572 motus perpetuo possunt servare creata. 573 sic aequo geritur certamine principiorum 574 ex infinito contractum tempore bellum. 575 nunc hic nunc illic superant vitalia rerum 576 et superantur item. miscetur funere vagor, 577 quem pueri tollunt visentis luminis oras; 578 nec nox ulla diem neque noctem aurora secutast, 579 quae non audierit mixtos vagitibus aegris 580 ploratus, mortis comites et funeris atri. 581 Illud in his obsignatum quoque rebus habere 582 convenit et memori mandatum mente tenere, 583 nil esse, in promptu quorum natura videtur, 584 quod genere ex uno consistat principiorum, 585 nec quicquam quod non permixto semine constet. 586 et quod cumque magis vis multas possidet in se 587 atque potestates, ita plurima principiorum 588 in sese genera ac varias docet esse figuras. 589 Principio tellus habet in se corpora prima, 590 unde mare inmensum volventes frigora fontes 591 adsidue renovent, habet ignes unde oriantur; 592 nam multis succensa locis ardent sola terrae, 593 ex imis vero furit ignibus impetus Aetnae. 594 tum porro nitidas fruges arbustaque laeta 595 gentibus humanis habet unde extollere possit,	

	596 unde etiam fluvios frondes et pabula laeta 597 montivago generi possit praebere ferarum.	
2.598	598 quare magna deum mater materque ferarum 599 et nostri genetrix haec dicta est corporis una. 600 Hanc veteres Graium docti cecinere poetae 601 sedibus in curru biiugos agitare leones, 602 aeris in spatio magnam pendere docentes 603 tellurem neque posse in terra sistere terram. 604 adiunxere feras, quia quamvis effera proles 605 officiis debet molliri victa parentum. 606 muralique caput summum cinxere corona, 607 eximiis munita locis quia sustinet urbes. 608 quo nunc insigni per magnas praedita terras 609 horrifice fertur divinae matris imago. 610 hanc variae gentes antiquo more sacrorum 611 Idaeam vocitant matrem Phrygiasque catervas 612 dant comites, quia primum ex illis finibus edunt 613 per terrarum orbes fruges coepisse creari. 614 Gallos attribuunt, quia, numen qui violarint 615 Matris et ingrati genitoribus inventi sint, 616 significare volunt indignos esse putandos, 617 vivam progeniem qui in oras luminis edant. 618 tympana tenta tonant palmis et cymbala circum 619 concava, raucisonoque minantur cornua cantu, 620 et Phrygio stimulat numero cava tibia mentis, 621 telaque praeportant, violenti signa furoris, 622 ingratos animos atque impia pectora volgi 623 conterrere metu quae possint numine divae. 624 ergo cum primum magnas invecta per urbis	

	625 munificat tacita mortalis muta salute, 626 aere atque argento sternunt iter omne viarum 627 largifica stipe ditantes ninguntque rosarum	
2.628	628 floribus umbrantes matrem comitumque catervam. 629 hic armata manus, Curetas nomine Grai 630 quos memorant, Phrygias inter si forte catervas 631 ludunt in numerumque exultant sanguine laeti 632 terrificas capitum quatientes numine cristas, 633 Dictaeos referunt Curetas, qui Iovis illum 634 vagitum in Creta quondam occultasse feruntur, 635 cum pueri circum puerum pernice chorea 636 637 armati in numerum pulsarent aeribus aera, 638 ne Saturnus eum malis mandaret adeptus 639 aeternumque daret matri sub pectore volnus. 640 propterea magnam armati matrem comitantur, 641 aut quia significant divam praedicere ut armis 642 ac virtute velint patriam defendere terram 643 praesidioque parent decorique parentibus esse. 644 quae bene et eximie quamvis disposta ferantur, 645 longe sunt tamen a vera ratione repulsa. 646 omnis enim per se divom natura necessest 647 inmortali aevo summa cum pace fruatur 648 semota ab nostris rebus seiunctaque longe; 649 nam privata dolore omni, privata periclis, 650 ipsa suis pollens opibus, nihil indiga nostri, 651 nec bene promeritis capitur neque tangitur ira. 652 terra quidem vero caret omni tempore sensu, 653 et quia multarum potitur primordia rerum, 654 multa modis multis effert in lumina	

	solis. 655 hic siquis mare Neptunum Cereremque vocare 656 constituet fruges et Bacchi nomine abuti 657 mavolt quam laticis proprium proferre vocamen,	
2.658	658 concedamus ut hic terrarum dictitet orbem 659 esse deum matrem, dum vera re tamen ipse 680 religione animum turpi contingere parcat. 660 Saepe itaque ex uno tondentes gramina campo 661 lanigerae pecudes et equorum duellica proles 662 buceriaeque greges eodem sub tegmine caeli 663 ex unoque sitim sedantes flumine aquai 664 dissimili vivont specie retinentque parentum 665 naturam et mores generatim quaeque imitantur. 666 tanta est in quovis genere herbae materiai 667 dissimilis ratio, tanta est in flumine quoque. 668 Hinc porro quamvis animantem ex omnibus unam 669 ossa cruor venae calor umor viscera nervi 670 constituunt, quae sunt porro distantia longe, 671 dissimili perfecta figura principiorum. 672 Tum porro quae cumque igni flammata cremantur. 673 si nil praeterea, tamen haec in corpore tradunt, 674 unde ignem iacere et lumen submittere possint 675 scintillasque agere ac late differre favillam. 676 cetera consimili mentis ratione peragrans 677 invenies igitur multarum semina rerum 678 corpore celare et varias cohibere figuras. 679 Denique multa vides, quibus et color et sapor una 681 reddita sunt cum odore in primis pleraque poma. 682 haec igitur variis debent constare figuris; 683 nidor enim penetrat qua fucus non	

	it in artus, 684 fucus item sorsum, sorsum sapor insinuatur 685 sensibus; ut noscas primis differre figuris. 686 dissimiles igitur formae glomeramen in unum 687 conveniunt et res permixto semine constant.	
2.688	688 Quin etiam passim nostris in versibus ipsis 689 multa elementa vides multis communia verbis, 690 cum tamen inter se versus ac verba necesse est 691 confiteare alia ex aliis constare elementis; 692 non quo multa parum communis littera currat 693 aut nulla inter se duo sint ex omnibus isdem, 694 sed quia non volgo paria omnibus omnia constant. 695 sic aliis in rebus item communia multa 696 multarum rerum cum sint, primordia rerum 697 dissimili tamen inter se consistere summa 698 possunt; ut merito ex aliis constare feratur 699 humanum genus et fruges arbustaque laeta. 700 Nec tamen omnimodis conecti posse putandum est 701 omnia; nam volgo fieri portenta videres, 702 semiferas hominum species existere et altos 703 inter dum ramos egigni corpore vivo 704 multaque conecti terrestria membra marinis, 705 tum flammam taetro spirantis ore Chimaeras 706 pascere naturam per terras omniparentis. 707 quorum nil fieri manifestum est, omnia quando 708 seminibus certis certa genetrice creata 709 conservare genus crescentia posse videmus. 710 scilicet id certa fieri ratione necessust. 711 nam sua cuique cibis ex omnibus intus in artus 712 corpora discedunt conexaque	

	convenientis 713 efficiunt motus; at contra aliena videmus 714 reicere in terras naturam, multaque caecis 715 corporibus fugiunt e corpore percita plagis, 716 quae neque conecti quoquam potuere neque intus 717 vitalis motus consentire atque imitari.	
2.718	718 sed ne forte putes animalia sola teneri 719 legibus his, quaedam ratio res terminat omnis 720 nam vel uti tota natura dissimiles sunt 721 inter se genitae res quaeque, ita quamque necessest 722 dissimili constare figura principiorum; 723 non quo multa parum simili sint praedita forma, 724 sed quia non volgo paria omnibus omnia constant. 725 semina cum porro distent, differre necessust 726 intervalla vias conexus pondera plagas 727 concursus motus; quae non animalia solum 728 corpora seiungunt, sed terras ac mare totum 729 secernunt caelumque a terris omne retentant. 730 Nunc age dicta meo dulci quaesita labore 731 percipe, ne forte haec albis ex alba rearis 732 principiis esse, ante oculos quae candida cernis, 733 aut ea quae nigrant nigro de semine nata; 734 nive alium quemvis quae sunt inbuta colorem, 735 propterea gerere hunc credas, quod materiai 736 corpora consimili sint eius tincta colore; 737 nullus enim color est omnino materiai 738 corporibus, neque par rebus neque denique dispar. 739 in quae corpora si nullus tibi forte videtur 740 posse animi iniectus fieri, procul avius erras. 741 nam cum caecigeni, solis qui	

	lumina numquam 742 dispexere, tamen cognoscant corpora tactu 743 ex ineunte aevo nullo coniuncta colore, 744 scire licet nostrae quoque menti corpora posse 745 vorti in notitiam nullo circum lita fuco. 746 denique nos ipsi caecis quaecumque tenebris 747 tangimus, haud ullo sentimus tincta colore.	
2.748	748 Quod quoniam vinco fieri, nunc esse docebo. 749 omnis enim color omnino mutatur in omnis; 750 quod facere haud ullo debent primordia pacto; 751 immutabile enim quiddam superare necessest, 752 ne res ad nihilum redigantur funditus omnes; 753 nam quod cumque suis mutatum finibus exit, 754 continuo hoc mors est illius quod fuit ante. 755 proinde colore cave contingas semina rerum, 756 ne tibi res redeant ad nihilum funditus omnes. 757 Praeterea si nulla coloris principiis est 758 reddita natura et variis sunt praedita formis, 759 e quibus omnigenus gignunt variantque colores, 760 propterea magni quod refert, semina quaeque 761 cum quibus et quali positura contineantur 762 et quos inter se dent motus accipiantque, 763 perfacile extemplo rationem reddere possis, 764 cur ea quae nigro fuerint paulo ante colore, 765 marmoreo fieri possint candore repente, 766 ut mare, cum magni commorunt aequora venti, 767 vertitur in canos candenti marmore fluctus; 768 dicere enim possis, nigrum quod saepe videmus, 769 materies ubi permixta est illius et ordo 770 principiis mutatus et addita	

	demptaque quaedam, 771 continuo id fieri ut candens videatur et album. 772 quod si caeruleis constarent aequora ponti 773 seminibus, nullo possent albescere pacto; 774 nam quo cumque modo perturbes caerula quae sint, 775 numquam in marmoreum possunt migrare colorem. 776 sin alio atque alio sunt semina tincta colore, 777 quae maris efficiunt unum purumque nitorem,	
2.778	778 ut saepe ex aliis formis variisque figuris 779 efficitur quiddam quadratum unaque figura, 780 conveniebat, ut in quadrato cernimus esse 781 dissimiles formas, ita cernere in aequore ponti 782 aut alio in quovis uno puroque nitore 783 dissimiles longe inter se variosque colores. 784 praeterea nihil officiunt obstantque figurae 785 dissimiles, quo quadratum minus omne sit extra; 786 at varii rerum inpediunt prohibentque colores, 787 quo minus esse uno possit res tota nitore. 788 Tum porro quae ducit et inlicit ut tribuamus 789 principiis rerum non numquam causa colores, 790 occidit, ex albis quoniam non alba creantur, 791 nec quae nigra cluent de nigris, sed variis ex. 792 quippe etenim multo proclivius exorientur 793 candida de nullo quam nigro nata colore 794 aut alio quovis, qui contra pugnet et obstet. 795 Praeterea quoniam nequeunt sine luce colores 796 esse neque in lucem existunt primordia rerum, 797 scire licet quam sint nullo velata colore; 798 qualis enim caecis poterit color esse tenebris? 799 lumine quin ipso mutatur propterea	Besides, since colours cannot be, sans light, And the primordials come not forth to light, 'Tis thine to know they are not clothed with colour- Truly, what kind of colour could there be In the viewless dark? Nay, in the light itself A colour changes, gleaming variedly, When smote by vertical or slanting ray. Thus in the sunlight shows the down of doves That circles, garlanding, the nape and throat: Now it is ruddy with a bright gold-bronze, Now, by a strange sensation it becomes Green-emerald blended with the coral-red. The peacock's tail, filled with the copious light, Changes its colours likewise, when it turns. Wherefore, since by some blow of light begot, Without such blow these colours can't become. And since the pupil of the eye receives Within itself one kind of blow, when said To feel a white hue, then another kind, When feeling a black or any other hue, And since it matters nothing with what hue The things thou touchest be perchance endowed, But rather with what sort of shape equipped, 'Tis thine to know the atoms need not colour, But render forth sensations, as of touch, That vary with their varied forms.

	quod 800 recta aut obliqua percussus luce refulget; 801 pluma columbarum quo pacto in sole videtur, 802 quae sita cervices circum collumque coronat; 803 namque alias fit uti claro sit rubra pyropo, 804 inter dum quodam sensu fit uti videatur 805 inter caeruleum viridis miscere zmaragdos. 806 caudaque pavonis, larga cum luce repleta est, 807 consimili mutat ratione obversa colores;	
2.808	808 qui quoniam quodam gignuntur luminis ictu, 809 scire licet, sine eo fieri non posse putandum est. 810 Et quoniam plagae quoddam genus excipit in se 811 pupula, cum sentire colorem dicitur album, 812 atque aliud porro, nigrum cum et cetera sentit, 813 nec refert ea quae tangas quo forte colore 814 praedita sint, verum quali magis apta figura, 815 scire licet nihil principiis opus esse colore, 816 sed variis formis variantes edere tactus. 817 Praeterea quoniam non certis certa figuris 818 est natura coloris et omnia principiorum 819 formamenta queunt in quovis esse nitore, 820 cur ea quae constant ex illis non pariter sunt 821 omnigenus perfusa coloribus in genere omni? 822 conveniebat enim corvos quoque saepe volantis 823 ex albis album pinnis iactare colorem 824 et nigros fieri nigro de semine cycnos 825 aut alio quovis uno varioque colore. 826 Quin etiam quanto in partes res quaeque minutas 827 distrahitur magis, hoc magis est ut cernere possis 828 evanescere paulatim stinguique colorem;	

	829 ut fit ubi in parvas partis discerpitur austrum: 830 purpura poeniceusque color clarissimus multo, 831 filatim cum distractum est, disperditur omnis; 832 noscere ut hinc possis prius omnem efflare colorem 833 particulas, quam discedant ad semina rerum. 834 Postremo quoniam non omnia corpora vocem 835 mittere concedis neque odorem, propterea fit 836 ut non omnibus adtribuas sonitus et odores: 837 sic oculis quoniam non omnia cernere quimus,	
2.838	838 scire licet quaedam tam constare orba colore 839 quam sine odore ullo quaedam sonituque remota, 840 nec minus haec animum cognoscere posse sagacem 841 quam quae sunt aliis rebus privata notare. 842 Sed ne forte putes solo spoliata colore 843 corpora prima manere, etiam secreta teporis 844 sunt ac frigoris omnino calidique vaporis, 845 et sonitu sterila et suco ieiuna feruntur, 846 nec iaciunt ullum proprium de corpore odorem. 847 sicut amaracini blandum stactaeque liquorem 848 et nardi florem, nectar qui naribus halat, 849 cum facere instituas, cum primis quaerere par est, 850 quod licet ac possis reperire, inolentis olivi 851 naturam, nullam quae mittat naribus auram, 852 quam minime ut possit mixtos in corpore odores 853 concoctosque suo contractans perdere viro, 854 propter eandem rem debent primordia rerum 855 non adhibere suum gignundis rebus odorem 856 nec sonitum, quoniam nihil ab se mittere possunt, 857 nec simili ratione saporem denique quemquam	

	858 nec frigus neque item calidum tepidumque vaporem, 859 cetera, quae cum ita sunt tamen ut mortalia constent, 860 molli lenta, fragosa putri, cava corpore raro, 861 omnia sint a principiis seiuncta necessest, 862 inmortalia si volumus subiungere rebus 863 fundamenta, quibus nitatur summa salutis; 864 ne tibi res redeant ad nihilum funditus omnes. 865 Nunc ea quae sentire videmus cumque necessest 866 ex insensilibus tamen omnia confiteare 867 principiis constare. neque id manufesta refutant	
2.868	868 nec contra pugnant, in promptu cognita quae sunt, 869 sed magis ipsa manu ducunt et credere cogunt 870 ex insensilibus, quod dico, animalia gigni. 871 quippe videre licet vivos existere vermes 872 stercore de taetro, putorem cum sibi nacta est 873 intempestivis ex imbribus umida tellus. 874 Praeterea cunctas itidem res vertere sese. 875 vertunt se fluvii in frondes et pabula laeta 876 in pecudes, vertunt pecudes in corpora nostra 877 naturam, et nostro de corpore saepe ferarum 878 augescunt vires et corpora pennipotentum. 879 ergo omnes natura cibos in corpora viva 880 vertit et hinc sensus animantum procreat omnes, 881 non alia longe ratione atque arida ligna 882 explicat in flammas et in ignis omnia versat. 883 iamne vides igitur magni primordia rerum 884 referre in quali sint ordine quaeque locata 885 et commixta quibus dent motus accipiantque? 886 Tum porro, quid id est, animum quod percutit, ipsum,	

	887 quod movet et varios sensus expromere cogit, 888 ex insensilibus ne credas sensile gigni? 889 ni mirum lapides et ligna et terra quod una 890 mixta tamen nequeunt vitalem reddere sensum. 891 illud in his igitur rebus meminisse decebit, 892 non ex omnibus omnino, quaecumque creant res 893 sensilia, extemplo me gigni dicere sensus, 894 sed magni referre ea primum quantula constent, 895 sensile quae faciunt, et qua sint praedita forma, 896 motibus ordinibus posituris denique quae sint. 897 quarum nil rerum in lignis glaebisque videmus;	
2.898	898 et tamen haec, cum sunt quasi putrefacta per imbres, 899 vermiculos pariunt, quia corpora materiai 900 antiquis ex ordinibus permota nova re 901 conciliantur ita ut debent animalia gigni. 902 Deinde ex sensilibus qui sensile posse creari 903 constituunt, porro ex aliis sentire sueti 903a * * * 904 mollia cum faciunt; nam sensus iungitur omnis 905 visceribus nervis venis, quae cumque videmus 906 mollia mortali consistere corpore creta. 907 sed tamen esto iam posse haec aeterna manere; 908 nempe tamen debent aut sensum partis habere 909 aut similis totis animalibus esse putari. 910 at nequeant per se partes sentire necesse est: 911 namque animus sensus membrorum respuit omnis, 912 nec manus a nobis potis est secreta neque ulla 913 corporis omnino sensum pars sola tenere. 914 linquitur ut totis animantibus adsimulentur, 915 vitali ut possint consentire undique	

	sensu. 916 qui poterunt igitur rerum primordia dici 917 et leti vitare vias, animalia cum sint, 918 atque animalia sint mortalibus una eademque? 919 quod tamen ut possint, at coetu concilioque 920 nil facient praeter volgum turbamque animantum, 921 scilicet ut nequeant homines armenta feraeque 922 inter sese ullam rem gignere conveniundo. 923 sic itidem quae sentimus sentire necessest. 924 quod si forte suum dimittunt corpore sensum 925 atque alium capiunt, quid opus fuit adtribui id quod 926 detrahitur? tum praeterea, quod fudimus ante,	
2.927	927 quatinus in pullos animalis vertier ova 928 cernimus alituum vermisque effervere terra, 929 intempestivos quam putor cepit ob imbris, 930 scire licet gigni posse ex non sensibus sensus. 931 Quod si forte aliquis dicet, dum taxat oriri 932 posse ex non sensu sensus mutabilitate, 933 aut aliquo tamquam partu quod proditur extra, 934 huic satis illud erit planum facere atque probare, 935 non fieri partum nisi concilio ante coacto, 936 nec quicquam commutari sine conciliatu. 937 Principio nequeunt ullius corporis esse 938 sensus ante ipsam genitam naturam animantis, 939 ni mirum quia materies disiecta tenetur 940 aere fluminibus terris terraque creatis, 941 nec congressa modo vitalis convenientes 942 contulit inter se motus, quibus omnituentes 943 accensi sensus animantem quamque tuentur. 944 Praeterea quamvis animantem	

	grandior ictus, 945 quam patitur natura, repente adfligit et omnis 946 corporis atque animi pergit confundere sensus. 947 dissoluuntur enim positurae principiorum 948 et penitus motus vitales inpediuntur, 949 donec materies omnis concussa per artus 950 vitalis animae nodos a corpore solvit 951 dispersamque foras per caulas eiecit omnis; 952 nam quid praeterea facere ictum posse reamur 953 oblatum, nisi discutere ac dissolvere quaeque? 954 fit quoque uti soleant minus oblato acriter ictu 955 reliqui motus vitalis vincere saepe, 956 vincere et ingentis plagae sedare tumultus	
2.957	957 inque suos quicquid rursus revocare meatus 958 et quasi iam leti dominantem in corpore motum 959 discutere ac paene amissos accendere sensus; 960 nam qua re potius leti iam limine ab ipso 961 ad vitam possint conlecta mente reverti, 962 quam quo decursum prope iam siet ire et abire? 963 Praeterea, quoniam dolor est, ubi materiai 964 corpora vi quadam per viscera viva per artus 965 sollicitata suis trepidant in sedibus intus, 966 inque locum quando remigrant, fit blanda voluptas, 967 scire licet nullo primordia posse dolore 968 temptari nullamque voluptatem capere ex se; 969 quandoquidem non sunt ex ullis principiorum 970 corporibus, quorum motus novitate laborent 971 aut aliquem fructum capiant dulcedinis almae. 972 haut igitur debent esse ullo praedita sensu. 973 Denique uti possint sentire animalia quaeque,	

	974 principiis si iam est sensus tribuendus eorum, 975 quid, genus humanum propritim de quibus auctumst? 976 scilicet et risu tremulo concussa cachinnant 977 et lacrimis spargunt rorantibus ora genasque 978 multaque de rerum mixtura dicere callent 979 et sibi proporro quae sint primordia quaerunt; 980 quando quidem totis mortalibus adsimulata 981 ipsa quoque ex aliis debent constare elementis, 982 inde alia ex aliis, nusquam consistere ut ausis; 983 quippe sequar, quod cumque loqui ridereque dices 984 et sapere, ex aliis eadem haec facientibus ut sit. 985 quod si delira haec furiosaque cernimus esse 986 et ridere potest non ex ridentibus auctus,	
2.987	987 et sapere et doctis rationem reddere dictis 988 non ex seminibus sapientibus atque disertis, 989 qui minus esse queant ea quae sentire videmus 990 seminibus permixta carentibus undique sensu? 991 Denique caelesti sumus omnes semine oriundi; 992 omnibus ille idem pater est, unde alma liquentis 993 umoris guttas mater cum terra recepit, 994 feta parit nitidas fruges arbustaque laeta 995 et genus humanum, parit omnia saecla ferarum, 996 pabula cum praebet, quibus omnes corpora pascunt 997 et dulcem ducunt vitam prolemque propagant; 998 qua propter merito maternum nomen adepta est. 999 cedit item retro, de terra quod fuit ante, 1000 in terras, et quod missumst ex aetheris oris, 1001 id rursum caeli rellatum templa receptant. 1002 nec sic interemit mors res ut materiai	

	1003 corpora conficiat, sed coetum dissupat ollis; 1004 inde aliis aliud coniungit et efficit, omnis 1005 res ut convertant formas mutentque colores 1006 et capiant sensus et puncto tempore reddant; 1007 ut noscas referre earum primordia rerum 1008 cum quibus et quali positura contineantur 1009 et quos inter se dent motus accipiantque, 1010 neve putes aeterna penes residere potesse 1011 corpora prima quod in summis fluitare videmus 1012 rebus et interdum nasci subitoque perire. 1013 quin etiam refert nostris in versibus ipsis 1014 cum quibus et quali sint ordine quaeque locata; 1015 namque eadem caelum mare terras flumina solem 1016 significant, eadem fruges arbusta animantis;	
2.1017	1017 si non omnia sunt, at multo maxima pars est 1018 consimilis; verum positura discrepitant res. 1019 sic ipsis in rebus item iam materiai 1020 1021 concursus motus ordo positura figurae 1022 cum permutantur, mutari res quoque debent. 1023 Nunc animum nobis adhibe veram ad rationem. 1024 nam tibi vehementer nova res molitur ad auris 1025 accedere et nova se species ostendere rerum. 1026 sed neque tam facilis res ulla est, quin ea primum 1027 difficilis magis ad credendum constet, itemque 1028 nil adeo magnum neque tam mirabile quicquam, 1029 quod non paulatim minuant mirarier omnes, 1030 principio caeli clarum purumque colorem 1031 quaeque in se cohibet, palantia sidera passim, 1032 lunamque et solis praeclara luce	

	nitorem; 1033 omnia quae nunc si primum mortalibus essent 1034 ex improviso si sint obiecta repente, 1035 quid magis his rebus poterat mirabile dici, 1036 aut minus ante quod auderent fore credere gentes? 1037 nil, ut opinor; ita haec species miranda fuisset. 1038 quam tibi iam nemo fessus satiate videndi, 1039 suspicere in caeli dignatur lucida templa. 1040 desine qua propter novitate exterritus ipsa 1041 expuere ex animo rationem, sed magis acri 1042 iudicio perpende, et si tibi vera videntur, 1043 dede manus, aut, si falsum est, accingere contra. 1044 quaerit enim rationem animus, cum summa loci sit 1045 infinita foris haec extra moenia mundi, 1046 quid sit ibi porro, quo prospicere usque velit mens	
2.1047	1047 atque animi iactus liber quo pervolet ipse. 1048 Principio nobis in cunctas undique partis 1049 et latere ex utroque supra supterque per omne 1050 nulla est finis; uti docui, res ipsaque per se 1051 vociferatur, et elucet natura profundi. 1052 nullo iam pacto veri simile esse putandumst, 1053 undique cum vorsum spatium vacet infinitum 1054 seminaque innumero numero summaque profunda 1055 multimodis volitent aeterno percita motu, 1056 hunc unum terrarum orbem caelumque creatum, 1057 nil agere illa foris tot corpora materiai; 1058 cum praesertim hic sit natura factus et ipsa 1059 sponte sua forte offensando semina rerum 1060 multimodis temere in cassum frustraque coacta 1061 tandem coluerunt ea quae	

	coniecta repente 1062 magnarum rerum fierent exordia semper, 1063 terrai maris et caeli generisque animantum. 1064 quare etiam atque etiam talis fateare necesse est 1065 esse alios alibi congressus materiai, 1066 qualis hic est, avido complexu quem tenet aether. 1067 Praeterea cum materies est multa parata, 1068 cum locus est praesto nec res nec causa moratur 1069 ulla, geri debent ni mirum et confieri res. 1070 nunc et seminibus si tanta est copia, quantam 1071 enumerare aetas animantum non queat omnis, 1072 quis eadem natura manet, quae semina rerum 1073 conicere in loca quaeque queat simili ratione 1074 atque huc sunt coniecta, necesse est confiteare 1075 esse alios aliis terrarum in partibus orbis 1076 et varias hominum gentis et saecla ferarum.	
2.1077	1077 Huc accedit ut in summa res nulla sit una, 1078 unica quae gignatur et unica solaque crescat, 1079 quin aliquoius siet saecli permultaque eodem 1080 sint genere. in primis animalibus indice mente 1081 invenies sic montivagum genus esse ferarum, 1082 sic hominum geminam prolem, sic denique mutas 1083 squamigerum pecudes et corpora cuncta volantum. 1084 qua propter caelum simili ratione fatendumst 1085 terramque et solem, lunam mare cetera quae sunt, 1086 non esse unica, sed numero magis innumerali; 1087 quando quidem vitae depactus terminus alte 1088 tam manet haec et tam nativo corpore constant 1089 quam genus omne, quod his generatimst rebus abundans. 1090 Quae bene cognita si teneas,	

	natura videtur 1091 libera continuo, dominis privata superbis, 1092 ipsa sua per se sponte omnia dis agere expers. 1093 nam pro sancta deum tranquilla pectora pace 1094 quae placidum degunt aevom vitamque serenam, 1095 quis regere immensi summam, quis habere profundi 1096 indu manu validas potis est moderanter habenas, 1097 quis pariter caelos omnis convertere et omnis 1098 ignibus aetheriis terras suffire feracis, 1099 omnibus inve locis esse omni tempore praesto, 1100 nubibus ut tenebras faciat caelique serena 1101 concutiat sonitu, tum fulmina mittat et aedis 1102 saepe suas disturbet et in deserta recedens 1103 saeviat exercens telum, quod saepe nocentes 1104 praeterit exanimatque indignos inque merentes? 1105 Multaque post mundi tempus genitale diemque 1106 primigenum maris et terrae solisque coortum	
2.1107	1107 addita corpora sunt extrinsecus, addita circum 1108 semina, quae magnum iaculando contulit omne, 1109 unde mare et terrae possent augescere et unde 1110 appareret spatium caeli domus altaque tecta 1111 tolleret a terris procul et consurgeret aer. 1112 nam sua cuique, locis ex omnibus, omnia plagis 1113 corpora distribuuntur et ad sua saecla recedunt, 1114 umor ad umorem, terreno corpore terra 1115 crescit et ignem ignes procudunt aetheraque aether, 1116 donique ad extremum crescendi perfica finem 1117 omnia perduxit rerum natura creatrix; 1118 ut fit ubi nihilo iam plus est quod datur intra 1119 vitalis venas quam quod fluit	

	atque recedit. 1120 omnibus hic aetas debet consistere rebus, 1121 hic natura suis refrenat viribus auctum. 1122 nam quae cumque vides hilaro grandescere adauctu 1123 paulatimque gradus aetatis scandere adultae, 1124 plura sibi adsumunt quam de se corpora mittunt, 1125 dum facile in venas cibus omnis inditur et dum 1126 non ita sunt late dispessa, ut multa remittant 1127 et plus dispendi faciant quam vescitur aetas. 1128 nam certe fluere atque recedere corpora rebus 1129 multa manus dandum est; sed plura accedere debent, 1130 donec alescendi summum tetigere cacumen. 1131 inde minutatim vires et robur adultum 1132 frangit et in partem peiorem liquitur aetas. 1133 quippe etenim quanto est res amplior, augmine adempto, 1134 et quo latior est, in cunctas undique partis 1135 plura modo dispargit et a se corpora mittit, 1136 nec facile in venas cibus omnis diditur ei	
2.1137	1137 nec satis est, pro quam largos exaestuat aestus, 1138 unde queat tantum suboriri ac subpeditare. 1139 iure igitur pereunt, cum rarefacta fluendo 1140 sunt et cum externis succumbunt omnia plagis, 1141 quando quidem grandi cibus aevo denique defit, 1142 nec tuditantia rem cessant extrinsecus ullam 1143 corpora conficere et plagis infesta domare. 1144 Sic igitur magni quoque circum moenia mundi 1145 expugnata dabunt labem putrisque ruinas; 1146 omnia debet enim cibus integrare novando 1147 et fulcire cibus, cibus omnia sustentare, 1148 ne quiquam, quoniam nec venae	Thus, too, the ramparts of the mighty world On all sides round shall taken be by storm, And tumble to wrack and shivered fragments down. For food it is must keep things whole, renewing; 'Tis food must prop and give support to all,- But to no purpose, since nor veins suffice To hold enough, nor nature ministers As much as needful. And even now 'tis thus: Its age is broken and the earth, outworn With many parturitions, scarce creates The little lives- she who created erst All generations and gave forth at birth Enormous bodies of wild beasts of old. For never, I fancy, did a golden cord From off the firmament above let down The mortal generations to the fields; Nor sea, nor breakers pounding on the rocks Created them; but earth it was who bore- The same to-day who feeds them from herself. Besides, herself of own accord, she first The shining grains and vineyards of all

	perpetiuntur 1149 quod satis est, neque quantum opus est natura ministrat. 1150 Iamque adeo fracta est aetas effetaque tellus 1151 vix animalia parva creat, quae cuncta creavit 1152 saecla deditque ferarum ingentia corpora partu. 1153 haud, ut opinor, enim mortalia saecla superne 1154 aurea de caelo demisit funis in arva 1155 nec mare nec fluctus plangentis saxa crearunt, 1156 sed genuit tellus eadem quae nunc alit ex se. 1157 praeterea nitidas fruges vinetaque laeta 1158 sponte sua primum mortalibus ipsa creavit, 1159 ipsa dedit dulcis fetus et pabula laeta; 1160 quae nunc vix nostro grandescunt aucta labore, 1161 conterimusque boves et viris agricolarum, 1162 conficimus ferrum vix arvis suppeditati: 1163 usque adeo parcunt fetus augentque laborem. 1164 iamque caput quassans grandis suspirat arator 1165 crebrius, in cassum magnos cecidisse labores, 1166 et cum tempora temporibus praesentia confert	joy Created for mortality; herself Gave the sweet fruitage and the pastures glad, Which now to-day yet scarcely wax in size, Even when aided by our toiling arms. We break the ox, and wear away the strength Of sturdy farm-hands; iron tools to-day Barely avail for tilling of the fields, So niggardly they grudge our harvestings, So much increase our labour. Now to-day The aged ploughman, shaking of his head, Sighs o'er and o'er that labours of his hands Have fallen out in vain, and, as he thinks How present times are not as times of old, Often he praises the fortunes of his sire, And crackles, prating, how the ancient race, Fulfilled with piety, supported life With simple comfort in a narrow plot, Since, man for man, the measure of each field Was smaller far i' the old days. And, again, The gloomy planter of the withered vine Rails at the season's change and wearies heaven, Nor grasps that all of things by sure degrees Are wasting away and going to the tomb, Outworn by venerable length of life.
2.1167	1167 praeteritis, laudat fortunas saepe parentis. 1168 tristis item vetulae vitis sator atque vietae 1169 temporis incusat momen saeclumque fatigat, 1170 et crepat, antiquum genus ut pietate repletum 1171 perfacile angustis tolerarit finibus aevom, 1172 cum minor esset agri multo modus ante viritim; 1173 nec tenet omnia paulatim tabescere et ire 1174 ad capulum spatio aetatis defessa vetusto.	
3.1	1 E tenebris tantis tam clarum extollere lumen 2 qui primus potuisti inlustrans commoda vitae,	O thou who first uplifted in such dark So clear a torch aloft, who first shed light Upon the profitable ends of man, O thee I follow, glory of the Greeks,

	3 te sequor, o Graiae gentis decus, inque tuis nunc 4 ficta pedum pono pressis vestigia signis, 5 non ita certandi cupidus quam propter amorem 6 quod te imitari aveo; quid enim contendat hirundo 7 cycnis, aut quid nam tremulis facere artubus haedi 8 consimile in cursu possint et fortis equi vis? 9 tu, pater, es rerum inventor, tu patria nobis 10 suppeditas praecepta, tuisque ex, inclute, chartis, 11 floriferis ut apes in saltibus omnia libant, 12 omnia nos itidem depascimur aurea dicta, 13 aurea, perpetua semper dignissima vita. 14 nam simul ac ratio tua coepit vociferari 15 naturam rerum divina mente coorta 16 diffugiunt animi terrores, moenia mundi 17 discedunt. totum video per inane geri res. 18 apparet divum numen sedesque quietae, 19 quas neque concutiunt venti nec nubila nimbis 20 aspergunt neque nix acri concreta pruina 21 cana cadens violat semper innubilus aether 22 integit et large diffuso lumine ridet: 23 omnia suppeditat porro natura neque ulla 24 res animi pacem delibat tempore in ullo. 25 at contra nusquam apparent Acherusia templa, 26 nec tellus obstat quin omnia dispiciantur, 27 sub pedibus quae cumque infra per inane geruntur. 28 his ibi me rebus quaedam divina voluptas 29 percipit atque horror, quod sic natura tua vi 30 tam manifesta patens ex omni parte retecta est.	And set my footsteps squarely planted now Even in the impress and the marks of thine- Less like one eager to dispute the palm, More as one craving out of very love That I may copy thee!- for how should swallow Contend with swans or what compare could be In a race between young kids with tumbling legs And the strong might of the horse? Our father thou, And finder-out of truth, and thou to us Suppliest a father's precepts; and from out Those scriven leaves of thine, renowned soul (Like bees that sip of all in flowery wolds), We feed upon thy golden sayings all- Golden, and ever worthiest endless life. For soon as ever thy planning thought that sprang From god-like mind begins its loud proclaim Of nature's courses, terrors of the brain Asunder flee, the ramparts of the world Dispart away, and through the void entire I see the movements of the universe. Rises to vision the majesty of gods, And their abodes of everlasting calm Which neither wind may shake nor rain-cloud splash, Nor snow, congealed by sharp frosts, may harm With its white downfall: ever, unclouded sky O'er roofs, and laughs with far-diffused light. For as to what men sometimes will affirm: That more than Tartarus (the realm of death) They fear diseases and a life of shame, And know the substance of the soul is blood, Or rather wind (if haply thus their whim), And so need naught of this our science, then Thou well may'st note from what's to follow now That more for glory do they braggart forth Than for belief. For mark these very same: Exiles from country, fugitives afar From sight of men, with charges foul attaint, Abased with every wretchedness, they yet Live, and where'er the wretches come, they yet Make the ancestral sacrifices there, Butcher the black sheep, and to gods below Offer the honours, and in bitter case Turn much more keenly to religion. Wherefore, it's surer testing of a man In doubtful perils- mark him as he is Amid adversities; for then alone Are the true voices conjured from his breast, The mask off-stripped, reality behind. And greed, again, and the blind lust of honours Which force poor wretches past the bounds of law, And, oft allies

		and ministers of crime, To push through nights and days with hugest toil To rise untrammelled to the peaks of power- These wounds of life in no mean part are kept Festering and open by this fright of death. For ever we see fierce Want and foul Disgrace First, then, I say, the mind which oft we call The intellect, wherein is seated life's Counsel and regimen, is part no less Of man than hand and foot and eyes are parts Of one whole breathing creature. [But some hold] That sense of mind is in no fixed part seated, But is of body some one vital state,- Named "harmony" by Greeks, because thereby We live with sense, though intellect be not In any part: as oft the body is said To have good health (when health, however, 's not One part of him who has it), so they place The sense of mind in no fixed part of man. Mightily, diversly, meseems they err. Often the body palpable and seen Sickens, while yet in some invisible part We feel a pleasure; oft the other way, A miserable in mind feels pleasure still Throughout his body- quite the same as when A foot may pain without a pain in head. Besides, when these our limbs are given o'er To gentle sleep and lies the burdened frame At random void of sense, a something else Is yet within us, which upon that time Bestirs itself in many a wise, receiving All motions of joy and phantom cares of heart. Now, for to see that in man's members dwells Also the soul, and body ne'er is wont To feel sensation by a "harmony" Take this in chief: the fact that life remains Mind and soul, I say, are held conjoined one with other, And form one single nature of themselves; But chief and regnant through the frame entire Is still that counsel which we call the mind, And that cleaves seated in the midmost breast. Here leap dismay and terror; round these haunts Be blandishments of joys; and therefore here The intellect, the mind. The rest of soul, Throughout the body scattered, but obeys- Moved by the nod and motion of the mind. This, for itself, sole through itself, hath thought; This for itself hath mirth, even when the thing That moves it, moves nor soul nor body at all. And as, when head or eye in us is smit By assailing pain, we are not tortured then

		Through all the body, so the mind alone Is sometimes smitten, or livens with a joy, Whilst yet the soul's remainder through the limbs And through the frame is stirred by nothing new. But when the mind is moved by shock more fierce, We mark the whole soul suffering all at once Along man's members: sweats and pallors spread Over the body, and the tongue is broken, And fails the voice away, and ring the ears, Mists blind the eyeballs, and the joints collapse,- Aye, men drop dead from terror of the mind. Hence, whoso will can readily remark That soul conjoined is with mind, and, when 'Tis strook by influence of the mind, forthwith
3.31	31 Et quoniam docui, cunctarum exordia rerum 32 qualia sint et quam variis distantia formis 33 sponte sua volitent aeterno percita motu, 34 quove modo possint res ex his quaeque creari, 35 hasce secundum res animi natura videtur 36 atque animae claranda meis iam versibus esse 37 et metus ille foras praeceps Acheruntis agendus, 38 funditus humanam qui vitam turbat ab imo 39 omnia suffundens mortis nigrore neque ullam 40 esse voluptatem liquidam puramque relinquit. 41 nam quod saepe homines morbos magis esse timendos 42 infamemque ferunt vitam quam Tartara leti 43 et se scire animi naturam sanguinis esse, 44 aut etiam venti, si fert ita forte voluntas, 45 nec prosum quicquam nostrae rationis egere, 46 hinc licet advertas animum magis omnia laudis 47 iactari causa quam quod res ipsa probetur. 48 extorres idem patria longeque fugati 49 conspectu ex hominum, foedati crimine turpi, 50 omnibus aerumnis adfecti denique vivunt, 51 et quo cumque tamen miseri venere	And nature gives to them their all, nor aught May ever pluck their peace of mind away. But nowhere to my vision rise no more The vaults of Acheron, though the broad earth Bars me no more from gazing down o'er all Which under our feet is going on below Along the void. O, here in these affairs Some new divine delight and trembling awe Takes hold through me, that thus by power of thine Nature, so plain and manifest at last, Hath been on every side laid bare to man! And since I've taught already of what sort The seeds of all things are, and how, distinct In divers forms, they flit of own accord, Stirred with a motion everlasting on, And in what mode things be from them create, Now, after such matters, should my verse, meseems, Make clear the nature of the mind and soul, And drive that dread of Acheron without, Headlong, which so confounds our human life Unto its deeps, pouring o'er all that is The black of death, nor leaves not anything To prosper- a liquid and unsullied joy. Dislodged afar from secure life and sweet, Like huddling Shapes before the doors of death. And whilst, from these, men wish to scape afar, Driven by false terror, and afar remove, With civic blood a fortune they amass, They double their riches, greedy, heapers-up Of corpse on corpse they have a cruel laugh For the sad burial of a brother-born, And hatred and fear of tables of their kin. Likewise, through this same terror, envy oft Makes them to peak because before their eyes That man is lordly, that man

	parentant 52 et nigras mactant pecudes et manibus divis 53 inferias mittunt multoque in rebus acerbis 54 acrius advertunt animos ad religionem. 55 quo magis in dubiis hominem spectare periclis 56 convenit adversisque in rebus noscere qui sit; 57 nam verae voces tum demum pectore ab imo 58 eliciuntur eripitur persona amanare. 59 denique avarities et honorum caeca cupido, 60 quae miseros homines cogunt transcendere fines	gazed upon Who walks begirt with honour glorious, Whilst they in filth and darkness roll around; Some perish away for statues and a name, And oft to that degree, from fright of death, Will hate of living and beholding light Take hold on humankind that they inflict Their own destruction with a gloomy heart- Forgetful that this fear is font of cares, This fear the plague upon their sense of shame, And this that breaks the ties of comradry And oversets all reverence and faith, Mid direst slaughter. For long ere to-day Often were traitors to country and dear parents Through quest to shun the realms of Acheron. For just as children tremble and fear all In the viewless dark, so even we at times Dread in the light so many things that be No whit more fearsome than what children feign, Oft in our limbs, when much of body's gone; Yet that same life, when particles of heat, Though few, have scattered been, and through the mouth Air has been given forth abroad, forthwith Forever deserts the veins, and leaves the bones. Thus mayst thou know that not all particles Perform like parts, nor in like manner all Are props of weal and safety: rather those- The seeds of wind and exhalations warm- Take care that in our members life remains. Therefore a vital heat and wind there is Within the very body, which at death Deserts our frames. And so, since nature of mind And even of soul is found to be, as 'twere, A part of man, give over "harmony"- Name to musicians brought from Helicon,- Unless themselves they filched it otherwise, To serve for what was lacking name till then. Whate'er it be, they're welcome to it- thou, Hearken my other maxims. In turn it hits and drives the body too. And this same argument establisheth That nature of mind and soul corporeal is: For when 'tis seen to drive the members on, To snatch from sleep the body, and to change The countenance, and the whole state of man To rule and turn,- what yet could never be Sans contact, and sans body contact fails- Must we not grant that mind and soul consist Of a corporeal nature?- And besides Thou markst that likewise with this body of ours Suffers the mind and with our

		body feels. If the dire speed of spear that cleaves the bones And bares the inner thews hits not the life, Yet follows a fainting and a foul collapse, And, on the ground, dazed tumult in the mind, And whiles a wavering will to rise afoot. So nature of mind must be corporeal, since From stroke and spear corporeal 'tis in throes. Now, of what body, what components formed Is this same mind I will go on to tell. First, I aver, 'tis superfine, composed Of tiniest particles- that such the fact Thou canst perceive, if thou attend, from this:
3.61	61 iuris et inter dum socios scelerum atque ministros 62 noctes atque dies niti praestante labore 63 ad summas emergere opes, haec vulnera vitae 64 non minimam partem mortis formidine aluntur. 65 turpis enim ferme contemptus et acris egestas 66 semota ab dulci vita stabilique videtur 67 et quasi iam leti portas cunctarier ante; 68 unde homines dum se falso terrore coacti 69 effugisse volunt longe longeque remosse, 70 sanguine civili rem conflant divitiasque 71 conduplicant avidi, caedem caede accumulantes, 72 crudeles gaudent in tristi funere fratris 73 et consanguineum mensas odere timentque. 74 consimili ratione ab eodem saepe timore 75 macerat invidia ante oculos illum esse potentem, 76 illum aspectari, claro qui incedit honore, 77 ipsi se in tenebris volvi caenoque queruntur. 78 intereunt partim statuarum et nominis ergo. 79 et saepe usque adeo, mortis formidine, vitae 80 percipit humanos odium lucisque videndae, 81 ut sibi consciscant maerenti pectore letum 82 obliti fontem curarum hunc esse timorem:	Shuddering, will be upon them in the dark. This terror, then, this darkness of the mind, Not sunrise with its flaring spokes of light, Nor glittering arrows of morning sun disperse, But only nature's aspect and her law. Not thus, I say, can the deserted frame Bear the dissevering of its joined soul, But, rent and ruined, moulders all away. Thus the joint contact of the body and soul Learns from their earliest age the vital motions, Even when still buried in the mother's womb; So no dissevering can hap to them, Without their bane and ill. And thence mayst see That, as conjoined is their source of weal, Conjoined also must their nature be. And since this nature of the soul is torn, Nor mounts away, as at one time, entire, We needs must hold it mortal. But perchance If thou supposest that the soul itself Can inward draw along the frame, and bring Its parts together to one place, and so From all the members draw the sense away, Why, then, that place in which such stock of soul Collected is, should greater seem in sense. But since such place is nowhere, for a fact, As said before, 'tis rent and scattered forth, And so goes under. Or again, if now I please to grant the false, and say that soul Can thus be lumped within the frames of those Who leave the sunshine, dying bit by bit, Still must the soul as mortal be confessed; Nor aught it matters whether to wrack it go, Dispersed in the winds, or, gathered in a mass From all its parts, sink down to brutish death, Since more and more in every region sense Fails the whole man, and less and less of life In every region lingers. Of time-to-be when we are dead and gone. And what is there so horrible appears?

	83 hunc vexare pudorem, hunc vincula amicitiai 84 rumpere et in summa pietate evertere suadet: 85 nam iam saepe homines patriam carosque parentis 86 prodiderunt vitare Acherusia templa petentes. 87 nam vel uti pueri trepidant atque omnia caecis 88 in tenebris metuunt, sic nos in luce timemus 89 inter dum, nihilo quae sunt metuenda magis quam 90 quae pueri in tenebris pavitant finguntque futura.	Now what is there so sad about it all? Is't not serener far than any sleep?
3.91	91 hunc igitur terrorem animi tenebrasque necessest 92 non radii solis neque lucida tela diei 93 discutiant, sed naturae species ratioque. 94 Primum animum dico, mentem quem saepe vocamus, 95 in quo consilium vitae regimenque locatum est, 96 esse hominis partem nihilo minus ac manus et pes 97 atque oculei partes animantis totius extant. 98 sensum animi certa non esse in parte locatum, 99 verum habitum quendam vitalem corporis esse, 100 harmoniam Grai quam dicunt, quod faciat nos 101 vivere cum sensu, nulla cum in parte siet mens; 102 ut bona saepe valetudo cum dicitur esse 103 corporis, et non est tamen haec pars ulla valentis, 104 sic animi sensum non certa parte reponunt; 105 magno opere in quo mi diversi errare videntur. 106 Saepe itaque, in promptu corpus quod cernitur, aegret, 107 cum tamen ex alia laetamur parte latenti; 108 et retro fit ubi contra sit saepe vicissim, 109 cum miser ex animo laetatur corpore toto; 110 non alio pacto quam si, pes cum dolet aegri, 111 in nullo caput interea sit forte dolore.	

	112 Praeterea molli cum somno dedita membra 113 effusumque iacet sine sensu corpus honustum, 114 est aliud tamen in nobis quod tempore in illo 115 multimodis agitatur et omnis accipit in se 116 laetitiae motus et curas cordis inanis. 117 Nunc animam quoque ut in membris cognoscere possis 118 esse neque harmonia corpus sentire solere, 119 principio fit uti detracto corpore multo	
3.120	120 saepe tamen nobis in membris vita moretur. 121 Atque eadem rursum, cum corpora pauca caloris 122 diffugere forasque per os est editus aegaër, 123 deserit extemplo venas atque ossa relinquit; 124 noscere ut hinc possis non aequas omnia partis 125 corpora habere neque ex aequo fulcire salutem, 126 sed magis haec, venti quae sunt calidique vaporis 127 semina, curare in membris ut vita moretur. 128 est igitur calor ac ventus vitalis in ipso 129 corpore, qui nobis moribundos deserit artus. 130 quapropter quoniam est animi natura reperta 131 atque animae quasi pars hominis, redde harmoniai 132 nomen, ad organicos alto delatum Heliconi, 133 sive aliunde ipsi porro traxere et in illam 134 transtulerunt, proprio quae tum res nomine egebat. 135 quidquid est, habeant: tu cetera percipe dicta. 136 Nunc animum atque animam dico coniuncta teneri 137 inter se atque unam naturam conficere ex se, 138 sed caput esse quasi et dominari in corpore toto 139 consilium, quod nos animum mentemque vocamus. 140 idque situm media regione in pectoris haeret.	

	141 hic exultat enim pavor ac metus, haec loca circum 142 laetitiae mulcent: hic ergo mens animusquest. 143 cetera pars animae per totum dissita corpus 144 paret et ad numen mentis momenque movetur. 145 idque sibi solum per se sapit et sibi gaudet, 146 cum neque res animam neque corpus commovet una. 147 et quasi, cum caput aut oculus temptante dolore 148 laeditur in nobis, non omni concruciamur 149 corpore, sic animus nonnumquam laeditur ipse	
3.150	150 laetitiaque viget, cum cetera pars animai 151 per membra atque artus nulla novitate cietur; 152 verum ubi vementi magis est commota metu mens, 153 consentire animam totam per membra videmus 154 sudoresque ita palloremque existere toto 155 corpore et infringi linguam vocemque aboriri, 156 caligare oculos, sonere auris, succidere artus, 157 denique concidere ex animi terrore videmus 158 saepe homines; facile ut quivis hinc noscere possit 159 esse animam cum animo coniunctam, quae cum animi 160 percussa est, exim corpus propellit et icit. 161 Haec eadem ratio naturam animi atque animai 162 corpoream docet esse; ubi enim propellere membra, 163 corripere ex somno corpus mutareque vultum 164 atque hominem totum regere ac versare videtur, 165 quorum nil fieri sine tactu posse videmus 166 nec tactum porro sine corpore, nonne fatendumst 167 corporea natura animum constare animamque? 168 praeterea pariter fungi cum corpore et una 169 consentire animum nobis in corpore cernis.	

	170 si minus offendit vitam vis horrida teli 171 ossibus ac nervis disclusis intus adacta, 172 at tamen insequitur languor terraeque petitus 173 suavis et in terra mentis qui gignitur aestus 174 inter dumque quasi exsurgendi incerta voluntas. 175 ergo corpoream naturam animi esse necessest, 176 corporeis quoniam telis ictuque laborat. 177 Is tibi nunc animus quali sit corpore et unde 178 constiterit pergam rationem reddere dictis. 179 principio esse aio persuptilem atque minutis	
3.180	180 perquam corporibus factum constare. id ita esse 181 hinc licet advertas animum, ut pernoscere possis. 182 Nil adeo fieri celeri ratione videtur, 183 quam si mens fieri proponit et inchoat ipsa; 184 ocius ergo animus quam res se perciet ulla, 185 ante oculos quorum in promptu natura videtur. 186 at quod mobile tanto operest, constare rutundis 187 perquam seminibus debet perquamque minutis, 188 momine uti parvo possint inpulsa moveri. 189 namque movetur aqua et tantillo momine flutat, 190 quippe volubilibus parvisque creata figuris. 191 at contra mellis constantior est natura 192 et pigri latices magis et cunctantior actus: 193 haeret enim inter se magis omnis materiai 194 copia, ni mirum quia non tam levibus extat 195 corporibus neque tam suptilibus atque rutundis. 196 namque papaveris aura potest suspensa levisque 197 cogere ut ab summo tibi diffluat altus acervus, 198 at contra lapidum coniectum spicarumque 199 noenu potest. igitur parvissima	

	corpora pro quam 200 et levissima sunt, ita mobilitate fruuntur; 201 at contra quae cumque magis cum pondere magno 202 asperaque inveniuntur, eo stabilita magis sunt. 203 nunc igitur quoniamst animi natura reperta 204 mobilis egregie, perquam constare necessest 205 corporibus parvis et levibus atque rutundis. 206 quae tibi cognita res in multis, o bone, rebus 207 utilis invenietur et opportuna cluebit. 208 Haec quoque res etiam naturam dedicat eius, 209 quam tenui constet textura quamque loco se	
3.210	210 contineat parvo, si possit conglomerari, 211 quod simul atque hominem leti secura quies est 212 indepta atque animi natura animaeque recessit, 213 nil ibi libatum de toto corpore cernas 214 ad speciem, nihil ad pondus: mors omnia praestat, 215 vitalem praeter sensum calidumque vaporem. 216 ergo animam totam perparvis esse necessest 217 seminibus nexam per venas viscera nervos, 218 qua tenus, omnis ubi e toto iam corpore cessit, 219 extima membrorum circumcaesura tamen se 220 incolumem praestat nec defit ponderis hilum. 221 quod genus est, Bacchi cum flos evanuit aut cum 222 spiritus unguenti suavis diffugit in auras 223 aut aliquo cum iam sucus de corpore cessit; 224 nil oculis tamen esse minor res ipsa videtur 225 propterea neque detractum de pondere quicquam, 226 ni mirum quia multa minutaque semina sucos 227 efficiunt et odorem in toto corpore rerum. 228 quare etiam atque etiam mentis	And so, Again, again, nature of mind and soul 'Tis thine to know created is of seeds The tiniest ever, since at flying-forth It beareth nothing of the weight away. Yet fancy not its nature simple so. For an impalpable aura, mixed with heat, Deserts the dying, and heat draws off the air; And heat there's none, unless commixed with air: For, since the nature of all heat is rare, Athrough it many seeds of air must move. Thus nature of mind is triple; yet those all Suffice not for creating sense- since mind Accepteth not that aught of these can cause Sense-bearing motions, and much less the thoughts A man revolves in mind. So unto these Must added be a somewhat, and a fourth; That somewhat's altogether void of name; Than which existeth naught more mobile, naught More an impalpable, of elements More small and smooth and round. That first transmits Sense-bearing motions through the frame, for that Is roused the first, composed of little shapes; Thence heat and viewless force of wind take up The motions, and thence air, and thence all things Are put in motion; the blood is strook, and then The vitals all begin to feel, and last To bones and marrow the sensation comes- Pleasure or torment. Nor will pain for naught Enter so far, nor a sharp ill seep through, But all things be perturbed to that degree That room for life will fail, and parts of soul Will scatter through the body's every pore.

	naturam animaeque 229 scire licet perquam pauxillis esse creatam 230 seminibus, quoniam fugiens nil ponderis aufert. 231 Nec tamen haec simplex nobis natura putanda est. 232 tenvis enim quaedam moribundos deserit aura 233 mixta vapore, vapor porro trahit aeraaëra secum; 234 nec calor est quisquam, cui non sit mixtus et aeraër; 235 rara quod eius enim constat natura, necessest 236 aerisaëris inter eum primordia multa moveri. 237 iam triplex animi est igitur natura reperta; 238 nec tamen haec sat sunt ad sensum cuncta creandum, 239 nil horum quoniam recipit mens posse creare	Yet as a rule, almost upon the skin These motion aIl are stopped, and this is why We have the power to retain our life. Now in my eagerness to tell thee how They are commixed, through what unions fit They function so, my country's pauper-speech Constrains me sadly. As I can, however, I'll touch some points and pass.
3.240	240 sensiferos motus, quae denique mente volutat. 241 quarta quoque his igitur quaedam natura necessest 242 adtribuatur; east omnino nominis expers; 243 qua neque mobilius quicquam neque tenvius extat 244 nec magis e parvis et levibus ex elementis; 245 sensiferos motus quae didit prima per artus. 246 prima cietur enim, parvis perfecta figuris, 247 inde calor motus et venti caeca potestas 248 accipit, inde aeraër, inde omnia mobilitantur: 249 concutitur sanguis, tum viscera persentiscunt 250 omnia, postremis datur ossibus atque medullis 251 sive voluptas est sive est contrarius ardor. 252 nec temere huc dolor usque potest penetrare neque acre 253 permanare malum, quin omnia perturbentur 254 usque adeo vitae desit locus atque animai 255 diffugiant partes per caulas corporis omnis. 256 sed plerumque fit in summo quasi corpore finis 257 motibus: hanc ob rem vitam	

	retinere valemus. 258 Nunc ea quo pacto inter sese mixta quibusque 259 compta modis vigeant rationem reddere aventem 260 abstrahit invitum patrii sermonis egestas; 261 sed tamen, ut potero summatim attingere, tangam. 262 inter enim cursant primordia principiorum 263 motibus inter se, nihil ut secernier unum 264 possit nec spatio fieri divisa potestas, 265 sed quasi multae vis unius corporis extant. 266 quod genus in quovis animantum viscere volgo 267 est odor et quidam color et sapor, et tamen ex his 268 omnibus est unum perfectum corporis augmen, 269 sic calor atque aeraër et venti caeca potestas	
3.270	270 mixta creant unam naturam et mobilis illa 271 vis, initum motus ab se quae dividit ollis, 272 sensifer unde oritur primum per viscera motus. 273 nam penitus prorsum latet haec natura subestque 274 nec magis hac infra quicquam est in corpore nostro 275 atque anima est animae proporro totius ipsa. 276 quod genus in nostris membris et corpore toto 277 mixta latens animi vis est animaeque potestas, 278 corporibus quia de parvis paucisque creatast, 279 sic tibi nominis haec expers vis, facta minutis 280 corporibus, latet atque animae quasi totius ipsa 281 proporrost anima et dominatur corpore toto. 282 consimili ratione necessest ventus et aeraër 283 et calor inter se vigeant commixta per artus 284 atque aliis aliud subsit magis emineatque, 285 ut quiddam fieri videatur ab omnibus unum, 286 ni calor ac ventus seorsum	

	seorsumque potestas 287 aerisaëris interemant sensum diductaque solvant. 288 est etiam calor ille animo, quem sumit, in ira 289 cum fervescit et ex oculis micat acrius ardor; 290 est et frigida multa, comes formidinis, aura, 291 quae ciet horrorem membris et concitat artus; 292 est etiam quoque pacati status aerisaëris ille, 293 pectore tranquillo fit qui voltuque sereno. 294 sed calidi plus est illis quibus acria corda 295 iracundaque mens facile effervescit in ira, 296 quo genere in primis vis est violenta leonum, 297 pectora qui fremitu rumpunt plerumque gementes 298 nec capere irarum fluctus in pectore possunt. 299 at ventosa magis cervorum frigida mens est	
3.300	300 et gelidas citius per viscera concitat auras, 301 quae tremulum faciunt membris existere motum. 302 at natura boum placido magis aereaëre vivit 303 nec nimis irai fax umquam subdita percit 304 fumida, suffundens caecae caliginis umbra, 305 nec gelidis torpet telis perfixa pavoris; 306 interutrasque sitast cervos saevosque leones. 307 sic hominum genus est: quamvis doctrina politos 308 constituat pariter quosdam, tamen illa relinquit 309 naturae cuiusque animi vestigia prima. 310 nec radicitus evelli mala posse putandumst, 311 quin proclivius hic iras decurrat ad acris, 312 ille metu citius paulo temptetur, at ille 313 tertius accipiat quaedam clementius aequo. 314 inque aliis rebus multis differre necessest 315 naturas hominum varias moresque	

	sequacis; 316 quorum ego nunc nequeo caecas exponere causas 317 nec reperire figurarum tot nomina quot sunt 318 principiis, unde haec oritur variantia rerum. 319 illud in his rebus video firmare potesse, 320 usque adeo naturarum vestigia linqui 321 parvola, quae nequeat ratio depellere nobis, 322 ut nihil inpediat dignam dis degere vitam. 323 Haec igitur natura tenetur corpore ab omni 324 ipsaque corporis est custos et causa salutis; 325 nam communibus inter se radicibus haerent 326 nec sine pernicie divelli posse videntur. 327 quod genus e thuris glaebis evellere odorem 328 haud facile est, quin intereat natura quoque eius, 329 sic animi atque animae naturam corpore toto	
3.330	330 extrahere haut facile est, quin omnia dissoluantur. 331 inplexis ita principiis ab origine prima 332 inter se fiunt consorti praedita vita, 333 nec sibi quaeque sine alterius vi posse videtur 334 corporis atque animi seorsum sentire potestas, 335 sed communibus inter eas conflatur utrimque 336 motibus accensus nobis per viscera sensus. 337 Praeterea corpus per se nec gignitur umquam 338 nec crescit neque post mortem durare videtur. 339 non enim, ut umor aquae dimittit saepe vaporem, 340 qui datus est, neque ea causa convellitur ipse, 341 sed manet incolumis, non, inquam, sic animai 342 discidium possunt artus perferre relicti, 343 sed penitus pereunt convulsi conque putrescunt. 344 ex ineunte aevo sic corporis atque animai	If one, moreover, denies that body feel, And holds that soul, through all the body mixed, Takes on this motion which we title "sense," He battles in vain indubitable facts: For who'll explain what body's feeling is, Except by what the public fact itself Has given and taught us? "But when soul is parted, Body's without all sense." True!- loses what Was even in its life-time not its own; And much beside it loses, when soul's driven Forth from that life-time. Or, to say that eyes Themselves can see no thing, but through the same The mind looks forth, as out of opened doors, Is- a hard saying; since the feel in eyes Says the reverse. For this itself draws on And forces into the pupils of our eyes Our consciousness. And note the case when often We lack the power to see refulgent things, Because our eyes are hampered by their light- With a mere doorway this would happen not; For, since it is our very selves that see, No open portals undertake the toil. Besides, if eyes of ours but act as doors, Methinks that, were our sight removed, the mind Ought then still better to behold a thing- When even the

	345 mutua vitalis discunt contagia motus, 346 maternis etiam membris alvoque reposta, 347 discidium nequeat fieri sine peste maloque; 348 ut videas, quoniam coniunctast causa salutis, 349 coniunctam quoque naturam consistere eorum. 350 Quod super est, siquis corpus sentire refutat 351 atque animam credit permixtam corpore toto 352 suscipere hunc motum quem sensum nominitamus, 353 vel manifestas res contra verasque repugnat. 354 quid sit enim corpus sentire quis adferet umquam, 355 si non ipsa palam quod res dedit ac docuit nos? 356 'at dimissa anima corpus caret undique sensu.' 357 perdit enim quod non proprium fuit eius in aevo 358 multaque praeterea perdit quom expellitur aevo. 359 Dicere porro oculos nullam rem cernere posse,	door-posts have been cleared away. Herein in these affairs nowise take up What honoured sage, Democritus, lays down- That proposition, that primordials Of body and mind, each super-posed on each, Vary alternately and interweave The fabric of our members. For not only Are the soul-elements smaller far than those Which this our body and inward parts compose, But also are they in their number less, And scattered sparsely through our frame. And thus This canst thou guarantee: soul's primal germs Maintain between them intervals as large At least as are the smallest bodies, which, When thrown against us, in our body rouse Sense-bearing motions.
3.360	360 sed per eos animum ut foribus spectare reclusis, 361 difficilest, contra cum sensus ducat eorum; 362 sensus enim trahit atque acies detrudit ad ipsas, 363 fulgida praesertim cum cernere saepe nequimus, 364 lumina luminibus quia nobis praepediuntur. 365 quod foribus non fit; neque enim, qua cernimus ipsi, 366 ostia suscipiunt ullum reclusa laborem. 367 praeterea si pro foribus sunt lumina nostra, 368 iam magis exemptis oculis debere videtur 369 cernere res animus sublatis postibus ipsis. 370 Illud in his rebus nequaquam sumere possis, 371 Democriti quod sancta viri sententia ponit, 372 corporis atque animi primordia singula primis 373 adposita alternis, variare ac nectere membra.	Hence it comes that we Sometimes don't feel alighting on our frames The clinging dust, or chalk that settles soft; Nor mists of night, nor spider's gossamer We feel against us, when, upon our road, Its net entangles us, nor on our head The dropping of its withered garmentings; Nor bird-feathers, nor vegetable down, Flying about, so light they barely fall; Nor feel the steps of every crawling thing, Nor each of all those footprints on our skin Of midges and the like. To that degree Must many primal germs be stirred in us Ere once the seeds of soul that through our frame Are intermingled 'gin to feel that those Primordials of the body have been strook, And ere, in pounding with such gaps between, They clash, combine and leap apart in turn. But mind is more the keeper of the gates, Hath more dominion over life than soul. For without intellect and mind there's not One part of soul can rest within our frame Least part of time; companioning, it goes With mind into the winds away, and leaves The icy members in the cold of death. But he

	374 nam cum multo sunt animae elementa minora 375 quam quibus e corpus nobis et viscera constant, 376 tum numero quoque concedunt et rara per artus 377 dissita sunt, dum taxat ut hoc promittere possis, 378 quantula prima queant nobis iniecta ciere 379 corpora sensiferos motus in corpore, tanta 380 intervalla tenere exordia prima animai. 381 nam neque pulveris inter dum sentimus adhaesum 382 corpore nec membris incussam sidere cretam, 383 nec nebulam noctu neque arani tenvia fila 384 obvia sentimus, quando obretimur euntes, 385 nec supera caput eiusdem cecidisse vietam 386 vestem nec plumas avium papposque volantis, 387 qui nimia levitate cadunt plerumque gravatim, 388 nec repentis itum cuiusvis cumque animantis 389 sentimus nec priva pedum vestigia quaeque,	whose mind and intellect abide Himself abides in life. However much The trunk be mangled, with the limbs lopped off, The soul withdrawn and taken from the limbs, Still lives the trunk and draws the vital air. Even when deprived of all but all the soul, Yet will it linger on and cleave to life,- Just as the power of vision still is strong, If but the pupil shall abide unharmed, Even when the eye around it's sorely rent- Provided only thou destroyest not Wholly the ball, but, cutting round the pupil, Leavest that pupil by itself behind- For more would ruin sight. But if that centre, That tiny part of eye, be eaten through, Forthwith the vision fails and darkness comes, Though in all else the unblemished ball be clear. 'Tis by like compact that the soul and mind Are each to other bound forevermore.
3.390	390 corpore quae in nostro culices et cetera ponunt. 391 usque adeo prius est in nobis multa ciendum 392 quam primordia sentiscant concussa animai, 393 semina corporibus nostris inmixta per artus, 394 et quam in his intervallis tuditantia possint 395 concursare coire et dissultare vicissim. 396 Et magis est animus vitai claustra coercenscoërcens 397 et dominantior ad vitam quam vis animai. 398 nam sine mente animoque nequit residere per artus 399 temporis exiguam partem pars ulla animai, 400 sed comes insequitur facile et discedit in auras 401 et gelidos artus in leti frigore linquit. 402 at manet in vita cui mens animusque remansit,	

	403 quamvis est circum caesis lacer undique membris; 404 truncus adempta anima circum membrisque remota 405 vivit et aetherias vitalis suscipit auras; 406 si non omnimodis, at magna parte animai 407 privatus, tamen in vita cunctatur et haeret; 408 ut, lacerato oculo circum si pupula mansit 409 incolumis, stat cernundi vivata potestas, 410 dum modo ne totum corrumpas luminis orbem 411 et circum caedas aciem solamque relinquas; 412 id quoque enim sine pernicie non fiet eorum. 413 at si tantula pars oculi media illa peresa est, 414 occidit extemplo lumen tenebraeque secuntur, 415 incolumis quamvis alioqui splendidus orbis. 416 hoc anima atque animus vincti sunt foedere semper. 417 Nunc age, nativos animantibus et mortalis 418 esse animos animasque levis ut noscere possis, 419 conquisita diu dulcique reperta labore	
3.420	420 digna tua pergam disponere carmina vita. 421 tu fac utrumque uno subiungas nomine eorum 422 atque animam verbi causa cum dicere pergam, 423 mortalem esse docens, animum quoque dicere credas, 424 qua tenus est unum inter se coniunctaque res est. 425 Principio quoniam tenuem constare minutis 426 corporibus docui multoque minoribus esse 427 principiis factam quam liquidus umor aquai 428 aut nebula aut fumus —; nam longe mobilitate 429 praestat et a tenui causa magis icta movetur, 430 quippe ubi imaginibus fumi nebulaeque movetur; 431 quod genus in somnis sopiti ubi cernimus alte	

	432 exhalare vaporem altaria ferreque fumum; 433 nam procul haec dubio nobis simulacra gerunturaegerunturæ 434 nunc igitur quoniam quassatis undique vasis 435 diffluere umorem et laticem discedere cernis, 436 et nebula ac fumus quoniam discedit in auras, 437 crede animam quoque diffundi multoque perire 438 ocius et citius dissolvi in corpora prima, 439 cum semel ex hominis membris ablata recessit; 440 quippe etenim corpus, quod vas quasi constitit eius, 441 cum cohibere nequit conquassatum ex aliqua re 442 ac rarefactum detracto sanguine venis, 443 aereaëre qui credas posse hanc cohiberier ullo, 444 corpore qui nostro rarus magis incohibens sit? 445 Praeterea gigni pariter cum corpore et una 446 crescere sentimus pariterque senescere mentem. 447 nam vel ut infirmo pueri teneroque vagantur 448 corpore, sic animi sequitur sententia tenvis. 449 inde ubi robustis adolevit viribus aetas,	
3.450	450 consilium quoque maius et auctior est animi vis. 451 post ubi iam validis quassatum est viribus aevi 452 corpus et obtusis ceciderunt viribus artus, 453 claudicat ingenium, delirat lingua mens, 454 omnia deficiunt atque uno tempore desunt. 455 ergo dissolui quoque convenit omnem animai 456 naturam, ceu fumus, in altas aerisaëris auras; 457 quando quidem gigni pariter pariterque videmus 458 crescere et, docui, simul aevo fessa fatisci. 459 Huc accedit uti videamus, corpus ut ipsum 460 suscipere inmanis morbos durumque dolorem,	

	461 sic animum curas acris luctumque metumque; 462 quare participem leti quoque convenit esse. 463 quin etiam morbis in corporis avius errat 464 saepe animus; dementit enim deliraque fatur, 465 inter dumque gravi lethargo fertur in altum 466 aeternumque soporem oculis nutuque cadenti; 467 unde neque exaudit voces nec noscere voltus 468 illorum potis est, ad vitam qui revocantes 469 circum stant lacrimis rorantes ora genasque. 470 quare animum quoque dissolui fateare necessest, 471 quandoquidem penetrant in eum contagia morbi; 472 nam dolor ac morbus leti fabricator uterquest, 473 multorum exitio perdocti quod sumus ante. 474 475 476 denique cor, hominem cum vini vis penetravit 477 acris et in venas discessit diditus ardor, 478 consequitur gravitas membrorum, praepediuntur 479 crura vacillanti, tardescit lingua, madet mens,	
3.480	480 nant oculi, clamor singultus iurgia gliscunt, 481 et iam cetera de genere hoc quae cumque secuntur, 482 cur ea sunt, nisi quod vehemens violentia vini 483 conturbare animam consuevit corpore in ipso? 484 at quae cumque queunt conturbari inque pediri, 485 significant, paulo si durior insinuarit 486 causa, fore ut pereant aevo privata futuro. 487 Quin etiam subito vi morbi saepe coactus 488 ante oculos aliquis nostros, ut fulminis ictu, 489 concidit et spumas agit, ingemit et tremit artus, 490 desipit, extentat nervos, torquetur, anhelat	

	491 inconstanter, et in iactando membra fatigat, 492 ni mirum quia vis morbi distracta per artus 493 turbat agens animam, spumans in aequore salso 494 ventorum validis fervescunt viribus undae. 495 exprimitur porro gemitus, quia membra dolore 496 adficiuntur et omnino quod semina vocis 497 eliciuntur et ore foras glomerata feruntur 498 qua quasi consuerunt et sunt munita viai. 499 desipientia fit, quia vis animi atque animai 500 conturbatur et, ut docui, divisa seorsum 501 disiectatur eodem illo distracta veneno. 502 inde ubi iam morbi reflexit causa, reditque 503 in latebras acer corrupti corporis umor, 504 tum quasi vaccillans primum consurgit et omnis 505 paulatim redit in sensus animamque receptat. 506 haec igitur tantis ubi morbis corpore in ipso 507 iactentur miserisque modis distracta laborent, 508 cur eadem credis sine corpore in aereaëre aperto 509 cum validis ventis aetatem degere posse?	
3.510	510 Et quoniam mentem sanari corpus ut aegrum 511 cernimus et flecti medicina posse videmus, 512 id quoque praesagit mortalem vivere mentem. 513 addere enim partis aut ordine traiecere aecumst 514 aut aliquid prosum de summa detrahere hilum, 515 commutare animum qui cumque adoritur et infit 516 aut aliam quamvis naturam flectere quaerit. 517 at neque transferri sibi partis nec tribui vult 518 inmortale quod est quicquam neque defluere hilum; 519 nam quod cumque suis mutatum finibus exit,	

	520 continuo hoc mors est illius quod fuit ante. 521 ergo animus sive aegrescit, mortalia signa 522 mittit, uti docui, seu flectitur a medicina. 523 usque adeo falsae rationi vera videtur 524 res occurrere et effugium praecludere eunti 525 ancipitique refutatu convincere falsum. 526 Denique saepe hominem paulatim cernimus ire 527 et membratim vitalem deperdere sensum; 528 in pedibus primum digitos livescere et unguis, 529 inde pedes et crura mori, post inde per artus 530 ire alios tractim gelidi vestigia leti. 531 scinditur atque animae haec quoniam natura nec uno 532 tempore sincera existit, mortalis habendast. 533 quod si forte putas ipsam se posse per artus 534 introsum trahere et partis conducere in unum 535 atque ideo cunctis sensum diducere membris, 536 at locus ille tamen, quo copia tanta animai 537 cogitur, in sensu debet maiore videri; 538 qui quoniam nusquamst, ni mirum, ut diximus , 539 dilaniata foras dispargitur, interit ergo.	
3.540	540 quin etiam si iam libeat concedere falsum 541 et dare posse animam glomerari in corpore eorum, 542 lumina qui lincunt moribundi particulatim, 543 mortalem tamen esse animam fateare necesse 544 nec refert utrum pereat dispersa per auras 545 an contracta suis e partibus obbrutescat, 546 quando hominem totum magis ac magis undique sensus 547 deficit et vitae minus et minus undique restat. 548 Et quoniam mens est hominis pars una locoque 549 fixa manet certo, vel ut aures atque	

	oculi sunt 550 atque alii sensus qui vitam cumque gubernant, 551 et vel uti manus atque oculus naresve seorsum 552 secreta ab nobis nequeunt sentire neque esse, 553 sed tamen in parvo lincuntur tempore tali, 554 sic animus per se non quit sine corpore et ipso 555 esse homine, illius quasi quod vas esse videtur, 556 sive aliud quid vis potius coniunctius ei 557 fingere, quandoquidem conexu corpus adhaeret. 558 Denique corporis atque animi vivata potestas 559 inter se coniuncta valent vitaque fruuntur; 560 nec sine corpore enim vitalis edere motus 561 sola potest animi per se natura nec autem 562 cassum anima corpus durare et sensibus uti. 563 scilicet avolsus radicibus ut nequit ullam 564 dispicere ipse oculus rem seorsum corpore toto, 565 sic anima atque animus per se nil posse videtur. 566 ni mirum quia venas et viscera mixtim, 567 per nervos atque ossa tenentur corpore ab omni 568 nec magnis intervallis primordia possunt 569 libera dissultare, ideo conclusa moventur	
3.570	570 sensiferos motus, quos extra corpus in auras 571 aerisaëris haut possunt post mortem eiecta moveri 572 propterea quia non simili ratione tenentur; 573 corpus enim atque animans erit aeraër, si cohibere 574 sese anima atque in eos poterit concludere motus, 575 quos ante in nervis et in ipso corpore agebat. 576 quare etiam atque etiam resoluto corporis omni 577 tegmine et eiectis extra vitalibus auris 578 dissolui sensus animi fateare	

	necessest 579 atque animam, quoniam coniunctast causa duobus. 580 Denique cum corpus nequeat perferre animai 581 discidium, quin in taetro tabescat odore, 582 quid dubitas quin ex imo penitusque coorta 583 emanarit uti fumus diffusa animae vis, 584 atque ideo tanta mutatum putre ruina 585 conciderit corpus, penitus quia mota loco sunt 586 fundamenta foras manant animaeque per artus 587 perque viarum omnis flexus, in corpore qui sunt, 588 atque foramina? multimodis ut noscere possis 589 dispertitam animae naturam exisse per artus 590 et prius esse sibi distractam corpore in ipso, 591 quam prolapsa foras enaret in aerisaëris auras. 592 Quin etiam finis dum vitae vertitur intra, 593 saepe aliqua tamen e causa labefacta videtur 594 ire anima ac toto solui de corpore 595 et quasi supremo languescere tempore voltus 596 molliaque exsangui cadere omnia membra. 597 quod genus est, animo male factum cum perhibetur 598 aut animam liquisse; ubi iam trepidatur et omnes 599 extremum cupiunt vitae reprehendere vinclum;	
3.600	600 conquassatur enim tum mens animaeque potestas 601 omnis. et haec ipso cum corpore conlabefiunt, 602 ut gravior paulo possit dissolvere causa. 603 Quid dubitas tandem quin extra prodita corpus 604 inbecilla foras in aperto, tegmine dempto, 605 non modo non omnem possit durare per aevom, 606 sed minimum quodvis nequeat consistere tempus? 607 nec sibi enim quisquam moriens sentire videtur	

	608 ire foras animam incolumem de corpore toto, 609 nec prius ad iugulum et supera succedere fauces, 610 verum deficere in certa regione locatam; 611 ut sensus alios in parti quemque sua scit 612 dissolui. quod si inmortalis nostra foret mens, 613 non tam se moriens dissolvi conquereretur, 614 sed magis ire foras vestemque relinquere, ut anguis. 615 Denique cur animi numquam mens consiliumque 616 gignitur in capite aut pedibus manibusve, sed unis 617 sedibus et certis regionibus omnibus haeret, 618 si non certa loca ad nascendum reddita cuique 619 sunt, et ubi quicquid possit durare creatum 620 atque ita multimodis partitis artubus esse, 621 membrorum ut numquam existat praeposterus ordo? 622 usque adeo sequitur res rem, neque flamma creari 623 fluminibus solitast neque in igni gignier algor. 624 Praeterea si inmortalis natura animaist 625 et sentire potest secreta a corpore nostro, 626 quinque, ut opinor, eam faciundum est sensibus auctam. 627 nec ratione alia nosmet proponere nobis 628 possumus infernas animas Acherunte vagare. 629 pictores itaque et scriptorum saecla priora	
3.630	630 sic animas intro duxerunt sensibus auctas. 631 at neque sorsum oculi neque nares nec manus ipsa 632 esse potest animae neque sorsum lingua neque aures; 633 haud igitur per se possunt sentire neque esse. 634 Et quoniam toto sentimus corpore inesse 635 vitalem sensum et totum esse animale videmus, 636 si subito medium celeri praeciderit ictu	

	637 vis aliqua, ut sorsum partem secernat utramque, 638 dispertita procul dubio quoque vis animai 639 et discissa simul cum corpore dissicietur. 640 at quod scinditur et partis discedit in ullas, 641 scilicet aeternam sibi naturam abnuit esse. 642 falciferos memorant currus abscidere membra 643 saepe ita de subito permixta caede calentis, 644 ut tremere in terra videatur ab artubus id quod 645 decidit abscisum, cum mens tamen atque hominis vis 646 mobilitate mali non quit sentire dolorem; 647 et simul in pugnae studio quod dedita mens est, 648 corpore relicuo pugnam caedesque petessit, 649 nec tenet amissam laevam cum tegmine saepe 650 inter equos abstraxe rotas falcesque rapaces, 651 nec cecidisse alius dextram, cum scandit et instat. 652 inde alius conatur adempto surgere crure, 653 cum digitos agitat propter moribundus humi pes. 654 et caput abscisum calido viventeque trunco 655 servat humi voltum vitalem oculosque patentis, 656 donec reliquias animai reddidit omnes. 657 quin etiam tibi si, lingua vibrante, minanti 658 serpentis cauda, procero corpore, utrumque 659 sit libitum in multas partis discidere ferro,	
3.660	660 omnia iam sorsum cernes ancisa recenti 661 volnere tortari et terram conspargere tabo, 662 ipsam seque retro partem petere ore priorem, 663 volneris ardenti ut morsu premat icta dolore. 664 omnibus esse igitur totas dicemus in illis 665 particulis animas? at ea ratione sequetur	

	666 unam animantem animas habuisse in corpore multas. 667 ergo divisast ea quae fuit una simul cum 668 corpore; quapropter mortale utrumque putandumst, 669 in multas quoniam partis disciditur aeque. 670 Praeterea si inmortalis natura animai 671 constat et in corpus nascentibus insinuatur, 672 cur super ante actam aetatem meminisse nequimus 673 nec vestigia gestarum rerum ulla tenemus? 674 nam si tanto operest animi mutata potestas, 675 omnis ut actarum exciderit retinentia rerum, 676 non, ut opinor, id ab leto iam longius errat; 677 qua propter fateare necessest quae fuit ante 678 interiisse, et quae nunc est nunc esse creatam. 679 Praeterea si iam perfecto corpore nobis 680 inferri solitast animi vivata potestas 681 tum cum gignimur et vitae cum limen inimus, 682 haud ita conveniebat uti cum corpore et una 683 cum membris videatur in ipso sanguine cresse, 684 sed vel ut in cavea per se sibi vivere solam 685 convenit, ut sensu corpus tamen affluat omne. 686 quare etiam atque etiam neque originis esse putandumst 687 expertis animas nec leti lege solutas; 688 nam neque tanto opere adnecti potuisse putandumst 689 corporibus nostris extrinsecus insinuatas,	
3.690	690 quod fieri totum contra manifesta docet res 691 aenamqueænamque ita conexa est per venas viscera nervos 692 ossaque, uti dentes quoque sensu participentur; 693 morbus ut indicat et gelidai stringor aquai 694 et lapis oppressus subitis e frugibus asperaeasperæ	Wherefore it seems that soul Hath both a natal and funeral hour. Besides are seeds of soul there left behind In the breathless body, or not? If there they are, It cannot justly be immortal deemed, Since, shorn of some parts lost, 'thas gone away: But if, borne off with members uncorrupt, 'Thas fled so absolutely all away It leaves not one remainder of itself Behind in body,

	695 nec, tam contextae cum sint, exire videntur 696 incolumes posse et salvas exsolvere sese 697 omnibus e nervis atque ossibus articulisque, 698 quod si forte putas extrinsecus insinuatam 699 permanare animam nobis per membra solere, 700 tanto quique magis cum corpore fusa peribit; 701 quod permanat enim, dissolvitur, interit ergo; 702 dispertitur enim per caulas corporis omnis. 703 ut cibus, in membra atque artus cum diditur omnis, 704 disperit atque aliam naturam sufficit ex se, 705 sic anima atque animus quamvis integra recens 706 corpus eunt, tamen in manando dissoluuntur, 707 dum quasi per caulas omnis diduntur in artus 708 particulae quibus haec animi natura creatur, 709 quae nunc in nostro dominatur corpore nata 710 ex illa quae tunc periit partita per artus. 711 quapropter neque natali privata videtur 712 esse die natura animae nec funeris expers. 713 Semina praeterea linquontur necne animai 714 corpore in exanimo? quod si lincuntur et insunt, 715 haut erit ut merito inmortalis possit haberi, 716 partibus amissis quoniam libata recessit. 717 sin ita sinceris membris ablata profugit, 718 ut nullas partis in corpore liquerit ex se, 719 unde cadavera rancenti iam viscere vermes	whence do cadavers, then, From out their putrid flesh exhale the worms, And whence does such a mass of living things, Boneless and bloodless, o'er the bloated frame Bubble and swarm? But if perchance thou thinkest That souls from outward into worms can wind, And each into a separate body come, And reckonest not why many thousand souls Collect where only one has gone away, Here is a point, in sooth, that seems to need Inquiry and a putting to the test: Whether the souls go on a hunt for seeds Of worms wherewith to build their dwelling places, Or enter bodies ready-made, as 'twere. But why themselves they thus should do and toil 'Tis hard to say, since, being free of body, They flit around, harassed by no disease, Nor cold nor famine; for the body labours By more of kinship to these flaws of life, And mind by contact with that body suffers So many ills. But grant it be for them However useful to construct a body To which to enter in, 'tis plain they can't. Then, souls for self no frames nor bodies make, Nor is there how they once might enter in To bodies ready-made- for they cannot Be nicely interwoven with the same, And there'll be formed no interplay of sense Common to each.
3.720	720 expirant atque unde animantum copia tanta 721 exos et exanguis tumidos perfluctuat artus? 722 quod si forte animas extrinsecus insinuari? 723 vermibus et privas in corpora posse venire	

	724 credis nec reputas cur milia multa animarum 725 conveniant unde una recesserit, hoc tamen est ut 726 quaerendum videatur et in discrimen agendum, 727 utrum tandem animae venentur semina quaeque 728 vermiculorum ipsaeque sibi fabricentur ubi sint, 729 an quasi corporibus perfectis insinuentur. 730 at neque cur faciant ipsae quareve laborent 731 dicere suppeditat. neque enim, sine corpore cum sunt, 732 sollicitae volitant morbis alguque fameque; 733 corpus enim magis his vitiis adfine laborat, 734 et mala multa animus contage fungitur eius. 735 sed tamen his esto quamvis facere utile corpus, 736 cum subeant; at qua possint via nulla videtur. 737 haut igitur faciunt animae sibi corpora et artus. 738 nec tamen est ut qui perfectis insinuentur 739 corporibus; neque enim poterunt suptiliter esse 740 conexae neque consensu contagia fient. 741 Denique cur acris violentia triste leonum 742 seminium sequitur, volpes dolus, et fuga cervos? 743 a patribus datur et patrius pavor incitat artus, 744 et iam cetera de genere hoc cur omnia membris 745 ex ineunte aevo generascunt ingenioque, 746 si non, certa suo quia semine seminioque 747 vis animi pariter crescit cum corpore quoque? 748 quod si inmortalis foret et mutare soleret 749 corpora, permixtis animantes moribus essent,	
3.750	750 effugeret canis Hyrcano de semine saepe 751 cornigeri incursum cervi tremeretque per auras 752 aerisaëris accipiter fugiens veniente columba,	

	753 desiperent homines, saperent fera saecla ferarum. 754 illud enim falsa fertur ratione, quod aiunt 755 inmortalem animam mutato corpore flecti; 756 quod mutatur enim, dissolvitur, interit ergo; 757 traiciuntur enim partes atque ordine migrant; 758 quare dissolui quoque debent posse per artus, 759 denique ut intereant una cum corpore cunctae. 760 sin animas hominum dicent in corpora semper 761 ire humana, tamen quaeram cur e sapienti 762 stulta queat fieri, nec prudens sit puer ullus, 763 764 nec tam doctus equae pullus quam fortis equi vis. 765 scilicet in tenero tenerascere corpore mentem 766 confugient. quod si iam fit, fateare necessest 767 mortalem esse animam, quoniam mutata per artus 768 tanto opere amittit vitam sensumque priorem. 769 quove modo poterit pariter cum corpore quoque 770 confirmata cupitum aetatis tangere florem 771 vis animi, nisi erit consors in origine prima? 772 quidve foras sibi vult membris exire senectis? 773 an metuit conclusa manere in corpore putri 774 et domus aetatis spatio ne fessa vetusto 775 obruat? at non sunt immortali ulla pericla. 776 Denique conubia ad Veneris partusque ferarum 777 esse animas praesto deridiculum esse videtur, 778 expectare immortalis mortalia membra 779 innumero numero certareque praeproperanter	
3.780	780 inter se quae prima potissimaque insinuetur; 781 si non forte ita sunt animarum foedera pacta, 782 ut quae prima volans advenerit	

	insinuetur 783 prima neque inter se contendant viribus hilum. 784 Denique in aethere non arbor, non aequore in alto 785 nubes esse queunt nec pisces vivere in arvis 786 nec cruor in lignis neque saxis sucus inesse. 787 certum ac dispositumst ubi quicquid crescat et insit. 788 sic animi natura nequit sine corpore oriri 789 sola neque a nervis et sanguine longius esse. 790 quod si posset enim, multo prius ipsa animi vis 791 in capite aut umeris aut imis calcibus esse 792 posset et innasci quavis in parte soleret, 793 tandem in eodem homine atque in eodem vase manere. 794 quod quoniam nostro quoque constat corpore certum 795 dispositumque videtur ubi esse et crescere possit 796 sorsum anima atque animus, tanto magis infitiandum 797 totum posse extra corpus durare genique. 798 quare, corpus ubi interiit, periisse necessest 799 confiteare animam distractam in corpore toto. 800 quippe etenim mortale aeterno iungere et una 801 consentire putare et fungi mutua posse 802 desiperest; quid enim diversius esse putandumst 803 aut magis inter se disiunctum discrepitansque, 804 quam mortale quod est inmortali atque perenni 805 iunctum in concilio saevas tolerare procellas? 806 praeterea quaecumque manent aeterna necessest 807 aut quia sunt solido cum corpore respuere ictus 808 nec penetrare pati sibi quicquam quod queat artas 809 dissociare intus partis, ut materiai	
3.810	810 corpora sunt, quorum naturam ostendimus ante, 811 aut ideo durare aetatem posse per omnem,	

	812 plagarum quia sunt expertia sicut inanest, 813 quod manet intactum neque ab ictu fungitur hilum, 814 aut etiam quia nulla loci sit copia circum, 815 quo quasi res possint discedere dissoluique, 816 sicut summarum summast aeterna, neque extra 817 quis locus est quo diffugiant neque corpora sunt quae 818 possint incidere et valida dissolvere plaga. 819 Quod si forte ideo magis inmortalis habendast, 820 quod vitalibus ab rebus munita tenetur, 821 aut quia non veniunt omnino aliena salutis, 822 aut quia quae veniunt aliqua ratione recedunt 823 pulsa prius quam quid noceant sentire queamus, 824 praeter enim quam quod morbis cum corporis aegret, 825 advenit id quod eam de rebus saepe futuris 826 macerat inque metu male habet curisque fatigat, 827 praeteritisque male admissis peccata remordent. 828 adde furorem animi proprium atque oblivia rerum, 829 adde quod in nigras lethargi mergitur undas. 830 Nil igitur mors est ad nos neque pertinet hilum, 831 quandoquidem natura animi mortalis habetur. 832 et vel ut ante acto nihil tempore sensimus aegri, 833 ad confligendum venientibus undique Poenis, 834 omnia cum belli trepido concussa tumultu 835 horrida contremuere sub altis aetheris auris, 836 in dubioque fuere utrorum ad regna cadendum 837 omnibus humanis esset terraque marique, 838 sic, ubi non erimus, cum corporis atque animai	
3.839	839 discidium fuerit, quibus e sumus uniter apti, 840 scilicet haud nobis quicquam, qui	

	non erimus tum, 841 accidere omnino poterit sensumque movere, 842 non si terra mari miscebitur et mare caelo. 843 et si iam nostro sentit de corpore postquam 844 distractast animi natura animaeque potestas, 845 nil tamen est ad nos, qui comptu coniugioque 846 corporis atque animae consistimus uniter apti. 847 nec, si materiem nostram collegerit aetas 848 post obitum rursumque redegerit ut sita nunc est, 849 atque iterum nobis fuerint data lumina vitae, 850 pertineat quicquam tamen ad nos id quoque factum, 851 interrupta semel cum sit repetentia nostri. 852 et nunc nil ad nos de nobis attinet, ante 853 qui fuimus, iam de illis nos adficit angor. 854 nam cum respicias inmensi temporis omne 855 praeteritum spatium, tum motus materiai 856 multimodi quam sint, facile hoc adcredere possis, 857 semina saepe in eodem, ut nunc sunt, ordine posta 858 haec eadem, quibus e nunc nos sumus, ante fuisse. 859 nec memori tamen id quimus reprehendere mente; 860 inter enim iectast vitai pausa vageque 861 deerrarunt passim motus ab sensibus omnes. 862 debet enim, misere si forte aegreque futurumst; 863 ipse quoque esse in eo tum tempore, cui male possit 864 accidere. id quoniam mors eximit, esseque prohibet 865 illum cui possint incommoda conciliari, 866 scire licet nobis nihil esse in morte timendum 867 nec miserum fieri qui non est posse, neque hilum 868 differre an nullo fuerit iam tempore natus,	
3.869	869 mortalem vitam mors cum	

	inmortalis ademit. 870 Proinde ubi se videas hominem indignarier ipsum, 871 post mortem fore ut aut putescat corpore posto 872 aut flammis interfiat malisve ferarum, 873 scire licet non sincerum sonere atque subesse 874 caecum aliquem cordi stimulum, quamvis neget ipse 875 credere se quemquam sibi sensum in morte futurum; 876 non, ut opinor, enim dat quod promittit et unde 877 nec radicitus e vita se tollit et eicit, 878 sed facit esse sui quiddam super inscius ipse. 879 vivus enim sibi cum proponit quisque futurum, 880 corpus uti volucres lacerent in morte feraeque, 881 ipse sui miseret; neque enim se dividit illim 882 nec removet satis a proiecto corpore et illum 883 se fingit sensuque suo contaminat astans. 884 hinc indignatur se mortalem esse creatum 885 nec videt in vera nullum fore morte alium se, 886 qui possit vivus sibi se lugere peremptum 887 stansque iacentem lacerari urive dolere. 888 nam si in morte malumst malis morsuque ferarum 889 tractari, non invenio qui non sit acerbum 890 ignibus inpositum calidis torrescere flammis 891 aut in melle situm suffocari atque rigere 892 frigore, cum summo gelidi cubat aequore saxi, 893 urgerive superne obrutum pondere terrae. 894 'Iam iam non domus accipiet te laeta neque uxor 895 optima, nec dulces occurrent oscula nati 896 praeripere et tacita pectus dulcedine tangent. 897 non poteris factis florentibus esse tuisque 898 praesidium. misero misere' aiunt 'omnia ademit	

3.899	899 una dies infesta tibi tot praemia vitae.' 900 illud in his rebus non addunt 'nec tibi earum 901 iam desiderium rerum super insidet una.' 902 quod bene si videant animo dictisque sequantur, 903 dissoluant animi magno se angore metuque. 904 'tu quidem ut es leto sopitus, sic eris aevi 905 quod super est cunctis privatus doloribus aegris; 906 at nos horrifico cinefactum te prope busto 907 insatiabiliter deflevimus, aeternumque 908 nulla dies nobis maerorem e pectore demet.' 909 illud ab hoc igitur quaerendum est, quid sit amari 910 tanto opere, ad somnum si res redit atque quietem, 911 cur quisquam aeterno possit tabescere luctu. 912 Hoc etiam faciunt ubi discubuere tenentque 913 pocula saepe homines et inumbrant ora coronis, 914 ex animo ut dicant: 'brevis hic est fructus homullis; 915 iam fuerit neque post umquam revocare licebit.' 916 tam quam in morte mali cum primis hoc sit eorum, 917 quod sitis exurat miseros atque arida torrat, 918 aut aliae cuius desiderium insideat rei. 919 nec sibi enim quisquam tum se vitamque requiret, 920 cum pariter mens et corpus sopita quiescunt; 921 nam licet aeternum per nos sic esse soporem, 922 nec desiderium nostri nos adficit ullum, 923 et tamen haud quaquam nostros tunc illa per artus 924 longe ab sensiferis primordia motibus errant, 925 cum correptus homo ex somno se colligit ipse. 926 multo igitur mortem minus ad nos esse putandumst, 927 si minus esse potest quam quod nihil esse videmus;	

	928 maior enim turbae disiectus materiai	
3.929	929 consequitur leto nec quisquam expergitus extat, 930 frigida quem semel est vitai pausa secuta. 931 Denique si vocem rerum natura repente. 932 mittat et hoc alicui nostrum sic increpet ipsa: 933 'quid tibi tanto operest, mortalis, quod nimis aegris 934 luctibus indulges? quid mortem congemis ac fles? 935 nam grata fuit tibi vita ante acta priorque 936 et non omnia pertusum congesta quasi in vas 937 commoda perfluxere atque ingrata interiere; 938 cur non ut plenus vitae conviva recedis 939 aequo animoque capis securam, stulte, quietem? 940 sin ea quae fructus cumque es periere profusa 941 vitaque in offensost, cur amplius addere quaeris, 942 rursum quod pereat male et ingratum occidat omne, 943 non potius vitae finem facis atque laboris? 944 nam tibi praeterea quod machiner inveniamque, 945 quod placeat, nihil est; eadem sunt omnia semper. 946 si tibi non annis corpus iam marcet et artus 947 confecti languent, eadem tamen omnia restant, 948 omnia si perges vivendo vincere saecla, 949 atque etiam potius, si numquam sis moriturus', 950 quid respondemus, nisi iustam intendere litem 951 naturam et veram verbis exponere causam? 952 grandior hic vero si iam seniorque queratur 953 atque obitum lamentetur miser amplius aequo, 954 non merito inclamet magis et voce increpet acri: 955 'aufer abhinc lacrimas, baratre, et compesce querellas. 956 omnia perfunctus vitai praemia marces;	

	957 sed quia semper aves quod abest, praesentia temnis, 958 inperfecta tibi elapsast ingrataque vita,	
3.959	959 et nec opinanti mors ad caput adstitit ante 960 quam satur ac plenus possis discedere rerum. 961 nunc aliena tua tamen aetate omnia mitte 962 aequo animoque, age dum, magnis concede necessis?' 963 iure, ut opinor, agat, iure increpet inciletque; 964 cedit enim rerum novitate extrusa vetustas 965 semper, et ex aliis aliud reparare necessest. 966 Nec quisquam in barathrum nec Tartara deditur atra; 967 materies opus est, ut crescant postera saecla; 968 quae tamen omnia te vita perfuncta sequentur; 969 nec minus ergo ante haec quam tu cecidere cadentque. 970 sic alid ex alio numquam desistet oriri 971 vitaque mancipio nulli datur, omnibus usu. 972 respice item quam nil ad nos ante acta vetustas 973 temporis aeterni fuerit, quam nascimur ante. 974 hoc igitur speculum nobis natura futuri 975 temporis exponit post mortem denique nostram. 976 numquid ibi horribile apparet, num triste videtur 977 quicquam, non omni somno securius exstat? 978 Atque ea ni mirum quae cumque Acherunte profundo 979 prodita sunt esse, in vita sunt omnia nobis. 980 nec miser inpendens magnum timet aereaëre saxum 981 Tantalus, ut famast, cassa formidine torpens; 982 sed magis in vita divom metus urget inanis 983 mortalis casumque timent quem cuique ferat fors. 984 nec Tityon volucres ineunt Acherunte iacentem 985 nec quod sub magno scrutentur pectore quicquam	

	986 perpetuam aetatem possunt reperire profecto. 987 quam libet immani proiectu corporis exstet, 988 qui non sola novem dispessis iugera membris	
3.989	989 optineat, sed qui terrai totius orbem, 990 non tamen aeternum poterit perferre dolorem 991 nec praebere cibum proprio de corpore semper. 992 sed Tityos nobis hic est, in amore iacentem 993 quem volucres lacerant atque exest anxius angor 994 aut alia quavis scindunt cuppedine curae. 995 Sisyphus in vita quoque nobis ante oculos est, 996 qui petere a populo fasces saevasque secures 997 imbibit et semper victus tristisque recedit. 998 nam petere imperium, quod inanest nec datur umquam, 999 atque in eo semper durum sufferre laborem, 1000 hoc est adverso nixantem trudere monte 1001 saxum, quod tamen summo iam vertice rusum 1002 volvitur et plani raptim petit aequora campi. 1003 deinde animi ingratam naturam pascere semper 1004 atque explere bonis rebus satiareque numquam, 1005 quod faciunt nobis annorum tempora, circum 1006 cum redeunt fetusque ferunt variosque lepores, 1007 nec tamen explemur vitai fructibus umquam, 1008 hoc, ut opinor, id est, aevo florente puellas 1009 quod memorant laticem pertusum congerere in vas, 1010 quod tamen expleri nulla ratione potestur. 1011 Cerberus et Furiae iam vero et lucis egestas, 1012 Tartarus horriferos eructans faucibus aestus! 1013 qui neque sunt usquam nec possunt esse profecto; 1014 sed metus in vita poenarum pro male factis	

	1015 est insignibus insignis scelerisque luela, 1016 carcer et horribilis de saxo iactus deorsum, 1017 verbera carnifices robur pix lammina taedae; 1018 quae tamen etsi absunt, at mens sibi conscia factis	
3.1019	1019 praemetuens adhibet stimulos torretque flagellis, 1020 nec videt interea qui terminus esse malorum 1021 possit nec quae sit poenarum denique finis, 1022 atque eadem metuit magis haec ne in morte gravescant. 1023 hic Acherusia fit stultorum denique vita. 1024 Hoc etiam tibi tute interdum dicere possis. 1025 'lumina sis oculis etiam bonus Ancus reliquit, 1026 qui melior multis quam tu fuit, improbe, rebus. 1027 inde alii multi reges rerumque potentes 1028 occiderunt, magnis qui gentibus imperitarunt. 1029 ille quoque ipse, viam qui quondam per mare magnum 1030 stravit iterque dedit legionibus ire per altum 1031 ac pedibus salsas docuit super ire lucunas 1032 et contempsit equis insultans murmura ponti, 1033 lumine adempto animam moribundo corpore fudit. 1034 Scipiadas, belli fulmen, Carthaginis horror, 1035 ossa dedit terrae proinde ac famul infimus esset. 1036 adde repertores doctrinarum atque leporum, 1037 adde Heliconiadum comites; quorum unus Homerus 1038 sceptra potitus eadem aliis sopitus quietest. 1039 denique Democritum post quam matura vetustas 1040 admonuit memores motus languescere mentis, 1041 sponte sua leto caput obvius optulit ipse. 1042 ipse Epicurus obit decurso lumine vitae, 1043 qui genus humanum ingenio superavit et omnis	This also to thy very self sometimes Repeat thou mayst: "Lo, even good Ancus left The sunshine with his eyes, in divers things A better man than thou, O worthless hind; And many other kings and lords of rule Thereafter have gone under, once who swayed O'er mighty peoples. And he also, he- Who whilom paved a highway down the sea, And gave his legionaries thoroughfare Along the deep, and taught them how to cross The pools of brine afoot, and did contemn, Trampling upon it with his cavalry, The bellowings of ocean- poured his soul From dying body, as his light was ta'en. And Scipio's son, the thunderbolt of war, Horror of Carthage, gave his bones to earth, Like to the lowliest villein in the house. Add finders-out of sciences and arts; Add comrades of the Heliconian dames, Among whom Homer, sceptered o'er them all, Now lies in slumber sunken with the rest. Then, too, Democritus, when ripened eld Admonished him his memory waned away, Of own accord offered his head to death. Even Epicurus went, his light of life Run out, the man in genius who o'er-topped The human race, extinguishing all others, As sun, in ether arisen, all the stars. Wilt thou, then, dally, thou complain to go?- For whom already life's as good as dead, Whilst yet thou livest and lookest?- who in sleep Wastest thy life- time's major part, and snorest Even when awake, and ceasest not to see The stuff of dreams, and bearest a mind beset By baseless terror, nor discoverest oft What's wrong with thee, when, like a sotted wretch, Thou'rt jostled along by many crowding cares, And wanderest reeling round, with mind aswim."

	1044 restinxit stellas exortus ut aetherius sol. 1045 tu vero dubitabis et indignabere obire? 1046 mortua cui vita est prope iam vivo atque videnti, 1047 qui somno partem maiorem conteris aevi, 1048 et viligans stertis nec somnia cernere cessas	
3.1049	1049 sollicitamque geris cassa formidine mentem 1050 nec reperire potes tibi quid sit saepe mali, cum 1051 ebrius urgeris multis miser undique curis 1052 atque animo incerto fluitans errore vagaris.' 1053 Si possent homines, proinde ac sentire videntur 1054 pondus inesse animo, quod se gravitate fatiget, 1055 e quibus id fiat causis quoque noscere et unde 1056 tanta mali tam quam moles in pectore constet, 1057 haut ita vitam agerent, ut nunc plerumque videmus 1058 quid sibi quisque velit nescire et quaerere semper, 1059 commutare locum, quasi onus deponere possit. 1060 exit saepe foras magnis ex aedibus ille, 1061 esse domi quem pertaesumst, subitoque , 1062 quippe foris nihilo melius qui sentiat esse. 1063 currit agens mannos ad villam praecipitanter 1064 auxilium tectis quasi ferre ardentibus instans; 1065 oscitat extemplo, tetigit cum limina villae, 1066 aut abit in somnum gravis atque oblivia quaerit, 1067 aut etiam properans urbem petit atque revisit. 1068 hoc se quisque modo fugit, at quem scilicet, ut fit, 1069 effugere haut potis est: ingratius haeret et odit 1070 propterea, morbi quia causam non tenet aeger; 1071 quam bene si videat, iam rebus quisque relictis 1072 naturam primum studeat cognoscere rerum,	If men, in that same way as on the mind They feel the load that wearies with its weight, Could also know the causes whence it comes, And why so great the heap of ill on heart, O not in this sort would they live their life, As now so much we see them, knowing not What 'tis they want, and seeking ever and ever A change of place, as if to drop the burden. The man who sickens of his home goes out, Forth from his splendid halls, and straight- returns, Feeling i'faith no better off abroad. He races, driving his Gallic ponies along, Down to his villa, madly,- as in haste To hurry help to a house afire.- At once He yawns, as soon as foot has touched the threshold, Or drowsily goes off in sleep and seeks Forgetfulness, or maybe bustles about And makes for town again. In such a way Each human flees himself- a self in sooth, As happens, he by no means can escape; And willy-nilly he cleaves to it and loathes, Sick, sick, and guessing not the cause of ail. Yet should he see but that, O chiefly then, Leaving all else, he'd study to divine The nature of things, since here is in debate Eternal time and not the single hour, Mortal's estate in whatsoever remains After great death. And too, when all is said, What evil lust of life is this so great Subdues us to live, so dreadfully distraught In perils and alarms? one fixed end Of life abideth for mortality; Death's not to shun, and we must go to meet. Besides we're busied with the same devices, Ever and ever, and we are at them ever, And there's no new delight that may be forged By living on. But whilst the thing we long for Is lacking, that seems good above all else; Thereafter, when we've touched it, something else We long for; ever one equal thirst of life Grips us agape. And doubtful 'tis what fortune The future times may carry, or what be That chance may bring, or what the

	1073 temporis aeterni quoniam, non unius horae, 1074 ambigitur status, in quo sit mortalibus omnis 1075 aetas, post mortem quae restat cumque manendo. 1076 Denique tanto opere in dubiis trepidare periclis 1077 quae mala nos subigit vitai tanta cupido? 1078 certe equidem finis vitae mortalibus adstat	issue next Awaiting us. Nor by prolonging life Take we the least away from death's own time, Nor can we pluck one moment off, whereby To minish the aeons of our state of death. Therefore, O man, by living on, fulfil As many generations as thou may: Eternal death shall there be waiting still; And he who died with light of yesterday Shall be no briefer time in death's No-more Than he who perished months or years before.
3.1079	1079 nec devitari letum pote, quin obeamus. 1080 praeterea versamur ibidem atque insumus usque 1081 nec nova vivendo procuditur ulla voluptas; 1082 sed dum abest quod avemus, id exsuperare videtur 1083 cetera; post aliud, cum contigit illud, avemus 1084 et sitis aequa tenet vitai semper hiantis. 1085 posteraque in dubiost fortunam quam vehat aetas, 1086 quidve ferat nobis casus quive exitus instet. 1087 nec prorsum vitam ducendo demimus hilum 1088 tempore de mortis nec delibare valemus, 1089 quo minus esse diu possimus forte perempti. 1090 proinde licet quod vis vivendo condere saecla, 1091 mors aeterna tamen nihilo minus illa manebit, 1092 nec minus ille diu iam non erit, ex hodierno 1093 lumine qui finem vitai fecit, et ille, 1094 mensibus atque annis qui multis occidit ante.	
4.1	1 Avia Pieridum peragro loca nullius ante 2 trita solo. iuvat integros accedere fontis 3 atque haurire, iuvatque novos decerpere flores 4 insignemque meo capiti petere inde coronam, 5 unde prius nulli velarint tempora musae; 6 primum quod magnis doceo de rebus et artis 7 religionum animum nodis exsolvere pergo,	I wander afield, thriving in sturdy thought, Through unpathed haunts of the Pierides, Trodden by step of none before. I joy To come on undefiled fountains there, To drain them deep; I joy to pluck new flowers, To seek for this my head a signal crown From regions where the Muses never yet Have garlanded the temples of a man: First, since I teach concerning mighty things, And go right on to loose from round the mind The tightened coils of dread religion; Next, since, concerning themes so dark, I frame Song so

	8 deinde quod obscura de re tam lucida pango 9 carmina musaeo contingens cuncta lepore. 10 id quoque enim non ab nulla ratione videtur; 11 nam vel uti pueris absinthia taetra medentes 12 cum dare conantur, prius oras pocula circum 13 contingunt mellis dulci flavoque liquore, 14 ut puerorum aetas inprovida ludificetur 15 labrorum tenus, interea perpotet amarum 16 absinthi laticem deceptaque non capiatur, 17 sed potius tali facto recreata valescat, 18 sic ego nunc, quoniam haec ratio plerumque videtur 19 tristior esse quibus non est tractata, retroque 20 volgus abhorret ab hac, volui tibi suaviloquenti 21 carmine Pierio rationem exponere nostram 22 et quasi musaeo dulci contingere melle; 23 si tibi forte animum tali ratione tenere 24 versibus in nostris possem, dum percipis omnem 25 naturam rerum ac persentis utilitatem. 26 Sed quoniam docui cunctarum exordia rerum 27 qualia sint et quam variis distantia formis 28 sponte sua volitent aeterno percita motu 29 quoque modo possit res ex his quaeque creari, 30	pellucid, touching all throughout Even with the Muses' charm- which, as 'twould seem, Is not without a reasonable ground: For as physicians, when they seek to give Young boys the nauseous wormwood, first do touch The brim around the cup with the sweet juice And yellow of the honey, in order that The thoughtless age of boyhood be cajoled As far as the lips, and meanwhile swallow down The wormwood's bitter draught, and, though befooled, Be yet not merely duped, but rather thus Grow strong again with recreated health: So now I too (since this my doctrine seems In general somewhat woeful unto those Who've had it not in hand, and since the crowd Starts back from it in horror) have desired To expound our doctrine unto thee in song Soft-speaking and Pierian, and, as 'twere, To touch it with sweet honey of the Muse- If by such method haply I might hold The mind of thee upon these lines of ours, Till thou dost learn the nature of all things And understandest their utility.
4.31	31 32 33 atque animi quoniam docui natura quid esset 34 et quibus e rebus cum corpore compta vigeret 35 quove modo distracta rediret in ordia prima, 36 nunc agere incipiam tibi, quod vehementer ad has res 37 attinet esse ea quae rerum simulacra vocamus, 38 quod speciem ac formam similem	Stretched overhead in mighty theatres, Upon their poles and cross-beams fluttering, Have such an action quite; for there they dye And make to undulate with their every hue The circled throng below, and all the stage, And rich attire in the patrician seats. And ever the more the theatre's dark walls Around them shut, the more all things within Laugh in the bright suffusion of strange glints, The daylight being withdrawn. And therefore, since The canvas hangings thus discharge

	gerit eius imago, 39 cuius cumque cluet de corpore fusa vagari; 40 quae quasi membranae summo de corpore rerum 41 dereptae volitant ultroque citroque per auras, 42 atque eadem nobis vigilantibus obvia mentes 43 terrificant atque in somnis, cum saepe figuras 44 contuimur miras simulacraque luce carentum, 45 quae nos horrifice languentis saepe sopore 46 excierunt ne forte animas Acherunte reamur 47 effugere aut umbras inter vivos volitare 48 neve aliquid nostri post mortem posse relinqui, 49 cum corpus simul atque animi natura perempta 50 in sua discessum dederint primordia quaeque. 51 dico igitur rerum effigias tenuisque figuras 52 mittier ab rebus summo de cortice eorum; 53 id licet hinc quamvis hebeti cognoscere corde. 54 Principio quoniam mittunt in rebus apertis 55 corpora res multae, partim diffusa solute, 56 robora ceu fumum mittunt ignesque vaporem, 57 et partim contexta magis condensaque, ut olim 58 cum teretis ponunt tunicas aestate cicadae, 59 et vituli cum membranas de corpore summo 60 nascentes mittunt, et item cum lubrica serpens	their dye From off their surface, things in general must Likewise their tenuous effigies discharge, Because in either case they are off-thrown From off the surface. So there are indeed Such certain prints and vestiges of forms Which flit around, of subtlest texture made, Invisible, when separate, each and one. With mightily swift order all goes on, So that upon one instant we may see What kind the object and how far away. Nor over-marvellous must this be deemed In these affairs that, though the films which strike Upon the eyes cannot be singly seen, The things themselves may be perceived. For thus When the wind beats upon us stroke by stroke And when the sharp cold streams, 'tis not our wont To feel each private particle of wind Or of that cold, but rather all at once; And so we see how blows affect our body, As if one thing were beating on the same And giving us the feel of its own body Outside of us. Again, whene'er we thump With finger-tip upon a stone, we touch But the rock's surface and the outer hue, Nor feel that hue by contact- rather feel The very hardness deep within the rock. Straightway no images can be returned. Further, our eye-balls tend to flee the bright And shun to gaze thereon; the sun even blinds, If thou goest on to strain them unto him, Because his strength is mighty, and the films Heavily downward from on high are borne Through the pure ether and the viewless winds, And strike the eyes, disordering their joints. So piecing lustre often burns the eyes, Because it holdeth many seeds of fire Which, working into eyes, engender pain. Again, whatever jaundiced people view Becomes wan-yellow, since from out their bodies Flow many seeds wan-yellow forth to meet The films of things, and many too are mixed Within their eye, which by contagion paint All things with sallowness. The angles of the tower each and all Have quite escaped the sense, the stones appear As rubbed and rounded on a turner's wheel- Yet not like objects near and truly round, But with a semblance to them, shadowily. Likewise, our shadow in the sun appears To move along and follow our own steps And imitate our carriage- if thou thinkest Air that is thus bereft of

		light can walk, Following the gait and motion of mankind. For what we use to name a shadow, sure Is naught but air deprived of light. No marvel: Because the earth from spot to spot is reft Progressively of light of sun, whenever In moving round we get within its way, While any spot of earth by us abandoned Is filled with light again, on this account It comes to pass that what was body's shadow Seems still the same to follow after us In one straight course. Since, evermore pour in New lights of rays, and perish then the old, Just like the wool that's drawn into the flame. Therefore the earth is easily spoiled of light And easily refilled and from herself Washeth the black shadows quite away.
4.61	61 exuit in spinis vestem; nam saepe videmus 62 illorum spoliis vepres volitantibus auctas. 63 quae quoniam fiunt, tenuis quoque debet imago 64 ab rebus mitti summo de corpore rerum. 65 nam cur illa cadant magis ab rebusque recedant 66 quam quae tenvia sunt, hiscendist nulla potestas; 67 praesertim cum sint in summis corpora rebus 68 multa minuta, iaci quae possint ordine eodem 69 quo fuerint et formai servare figuram, 70 et multo citius, quanto minus indupediri 71 pauca queunt et sunt prima fronte locata. 72 nam certe iacere ac largiri multa videmus, 73 non solum ex alto penitusque, ut diximus ante, 74 verum de summis ipsum quoque saepe colorem. 75 et volgo faciunt id lutea russaque vela 76 et ferrugina, cum magnis intenta theatris 77 per malos volgata trabesque trementia flutant; 78 namque ibi consessum caveai supter et omnem 79 scaenai speciem patrum matrumque deorsum 80 inficiunt coguntque suo fluitare	Again, all odour, smoke, and heat, and such Streams out of things diffusedly, because, Whilst coming from the deeps of body forth And rising out, along their bending path They're torn asunder, nor have gateways straight Wherethrough to mass themselves and struggle abroad. But contrariwise, when such a tenuous film Of outside colour is thrown off, there's naught Can rend it, since 'tis placed along the front Ready to hand. Lastly those images Which to our eyes in mirrors do appear, In water, or in any shining surface, Must be, since furnished with like look of things, Fashioned from images of things sent out. There are, then, tenuous effigies of forms, Like unto them, which no one can divine When taken singly, which do yet give back, When by continued and recurrent discharge Expelled, a picture from the mirrors' plane. Nor otherwise, it seems, can they be kept So well conserved that thus be given back Figures so like each object. And, contrariwise, with those to whom that sweet Is sour within the mouth, beyond a doubt The rough and barbed particles have got Into the narrows of the apertures. Now easy it is from these affairs to know Whatever... . . . . . Indeed, where one from o'er-abundant bile Is stricken with fever, or in other wise Feels the roused violence of some malady, There the whole frame is now upset, and there All the positions of the seeds are changed,- So that the bodies which before were fit To cause the savour, now are fit no more, And now

	colore. 81 et quanto circum mage sunt inclusa theatri 82 moenia, tam magis haec intus perfusa lepore 83 omnia conrident correpta luce diei. 84 ergo lintea de summo cum corpore fucum 85 mittunt, effigias quoque debent mittere tenvis 86 res quaeque, ex summo quoniam iaculantur utraque. 87 sunt igitur iam formarum vestigia certa, 88 quae volgo volitant subtili praedita filo 89 nec singillatim possunt secreta videri. 90 Praeterea omnis odor fumus vapor atque aliae res	more apt are others which be able To get within the pores and gender sour. Both sorts, in sooth, are intermixed in honey- What oft we've proved above to thee before. Of larger primal germs than voice, because It enters not through stony walls, wherethrough Unfailingly the voice and sound are borne; Wherefore, besides, thou wilt observe 'tis not So easy to trace out in whatso place The smelling object is. For, dallying on Along the winds, the particles cool off, And then the scurrying messengers of things Arrive our senses, when no longer hot. So dogs oft wander astray, and hunt the scent. Whom the mind feigns to see alive, long since Hath been the gain of death and dissolution. And further, 'tis no marvel idols move And toss their arms and other members round In rhythmic time- and often in men's sleeps It haps an image this is seen to do; In sooth, when perishes the former image, And other is gendered of another pose, That former seemeth to have changed its gestures. Of course the change must be conceived as speedy; So great the swiftness and so great the store Of idol-things, and (in an instant brief As mind can mark) so great, again, the store Of separate idol-parts to bring supplies. It happens also that there is supplied Sometimes an image not of kind the same; But what before was woman, now at hand Is seen to stand there, altered into male; Or other visage, other age succeeds; But slumber and oblivion take care That we shall feel no wonder at the thing.
4.91	91 consimiles ideo diffusae rebus abundant, 92 ex alto quia dum veniunt extrinsecus ortae 93 scinduntur per iter flexum, nec recta viarum 94 ostia sunt, qua contendant exire coortae. 95 at contra tenuis summi membrana coloris 96 cum iacitur, nihil est quod eam discerpere possit, 97 in promptu quoniam est in prima fronte locata. 98 Postremo speculis in aqua splendoreque in omni 99 quae cumque apparent nobis simulacra, necessest,	Now then, learn How tenuous is the nature of an image. And in the first place, since primordials be So far beneath our senses, and much less E'en than those objects which begin to grow Too small for eyes to note, learn now in few How nice are the beginnings of all things- That this, too, I may yet confirm in proof: First, living creatures are sometimes so small That even their third part can nowise be seen; Judge, then, the size of any inward organ- What of their sphered heart, their eyes, their limbs, The skeleton?- How tiny thus they are! And what besides of those first particles Whence soul and mind must fashioned be?- Seest not How nice and how minute? Besides,

	100 quandoquidem simili specie sunt praedita rerum, 101 exin imaginibus missis consistere eorum. 102 103 104 sunt igitur tenues formarum illis similesque 105 effigiae, singillatim quas cernere nemo 106 cum possit, tamen adsiduo crebroque repulsu 107 reiectae reddunt speculorum ex aequore visum, 108 nec ratione alia servari posse videntur, 109 tanto opere ut similes reddantur cuique figurae. 110 Nunc age, quam tenui natura constet imago 111 percipe. et in primis, quoniam primordia tantum 112 sunt infra nostros sensus tantoque minora 113 quam quae primum oculi coeptant non posse tueri, 114 nunc tamen id quoque uti confirmem, exordia rerum 115 cunctarum quam sint subtilia percipe paucis. 116 primum animalia sunt iam partim tantula, corum 117 tertia pars nulla possit ratione videri. 118 horum intestinum quodvis quale esse putandumst! 119 quid cordis globus aut oculi? quid membra? quid artus? 120 quantula sunt! quid praeterea primordia quaeque,	whatever Exhales from out its body a sharp smell- The nauseous absinth, or the panacea, Strong southernwood, or bitter centaury- If never so lightly with thy [fingers] twain Perchance [thou touch] a one of them . . . . . Then why not rather know that images Flit hither and thither, many, in many modes, Bodiless and invisible? But lest Haply thou holdest that those images Which come from objects are the sole that flit, Others indeed there be of own accord Begot, self-formed in earth's aery skies, Which, moulded to innumerable shapes, Are borne aloft, and, fluid as they are, Cease not to change appearance and to turn Into new outlines of all sorts of forms; As we behold the clouds grow thick on high And smirch the serene vision of the world, Stroking the air with motions. For oft are seen The giants' faces flying far along And trailing a spread of shadow; and at times The mighty mountains and mountain-sundered rocks Going before and crossing on the sun, Whereafter a monstrous beast dragging amain And leading in the other thunderheads. They pour the billows of a potent stream And stain their garment.
4.121	121 unde anima atque animi constet natura necessumst, 122 nonne vides quam sint subtilia quamque minuta? 123 praeterea quaecumque suo de corpore odorem 124 expirant acrem, panaces absinthia taetra 125 habrotonique graves et tristia centaurea, 126 quorum unum quidvis leviter si forte duobus 127 quin potius noscas rerum simulacra vagari 128 multa modis multis, nulla vi cassaque sensu? 129 Sed ne forte putes ea demum sola	Now [hear] how easy and how swift they be Engendered, and perpetually flow off From things and gliding pass away.... . . . . For ever every outside streams away From off all objects, since discharge they may; And when this outside reaches other things, As chiefly glass, it passes through; but where It reaches the rough rocks or stuff of wood, There 'tis so rent that it cannot give back An image. But when gleaming objects dense, As chiefly mirrors, have been set before it, Nothing of this sort happens. For it can't Go, as through glass, nor yet be rent- its safety, By virtue of that smoothness, being sure. 'Tis therefore that from them the images Stream back

	vagari, 130 quae cumque ab rebus rerum simulacra recedunt, 131 sunt etiam quae sponte sua gignuntur et ipsa 132 constituuntur in hoc caelo, qui dicitur aer, 133 quae multis formata modis sublime feruntur, 134 ut nubes facile inter dum concrescere in alto 135 cernimus et mundi speciem violare serenam 136 aeraaëra mulcentes motu; nam saepe Gigantum 137 ora volare videntur et umbram ducere late, 138 inter dum magni montes avolsaque saxa 139 montibus ante ire et solem succedere praeter, 140 inde alios trahere atque inducere belua nimbos. 141 nec speciem mutare suam liquentia cessant 142 et cuiusque modi formarum vertere in oras. 143 Nunc ea quam facili et celeri ratione genantur 144 perpetuoque fluant ab rebus lapsaque cedant 145 semper enim summum quicquid de rebus abundat, 146 quod iaculentur. et hoc alias cum pervenit in res, 147 transit, ut in primis vestem; sed ubi aspera saxa 148 aut in materiam ligni pervenit, ibi iam	to us; and howso suddenly Thou place, at any instant, anything Before a mirror, there an image shows; Proving that ever from a body's surface Flow off thin textures and thin shapes of things. Thus many images in little time Are gendered; so their origin is named Rightly a speedy. And even as the sun Must send below, in little time, to earth So many beams to keep all things so full Of light incessant; thus, on grounds the same, From things there must be borne, in many modes, To every quarter round, upon the moment, The many images of things; because Unto whatever face of things we turn The mirror, things of form and hue the same Respond. Besides, though but a moment since Serenest was the weather of the sky, So fiercely sudden is it foully thick That ye might think that round about all murk Had parted forth from Acheron and filled The mighty vaults of sky- so grievously, As gathers thus the storm-clouds' gruesome night, Do faces of black horror hang on high- Of which how small a part an image is There's none to tell or reckon out in words.
4.149	149 scinditur, ut nullum simulacrum reddere possit. 150 at cum splendida quae constant opposta fuerunt 151 densaque, ut in primis speculum est, nihil accidit horum; 152 nam neque, uti vestem, possunt transire, neque autem 153 scindi; quam meminit levor praestare salutem. 154 qua propter fit ut hinc nobis simulacra redundent. 155 et quamvis subito quovis in tempore quamque 156 rem contra speculum ponas, apparet imago; 157 perpetuo fluere ut noscas e corpore summo	Now come; with what swift motion they are borne, These images, and what the speed assigned To them across the breezes swimming on- So that o'er lengths of space a little hour Alone is wasted, toward whatever region Each with its divers impulse tends- I'll tell In verses sweeter than they many are; Even as the swan's slight note is better far Than that dispersed clamour of the cranes Among the southwind's aery clouds. And first, One oft may see that objects which are light And made of tiny bodies are the swift; In which class is the sun's light and his heat, Since made from small primordial elements Which, as it were, are forward knocked along And through the interspaces of

	158 texturas rerum tenuis tenuisque figuras. 159 ergo multa brevi spatio simulacra genuntur, 160 ut merito celer his rebus dicatur origo. 161 et quasi multa brevi spatio summittere debet 162 lumina sol, ut perpetuo sint omnia plena, 163 sic ab rebus item simili ratione necessest 164 temporis in puncto rerum simulacra ferantur 165 multa modis multis in cunctas undique partis; 166 quandoquidem speculum quo cumque obvertimus oris, 167 res ibi respondent simili forma atque colore. 168 Praeterea modo cum fuerit liquidissima caeli 169 tempestas, perquam subito fit turbida foede, 170 undique uti tenebras omnis Acherunta rearis 171 liquisse et magnas caeli complesse cavernas. 172 usque adeo taetra nimborum nocte coorta 173 inpendent atrae Formidinis ora superne; 174 quorum quantula pars sit imago dicere nemost 175 qui possit neque eam rationem reddere dictis. 176 Nunc age, quam celeri motu simulacra ferantur, 177 et quae mobilitas ollis tranantibus auras 178 reddita sit, longo spatio ut brevis hora teratur,	the air To pass delay not, urged by blows behind; For light by light is instantly supplied And gleam by following gleam is spurred and driven. Thus likewise must the images have power Through unimaginable space to speed Within a point of time,- first, since a cause Exceeding small there is, which at their back Far forward drives them and propels, where, too, They're carried with such winged lightness on; And, secondly, since furnished, when sent off, With texture of such rareness that they can Through objects whatsoever penetrate And ooze, as 'twere, through intervening air.
4.179	179 in quem quaeque locum diverso numine tendunt, 180 suavidicis potius quam multis versibus edam; 181 parvus ut est cycni melior canor, ille gruum quam 182 clamor in aetheriis dispersus nubibus austri. 183 Principio persaepe levis res atque minutis 184 corporibus factas celeris licet esse videre. 185 in quo iam genere est solis lux et vapor eius, 186 propterea quia sunt e primis facta minutis,	Besides, if those fine particles of things Which from so deep within are sent abroad, As light and heat of sun, are seen to glide And spread themselves through all the space of heaven Upon one instant of the day, and fly O'er sea and lands and flood the heaven, what then Of those which on the outside stand prepared, When they're hurled off with not a thing to check Their going out? Dost thou not see indeed How swifter and how farther must they go And speed through manifold the length of space In time the same that from the sun the rays O'erspread the heaven? This also seems to be Example

	187 quae quasi cuduntur perque aerisaëris intervallum 188 non dubitant transire sequenti concita plaga; 189 suppeditatur enim confestim lumine lumen 190 et quasi protelo stimulatur fulgere fulgur. 191 qua propter simulacra pari ratione necessest 192 inmemorabile per spatium transcurrere posse 193 temporis in puncto, primum quod parvola causa 194 est procul a tergo quae provehat atque propellat, 195 quod super est, ubi tam volucri levitate ferantur, 196 deinde quod usque adeo textura praedita rara 197 mittuntur, facile ut quasvis penetrare queant res 198 et quasi permanare per aerisaëris intervallum. 199 Praeterea si quae penitus corpuscula rerum 200 ex altoque foras mittuntur, solis uti lux 201 ac vapor, haec puncto cernuntur lapsa diei 202 per totum caeli spatium diffundere sese 203 perque volare mare ac terras caelumque rigare. 204 quid quae sunt igitur iam prima fronte parata, 205 cum iaciuntur et emissum res nulla moratur? 206 quone vides citius debere et longius ire 207 multiplexque loci spatium transcurrere eodem 208 tempore quo solis pervolgant lumina caelum?	chief and true with what swift speed The images of things are borne about: That soon as ever under open skies Is spread the shining water, all at once, If stars be out in heaven, upgleam from earth, Serene and radiant in the water there, The constellations of the universe- Now seest thou not in what a point of time An image from the shores of ether falls Unto the shores of earth? Wherefore, again, And yet again, 'tis needful to confess With wondrous... . . . . .
4.209	209 Hoc etiam in primis specimen verum esse videtur, 210 quam celeri motu rerum simulacra ferantur, 211 quod simul ac primum sub diu splendor aquai 212 ponitur, extemplo caelo stellante serena 213 sidera respondent in aqua radiantia mundi. 214 iamne vides igitur quam puncto tempore imago 215 aetheris ex oris in terrarum accidat oras?	

	216 quare etiam atque etiam mitti fateare necessest 217 corpora quae feriant oculos visumque lacessant. 218 perpetuoque fluunt certis ab rebus odores, 219 frigus ut a fluviis, calor ab sole, aestus ab undis 220 aequoris, exesor moerorum litora circum, 221 nec variae cessant voces volitare per auras. 222 denique in os salsi venit umor saepe saporis, 223 cum mare versamur propter, dilutaque contra 224 cum tuimur misceri absinthia, tangit amaror. 225 usque adeo omnibus ab rebus res quaeque fluenter 226 fertur et in cunctas dimittitur undique partis 227 nec mora nec requies interdatur ulla fluendi, 228 perpetuo quoniam sentimus et omnia semper 229 cernere odorari licet et sentire sonare. 230 Praeterea quoniam manibus tractata figura 231 in tenebris quaedam cognoscitur esse eadem quae 232 cernitur in luce et claro candore, necessest 233 consimili causa tactum visumque moveri. 234 nunc igitur si quadratum temptamus et id nos 235 commovet in tenebris, in luci quae poterit res 236 accidere ad speciem quadrata, nisi eius imago? 237 esse in imaginibus qua propter causa videtur 238 cernundi neque posse sine his res ulla videri.	
4.239	239 Nunc ea quae dico rerum simulacra feruntur 240 undique et in cunctas iaciuntur didita partis; 241 verum nos oculis quia solis cernere quimus, 242 propterea fit uti, speciem quo vertimus, omnes 243 res ibi eam contra feriant forma atque colore. 244 et quantum quaeque ab nobis res absit, imago	But since I've taught already of what sort The seeds of all things are, and how distinct In divers forms they flit of own accord, Stirred with a motion everlasting on, And in what mode things be from them create, And since I've taught what the mind's nature is, And of what things 'tis with the body knit And thrives in strength, and by what mode uptorn That mind returns to its primordials, Now will I undertake an argument- One for these matters of

	245 efficit ut videamus et internoscere curat; 246 nam cum mittitur, extemplo protrudit agitque 247 aeraaëra qui inter se cumque est oculosque locatus, 248 isque ita per nostras acies perlabitur omnis 249 et quasi perterget pupillas atque ita transit. 250 propterea fit uti videamus quam procul absit 251 res quaeque. et quanto plus aerisaëris ante agitatur 252 et nostros oculos perterget longior aura, 253 tam procul esse magis res quaeque remota videtur. 254 scilicet haec summe celeri ratione geruntur, 255 quale sit ut videamus, et una quam procul absit. 256 Illud in his rebus minime mirabile habendumst, 257 cur, ea quae feriant oculos simulacra videri 258 singula cum nequeant, res ipsae perspiciantur. 259 ventus enim quoque paulatim cum verberat et cum 260 acre fluit frigus, non privam quamque solemus 261 particulam venti sentire et frigoris eius, 262 sed magis unorsum, fierique perinde videmus 263 corpore tum plagas in nostro tam quam aliquae res 264 verberet atque sui det sensum corporis extra. 265 praeterea lapidem digito cum tundimus, ipsum 266 tangimus extremum saxi summumque colorem 267 nec sentimus eum tactu, verum magis ipsam 268 duritiem penitus saxi sentimus in alto.	supreme concern- That there exist those somewhats which we call The images of things: these, like to films Scaled off the utmost outside of the things, Flit hither and thither through the atmosphere, And the same terrify our intellects, Coming upon us waking or in sleep, When oft we peer at wonderful strange shapes And images of people lorn of light, Which oft have horribly roused us when we lay In slumber- that haply nevermore may we Suppose that souls get loose from Acheron, Or shades go floating in among the living, Or aught of us is left behind at death, When body and mind, destroyed together, each Back to its own primordials goes away. And thus I say that effigies of things, And tenuous shapes from off the things are sent, From off the utmost outside of the things, Which are like films or may be named a rind, Because the image bears like look and form With whatso body has shed it fluttering forth- A fact thou mayst, however dull thy wits, Well learn from this: mainly, because we see Even 'mongst visible objects many be That send forth bodies, loosely some diffused- Like smoke from oaken logs and heat from fires- And some more interwoven and condensed- As when the locusts in the summertime Put off their glossy tunics, or when calves At birth drop membranes from their body's surface, Or when, again, the slippery serpent doffs Its vestments 'mongst the thorns- for oft we see The breres augmented with their flying spoils: Since such takes place, 'tis likewise certain too That tenuous images from things are sent, From off the utmost outside of the things. For why those kinds should drop and part from things, Rather than others tenuous and thin, No power has man to open mouth to tell; Especially, since on outsides of things Are bodies many and minute which could, In the same order which they had before, And with the figure of their form preserved, Be thrown abroad, and much more swiftly too, Being less subject to impediments, As few in number and placed along the front. For truly many things we see discharge Their stuff at large, not only from their cores Deep-set within, as we have said above, But from their

		surfaces at times no less- Their very colours too. And commonly The awnings, saffron, red and dusky blue,
4.269	269 Nunc age, cur ultra speculum videatur imago 270 percipe: nam certe penitus remmota videtur. 271 quod genus illa foris quae vere transpiciuntur, 272 ianua cum per se transpectum praebet apertum, 273 multa facitque foris ex aedibus ut videantur; 274 is quoque enim duplici geminoque fit aereaëre visus. 275 primus enim citra postes tum cernitur aeraër, 276 inde fores ipsae dextra laevaque secuntur, 277 post extraria lux oculos perterget et aeraër 278 alter, et illa foris quae vere transpiciuntur. 279 sic ubi se primum speculi proiecit imago, 280 dum venit ad nostras acies, protrudit agitque 281 aeraaëra qui inter se cumquest oculosque locatus, 282 et facit, ut prius hunc omnem sentire queamus 283 quam speculum; sed ubi speculum quoque sensimus ipsum, 284 continuo a nobis in eum quae fertur imago 285 pervenit, et nostros oculos reiecta revisit 286 atque alium prae se propellens aeraaëra volvit, 287 et facit ut prius hunc quam se videamus, eoque 288 distare ab speculo tantum semota videtur. 289 quare etiam atque etiam minime mirarier est par 290 illis quae reddunt speculorum ex aequore visum, 291 aeribusaëribus binis quoniam res confit utraque. 292 Nunc ea quae nobis membrorum dextera pars est, 293 in speculis fit ut in laeva videatur eo quod 294 planitiem ad speculi veniens cum offendit imago, 295 non convertitur incolumis, sed recta retrorsum	Now come, and why beyond a looking-glass An image may be seen, perceive. For seen It soothly is, removed far within. 'Tis the same sort as objects peered upon Outside in their true shape, whene'er a door Yields through itself an open peering-place, And lets us see so many things outside Beyond the house. Also that sight is made By a twofold twin air: for first is seen The air inside the door-posts; next the doors, The twain to left and right; and afterwards A light beyond comes brushing through our eyes, Then other air, then objects peered upon Outside in their true shape. And thus, when first The image of the glass projects itself, As to our gaze it comes, it shoves ahead And drives along the air that's in the space Betwixt it and our eyes, and brings to pass That we perceive the air ere yet the glass. But when we've also seen the glass itself, Forthwith that image which from us is borne Reaches the glass, and there thrown back again Comes back unto our eyes, and driving rolls Ahead of itself another air, that then 'Tis this we see before itself, and thus It looks so far removed behind the glass. Wherefore again, again, there's naught for wonder . . . . . In those which render from the mirror's plane A vision back, since each thing comes to pass By means of the two airs. Now, in the glass The right part of our members is observed Upon the left, because, when comes the image Hitting against the level of the glass, 'Tis not returned unshifted; but forced off Backwards in line direct and not oblique,- Exactly as whoso his plaster-mask Should dash, before 'twere dry, on post or beam, And it should straightway keep, at clinging there, Its shape, reversed, facing him who threw, And so remould the features it gives back: It comes that now the right eye is the left, The left the right.

	296 sic eliditur, ut siquis, prius arida quam sit 297 cretea persona, adlidat pilaeve trabive,	
4.298	298 atque ea continuo rectam si fronte figuram 299 servet et elisam retro sese exprimat ipsa. 300 fiet ut, ante oculus fuerit qui dexter, ut idem 301 nunc sit laevus et e laevo sit mutua dexter. 302 Fit quoque de speculo in speculum ut tradatur imago, 303 quinque etiam sex ut fieri simulacra suerintsuërint. 304 nam quae cumque retro parte interiore latebunt, 305 inde tamen, quamvis torte penitusque remota, 306 omnia per flexos aditus educta licebit 307 pluribus haec speculis videantur in aedibus esse. 308 usque adeo speculo in speculum translucet imago, 309 et cum laeva data est, fit rusum ut dextera fiat, 310 inde retro rursum redit et convertit eodem. 311 Quin etiam quae cumque latuscula sunt speculorum 312 adsimili lateris flexura praedita nostri, 313 dextera ea propter nobis simulacra remittunt, 314 aut quia de speculo in speculum transfertur imago, 315 inde ad nos elisa bis advolat, aut etiam quod 316 circum agitur, cum venit, imago propterea quod 317 flexa figura docet speculi convertier ad nos. 318 Indugredi porro pariter simulacra pedemque 319 ponere nobiscum credas gestumque imitari 320 propterea quia, de speculi qua parte recedas, 321 continuo nequeunt illinc simulacra reverti; 322 omnia quandoquidem cogit natura referri 323 ac resilire ab rebus ad aequos reddita flexus. 324 Splendida porro oculi fugitant vitantque tueri.	

	325 sol etiam caecat, contra si tendere pergas, 326 propterea quia vis magnast ipsius et alte 327 aeraaëra per purum simulacra feruntur	
4.328	328 et feriunt oculos turbantia composituras. 329 Praeterea splendor qui cumque est acer adurit 330 saepe oculos ideo quod semina possidet ignis 331 multa, dolorem oculis quae gignunt insinuando. 332 lurida praeterea fiunt quae cumque tuentur 333 arquati, quia luroris de corpore eorum 334 semina multa fluunt simulacris obvia rerum, 335 multaque sunt oculis in eorum denique mixta, 336 quae contage sua palloribus omnia pingunt. 337 E tenebris autem quae sunt in luce tuemur 338 propterea quia, cum propior caliginis aeraër 339 ater init oculos prior et possedit apertos, 340 insequitur candens confestim lucidus aeraër, 341 qui quasi purgat eos ac nigras discutit umbras 342 aerisaëris illius; nam multis partibus hic est 343 mobilior multisque minutior et mage pollens. 344 qui simul atque vias oculorum luce replevit 345 atque pate fecit, quas ante obsederat aeraër 346 ATER, continuo rerum simulacra secuntur, 347 quae sita sunt in luce, lacessuntque ut videamus. 348 quod contra facere in tenebris e luce nequimus 349 propterea quia posterior caliginis aeraër 350 crassior insequitur, qui cuncta foramina complet 351 obsiditque vias oculorum, ne simulacra 352 possint ullarum rerum coniecta moveri. 353 Quadratasque procul turris cum cernimus urbis,	

	354 propterea fit uti videantur saepe rutundae, 355 angulus optusus quia longe cernitur omnis 356 sive etiam potius non cernitur ac perit eius 357 plaga nec ad nostras acies perlabitur ictus,	
4.358	358 aeraaëra per multum quia dum simulacra feruntur, 359 cogit hebescere eum crebris offensibus aeraër. 360 hoc ubi suffugit sensum simul angulus omnis. 361 fit quasi ut ad turnum saxorum structa tuantur; 362 non tamen ut coram quae sunt vereque rutunda, 363 sed quasi adumbratim paulum simulata videntur. 364 Umbra videtur item nobis in sole moveri 365 et vestigia nostra sequi gestumque imitari, 366 aeraaëra si credis privatum lumine posse 367 indugredi, motus hominum gestumque sequentem; 368 nam nihil esse potest aliud nisi lumine cassus 369 aeraër id quod nos umbram perhibere suemussuëmus. 370 ni mirum, quia terra locis ex ordine certis 371 lumine privatur solis qua cumque meantes 372 officimus, repletur item quod liquimus eius, 373 propterea fit uti videatur, quae fuit umbra 374 corporis, e regione eadem nos usque secuta. 375 semper enim nova se radiorum lumina fundunt 376 primaque dispereunt, quasi in ignem lana trahatur. 377 propterea facile et spoliatur lumine terra 378 et repletur item nigrasque sibi abluit umbras. 379 Nec tamen hic oculos falli concedimus hilum. 380 nam quo cumque loco sit lux atque umbra tueri 381 illorum est; eadem vero sint lumina necne, 382 umbraque quae fuit hic eadem nunc transeat illuc,	

	383 an potius fiat paulo quod diximus ante, 384 hoc animi demum ratio discernere debet, 385 nec possunt oculi naturam noscere rerum. 386 proinde animi vitium hoc oculis adfingere noli. 387 Qua vehimur navi, fertur, cum stare videtur;	
4.388	388 quae manet in statione, ea praeter creditur ire. 389 et fugere ad puppim colles campique videntur, 390 quos agimus praeter navem velisque volamus. 391 Sidera cessare aetheriis adfixa cavernis 392 cuncta videntur, et adsiduo sunt omnia motu, 393 quandoquidem longos obitus exorta revisunt, 394 cum permensa suo sunt caelum corpore claro. 395 solque pari ratione manere et luna videtur 396 in statione, ea quae ferri res indicat ipsa. 397 Exstantisque procul medio de gurgite montis 398 classibus inter quos liber patet exitus ingens, 399 insula coniunctis tamen ex his una videtur. 400 atria versari et circum cursare columnae 401 usque adeo fit uti pueris videantur, ubi ipsi 402 desierunt verti, vix ut iam credere possint 403 non supra sese ruere omnia tecta minari. 404 Iamque rubrum tremulis iubar ignibus erigere alte 405 cum coeptat natura supraque extollere montes, 406 quos tibi tum supra sol montis esse videtur 407 comminus ipse suo contingens fervidus igni, 408 vix absunt nobis missus bis mille sagittae, 409 vix etiam cursus quingentos saepe veruti; 410 inter eos solemque iacent immania ponti 411 aequora substrata aetheriis ingentibus oris,	A pool of water of but a finger's depth, Which lies between the stones along the pave, Offers a vision downward into earth As far, as from the earth o'erspread on high The gulfs of heaven; that thus thou seemest to view Clouds down below and heavenly bodies plunged Wondrously in heaven under earth. Then too, when in the middle of the stream Sticks fast our dashing horse, and down we gaze Into the river's rapid waves, some force Seems then to bear the body of the horse, Though standing still, reversely from his course, And swiftly push up-stream. And wheresoe'er We cast our eyes across, all objects seem Thus to be onward borne and flow along In the same way as we. A portico, Albeit it stands well propped from end to end On equal columns, parallel and big, Contracts by stages in a narrow cone, When from one end the long, long whole is seen,- Until, conjoining ceiling with the floor, And the whole right side with the left, it draws Together to a cone's nigh-viewless point. To sailors on the main the sun he seems From out the waves to rise, and in the waves To set and bury his light- because indeed They gaze on naught but water and the sky. Again, to gazers ignorant of the sea, Vessels in port seem, as with broken poops, To lean upon the water, quite agog; For any portion of the oars that's raised Above the briny spray is straight, and straight The rudders from above. But other parts, Those sunk, immersed below the water-line, Seem broken all and bended and inclined Sloping to upwards, and turned back to float Almost atop the water. And when the winds Carry the scattered drifts along the sky In the night-time, then seem to glide along The radiant constellations 'gainst the clouds And there on high to take far other course From that whereon in truth they're

	412 interiectaque sunt terrarum milia multa, 413 quae variae retinent gentes et saecla ferarum. 414 At coniectus aquae digitum non altior unum, 415 qui lapides inter sistit per strata viarum, 416 despectum praebet sub terras inpete tanto, 417 a terris quantum caeli patet altus hiatus,	borne. And then,
4.418	418 nubila despicere et caelum ut videare videre, 419 corpora mirande sub terras abdita caelo. 420 Denique ubi in medio nobis ecus acer obhaesit 421 flumine et in rapidas amnis despeximus undas, 422 stantis equi corpus transversum ferre videtur 423 vis et in adversum flumen contrudere raptim, 424 et quo cumque oculos traiecimus omnia ferri 425 et fluere adsimili nobis ratione videntur. 426 Porticus aequali quamvis est denique ductu 427 stansque in perpetuum paribus suffulta columnis, 428 longa tamen parte ab summa cum tota videtur, 429 paulatim trahit angusti fastigia coni, 430 tecta solo iungens atque omnia dextera laevis 431 donec in obscurum coni conduxit acumen. 432 In pelago nautis ex undis ortus in undis 433 sol fit uti videatur obire et condere lumen; 434 quippe ubi nil aliud nisi aquam caelumque tuentur; 435 ne leviter credas labefactari undique sensus. 436 at maris ignaris in portu clauda videntur 437 navigia aplustris fractis obnitier undis. 438 nam quae cumque supra rorem salis edita pars est 439 remorum, recta est, et recta superne guberna; 440 quae demersa liquore obeunt, refracta videntur	If haply our hand be set beneath one eye And press below thereon, then to our gaze Each object which we gaze on seems to be, By some sensation twain- then twain the lights Of lampions burgeoning in flowers of flame, And twain the furniture in all the house, Two-fold the visages of fellow-men, And twain their bodies. And again, when sleep Has bound our members down in slumber soft And all the body lies in deep repose, Yet then we seem to self to be awake And move our members; and in night's blind gloom We think to mark the daylight and the sun; And, shut within a room, yet still we seem To change our skies, our oceans, rivers, hills, To cross the plains afoot, and hear new sounds, Though still the austere silence of the night Abides around us, and to speak replies, Though voiceless. Other cases of the sort Wondrously many do we see, which all Seek, so to say, to injure faith in sense- In vain, because the largest part of these Deceives through mere opinions of the mind, Which we do add ourselves, feigning to see What by the senses are not seen at all. For naught is harder than to separate Plain facts from dubious, which the mind forthwith Adds by itself.

	441 omnia converti sursumque supina reverti 442 et reflexa prope in summo fluitare liquore. 443 Raraque per caelum cum venti nubila portant 444 tempore nocturno, tum splendida signa videntur 445 labier adversum nimbos atque ire superne 446 longe aliam in partem ac vera ratione feruntur 447 At si forte oculo manus uni subdita supter	
4.448	448 pressit eum, quodam sensu fit uti videantur 449 omnia quae tuimur fieri tum bina tuendo, 450 bina lucernarum florentia lumina flammis 451 binaque per totas aedis geminare supellex 452 et duplicis hominum facies et corpora bina. 453 Denique cum suavi devinxit membra sopore 454 somnus et in summa corpus iacet omne quiete, 455 tum vigilare tamen nobis et membra movere 456 nostra videmur, et in noctis caligine caeca 457 cernere censemus solem lumenque diurnum, 458 conclusoque loco caelum mare flumina montis 459 mutare et campos pedibus transire videmur, 460 et sonitus audire, severa silentia noctis 461 undique cum constent, et reddere dicta tacentes. 462 Cetera de genere hoc mirande multa videmus, 463 quae violare fidem quasi sensibus omnia quaerunt, 464 ne quiquam, quoniam pars horum maxima fallit 465 propter opinatus animi, quos addimus ipsi, 466 pro visis ut sint quae non sunt sensibus visa; 467 nam nihil aegrius est quam res secernere apertas 468 ab dubiis, animus quas ab se protinus addit. 469 Denique nil sciri siquis putat, id quoque nescit	Again, if one suppose That naught is known, he knows not whether this Itself is able to be known, since he Confesses naught to know. Therefore with him I waive discussion- who has set his head Even where his feet should be. But let me grant That this he knows,- I question: whence he knows What 'tis to know and not-to-know in turn, And what created concept of the truth, And what device has proved the dubious To differ from the certain?- since in things He's heretofore seen naught of true. Thou'lt find That from the senses first hath been create Concept of truth, nor can the senses be Rebutted. For criterion must be found Worthy of greater trust, which shall defeat Through own authority the false by true; What, then, than these our senses must there be Worthy a greater trust? Shall reason, sprung From some false sense, prevail to contradict Those senses, sprung as reason wholly is From out the senses?- For lest these be true, All reason also then is falsified. Or shall the ears have power to blame the eyes, Or yet the touch the ears? Again, shall taste Accuse this touch or shall the nose confute Or eyes defeat it? Methinks not so it is: For unto each has been divided off Its function quite apart, its power to each; And thus we're still constrained to perceive The soft, the cold, the hot apart, apart All divers hues and whatso things there be Conjoined with hues. Likewise the tasting tongue Has its own power apart, and smells apart And sounds apart are known. And thus it is That no one sense can e'er convict another. Nor shall one sense have power to blame itself, Because it always must be deemed the same, Worthy of equal

	470 an sciri possit, quoniam nil scire fatetur. 471 hunc igitur contra minuam contendere causam, 472 qui capite ipse suo in statuit vestigia sese. 473 et tamen hoc quoque uti concedam scire, at id ipsum 474 quaeram, cum in rebus veri nil viderit ante, 475 unde sciat quid sit scire et nescire vicissim, 476 notitiam veri quae res falsique crearit 477 et dubium certo quae res differre probarit.	trust. And therefore what At any time unto these senses showed, The same is true.
4.478	478 invenies primis ab sensibus esse creatam 479 notitiem veri neque sensus posse refelli. 480 nam maiore fide debet reperirier illud, 481 sponte sua veris quod possit vincere falsa. 482 quid maiore fide porro quam sensus haberi 483 debet? an ab sensu falso ratio orta valebit 484 dicere eos contra, quae tota ab sensibus orta est? 485 qui nisi sunt veri, ratio quoque falsa fit omnis. 486 An poterunt oculos aures reprehendere, an aures 487 tactus? an hunc porro tactum sapor arguet oris, 488 an confutabunt nares oculive revincent? 489 non, ut opinor, ita est. nam seorsum cuique potestas 490 divisast, sua vis cuiquest, ideoque necesse est 491 et quod molle sit et gelidum fervensve videre 492 et seorsum varios rerum sentire colores 493 et quae cumque coloribus sint coniuncta necessest. 494 seorsus item sapor oris habet vim, seorsus odores 495 nascuntur, seorsum sonitus. ideoque necesse est 496 non possint alios alii convincere sensus. 497 nec porro poterunt ipsi reprehendere sese, 498 aequa fides quoniam debebit semper haberi.	And if the reason be Unable to unravel us the cause Why objects, which at hand were square, afar Seemed rounded, yet it more availeth us, Lacking the reason, to pretend a cause For each configuration, than to let From out our hands escape the obvious things And injure primal faith in sense, and wreck All those foundations upon which do rest Our life and safety. For not only reason Would topple down; but even our very life Would straightaway collapse, unless we dared To trust our senses and to keep away From headlong heights and places to be shunned Of a like peril, and to seek with speed Their opposites! Again, as in a building, If the first plumb-line be askew, and if The square deceiving swerve from lines exact, And if the level waver but the least In any part, the whole construction then Must turn out faulty- shelving and askew, Leaning to back and front, incongruous, That now some portions seem about to fall, And falls the whole ere long- betrayed indeed By first deceiving estimates: so too Thy calculations in affairs of life Must be askew and false, if sprung for thee From senses false. So all that troop of words Marshalled against the senses is quite vain.

	499 proinde quod in quoquest his visum tempore, verumst. 500 Et si non poterit ratio dissolvere causam, 501 cur ea quae fuerint iuxtim quadrata, procul sint 502 visa rutunda, tamen praestat rationis egentem 503 reddere mendose causas utriusque figurae, 504 quam manibus manifesta suis emittere quoquam 505 et violare fidem primam et convellere tota 506 fundamenta quibus nixatur vita salusque. 507 non modo enim ratio ruat omnis, vita quoque ipsa	
4.508	508 concidat extemplo, nisi credere sensibus ausis 509 praecipitisque locos vitare et cetera quae sint 510 in genere hoc fugienda, sequi contraria quae sint. 511 illa tibi est igitur verborum copia cassa 512 omnis, quae contra sensus instructa paratast. 513 Denique ut in fabrica, si pravast regula prima, 514 normaque si fallax rectis regionibus exit, 515 et libella aliqua si ex parti claudicat hilum, 516 omnia mendose fieri atque obstipa necessu est 517 prava cubantia prona supina atque absona tecta, 518 iam ruere ut quaedam videantur velle, ruantque 519 prodita iudiciis fallacibus omnia primis, 520 sic igitur ratio tibi rerum prava necessest 521 falsaque sit, falsis quae cumque ab sensibus ortast. 522 Nunc alii sensus quo pacto quisque suam rem 523 sentiat, haud quaquam ratio scruposa relicta est. 524 Principio auditur sonus et vox omnis, in auris 525 insinuata suo pepulere ubi corpore sensum. 526 corpoream quoque enim constare fatendumst 527 et sonitum, quoniam possunt inpellere sensus.	And now remains to demonstrate with ease How other senses each their things perceive. Firstly, a sound and every voice is heard, When, getting into ears, they strike the sense With their own body. For confess we must Even voice and sound to be corporeal, Because they're able on the sense to strike. Besides voice often scrapes against the throat, And screams in going out do make more rough The wind-pipe- naturally enough, methinks, When, through the narrow exit rising up In larger throng, these primal germs of voice Have thus begun to issue forth. In sooth, Also the door of the mouth is scraped against [By air blown outward] from distended [cheeks]. . . . . And thus no doubt there is, that voice and words Consist of elements corporeal, With power to pain. Nor art thou unaware Likewise how much of body's ta'en away, How much from very thews and powers of men May be withdrawn by steady talk, prolonged Even from the rising splendour of the morn To shadows of black evening,- above all If 't be outpoured with most exceeding shouts. Therefore the voice must be corporeal, Since the long talker loses from his frame A part. Moreover, roughness in the sound Comes from the roughness in the primal germs, As a smooth sound from smooth ones is create; Nor have these elements a form the same When the trump rumbles with a hollow roar, As when barbaric Berecynthian pipe Buzzes with raucous boomings, or when swans By night from icy shores of Helicon With wailing

	528 Praeterea radit vox fauces saepe facitque 529 asperiora foras gradiens arteria clamor, 530 quippe per angustum turba maiore coorta 531 ire foras ubi coeperunt primordia vocum. 532 scilicet expletis quoque ianua raditur oris. 533 haud igitur dubiumst quin voces verbaque constent 534 corporeis e principiis, ut laedere possint. 535 nec te fallit item quid corporis auferat et quid 536 detrahat ex hominum nervis ac viribus ipsis 537 perpetuus sermo nigrai noctis ad umbram	voices raise their liquid dirge.
4.538	538 aurorae perductus ab exoriente nitore, 539 praesertim si cum summost clamore profusus. 540 ergo corpoream vocem constare necessest, 541 multa loquens quoniam amittit de corpore partem. 542 Asperitas autem vocis fit ab asperitate 543 principiorum et item levor levore creatur; 544 nec simili penetrant auris primordia forma, 545 cum tuba depresso graviter sub murmure mugit 546 et reboat raucum retro cita barbita bombum, 547 et Dauliades natae hortis ex Heliconis 548 cum liquidam tollunt lugubri voce querellam. 549 Hasce igitur penitus voces cum corpore nostro 550 exprimimus rectoque foras emittimus ore, 551 mobilis articulat nervorum daedala lingua, 552 formaturaque labrorum pro parte figurat. 553 hoc ubi non longum spatiumst unde illa profecta 554 perveniat vox quaeque, necessest verba quoque ipsa 555 plane exaudiri discernique articulatim; 556 servat enim formaturam servatque figuram.	Thus, when from deep within our frame we force These voices, and at mouth expel them forth, The mobile tongue, artificer of words, Makes them articulate, and too the lips By their formations share in shaping them. Hence when the space is short from starting-point To where that voice arrives, the very words Must too be plainly heard, distinctly marked. For then the voice conserves its own formation, Conserves its shape. But if the space between Be longer than is fit, the words must be Through the much air confounded, and the voice Disordered in its flight across the winds- And so it haps, that thou canst sound perceive, Yet not determine what the words may mean; To such degree confounded and encumbered The voice approaches us. Again, one word, Sent from the crier's mouth, may rouse all ears Among the populace. And thus one voice Scatters asunder into many voices, Since it divides itself for separate ears, Imprinting form of word and a clear tone. But whatso part of voices fails to hit The ears themselves perishes, borne beyond, Idly diffused among the winds. A part, Beating on solid porticoes, tossed back Returns a sound; and sometimes mocks the ear With a mere phantom of a word.

	557 at si inter positum spatium sit longius aequo, 558 aeraaëra per multum confundi verba necessest 559 et conturbari vocem, dum transvolat auras. 560 ergo fit, sonitum ut possis sentire neque illam 561 internoscere, verborum sententia quae sit; 562 usque adeo confusa venit vox inque pedita. 563 Praeterea verbum saepe unum perciet auris 564 omnibus in populo missum praeconis ab ore. 565 in multas igitur voces vox una repente 566 diffugit, in privas quoniam se dividit auris 567 obsignans formam verbis clarumque sonorem.	
4.568	568 at quae pars vocum non auris incidit ipsas, 569 praeter lata perit frustra diffusa per auras. 570 pars solidis adlisa locis reiecta sonorem 571 reddit et inter dum frustratur imagine verbi. 572 Quae bene cum videas, rationem reddere possis 573 tute tibi atque aliis, quo pacto per loca sola 574 saxa paris formas verborum ex ordine reddant. 575 palantis comites com montis inter opacos 576 quaerimus et magna dispersos voce ciemus. 577 sex etiam aut septem loca vidi reddere vocis, 578 unam cum iaceres: ita colles collibus ipsi 579 verba repulsantes iterabant dicta referri. 580 haec loca capripedes Satyros Nymphasque tenere 581 finitimi fingunt et Faunos esse locuntur, 582 quorum noctivago strepitu ludoque iocanti 583 adfirmant volgo taciturna silentia rumpi 584 chordarumque sonos fieri dulcisque querellas, 585 tibia quas fundit digitis pulsata canentum,	When this Thou well hast noted, thou canst render count Unto thyself and others why it is Along the lonely places that the rocks Give back like shapes of words in order like, When search we after comrades wandering Among the shady mountains, and aloud Call unto them, the scattered. I have seen Spots that gave back even voices six or seven For one thrown forth- for so the very hills, Dashing them back against the hills, kept on With their reverberations. And these spots The neighbouring country-side doth feign to be Haunts of the goat-foot satyrs and the nymphs; And tells ye there be fauns, by whose night noise And antic revels yonder they declare The voiceless silences are broken oft, And tones of strings are made and wailings sweet Which the pipe, beat by players' finger-tips, Pours out; and far and wide the farmer-race Begins to hear, when, shaking the garmentings Of pine upon his half-beast head, god-Pan With puckered lip oft runneth o'er and o'er The open reeds,- lest flute should cease to pour The woodland music! Other prodigies And wonders of this ilk they love to tell, Lest they be thought to dwell in lonely spots And even by gods deserted. This is why They boast of marvels in their story-tellings; Or by some other reason are led on- Greedy, as all mankind hath ever been, To prattle fables into ears.

	586 et genus agricolum late sentiscere, quom Pan 587 pinea semiferi capitis velamina quassans 588 unco saepe labro calamos percurrit hiantis, 589 fistula silvestrem ne cesset fundere musam. 590 cetera de genere hoc monstra ac portenta loquontur, 591 ne loca deserta ab divis quoque forte putentur 592 sola tenere. ideo iactant miracula dictis 593 aut aliqua ratione alia ducuntur, ut omne 594 humanum genus est avidum nimis auricularum. 595 Quod super est, non est mirandum qua ratione, 596 per loca quae nequeunt oculi res cernere apertas, 597 haec loca per voces veniant aurisque lacessant,	
4.598	598 conloquium clausis foribus quoque saepe videmus; 599 ni mirum quia vox per flexa foramina rerum 600 incolumis transire potest, simulacra renutant; 601 perscinduntur enim, nisi recta foramina tranant, 602 qualia sunt vitrei, species qua travolat omnis. 603 praeterea partis in cunctas dividitur vox, 604 ex aliis aliae quoniam gignuntur, ubi una 605 dissuluit semel in multas exorta, quasi ignis 606 saepe solet scintilla suos se spargere in ignis. 607 ergo replentur loca vocibus abdita retro, 608 omnia quae circum fervunt sonituque cientur. 609 at simulacra viis derectis omnia tendunt, 610 ut sunt missa semel; qua propter cernere nemo 611 saepe supra potis est, at voces accipere extra. 612 et tamen ipsa quoque haec, dum transit clausa 613 vox optunditur atque auris confusa penetrat 614 et sonitum potius quam verba audire videmur.	

	615 Hoc, qui sentimus sucum, lingua atque palatum 616 plusculum habent in se rationis, plus operai. 617 principio sucum sentimus in ore, cibum cum 618 mandendo exprimimus, ceu plenam spongiam aquai 619 siquis forte manu premere ac siccare coepitcoëpit. 620 inde quod exprimimus per caulas omne palati 621 diditur et rarae per flexa foramina linguae, 622 hoc ubi levia sunt manantis corpora suci, 623 suaviter attingunt et suaviter omnia tractant 624 umida linguai circum sudantia templa; 625 at contra pungunt sensum lacerantque coorta, 626 quanto quaeque magis sunt asperitate repleta. 627 deinde voluptas est e suco fine palati;	
4.628	628 cum vero deorsum per fauces praecipitavit, 629 nulla voluptas est, dum diditur omnis in artus; 630 nec refert quicquam quo victu corpus alatur, 631 dum modo quod capias concoctum didere possis 632 artubus et stomachi tumidum servare tenorem. 633 Nunc aliis alius qui sit cibus ut videamus, 634 expediam, quareve, aliis quod triste et amarumst, 635 hoc tamen esse aliis possit perdulce videri, 636 tantaque his rebus distantia differitasque est, 637 ut quod aliis cibus est aliis fuat acre venenum; 638 est itaque ut serpens, hominis quae tacta salivis 639 disperit ac sese mandendo conficit ipsa. 640 praeterea nobis veratrum est acre venenum, 641 at capris adipes et cocturnicibus auget. 642 id quibus ut fiat rebus cognoscere possis, 643 principio meminisse decet quae diximus ante,	

	644 semina multimodis in rebus mixta teneri. 645 porro omnes quae cumque cibum capiunt animantes, 646 ut sunt dissimiles extrinsecus et generatim 647 extima membrorum circumcaesura coercetcoërcet, 648 proinde et seminibus constant variantque figura. 649 semina cum porro distent, differre necessest 650 intervalla viasque, foramina quae perhibemus, 651 omnibus in membris et in ore ipsoque palato. 652 esse minora igitur quaedam maioraque debent, 653 esse triquetra aliis, aliis quadrata necessest, 654 multa rutunda, modis multis multangula quaedam. 655 namque figurarum ratio ut motusque reposcunt, 656 proinde foraminibus debent differe figurae 657 et variare viae proinde ac textura coercetcoërcet.	
4.658	658 hoc ubi quod suave est aliis aliis fit amarum, 659 illi, cui suave est, levissima corpora debent 660 contractabiliter caulas intrare palati, 661 at contra quibus est eadem res intus acerba, 662 aspera ni mirum penetrant hamataque fauces. 663 nunc facile est ex his rebus cognoscere quaeque. 664 quippe ubi cui febris bili superante coorta est 665 aut alia ratione aliquast vis excita morbi, 666 perturbatur ibi iam totum corpus et omnes 667 commutantur ibi positurae principiorum; 668 fit prius ad sensum quae corpora conveniebant 669 nunc non conveniant, et cetera sint magis apta, 670 quae penetrata queunt sensum progignere acerbum; 671 utraque enim sunt in mellis commixta sapore; 672 id quod iam supera tibi saepe ostendimus ante.	

	673 Nunc age, quo pacto naris adiectus odoris 674 tangat agam. primum res multas esse necessest 675 unde fluens volvat varius se fluctus odorum, 676 et fluere et mitti volgo spargique putandumst; 677 verum aliis alius magis est animantibus aptus, 678 dissimilis propter formas. ideoque per auras 679 mellis apes quamvis longe ducuntur odore, 680 volturiique cadaveribus; tum fissa ferarum 681 ungula quo tulerit gressum promissa canum vis 682 ducit, et humanum longe praesentit odorem 683 Romulidarum arcis servator, candidus anser. 684 sic aliis alius nidor datus ad sua quemque 685 pabula ducit et a taetro resilire veneno 686 cogit, eoque modo servantur saecla ferarum. 687 Hic odor ipse igitur, naris qui cumque lacessit,	
4.688	688 est alio ut possit permitti longius alter; 689 sed tamen haud quisquam tam longe fertur eorum 690 quam sonitus, quam vox, mitto iam dicere quam res 691 quae feriunt oculorum acies visumque lacessunt. 692 errabundus enim tarde venit ac perit ante 693 paulatim facilis distractus in aerisaëris auras; 694 ex alto primum quia vix emittitur ex re; 695 nam penitus fluere atque recedere rebus odores 696 significat quod fracta magis redolere videntur 697 omnia, quod contrita, quod igni conlabefacta. 698 deinde videre licet maioribus esse creatum 699 principiis quam vox, quoniam per saxea saepta 700 non penetrat, qua vox volgo sonitusque feruntur. 701 quare etiam quod olet non tam facile esse videbis	

	702 investigare in qua sit regione locatum; 703 refrigescit enim cunctando plaga per auras 704 nec calida ad sensum decurrunt nuntia rerum. 705 errant saepe canes itaque et vestigia quaerunt. 706 Nec tamen hoc solis in odoribus atque saporum 707 in generest, sed item species rerum atque colores 708 non ita conveniunt ad sensus omnibus omnes, 709 ut non sint aliis quaedam magis acria visu. 710 quin etiam gallum noctem explaudentibus alis 711 auroram clara consuetum voce vocare, 712 noenu queunt rapidi contra constare leones 713 inque tueri: ita continuo meminere fugai. 714 ni mirum quia sunt gallorum in corpore quaedam 715 semina, quae cum sunt oculis inmissa leonum, 716 pupillas interfodiunt acremque dolorem 717 praebent, ut nequeant contra durare feroces,	
4.718	718 cum tamen haec nostras acies nil laedere possint, 719 aut quia non penetrant aut quod penetrantibus illis 720 exitus ex oculis liber datur, in remorando 721 laedere ne possint ex ulla lumina parte. 722 Nunc age, quae moveant animum res accipe, et unde 723 quae veniunt veniant in mentem percipe paucis. 724 principio hoc dico, rerum simulacra vagari 725 multa modis multis in cunctas undique partis 726 tenvia, quae facile inter se iunguntur in auris, 727 obvia cum veniunt, ut aranea bratteaque auri. 728 quippe etenim multo magis haec sunt tenvia textu 729 quam quae percipiunt oculos visumque lacessunt, 730 corporis haec quoniam penetrant per rara cientque	

	731 tenvem animi naturam intus sensumque lacessunt. 732 Centauros itaque et Scyllarum membra videmus 733 Cerbereasque canum facies simulacraque eorum 734 quorum morte obita tellus amplectitur ossa; 735 omnigenus quoniam passim simulacra feruntur, 736 partim sponte sua quae fiunt aereaëre in ipso, 737 partim quae variis ab rebus cumque recedunt 738 et quae confiunt ex horum facta figuris. 739 nam certe ex vivo Centauri non fit imago, 740 nulla fuit quoniam talis natura animata; 741 verum ubi equi atque hominis casu convenit imago, 742 haerescit facile extemplo, quod diximus ante, 743 propter subtilem naturam et tenvia texta. 744 cetera de genere hoc eadem ratione creantur. 745 quae cum mobiliter summa levitate feruntur, 746 ut prius ostendi, facile uno commovet ictu 747 quae libet una animum nobis subtilis imago;	
4.748	748 tenvis enim mens est et mire mobilis ipsa. 749 haec fieri ut memoro, facile hinc cognoscere possis. 750 quatinus hoc simile est illi, quod mente videmus 751 atque oculis, simili fieri ratione necessest. 752 Nunc igitur docui quoniam me forte leonum 753 cernere per simulacra, oculos quae cumque lacessunt, 754 scire licet mentem simili ratione moveri 755 per simulacra leonum cetera quae videt aeque 756 nec minus atque oculi, nisi quod mage tenvia cernit. 757 nec ratione alia, cum somnus membra profudit, 758 mens animi vigilat, nisi quod simulacra lacessunt 759 haec eadem nostros animos quae cum vigilamus,	

	760 usque adeo, certe ut videamur cernere eum quem 761 rellicta vita iam mors et terra potitast. 762 hoc ideo fieri cogit natura, quod omnes 763 corporis offecti sensus per membra quiescunt 764 nec possunt falsum veris convincere rebus. 765 praeterea meminisse iacet languetque sopore, 766 nec dissentit eum mortis letique potitum 767 iam pridem, quem mens vivom se cernere credit. 768 quod super est, non est mirum simulacra moveri 769 bracchiaque in numerum iactare et cetera membra; 770 nam fit ut in somnis facere hoc videatur imago. 771 quippe, ubi prima perit alioque est altera nata 772 inde statu, prior hic gestum mutasse videtur. 773 scilicet id fieri celeri ratione putandumst: 774 tanta est mobilitas et rerum copia tanta 775 tantaque sensibili quovis est tempore in uno 776 copia particularum, ut possit suppeditare. 777 Multaque in his rebus quaeruntur multaque nobis	
4.778	778 clarandumst, plane si res exponere avemus. 779 quaeritur in primis quare, quod cuique libido 780 venerit, extemplo mens cogitet eius id ipsum. 781 anne voluntatem nostram simulacra tuentur 782 et simul ac volumus nobis occurrit imago, 783 si mare, si terram cordist, si denique caelum? 784 conventus hominum, pompam, convivia, pugnas, 785 omnia sub verbone creat natura paratque? 786 cum praesertim aliis eadem in regione locoque 787 longe dissimilis animus res cogitet omnis. 788 quid porro, in numerum procedere cum simulacra	

	789 cernimus in somnis et mollia membra movere, 790 mollia mobiliter cum alternis bracchia mittunt 791 et repetunt oculis gestum pede convenienti? 792 scilicet arte madent simulacra et docta vagantur, 793 nocturno facere ut possint in tempore ludos. 794 an magis illud erit verum? quia tempore in uno, 795 cum sentimus, id est cum vox emittitur una, 796 tempora multa latent, ratio quae comperit esse, 797 propterea fit uti quovis in tempore quaeque 798 praesto sint simulacra locis in quisque parata. 799 tanta est mobilitas et rerum copia tanta. 800 hoc ubi prima perit alioque est altera nata 801 inde statu, prior hic gestum mutasse videtur. 802 et quia tenvia sunt, nisi quae contendit, acute 803 cernere non potis est animus; proinde omnia quae sunt 804 praeterea pereunt, nisi quae ex se ipse paravit. 805 ipse parat sese porro speratque futurum 806 ut videat quod consequitur rem quamque: fit ergo. 807 nonne vides oculos etiam, cum tenvia quae sunt	
4.808	808 809 cernere coeperunt, contendere se atque parare, 810 nec sine eo fieri posse ut cernamus acute? 811 et tamen in rebus quoque apertis noscere possis, 812 si non advertas animum, proinde esse quasi omni 813 tempore semotum fuerit longeque remotum. 814 cur igitur mirumst, animus si cetera perdit 815 praeter quam quibus est in rebus deditus ipse? 816 deinde adopinamur de signis maxima parvis 817 ac nos in fraudem induimus frustraminis ipsi. 818 Fit quoque ut inter dum non	In these affairs We crave that thou wilt passionately flee The one offence, and anxiously wilt shun The error of presuming the clear lights Of eyes created were that we might see; Or thighs and knees, aprop upon the feet, Thuswise can bended be, that we might step With goodly strides ahead; or forearms joined Unto the sturdy uppers, or serving hands On either side were given, that we might do Life's own demands. All such interpretation Is aft-for-fore with inverse reasoning, Since naught is born in body so that we May use the same, but birth engenders use: No seeing ere the lights of eyes were born, No speaking ere the tongue created was; But origin of tongue came long before Discourse of words, and ears created were Much earlier than

	suppeditetur imago 819 eiusdem generis, sed femina quae fuit ante, 820 in manibus vir uti factus videatur adesse, 821 aut alia ex alia facies aetasque sequatur. 822 quod ne miremur sopor atque oblivia curant. 823 Illud in his rebus vitium vehementer ainesseäinesse 824 effugere errorem vitareque praemetuenter, 825 lumina ne facias oculorum clara creata, 826 prospicere ut possimus, et ut proferre queamus 827 proceros passus, ideo fastigia posse 828 surarum ac feminum pedibus fundata plicari, 829 bracchia tum porro validis ex apta lacertis 830 esse manusque datas utraque parte ministras, 831 ut facere ad vitam possemus quae foret usus. 832 cetera de genere hoc inter quae cumque pretantur, 833 omnia perversa praepostera sunt ratione, 834 nil ideo quoniam natumst in corpore ut uti 835 possemus, sed quod natumst id procreat usum. 836 nec fuit ante videre oculorum lumina nata, 837 nec dictis orare prius quam lingua creatast,	any sound was heard; And all the members, so meseems, were there Before they got their use: and therefore, they Could not be gendered for the sake of use. But contrariwise, contending in the fight With hand to hand, and rending of the joints, And fouling of the limbs with gore, was there, O long before the gleaming spears ere flew; And nature prompted man to shun a wound, Before the left arm by the aid of art Opposed the shielding targe. And, verily, Yielding the weary body to repose, Far ancienter than cushions of soft beds, And quenching thirst is earlier than cups. These objects, therefore, which for use and life Have been devised, can be conceived as found For sake of using. But apart from such Are all which first were born and afterwards Gave knowledge of their own utility- Chief in which sort we note the senses, limbs: Wherefore, again, 'tis quite beyond thy power To hold that these could thus have been create For office of utility.
4.838	838 sed potius longe linguae praecessit origo 839 sermonem multoque creatae sunt prius aures 840 quam sonus est auditus, et omnia denique membra 841 ante fuere, ut opinor, eorum quam foret usus; 842 haud igitur potuere utendi crescere causa. 843 at contra conferre manu certamina pugnae 844 et lacerare artus foedareque membra cruore 845 ante fuit multo quam lucida tela volarent, 846 et volnus vitare prius natura coegitcoëgit 847 quam daret obiectum parmai laeva	Likewise, 'Tis nothing strange that all the breathing creatures Seek, even by nature of their frame, their food. Yes, since I've taught thee that from off the things Stream and depart innumerable bodies In modes innumerable too; but most Must be the bodies streaming from the living- Which bodies, vexed by motion evermore, Are through the mouth exhaled innumerable, When weary creatures pant, or through the sweat Squeezed forth innumerable from deep within. Thus body rarefies, so undermined In all its nature, and pain attends its state. And so the food is taken to underprop The tottering joints, and by its interfusion To re-create their powers, and there stop up The longing, open-mouthed through

	per artem. 848 scilicet et fessum corpus mandare quieti 849 multo antiquius est quam lecti mollia strata, 850 et sedare sitim prius est quam pocula natum. 851 haec igitur possunt utendi cognita causa 852 credier, ex usu quae sunt vitaque reperta. 853 illa quidem seorsum sunt omnia, quae prius ipsa 854 nata dedere suae post notitiam utilitatis. 855 quo genere in primis sensus et membra videmus; 856 quare etiam atque etiam procul est ut credere possis 857 utilitatis ob officium potuisse creari. 858 Illud item non est mirandum, corporis ipsa 859 quod natura cibum quaerit cuiusque animantis. 860 quippe etenim fluere atque recedere corpora rebus 861 multa modis multis docui, sed plurima debent 862 ex animalibus; quia sunt exercita motu, 863 multa per os exhalantur, cum languida anhelant, 864 multaque per sudorem ex alto pressa feruntur. 865 his igitur rebus rarescit corpus et omnis 866 subruitur natura, dolor quam consequitur rem. 867 propterea capitur cibus, ut suffulciat artus	limbs and veins, For eating. And the moist no less departs Into all regions that demand the moist; And many heaped-up particles of hot, Which cause such burnings in these bellies of ours, The liquid on arriving dissipates And quenches like a fire, that parching heat No longer now can scorch the frame. And so, Thou seest how panting thirst is washed away From off our body, how the hunger-pang It, too, appeased.
4.868	868 et recreet vires inter datus, atque patentem 869 per membra ac venas ut amorem opturet edendi. 870 umor item discedit in omnia quae loca cumque 871 poscunt umorem; glomerataque multa vaporis 872 corpora, quae stomacho praebent incendia nostro, 873 dissupat adveniens liquor ac restinguit ut ignem, 874 urere ne possit calor amplius aridus artus. 875 sic igitur tibi anhela sitis de corpore nostro 876 abluitur, sic expletur ieiuna cupido.	Now, how it comes that we, Whene'er we wish, can step with strides ahead, And how 'tis given to move our limbs about, And what device is wont to push ahead This the big load of our corporeal frame, I'll say to thee- do thou attend what's said. I say that first some idol-films of walking Into our mind do fall and smite the mind, As said before. Thereafter will arises; For no one starts to do a thing, before The intellect previsions what it wills; And what it there pre-visioneth depends On what that image is. When, therefore, mind Doth so bestir itself that it doth will To go and step along, it strikes at once That energy of soul that's sown

	877 Nunc qui fiat uti passus proferre queamus, 878 cum volumus, quareque datum sit membra movere 879 et quae res tantum hoc oneris protrudere nostri 880 corporis insuerit, dicam: tu percipe dicta. 881 dico animo nostro primum simulacra meandi 882 accidere atque animum pulsare, ut diximus ante. 883 inde voluntas fit; neque enim facere incipit ullam 884 rem quisquam, mens providit quid velit ante. 885 id quod providet, illius rei constat imago, 886 ergo animus cum sese ita commovet ut velit ire 887 inque gredi, ferit extemplo quae in corpore toto 888 per membra atque artus animai dissita vis est; 889 et facilest factu, quoniam coniuncta tenetur. 890 inde ea proporro corpus ferit, atque ita tota 891 paulatim moles protruditur atque movetur. 892 praeterea tum rarescit quoque corpus et aeraër, 893 scilicet ut debet qui semper mobilis extat, 894 per patefacta venit penetratque foramina largus, 895 et dispargitur ad partis ita quasque minutas 896 corporis. hic igitur rebus fit utrimque duabus, 897 corpus ut ac navis velis ventoque feratur.	about In all the body through the limbs and frame- And this is easy of performance, since The soul is close conjoined with the mind. Next, soul in turn strikes body, and by degrees Thus the whole mass is pushed along and moved. Then too the body rarefies, and air, Forsooth as ever of such nimbleness, Comes on and penetrates aboundingly Through opened pores, and thus is sprinkled round Unto all smallest places in our frame. Thus then by these twain factors, severally, Body is borne like ship with oars and wind. Nor yet in these affairs is aught for wonder That particles so fine can whirl around So great a body and turn this weight of ours; For wind, so tenuous with its subtle body, Yet pushes, driving on the mighty ship Of mighty bulk; one hand directs the same, Whatever its momentum, and one helm Whirls it around, whither ye please; and loads, Many and huge, are moved and hoisted high By enginery of pulley-blocks and wheels, With but light strain.
4.898	898 nec tamen illud in his rebus mirabile constat, 899 tantula quod tantum corpus corpuscula possunt 900 contorquere et onus totum convertere nostrum; 901 quippe etenim ventus subtili corpore tenvis 902 trudit agens magnam magno molimine navem 903 et manus una regit quanto vis impete euntem 904 atque gubernaclum contorquet quo libet unum, 905 multaque per trocleas et tympana pondere magno	Now, by what modes this sleep Pours through our members waters of repose And frees the breast from cares of mind, I'll tell In verses sweeter than they many are; Even as the swan's slight note is better far Than that dispersed clamour of the cranes Among the southwind's aery clouds. Do thou Give me sharp ears and a sagacious mind,- That thou mayst not deny the things to be Whereof I'm speaking, nor depart away With bosom scorning these the spoken truths, Thyself at fault unable to perceive. Sleep chiefly comes when energy of soul Hath now been scattered through the frame, and part

	906 commovet atque levi sustollit machina nisu. 907 Nunc quibus ille modis somnus per membra quietem 908 inriget atque animi curas e pectore solvat, 909 suavidicis potius quom multis versibus edam, 910 parvus ut est cycni melior canor, ille gruum quam 911 clamor in aetheriis dispersus nubibus austri. 912 tu mihi da tenuis auris animumque sagacem, 913 ne fieri negites quae dicam posse retroque 914 vera repulsanti discedas pectore dicta, 915 tutemet in culpa cum sis neque cernere possis. 916 Principio somnus fit ubi est distracta per artus 917 vis animae partimque foras eiecta recessit 918 et partim contrusa magis concessit in altum; 919 dissoluuntur enim tum demum membra fluuntque. 920 nam dubium non est, animai quin opera sit 921 sensus hic in nobis, quem cum sopor inpedit esse, 922 tum nobis animam perturbatam esse putandumst 923 eiectamque foras, non omnem; namque iaceret 924 aeterno corpus perfusum frigore leti. 925 quippe ubi nulla latens animai pars remaneret 926 in membris, cinere ut multa latet obrutus ignis, 927 unde reconflari sensus per membra repente	Expelled abroad and gone away, and part Crammed back and settling deep within the frame- Whereafter then our loosened members droop. For doubt is none that by the work of soul Exist in us this sense, and when by slumber That sense is thwarted, we are bound to think The soul confounded and expelled abroad- Yet not entirely, else the frame would lie Drenched in the everlasting cold of death. In sooth, where no one part of soul remained Lurking among the members, even as fire Lurks buried under many ashes, whence Could sense amain rekindled be in members, As flame can rise anew from unseen fire?
4.928	928 possit, ut ex igni caeco consurgere flamma? 929 Sed quibus haec rebus novitas confiat et unde 930 perturbari anima et corpus languescere possit, 931 expediam: tu fac ne ventis verba profundam. 932 Principio externa corpus de parte necessum est, 933 aeriisaëriis quoniam vicinum tangitur auris, 934 tundier atque eius crebro pulsarier ictu,	

	935 proptereaque fere res omnes aut corio sunt 936 aut etiam conchis aut callo aut cortice tectae. 937 interiorem etiam partem spirantibus aeraër 938 verberat hic idem, cum ducitur atque reflatur. 939 quare utrimque secus cum corpus vapulet et cum 940 perveniant plagae per parva foramina nobis 941 corporis ad primas partis elementaque prima, 942 fit quasi paulatim nobis per membra ruina. 943 conturbantur enim positurae principiorum 944 corporis atque animi. fit uti pars inde animai 945 eliciatur et introrsum pars abdita cedat, 946 pars etiam distracta per artus non queat esse 947 coniuncta inter se neque motu mutua fungi; 948 inter enim saepit coetus natura viasque. 949 ergo sensus abit mutatis motibus alte. 950 et quoniam non est quasi quod suffulciat artus, 951 debile fit corpus languescuntque omnia membra, 952 bracchia palpebraeque cadunt poplitesque cubanti 953 saepe tamen summittuntur virisque resolvunt. 954 Deinde cibum sequitur somnus, quia, quae facit aeraër, 955 haec eadem cibus, in venas dum diditur omnis, 956 efficit. et multo sopor ille gravissimus exstat, 957 quem satur aut lassus capias, quia plurima tum se	
4.958	958 corpora conturbant magno contusa labore. 959 fit ratione eadem coniectus parte animai 960 altior atque foras eiectus largior eius, 961 et divisior inter se ac distractior intus. 962 Et quo quisque fere studio devinctus adhaeret 963 aut quibus in rebus multum sumus ante morati	

	964 atque in ea ratione fuit contenta magis mens, 965 in somnis eadem plerumque videmur obire: 966 causidici causas agere et componere leges, 967 induperatores pugnare ac proelia obire, 968 nautae contractum cum ventis degere bellum, 969 nos agere hoc autem et naturam quaerere rerum 970 semper et inventam patriis exponere chartis. 971 cetera sic studia atque artes plerumque videntur 972 in somnis animos hominum frustrata tenere. 973 et qui cumque dies multos ex ordine ludis 974 adsiduas dederunt operas, plerumque videmus, 975 cum iam destiterunt ea sensibus usurpare, 976 relicuas tamen esse vias in mente patentis, 977 qua possint eadem rerum simulacra venire; 978 per multos itaque illa dies eadem obversantur 979 ante oculos, etiam vigilantes ut videantur 980 cernere saltantis et mollia membra moventis 981 et citharae liquidum carmen chordasque loquentis 982 auribus accipere et consessum cernere eundem 983 scenaique simul varios splendere decores. 984 usque adeo magni refert studium atque voluntas, 985 et quibus in rebus consuerint esse operati 986 non homines solum sed vero animalia cuncta. 987 quippe videbis equos fortis, cum membra iacebunt,	
4.988	988 in somnis sudare tamen spirareque semper 989 et quasi de palma summas contendere viris 990 aut quasi carceribus patefactis 991 venantumque canes in molli saepe quiete 992 iactant crura tamen subito vocisque repente 993 mittunt et crebro redducunt	

	naribus auras. 994 ut vestigia si teneant inventa ferarum, 995 expergefactique secuntur inania saepe 996 cervorum simulacra, fugae quasi dedita cernant, 997 donec discussis redeant erroribus ad se. 998 at consueta domi catulorum blanda propago 999 discutere et corpus de terra corripere instant, 1000 1001 1002 1003 1004 proinde quasi ignotas facies atque ora tuantur. 1005 et quo quaeque magis sunt aspera seminiorum, 1006 tam magis in somnis eadem saevire necessust. 1007 at variae fugiunt volucres pinnisque repente 1008 sollicitant divom nocturno tempore lucos, 1009 accipitres somno in leni si proelia pugnas 1010 edere sunt persectantes visaeque volantes. 1011 porro hominum mentes, magnis quae motibus edunt 1012 magna, itidem saepe in somnis faciuntque geruntque, 1013 reges expugnant, capiuntur, proelia miscent, 1014 tollunt clamorem, quasi si iugulentur ibidem. 1015 multi depugnant gemitusque doloribus edunt 1016 et quasi pantherae morsu saevive leonis 1017 mandantur, magnis clamoribus omnia complent.	
4.1018	1018 multi de magnis per somnum rebus loquuntur 1019 indicioque sui facti persaepe fuere. 1020 multi mortem obeunt. multi, de montibus altis 1021 ut quasi praecipitent ad terram corpore toto, 1022 exterruntur et ex somno quasi mentibus capti 1023 vix ad se redeunt permoti corporis aestu. 1024 flumen item sitiens aut fontem	And as said before, That seed is roused in us when once ripe age Has made our body strong... As divers causes give to divers things Impulse and irritation, so one force In human kind rouses the human seed To spurt from man. As soon as ever it issues, Forced from its first abodes, it passes down In the whole body through the limbs and frame, Meeting in certain regions of our thews, And stirs amain the genitals of man. The goaded regions swell with seed, and then Comes the delight to

	propter amoenum 1025 adsidet et totum prope faucibus occupat amnem. 1026 puri saepe lacum propter si ac dolia curta 1027 somno devincti credunt se extollere vestem, 1028 totius umorem saccatum corporis fundunt, 1029 cum Babylonica magnifico splendore rigantur. 1030 tum quibus aetatis freta primitus insinuatur 1031 semen, ubi ipsa dies membris matura creavit, 1032 conveniunt simulacra foris e corpore quoque, 1033 nuntia praeclari voltus pulchrique coloris, 1034 qui ciet inritans loca turgida semine multo, 1035 ut quasi transactis saepe omnibus rebus profundant 1036 fluminis ingentis fluctus vestemque cruentent. 1037 Sollicitatur id nobis, quod diximus ante, 1038 semen, adulta aetas cum primum roborat artus. 1039 namque alias aliud res commovet atque lacessit; 1040 ex homine humanum semen ciet una hominis vis. 1041 quod simul atque suis eiectum sedibus exit, 1042 per membra atque artus decedit corpore toto, 1043 in loca conveniens nervorum certa cietque 1044 continuo partis genitalis corporis ipsas. 1045 inritata tument loca semine fitque voluntas 1046 eicere id quo se contendit dira lubido, 1047	dart the same at what The mad desire so yearns, and body seeks That object, whence the mind by love is pierced. For well-nigh each man falleth toward his wound, And our blood spurts even toward the spot from whence The stroke wherewith we are strook, and if indeed The foe be close, the red jet reaches him. Thus, one who gets a stroke from Venus' shafts- Whether a boy with limbs effeminate Assault him, or a woman darting love From all her body- that one strains to get Even to the thing whereby he's hit, and longs To join with it and cast into its frame The fluid drawn even from within its own. For the mute craving doth presage delight.
4.1048	1048 idque petit corpus, mens unde est saucia amore; 1049 namque omnes plerumque cadunt in vulnus et illam 1050 emicat in partem sanguis, unde icimur ictu, 1051 et si comminus est, hostem ruber occupat umor. 1052 sic igitur Veneris qui telis accipit ictus, 1053 sive puer membris muliebribus hunc iaculatur	

	1054 seu mulier toto iactans e corpore amorem, 1055 unde feritur, eo tendit gestitque coire 1056 et iacere umorem in corpus de corpore ductum; 1057 namque voluptatem praesagit muta cupido. 1058 Haec Venus est nobis; hinc autemst nomen Amoris, 1059 hinc illaec primum Veneris dulcedinis in cor 1060 stillavit gutta et successit frigida cura; 1061 nam si abest quod ames, praesto simulacra tamen sunt 1062 illius et nomen dulce obversatur ad auris. 1063 sed fugitare decet simulacra et pabula amoris 1064 absterrere sibi atque alio convertere mentem 1065 et iacere umorem coniectum in corpora quaeque 1066 nec retinere semel conversum unius amore 1067 et servare sibi curam certumque dolorem; 1068 ulcus enim vivescit et inveterascit alendo 1069 inque dies gliscit furor atque aerumna gravescit, 1070 si non prima novis conturbes volnera plagis 1071 volgivagaque vagus Venere ante recentia cures 1072 aut alio possis animi traducere motus. 1073 Nec Veneris fructu caret is qui vitat amorem, 1074 sed potius quae sunt sine poena commoda sumit; 1075 nam certe purast sanis magis inde voluptas 1076 quam miseris; etenim potiundi tempore in ipso 1077 fluctuat incertis erroribus ardor amantum	
4.1078	1078 nec constat quid primum oculis manibusque fruantur. 1079 quod petiere, premunt arte faciuntque dolorem 1080 corporis et dentes inlidunt saepe labellis 1081 osculaque adfigunt, quia non est pura voluptas 1082 et stimuli subsunt, qui instigant laedere id ipsum,	

	1083 quod cumque est, rabies unde illaec germina surgunt. 1084 sed leviter poenas frangit Venus inter amorem 1085 blandaque refrenat morsus admixta voluptas. 1086 namque in eo spes est, unde est ardoris origo, 1087 restingui quoque posse ab eodem corpore flammam. 1088 quod fieri contra totum natura repugnat; 1089 unaque res haec est, cuius quam plurima habemus, 1090 tam magis ardescit dira cuppedine pectus. 1091 nam cibus atque umor membris adsumitur intus; 1092 quae quoniam certas possunt obsidere partis, 1093 hoc facile expletur laticum frugumque cupido. 1094 ex hominis vero facie pulchroque colore 1095 nil datur in corpus praeter simulacra fruendum 1096 tenvia; quae vento spes raptast saepe misella. 1097 ut bibere in somnis sitiens quom quaerit et umor 1098 non datur, ardorem qui membris stinguere possit, 1099 sed laticum simulacra petit frustraque laborat 1100 in medioque sitit torrenti flumine potans, 1101 sic in amore Venus simulacris ludit amantis, 1102 nec satiare queunt spectando corpora coram 1103 nec manibus quicquam teneris abradere membris 1104 possunt errantes incerti corpore toto. 1105 denique cum membris conlatis flore fruuntur 1106 aetatis, iam cum praesagit gaudia corpus 1107 atque in eost Venus ut muliebria conserat arva,	
4.1108	1108 adfigunt avide corpus iunguntque salivas 1109 oris et inspirant pressantes dentibus ora, 1110 ne quiquam, quoniam nihil inde abradere possunt 1111 nec penetrare et abire in corpus corpore toto;	

	1112 nam facere inter dum velle et certare videntur. 1113 usque adeo cupide in Veneris compagibus haerent, 1114 membra voluptatis dum vi labefacta liquescunt. 1115 tandem ubi se erupit nervis coniecta cupido, 1116 parva fit ardoris violenti pausa parumper. 1117 inde redit rabies eadem et furor ille revisit, 1118 cum sibi quod cupiant ipsi contingere quaerunt, 1119 nec reperire malum id possunt quae machina vincat. 1120 usque adeo incerti tabescunt volnere caeco. 1121 Adde quod absumunt viris pereuntque labore, 1122 adde quod alterius sub nutu degitur aetas, 1123 languent officia atque aegrotat fama vacillans. 1124 labitur interea res et Babylonia fiunt 1125 unguenta et pulchra in pedibus Sicyonia rident, 1126 scilicet et grandes viridi cum luce zmaragdi 1127 auro includuntur teriturque thalassina vestis 1128 adsidue et Veneris sudorem exercita potat. 1129 et bene parta patrum fiunt anademata, mitrae, 1130 inter dum in pallam atque Alidensia Ciaque vertunt. 1131 eximia veste et victu convivia, ludi, 1132 pocula crebra, unguenta, coronae, serta parantur, 1133 ne quiquam, quoniam medio de fonte leporum 1134 surgit amari aliquid, quod in ipsis floribus angat, 1135 aut cum conscius ipse animus se forte remordet 1136 desidiose agere aetatem lustrisque perire, 1137 aut quod in ambiguo verbum iaculata reliquit,	
4.1138	1138 quod cupido adfixum cordi vivescit ut ignis, 1139 aut nimium iactare oculos aliumve tueri 1140 quod putat in voltuque videt vestigia risus.	

	1141 Atque in amore mala haec proprio summeque secundo 1142 inveniuntur; in adverso vero atque inopi sunt, 1143 prendere quae possis oculorum lumine operto. 1144 innumerabilia; ut melius vigilare sit ante, 1145 qua docui ratione, cavereque, ne inliciaris. 1146 nam vitare, plagas in amoris ne iaciamur, 1147 non ita difficile est quam captum retibus ipsis 1148 exire et validos Veneris perrumpere nodos. 1149 et tamen implicitus quoque possis inque peditus 1150 effugere infestum, nisi tute tibi obvius obstes 1151 et praetermittas animi vitia omnia primum 1152 aut quae corporis sunt eius, quam praepetis ac vis. 1153 nam faciunt homines plerumque cupidine caeci 1154 et tribuunt ea quae non sunt his commoda vere. 1155 multimodis igitur pravas turpisque videmus 1156 esse in deliciis summoque in honore vigere. 1157 atque alios alii inrident Veneremque suadent 1158 ut placent, quoniam foedo adflictentur amore, 1159 nec sua respiciunt miseri mala maxima saepe. 1160 nigra melichrus est, inmunda et fetida acosmos, 1161 caesia Palladium, nervosa et lignea dorcas, 1162 parvula, pumilio, chariton mia, tota merum sal, 1163 magna atque inmanis cataplexis plenaque honoris. 1164 balba loqui non quit, traulizi, muta pudens est; 1165 at flagrans, odiosa, loquacula Lampadium fit. 1166 ischnon eromenion tum fit, cum vivere non quit 1167 prae macie; rhadine verost iam mortua tussi.	
4.1168	1168 at nimia et mammosa Ceres est ipsa ab Iaccho, 1169 simula Silena ac Saturast, labeosa philema.	Nor sighs the woman always with feigned love, Who links her body round man's body locked And holds him fast, making his kisses wet With lips sucked

	1170 cetera de genere hoc longum est si dicere coner. 1171 sed tamen esto iam quantovis oris honore, 1172 cui Veneris membris vis omnibus exoriatur; 1173 nempe aliae quoque sunt; nempe hac sine viximus ante; 1174 nempe eadem facit et scimus facere omnia turpi 1175 et miseram taetris se suffit odoribus ipsa, 1176 quam famulae longe fugitant furtimque cachinnant. 1177 at lacrimans exclusus amator limina saepe 1178 floribus et sertis operit postisque superbos 1179 unguit amaracino et foribus miser oscula figit; 1180 quem si iam ammissum venientem offenderit aura 1181 una modo, causas abeundi quaerat honestas 1182 et meditata diu cadat alte sumpta querella 1183 stultitiaque ibi se damnet, tribuisse quod illi 1184 plus videat quam mortali concedere par est. 1185 nec Veneres nostras hoc fallit; quo magis ipsae 1186 omnia summo opere hos vitae poscaenia celant, 1187 quos retinere volunt adstrictosque esse in amore, 1188 ne quiquam, quoniam tu animo tamen omnia possis 1189 protrahere in lucem atque omnis inquirere risus 1190 et, si bello animost et non odiosa, vicissim 1191 praetermittere humanis concedere rebus. 1192 Nec mulier semper ficto suspirat amore, 1193 quae conplexa viri corpus cum corpore iungit 1194 et tenet adsuctis umectans oscula labris; 1195 nam facit ex animo saepe et communia quaerens 1196 gaudia sollicitat spatium decurrere amoris. 1197 nec ratione alia volucres armenta feraeque	into lips; for oft she acts Even from desire, and, seeking mutual joys, Incites him there to run love's race-course through. Nor otherwise can cattle, birds, wild beasts, And sheep and mares submit unto the males, Except that their own nature is in heat, And burns abounding and with gladness takes Once more the Venus of the mounting males. And seest thou not how those whom mutual pleasure Hath bound are tortured in their common bonds? How often in the cross-roads dogs that pant To get apart strain eagerly asunder With utmost might?- When all the while they're fast In the stout links of Venus. But they'd ne'er So pull, except they knew those mutual joys- So powerful to cast them unto snares And hold them bound. Wherefore again, again, Even as I say, there is a joint delight.
4.1198	1198 et pecudes et equae maribus subsidere possent,	

	1199 si non, ipsa quod illarum subat, ardet abundans 1200 natura et Venerem salientum laeta retractat. 1201 nonne vides etiam quos mutua saepe voluptas 1202 vinxit, ut in vinclis communibus excrucientur, 1203 in triviis cum saepe canes discedere aventis 1204 divorsi cupide summis ex viribus tendunt, 1205 quom interea validis Veneris compagibus haerent? 1206 quod facerent numquam, nisi mutua gaudia nossent, 1207 quae iacere in fraudem possent vinctosque tenere. 1208 quare etiam atque etiam, ut dico, est communis voluptas. 1209 Et commiscendo quom semine forte virilem 1210 femina vim vicit subita vi corripuitque, 1211 tum similes matrum materno semine fiunt, 1212 ut patribus patrio. sed quos utriusque figurae 1213 esse vides, iuxtim miscentes vulta parentum, 1214 corpore de patrio et materno sanguine crescunt, 1215 semina cum Veneris stimulis excita per artus 1216 obvia conflixit conspirans mutuus ardor, 1217 et neque utrum superavit eorum nec superatumst. 1218 fit quoque ut inter dum similes existere avorum 1219 possint et referant proavorum saepe figuras, 1220 propterea quia multa modis primordia multis 1221 mixta suo celant in corpore saepe parentis, 1222 quae patribus patres tradunt a stirpe profecta. 1223 inde Venus varia producit sorte figuras, 1224 maiorumque refert voltus vocesque comasque; 1225 quandoquidem nihilo magis haec semine certo 1226 fiunt quam facies et corpora membraque nobis. 1227 et muliebre oritur patrio de semine saeclum	

4.1228	1228 maternoque mares existunt corpore creti; 1229 semper enim partus duplici de semine constat, 1230 atque utri similest magis id quod cumque creatur, 1231 eius habet plus parte aequa; quod cernere possis, 1232 sive virum suboles sivest muliebris origo. 1233 Nec divina satum genitalem numina cuiquam 1234 absterrent, pater a gnatis ne dulcibus umquam 1235 appelletur et ut sterili Venere exigat aevom; 1236 quod plerumque putant et multo sanguine maesti 1237 conspergunt aras adolentque altaria donis, 1238 ut gravidas reddant uxores semine largo; 1239 ne quiquam divom numen sortisque fatigant; 1240 nam steriles nimium crasso sunt semine partim, 1241 et liquido praeter iustum tenuique vicissim. 1242 tenve locis quia non potis est adfigere adhaesum, 1243 liquitur extemplo et revocatum cedit abortu. 1244 crassius hinc porro quoniam concretius aequo 1245 mittitur, aut non tam prolixo provolat ictu 1246 aut penetrare locos aeque nequit aut penetratum 1247 aegre admiscetur muliebri semine semen. 1248 nam multum harmoniae Veneris differre videntur. 1249 atque alias alii complent magis ex aliisque 1250 succipiunt aliae pondus magis inque gravescunt. 1251 et multae steriles Hymenaeis ante fuerunt 1252 pluribus et nactae post sunt tamen unde puellos 1253 suscipere et partu possent ditescere dulci. 1254 et quibus ante domi fecundae saepe nequissent 1255 uxoris parere, inventast illis quoque compar 1256 natura, ut possent gnatis munire senectam.	

	1257 usque adeo magni refert, ut semina possint	
4.1258	1258 seminibus commisceri genitaliter apta 1259 crassaque conveniant liquidis et liquida crassis. 1260 atque in eo refert quo victu vita colatur; 1261 namque aliis rebus concrescunt semina membris 1262 atque aliis extenvantur tabentque vicissim. 1263 et quibus ipsa modis tractetur blanda voluptas. 1264 id quoque permagni refert; nam more ferarum 1265 quadrupedumque magis ritu plerumque putantur 1266 concipere uxores, quia sic loca sumere possunt 1267 pectoribus positis sublatis semina lumbis. 1268 nec molles opus sunt motus uxoribus hilum. 1269 nam mulier prohibet se concipere atque repugnat, 1270 clunibus ipsa viri Venerem si laeta retractat 1271 atque exossato ciet omni pectore fluctus; 1272 eicit enim sulcum recta regione viaque 1273 vomeris atque locis avertit seminis ictum. 1274 idque sua causa consuerunt scorta moveri, 1275 ne complerentur crebro gravidaeque iacerent, 1276 et simul ipsa viris Venus ut concinnior esset; 1277 coniugibus quod nil nostris opus esse videtur. 1278 Nec divinitus inter dum Venerisque sagittis 1279 deteriore fit ut forma muliercula ametur; 1280 nam facit ipsa suis inter dum femina factis 1281 morigerisque modis et munde corpore culto, 1282 ut facile insuescat secum degere vitam. 1283 quod super est, consuetudo concinnat amorem; 1284 nam leviter quamvis quod crebro tunditur ictu, 1285 vincitur in longo spatio tamen atque labascit.	Sometimes too It happens- and through no divinity Nor arrows of Venus- that a sorry chit Of scanty grace will be beloved by man; For sometimes she herself by very deeds, By her complying ways, and tidy habits, Will easily accustom thee to pass With her thy life-time- and, moreover, lo, Long habitude can gender human love, Even as an object smitten o'er and o'er By blows, however lightly, yet at last Is overcome and wavers. Seest thou not, Besides, how drops of water falling down Against the stones at last bore through the stones?

	1286 nonne vides etiam guttas in saxa cadentis 1287 umoris longo in spatio pertundere saxa?	
5.1	1 Quis potis est dignum pollenti pectore carmen 2 condere pro rerum maiestate hisque repertis? 3 quisve valet verbis tantum, qui fingere laudes 4 pro meritis eius possit, qui talia nobis 5 pectore parta suo quaesitaque praemia liquit? 6 nemo, ut opinor, erit mortali corpore cretus. 7 nam si, ut ipsa petit maiestas cognita rerum, 8 dicendum est, deus ille fuit, deus, inclyte Memmi, 9 qui princeps vitae rationem invenit eam quae 10 nunc appellatur sapientia, quique per artem 11 fluctibus et tantis vitam tantisque tenebris 12 in tam tranquillo et tam clara luce locavit. 13 confer enim divina aliorum antiqua reperta. 14 namque Ceres fertur fruges Liberque liquoris 15 vitigeni laticem mortalibus instituisse; 16 cum tamen his posset sine rebus vita manere, 17 ut fama est aliquas etiam nunc vivere gentis. 18 at bene non poterat sine puro pectore vivi; 19 quo magis hic merito nobis deus esse videtur, 20 ex quo nunc etiam per magnas didita gentis 21 dulcia permulcent animos solacia vitae. 22 Herculis antistare autem si facta putabis, 23 longius a vera multo ratione ferere. 24 quid Nemeaeus enim nobis nunc magnus hiatus 25 ille leonis obesset et horrens Arcadius sus, 26 tanto opere officerent nobis Stymphala colentes? 27 denique quid Cretae taurus Lernaeaque pestis 28 hydra venenatis posset vallata colubris?	O who can build with puissant breast a song Worthy the majesty of these great finds? Or who in words so strong that he can frame The fit laudations for deserts of him Who left us heritors of such vast prizes, By his own breast discovered and sought out?- There shall be none, methinks, of mortal stock. For if must needs be named for him the name Demanded by the now known majesty Of these high matters, then a god was he,- Hear me, illustrious Memmius- a god; Who first and chief found out that plan of life Which now is called philosophy, and who By cunning craft, out of such mighty waves, Out of such mighty darkness, moored life In havens so serene, in light so clear. Compare those old discoveries divine Of others: lo, according to the tale, Ceres established for mortality The grain, and Bacchus juice of vine-born grape, Though life might yet without these things abide, Even as report saith now some peoples live. But man's well-being was impossible Without a breast all free. Wherefore the more That man doth justly seem to us a god, From whom sweet solaces of life, afar Distributed o'er populous domains, Now soothe the minds of men. But if thou thinkest Labours of Hercules excel the same, Much farther from true reasoning thou farest. And walking now In his own footprints, I do follow through His reasonings, and with pronouncements teach The covenant whereby all things are framed, How under that covenant they must abide Nor ever prevail to abrogate the aeons' Inexorable decrees,- how (as we've found), In class of mortal objects, o'er all else, The mind exists of earth-born frame create And impotent unscathed to abide Across the mighty aeons, and how come In sleep those idol-apparitions, That so befool intelligence when we Do seem to view a man whom life has left. Thus far we've gone; the order of my plan Hath brought me now unto the point where I Must make report how, too, the universe Consists of mortal body, born in time, And in what modes that congregated stuff

	29 quidve tripectora tergemini vis Geryonai 30 et Diomedis equi spirantes naribus ignem	Established itself as earth and sky, Ocean, and stars, and sun, and ball of moon; And then what living creatures rose from out The old telluric places, and what ones Were never born at all; and in what mode The human race began to name its things And use the varied speech from man to man; And in what modes hath bosomed in their breasts That awe of gods, which halloweth in all lands Fanes, altars, groves, lakes, idols of the gods. Also I shall untangle by what power But ere on this I take a step to utter Oracles holier and soundlier based Than ever the Pythian pronounced for men From out the tripod and the Delphian laurel, I will unfold for thee with learned words Many a consolation, lest perchance, Still bridled by religion, thou suppose Lands, sun, and sky, sea, constellations, moon, Must dure forever, as of frame divine- And so conclude that it is just that those, (After the manner of the Giants), should all Pay the huge penalties for monstrous crime, Who by their reasonings do overshake The ramparts of the universe and wish There to put out the splendid sun of heaven, Branding with mortal talk immortal things- Though these same things are even so far removed From any touch of deity and seem So far unworthy of numbering with the gods, That well they may be thought to furnish rather A goodly instance of the sort of things That lack the living motion, living sense. For sure 'tis quite beside the mark to think That judgment and the nature of the mind In any kind of body can exist- Just as in ether can't exist a tree, Nor clouds in the salt sea, nor in the fields Can fishes live, nor blood in timber be, Nor sap in boulders: fixed and arranged Where everything may grow and have its place. Likewise, thou canst ne'er Believe the sacred seats of gods are here In any regions of this mundane world; Indeed, the nature of the gods, so subtle, So far removed from these our senses, scarce Is seen even by intelligence of mind. And since they've ever eluded touch and thrust Of human hands, they cannot reach to grasp Aught tangible to us. For what may not Itself be touched in turn can never touch. Wherefore, besides, also their seats must be Unlike these seats

		of ours,- even subtle too, As meet for subtle essence- as I'll prove Hereafter unto thee with large discourse. Further, to say that for the sake of men They willed to prepare this world's magnificence, And that 'tis therefore duty and behoof To praise the work of gods as worthy praise, And that 'tis sacrilege for men to shake Ever by any force from out their seats What hath been stablished by the Forethought old To everlasting for races of mankind, And that 'tis sacrilege to assault by words And overtopple all from base to beam,- Memmius, such notions to concoct and pile, Is verily- to dote. Our gratefulness, O what emoluments could it confer Upon Immortals and upon the Blessed That they should take a step to manage aught For sake of us? Or what new factor could,
5.31	31 Thracia Bistoniasque plagas atque Ismara propter 32 aureaque Hesperidum servans fulgentia mala, 33 asper, acerba tuens, immani corpore serpens 34 arboris amplexus stirpes? quid denique obesset 35 propter Atlanteum litus pelagique severa, 36 quo neque noster adit quisquam nec barbarus audet? 37 cetera de genere hoc quae sunt portenta perempta, 38 si non victa forent, quid tandem viva nocerent? 39 nil, ut opinor: ita ad satiatem terra ferarum 40 nunc etiam scatit et trepido terrore repleta est 41 per nemora ac montes magnos silvasque profundas; 42 quae loca vitandi plerumque est nostra potestas. 43 at nisi purgatumst pectus, quae proelia nobis 44 atque pericula tumst ingratis insinuandum! 45 quantae tum scindunt hominem cuppedinis acres 46 sollicitum curae quantique perinde timores! 47 quidve superbia spurcitia ac petulantia? quantas 48 efficiunt clades! quid luxus desidiaeque? 49 haec igitur qui cuncta subegerit ex	For what could hurt us now that mighty maw Of Nemeaean Lion, or what the Boar Who bristled in Arcadia? Or, again, O what could Cretan Bull, or Hydra, pest Of Lerna, fenced with vipers venomous? Or what the triple-breasted power of her The three-fold Geryon... The sojourners in the Stymphalian fens So dreadfully offend us, or the Steeds Of Thracian Diomedes breathing fire From out their nostrils off along the zones Bistonian and Ismarian? And the Snake, The dread fierce gazer, guardian of the golden And gleaming apples of the Hesperides, Coiled round the tree-trunk with tremendous bulk, O what, again, could he inflict on us Along the Atlantic shore and wastes of sea?- Where neither one of us approacheth nigh Nor no barbarian ventures. And the rest Of all those monsters slain, even if alive, Unconquered still, what injury could they do? None, as I guess. For so the glutted earth Swarms even now with savage beasts, even now Is filled with anxious terrors through the woods And mighty mountains and the forest deeps- Quarters 'tis ours in general to avoid. But lest the breast be purged, what conflicts then, What perils, must bosom, in our own despite! O then how great and keen the cares of lust That split the man distraught! How great the fears! The steersman nature guides the sun's courses, And the meanderings of the moon, lest we, Percase, should

	animoque 50 expulerit dictis, non armis, nonne decebit 51 hunc hominem numero divom dignarier esse? 52 cum bene praesertim multa ac divinitus ipsis 53 iam mortalibus e divis dare dicta suerit 54 atque omnem rerum naturam pandere dictis. 55 Cuius ego ingressus vestigia dum rationes 56 persequor ac doceo dictis, quo quaeque creata 57 foedere sint, in eo quam sit durare necessum 58 nec validas valeant aevi rescindere leges, 59 quo genere in primis animi natura reperta est 60 nativo primum consistere corpore creta,	fancy that of own free will They circle their perennial courses round, Timing their motions for increase of crops And living creatures, or lest we should think They roll along by any plan of gods. For even those men who have learned full well That godheads lead a long life free of care, If yet meanwhile they wonder by what plan Things can go on (and chiefly yon high things Observed o'erhead on the ethereal coasts), Again are hurried back unto the fears Of old religion and adopt again Harsh masters, deemed almighty,- wretched men, Unwitting what can be and what cannot, And by what law to each its scope prescribed, Its boundary stone that clings so deep in Time. Thus nature of mind cannot arise alone Without the body, nor have its being far From thews and blood. Yet if 'twere possible?- Much rather might this very power of mind Be in the head, the shoulders, or the heels, And, born in any part soever, yet In the same man, in the same vessel abide But since within this body even of ours Stands fixed and appears arranged sure Where soul and mind can each exist and grow, Deny we must the more that they can dure Outside the body and the breathing form In rotting clods of earth, in the sun's fire, In water, or in ether's skiey coasts. Therefore these things no whit are furnished With sense divine, since never can they be With life-force quickened. After so long a time, inveigle them- The hitherto reposeful- to desire To change their former life? For rather he Whom old things chafe seems likely to rejoice At new; but one that in fore-passed time Hath chanced upon no ill, through goodly years, O what could ever enkindle in such an one Passion for strange experiment? Or what The evil for us, if we had ne'er been born?- As though, forsooth, in darkling realms and woe Our life were lying till should dawn at last The day-spring of creation! Whosoever Hath been begotten wills perforce to stay In life, so long as fond delight detains; But whoso ne'er hath tasted love of life, And ne'er was in the count of living things, What hurts it him that he was never born? Whence, further, first was planted in the gods The archetype for gendering the world

		And the fore-notion of what man is like, So that they knew and pre-conceived with mind Just what they wished to make? Or how were known Ever the energies of primal germs, And what those germs, by interchange of place, Could thus produce, if nature's self had not Given example for creating all? For in such wise primordials of things, Many in many modes, astir by blows From immemorial aeons, in motion too By their own weights, have evermore been wont
5.61	61 nec posse incolumem magnum durare per aevum, 62 sed simulacra solere in somnis fallere mentem, 63 cernere cum videamur eum quem vita reliquit, 64 quod super est, nunc huc rationis detulit ordo, 65 ut mihi mortali consistere corpore mundum 66 nativomque simul ratio reddunda sit esse; 67 et quibus ille modis congressus materiai 68 fundarit terram caelum mare sidera solem 69 lunaique globum; tum quae tellure animantes 70 extiterint, et quae nullo sint tempore natae; 71 quove modo genus humanum variante loquella 72 coeperit inter se vesci per nomina rerum; 73 et quibus ille modis divom metus insinuarit 74 pectora, terrarum qui in orbi sancta tuetur 75 fana lacus lucos aras simulacraque divom. 76 praeterea solis cursus lunaeque meatus 77 expediam qua vi flectat natura gubernans; 78 ne forte haec inter caelum terramque reamur 79 libera sponte sua cursus lustrare perennis, 80 morigera ad fruges augendas atque animantis, 81 neve aliqua divom volvi ratione putemus. 82 nam bene qui didicere deos securum agere aevom, 83 si tamen interea mirantur qua	And lo, the pride, grim greed, and wantonness- How great the slaughters in their train! and lo, Debaucheries and every breed of sloth! Therefore that man who subjugated these, And from the mind expelled, by words indeed, Not arms, O shall it not be seemly him To dignify by ranking with the gods?- And all the more since he was wont to give, Concerning the immortal gods themselves, Many pronouncements with a tongue divine, And to unfold by his pronouncements all The nature of the world. To be so borne along and in all modes To meet together and to try all sorts Which, by combining one with other, they Are powerful to create, that thus it is No marvel now, if they have also fallen Into arrangements such, and if they've passed Into vibrations such, as those whereby This sum of things is carried on to-day By fixed renewal. The high refulgent circuits of the heavens. The plains began to sink, and windy slopes Of the high mountains to increase; for rocks Could not subside, nor all the parts of ground Settle alike to one same level there. With thunder-bolts. At last earth's Shortest-Day Bears on to men the snows and brings again The numbing cold. And Winter follows her, His teeth with chills a-chatter. Therefore, 'tis The less a marvel, if at fixed time A moon is thus begotten and again At fixed time destroyed, since things so many Can come to being thus at fixed time. Likewise, the sun's eclipses and the moon's Far occultations rightly thou mayst deem

	ratione 84 quaeque geri possint, praesertim rebus in illis 85 quae supera caput aetheriis cernuntur in oris, 86 rursus in antiquas referuntur religiones 87 et dominos acris adsciscunt, omnia posse 88 quos miseri credunt, ignari quid queat esse, 89 quid nequeat, finita potestas denique cuique 90 qua nam sit ratione atque alte terminus haerens.	
5.91	91 Quod super est, ne te in promissis plura moremur, 92 principio maria ac terras caelumque tuere; 93 quorum naturam triplicem, tria corpora, Memmi, 94 tris species tam dissimilis, tria talia texta, 95 una dies dabit exitio, multosque per annos 96 sustentata ruet moles et machina mundi. 97 nec me animi fallit quam res nova miraque menti 98 accidat exitium caeli terraeque futurum, 99 et quam difficile id mihi sit pervincere dictis; 100 ut fit ubi insolitam rem adportes auribus ante 101 nec tamen hanc possis oculorum subdere visu 102 nec iacere indu manus, via qua munita fidei 103 proxima fert humanum in pectus templaque mentis. 104 sed tamen effabor. dictis dabit ipsa fidem res 105 forsitan et graviter terrarum motibus ortis 106 omnia conquassari in parvo tempore cernes. 107 quod procul a nobis flectat fortuna gubernans, 108 et ratio potius quam res persuadeat ipsa 109 succidere horrisono posse omnia victa fragore. 110 Qua prius adgrediar quam de re fundere fata 111 sanctius et multo certa ratione magis quam 112 Pythia quae tripode a Phoebi	But for the rest,- lest we delay thee here Longer by empty promises- behold, Before all else, the seas, the lands, the sky: O Memmius, their threefold nature, lo, Their bodies three, three aspects so unlike, Three frames so vast, a single day shall give Unto annihilation! Then shall crash That massive form and fabric of the world Sustained so many aeons! Nor do I Fail to perceive how strange and marvellous This fact must strike the intellect of man,- Annihilation of the sky and earth That is to be,- and with what toil of words 'Tis mine to prove the same; as happens oft When once ye offer to man's listening ears Something before unheard of, but may not Subject it to the view of eyes for him Nor put it into hand- the sight and touch, Whereby the opened highways of belief Lead most directly into human breast And regions of intelligence. But yet I will speak out. The fact itself, perchance, Will force belief in these my words, and thou Mayst see, in little time, tremendously With risen commotions of the lands all things Quaking to pieces- which afar from us May she, the steersman Nature, guide: and may Reason, O rather than the fact itself, Persuade us that all things can be o'erthrown And sink with awful-sounding breakage down!

	lauroque profatur, 113 multa tibi expediam doctis solacia dictis; 114 religione refrenatus ne forte rearis 115 terras et solem et caelum, mare sidera lunam, 116 corpore divino debere aeterna manere, 117 proptereaque putes ritu par esse Gigantum 118 pendere eos poenas inmani pro scelere omnis, 119 qui ratione sua disturbent moenia mundi 120 praeclarumque velint caeli restinguere solem	
5.121	121 inmortalia mortali sermone notantes; 122 quae procul usque adeo divino a numine distent 123 inque deum numero quae sint indigna videri, 124 notitiam potius praebere ut posse putentur 125 quid sit vitali motu sensuque remotum. 126 quippe etenim non est, cum quovis corpore ut esse 127 posse animi natura putetur consiliumque. 128 sicut in aethere non arbor, non aequore salso 129 nubes esse queunt neque pisces vivere in arvis 130 nec cruor in lignis neque saxis sucus inesse, 131 certum ac dispositumst ubi quicquid crescat et insit, 132 sic animi natura nequit sine corpore oriri 133 sola neque a nervis et sanguine longius esse. 134 quod si posset enim, multo prius ipsa animi vis 135 in capite aut umeris aut imis calcibus esse 136 posset et innasci quavis in parte soleret, 137 tandem in eodem homine atque in eodem vase manere. 138 quod quoniam nostro quoque constat corpore certum 139 dispositumque videtur ubi esse et crescere possit 140 seorsum anima atque animus, tanto magis infitiandum 141 totum posse extra corpus formamque animalem	

	142 putribus in glebis terrarum aut solis in igni 143 aut in aqua durare aut altis aetheris oris. 144 haud igitur constant divino praedita sensu, 145 quandoquidem nequeunt vitaliter esse animata. 146 Illud item non est ut possis credere, sedes 147 esse deum sanctas in mundi partibus ullis. 148 tenvis enim natura deum longeque remota 149 sensibus ab nostris animi vix mente videtur; 150 quae quoniam manuum tactum suffugit et ictum,	
5.151	151 tactile nil nobis quod sit contingere debet; 152 tangere enim non quit quod tangi non licet ipsum. 153 quare etiam sedes quoque nostris sedibus esse 154 dissimiles debent, tenues de corpore eorum; 155 quae tibi posterius largo sermone probabo. 156 Dicere porro hominum causa voluisse parare 157 praeclaram mundi naturam proptereaque 158 adlaudabile opus divom laudare decere 159 aeternumque putare atque inmortale futurum, 160 nec fas esse, deum quod sit ratione vetusta 161 gentibus humanis fundatum perpetuo aevo, 162 sollicitare suis ulla vi ex sedibus umquam 163 nec verbis vexare et ab imo evertere summa, 164 cetera de genere hoc adfingere et addere, Memmi, 165 desiperest. quid enim inmortalibus atque beatis 166 gratia nostra queat largirier emolumenti, 167 ut nostra quicquam causa gerere adgrediantur? 168 quidve novi potuit tanto post ante quietos 169 inlicere ut cuperent vitam mutare priorem? 170 nam gaudere novis rebus debere videtur	

	171 cui veteres obsunt; sed cui nihil accidit aegri 172 tempore in ante acto, cum pulchre degeret aevom, 173 quid potuit novitatis amorem accendere tali? 174 quidve mali fuerat nobis non esse creatis? 175 an, credo, in tenebris vita ac maerore iacebat, 176 donec diluxit rerum genitalis origo? 177 natus enim debet qui cumque est velle manere 178 in vita, donec retinebit blanda voluptas; 179 qui numquam vero vitae gustavit amorem 180 nec fuit in numero, quid obest non esse creatum?	
5.181	181 exemplum porro gignundis rebus et ipsa 182 notities hominum divis unde insita primum est, 183 quid vellent facere ut scirent animoque viderent, 184 quove modost umquam vis cognita principiorum 185 quidque inter sese permutato ordine possent. 186 si non ipsa dedit speciem natura creandi? 187 namque ita multa modis multis primordia rerum 188 ex infinito iam tempore percita plagis 189 ponderibusque suis consuerunt concita ferri 190 omnimodisque coire atque omnia pertemptare, 191 quae cumque inter se possint congressa creare, 192 ut non sit mirum, si in talis disposituras 193 deciderunt quoque et in talis venere meatus, 194 qualibus haec rerum geritur nunc summa novando. 195 Quod iam rerum ignorem primordia quae sint, 196 hoc tamen ex ipsis caeli rationibus ausim 197 confirmare aliisque ex rebus reddere multis, 198 nequaquam nobis divinitus esse paratam 199 naturam rerum: tanta stat praedita culpa. 200 principio quantum caeli tegit	

	impetus ingens, 201 inde avidam partem montes silvaeque ferarum 202 possedere, tenent rupes vastaeque paludes 203 et mare, quod late terrarum distinet oras. 204 inde duas porro prope partis fervidus ardor 205 adsiduusque geli casus mortalibus aufert. 206 quod super est arvi, tamen id natura sua vi 207 sentibus obducat, ni vis humana resistat 208 vitai causa valido consueta bidenti 209 ingemere et terram pressis proscindere aratris. 210 si non fecundas vertentes vomere glebas	
5.211	211 terraique solum subigentes cimus ad ortus. 212 sponte sua nequeant liquidas existere in auras. 213 et tamen inter dum magno quaesita labore 214 cum iam per terras frondent atque omnia florent, 215 aut nimiis torret fervoribus aetherius sol 216 aut subiti peremunt imbris gelidaeque pruinae 217 flabraque ventorum violento turbine vexant. 218 praeterea genus horriferum natura ferarum 219 humanae genti infestum terraque marique 220 cur alit atque auget? cur anni tempora morbos 221 adportant? quare mors inmatura vagatur? 222 tum porro puer, ut saevis proiectus ab undis 223 navita, nudus humi iacet infans indigus omni 224 vitali auxilio, cum primum in luminis oras 225 nixibus ex alvo matris natura profudit, 226 vagituque locum lugubri complet, ut aequumst 227 cui tantum in vita restet transire malorum. 228 at variae crescunt pecudes armenta feraeque 229 nec crepitacillis opus est nec cuiquam adhibendast	And first, Since body of earth and water, air's light breath, And fiery exhalations (of which four This sum of things is seen to be compact) So all have birth and perishable frame, Thus the whole nature of the world itself Must be conceived as perishable too. For, verily, those things of which we see The parts and members to have birth in time And perishable shapes, those same we mark To be invariably born in time And born to die. And therefore when I see The mightiest members and the parts of this Our world consumed and begot again, 'Tis mine to know that also sky above And earth beneath began of old in time And shall in time go under to disaster. And lest in these affairs thou deemest me To have seized upon this point by sleight to serve My own caprice- because I have assumed That earth and fire are mortal things indeed, And have not doubted water and the air Both perish too and have affirmed the same To be again begotten and wax big- Mark well the argument: in first place, lo, Some certain parts of earth, grievously parched By unremitting suns, and trampled on By a vast throng of feet, exhale abroad A powdery haze and flying clouds of dust, Which the stout winds disperse in the whole air. A part, moreover, of her sod and soil Is summoned to inundation by the rains; And rivers graze and gouge the banks away. Besides, whatever takes a part its own In fostering and increasing

	230 almae nutricis blanda atque infracta loquella 231 nec varias quaerunt vestes pro tempore caeli, 232 denique non armis opus est, non moenibus altis, 233 qui sua tutentur, quando omnibus omnia large 234 tellus ipsa parit naturaque daedala rerum. 235 Principio quoniam terrai corpus et umor 236 aurarumque leves animae calidique vapores, 237 e quibus haec rerum consistere summa videtur, 238 omnia nativo ac mortali corpore constant, 239 debet eodem omnis mundi natura putari. 240 quippe etenim, quorum partis et membra videmus	[aught]... . . . . Is rendered back; and since, beyond a doubt, Earth, the all-mother, is beheld to be Likewise the common sepulchre of things, Therefore thou seest her minished of her plenty, And then again augmented with new growth.
5.241	241 corpore nativo mortalibus esse figuris, 242 haec eadem ferme mortalia cernimus esse 243 et nativa simul. qua propter maxima mundi 244 cum videam membra ac partis consumpta regigni, 245 scire licet caeli quoque item terraeque fuisse 246 principiale aliquod tempus clademque futuram. 247 Illud in his rebus ne corripuisse rearis 248 me mihi, quod terram atque ignem mortalia sumpsi 249 esse neque umorem dubitavi aurasque perire 250 atque eadem gigni rursusque augescere dixi. 251 principio pars terrai non nulla, perusta 252 solibus adsiduis, multa pulsata pedum vi, 253 pulveris exhalat nebulam nubesque volantis, 254 quas validi toto dispergunt aereaëre venti. 255 pars etiam glebarum ad diluviem revocatur 256 imbribus et ripas radentia flumina rodunt. 257 praeterea pro parte sua, quod cumque alit auget, 258 redditur; et quoniam dubio procul esse videtur	And for the rest, that sea, and streams, and springs Forever with new waters overflow, And that perennially the fluids well, Needeth no words- the mighty flux itself Of multitudinous waters round about Declareth this. But whatso water first Streams up is ever straightway carried off, And thus it comes to pass that all in all There is no overflow; in part because The burly winds (that over-sweep amain) And skiey sun (that with his rays dissolves) Do minish the level seas; in part because The water is diffused underground Through all the lands. The brine is filtered off, And then the liquid stuff seeps back again And all regathers at the river-heads, Whence in fresh-water currents on it flows Over the lands, adown the channels which Were cleft erstwhile and erstwhile bore along The liquid-footed floods.

	259 omniparens eadem rerum commune sepulcrum. 260 ergo terra tibi libatur et aucta recrescit. 261 Quod super est, umore novo mare flumina fontes 262 semper abundare et latices manare perennis 263 nil opus est verbis: magnus decursus aquarum 264 undique declarat. sed primum quicquid aquai 265 tollitur in summaque fit ut nihil umor abundet, 266 partim quod validi verrentes aequora venti 267 deminuunt radiisque retexens aetherius sol, 268 partim quod supter per terras diditur omnis; 269 percolatur enim virus retroque remanat 270 materies umoris et ad caput amnibus omnis	
5.271	271 convenit, inde super terras fluit agmine dulci 272 qua via secta semel liquido pede detulit undas. 273 AeraAëra nunc igitur dicam, qui corpore toto 274 innumerabiliter privas mutatur in horas. 275 semper enim, quod cumque fluit de rebus, id omne 276 aerisaëris in magnum fertur mare; qui nisi contra 277 corpora retribuat rebus recreetque fluentis, 278 omnia iam resoluta forent et in aeraaëra versa. 279 haut igitur cessat gigni de rebus et in res 280 reccidere, adsidue quoniam fluere omnia constat. 281 Largus item liquidi fons luminis, aetherius sol, 282 inrigat adsidue caelum candore recenti 283 suppeditatque novo confestim lumine lumen. 284 nam primum quicquid fulgoris disperit ei, 285 quo cumque accidit. id licet hinc cognoscere possis, 286 quod simul ac primum nubes succedere soli 287 coepere et radios inter quasi rumpere lucis,	Now, then, of air I'll speak, which hour by hour in all its body Is changed innumerably. For whatso'er Streams up in dust or vapour off of things, The same is all and always borne along Into the mighty ocean of the air; And did not air in turn restore to things Bodies, and thus recruit them as they stream, All things by this time had resolved been And changed into air. Therefore it never Ceases to be engendered off of things And to return to things, since verily In constant flux do all things stream. Likewise, The abounding well-spring of the liquid light, The ethereal sun, doth flood the heaven o'er With constant flux of radiance ever new, And with fresh light supplies the place of light, Upon the instant. For whatever effulgence Hath first streamed off, no matter where it falls, Is lost unto the sun. And this 'tis thine To know from these examples: soon as clouds Have first begun to under-pass the sun, And, as it were, to rend the rays of light In twain, at once the lower part of them Is lost entire, and earth is overcast Where'er the thunderheads are rolled along- So know thou mayst that things forever need A fresh replenishment of gleam and glow, And each effulgence, foremost flashed forth, Perisheth one by one. Nor otherwise Can things be seen in sunlight, lest alway The

	288 extemplo inferior pars horum disperit omnis 289 terraque inumbratur qua nimbi cumque feruntur; 290 ut noscas splendore novo res semper egere 291 et primum iactum fulgoris quemque perire 292 nec ratione alia res posse in sole videri, 293 perpetuo ni suppeditet lucis caput ipsum. 294 quin etiam nocturna tibi, terrestria quae sunt, 295 lumina, pendentes lychni claraeque coruscis 296 fulguribus pingues multa caligine taedae 297 consimili properant ratione, ardore ministro, 298 suppeditare novom lumen, tremere ignibus instant, 299 instant, nec loca lux inter quasi rupta relinquit: 300 usque adeo properanter ab omnibus ignibus ei	fountain-head of light supply new light. Indeed your earthly beacons of the night, The hanging lampions and the torches, bright With darting gleams and dense with livid soot, Do hurry in like manner to supply With ministering heat new light amain; Are all alive to quiver with their fires,- Are so alive, that thus the light ne'er leaves The spots it shines on, as if rent in twain: So speedily is its destruction veiled By the swift birth of flame from all the fires. Thus, then, we must suppose that sun and moon And stars dart forth their light from under-births Ever and ever new, and whatso flames First rise do perish always one by one- Lest, haply, thou shouldst think they each endure Inviolable.
5.301	301 exitium celeri celeratur origine flammae. 302 sic igitur solem lunam stellasque putandum 303 ex alio atque alio lucem iactare subortu 304 et primum quicquid flammarum perdere semper, 305 inviolabilia haec ne credas forte vigere. 306 Denique non lapides quoque vinci cernis ab aevo, 307 non altas turris ruere et putrescere saxa, 308 non delubra deum simulacraque fessa fatisci 309 nec sanctum numen fati protollere finis 310 posse neque adversus naturae foedera niti? 311 denique non monimenta virum dilapsa videmus, 312 313 non ruere avolsos silices a montibus altis 314 nec validas aevi vires perferre patique 315 finiti? neque enim caderent avolsa repente, 316 ex infinito quae tempore pertolerassent 317 omnia tormenta aetatis, privata	Again, perceivest not How stones are also conquered by Time?- Not how the lofty towers ruin down, And boulders crumble?- Not how shrines of gods And idols crack outworn?- Nor how indeed The holy Influence hath yet no power There to postpone the Terminals of Fate, Or headway make 'gainst Nature's fixed decrees? Again, behold we not the monuments Of heroes, now in ruins, asking us, In their turn likewise, if we don't believe They also age with eld? Behold we not The rended basalt ruining amain Down from the lofty mountains, powerless To dure and dree the mighty forces there Of finite time?- for they would never fall Rended asudden, if from infinite Past They had prevailed against all engin'ries Of the assaulting aeons, with no crash. Again, now look at This, which round, above, Contains the whole earth in its one embrace: If from itself it procreates all things- As some men tell- and takes them to itself When once destroyed, entirely must it be Of mortal birth and body; for whate'er From out itself giveth to other things Increase and food, the same perforce must be Minished, and then recruited when it takes Things back into itself. Besides all this, If there had been no

	fragore. 318 Denique iam tuere hoc, circum supraque quod omne 319 continet amplexu terram: si procreat ex se 320 omnia, quod quidam memorant, recipitque perempta, 321 totum nativum mortali corpore constat. 322 nam quod cumque alias ex se res auget alitque, 323 deminui debet, recreari, cum recipit res. 324 Praeterea si nulla fuit genitalis origo 325 terrarum et caeli semperque aeterna fuere, 326 cur supera bellum Thebanum et funera Troiae 327 non alias alii quoque res cecinere poetaepoëtae? 328 quo tot facta virum totiens cecidere neque usquam 329 aeternis famae monimentis insita florent? 330 verum, ut opinor, habet novitatem summa recensque	origin-in-birth Of lands and sky, and they had ever been The everlasting, why, ere Theban war And obsequies of Troy, have other bards Not also chanted other high affairs? Whither have sunk so oft so many deeds Of heroes? Why do those deeds live no more, Ingrafted in eternal monuments Of glory? Verily, I guess, because The Sum is new, and of a recent date The nature of our universe, and had Not long ago its own exordium. Wherefore, even now some arts are being still Refined, still increased: now unto ships Is being added many a new device; And but the other day musician-folk Gave birth to melic sounds of organing; And, then, this nature, this account of things Hath been discovered latterly, and I Myself have been discovered only now, As first among the first, able to turn The same into ancestral Roman speech. Yet if, percase, thou deemest that ere this Existed all things even the same, but that Perished the cycles of the human race In fiery exhalations, or cities fell By some tremendous quaking of the world, Or rivers in fury, after constant rains, Had plunged forth across the lands of earth And whelmed the towns- then, all the more must thou Confess, defeated by the argument, That there shall be annihilation too Of lands and sky. For at a time when things Were being taxed by maladies so great, And so great perils, if some cause more fell Had then assailed them, far and wide they would Have gone to disaster and supreme collapse. And by no other reasoning are we Seen to be mortal, save that all of us Sicken in turn with those same maladies With which have sickened in the past those men Whom nature hath removed from life.
5.331	331 naturast mundi neque pridem exordia cepit. 332 quare etiam quaedam nunc artes expoliuntur, 333 nunc etiam augescunt; nunc addita navigiis sunt 334 multa, modo organici melicos peperere sonores, 335 denique natura haec rerum ratioque repertast 336 nuper, et hanc primus cum primis ipse repertus 337 nunc ego sum in patrias qui possim	

	vertere voces. 338 Quod si forte fuisse ante hac eadem omnia credis, 339 sed periise hominum torrenti saecla vapore, 340 aut cecidisse urbis magno vexamine mundi, 341 aut ex imbribus adsiduis exisse rapaces 342 per terras amnes atque oppida coperuisse. 343 tanto quique magis victus fateare necessest 344 exitium quoque terrarum caelique futurum; 345 nam cum res tantis morbis tantisque periclis 346 temptarentur, ibi si tristior incubuisset 347 causa, darent late cladem magnasque ruinas. 348 nec ratione alia mortales esse videmur, 349 inter nos nisi quod morbis aegrescimus isdem 350 atque illi quos a vita natura removit. 351 Praeterea quae cumque manent aeterna necessust 352 aut, quia sunt solido cum corpore, respuere ictus 353 nec penetrare pati sibi quicquam quod queat artas 354 dissociare intus partis, ut materiai 355 corpora sunt, quorum naturam ostendimus ante, 356 aut ideo durare aetatem posse per omnem, 357 plagarum quia sunt expertia, sicut inane est, 358 quod manet intactum neque ab ictu fungitur hilum, 359 aut etiam quia nulla loci sit copia circum, 360 quo quasi res possint discedere dissoluique,	
5.361	361 sicut summarum summa est aeterna, neque extra 362 qui locus est quo dissiliant neque corpora sunt quae 363 possint incidere et valida dissolvere plaga. 364 at neque, uti docui, solido cum corpore mundi 365 naturast, quoniam admixtumst in rebus inane, 366 nec tamen est ut inane, neque autem corpora desunt,	

	367 ex infinito quae possint forte coorta 368 corruere hanc rerum violento turbine summam 369 aut aliam quamvis cladem inportare pericli, 370 nec porro natura loci spatiumque profundi 371 deficit, exspargi quo possint moenia mundi, 372 aut alia quavis possunt vi pulsa perire. 373 haut igitur leti praeclusa est ianua caelo 374 nec soli terraeque neque altis aequoris undis, 375 sed patet immani et vasto respectat hiatu. 376 quare etiam nativa necessumst confiteare 377 haec eadem; neque enim, mortali corpore quae sunt, 378 ex infinito iam tempore adhuc potuissent 379 inmensi validas aevi contemnere vires. 380 Denique tantopere inter se cum maxima mundi 381 pugnent membra, pio nequaquam concita bello, 382 nonne vides aliquam longi certaminis ollis 383 posse dari finem, vel cum sol et vapor omnis 384 omnibus epotis umoribus exsuperarint? 385 quod facere intendunt, neque adhuc conata patrantur; 386 tantum suppeditant amnes ultraque minantur 387 omnia diluviare ex alto gurgite ponti: 388 ne quiquam, quoniam verrentes aequora venti 389 deminuunt radiisque retexens aetherius sol, 390 et siccare prius confidunt omnia posse	
5.391	391 quam liquor incepti possit contingere finem. 392 tantum spirantes aequo certamine bellum 393 magnis de rebus cernere certant, 394 cum semel interea fuerit superantior ignis 395 et semel, ut fama est, umor regnarit in arvis. 396 ignis enim superavit et ambiens multa perussit,	But in what modes that conflux of first-stuff Did found the multitudinous universe Of earth, and sky, and the unfathomed deeps Of ocean, and courses of the sun and moon, I'll now in order tell. For of a truth Neither by counsel did the primal germs 'Stablish themselves, as by keen act of mind, Each in its proper place; nor did they make, Forsooth, a compact how each germ should move; But, lo, because

	397 avia cum Phaethonta rapax vis solis equorum 398 aethere raptavit toto terrasque per omnis. 399 at pater omnipotens ira tum percitus acri 400 magnanimum Phaethonta repenti fulminis ictu 401 deturbavit equis in terram, Solque cadenti 402 obvius aeternam succepit lampada mundi 403 disiectosque redegit equos iunxitque trementis, 404 inde suum per iter recreavit cuncta gubernans, 405 scilicet ut veteres Graium cecinere poetaepoëtae. 406 quod procul a vera nimis est ratione repulsum. 407 ignis enim superare potest ubi materiai 408 ex infinito sunt corpora plura coorta; 409 inde cadunt vires aliqua ratione revictae, 410 aut pereunt res exustae torrentibus auris. 411 umor item quondam coepit superare coortus, 412 ut fama est, hominum vitas quando obruit undis; 413 inde ubi vis aliqua ratione aversa recessit, 414 ex infinito fuerat quae cumque coorta, 415 constiterunt imbres et flumina vim minuerunt. 416 Sed quibus ille modis coniectus materiai 417 fundarit terram et caelum pontique profunda, 418 solis lunai cursus, ex ordine ponam. 419 nam certe neque consilio primordia rerum 420 ordine se suo quaeque sagaci mente locarunt	primordials of things, Many in many modes, astir by blows From immemorial aeons, in motion too By their own weights, have evermore been wont To be so borne along and in all modes To meet together and to try all sorts Which, by combining one with other, they Are powerful to create: because of this It comes to pass that those primordials, Diffused far and wide through mighty aeons, The while they unions try, and motions too, Of every kind, meet at the last amain, And so become oft the commencements fit Of mighty things- earth, sea, and sky, and race Of living creatures.
5.421	421 nec quos quaeque darent motus pepigere profecto; 422 sed quia multa modis multis primordia rerum 423 ex infinito iam tempore percita plagis 424 ponderibusque suis consuerunt concita ferri 425 omnimodisque coire atque omnia pertemptare,	

	426 quae cumque inter se possent congressa creare, 427 propterea fit uti magnum volgata per aevom 428 omnigenus coetus et motus experiundo 429 tandem conveniant ea quae coniecta repente 430 magnarum rerum fiunt exordia saepe, 431 terrai maris et caeli generisque animantum. 432 Hic neque tum solis rota cerni lumine largo 433 altivolans poterat nec magni sidera mundi 434 nec mare nec caelum nec denique terra neque aeraër 435 nec similis nostris rebus res ulla videri, 436 sed nova tempestas quaedam molesque coorta. 437 diffugere inde loci partes coepere paresque 438 cum paribus iungi res et discludere mundum 439 membraque dividere et magnas disponere partes 440 omnigenis e principiis, discordia quorum 441 intervalla vias conexus pondera plagas 442 concursus motus turbabat proelia miscens 443 propter dissimilis formas variasque figuras, 444 quod non omnia sic poterant coniuncta manere 445 nec motus inter sese dare convenientis, 446 hoc est, a terris altum secernere caelum, 447 et sorsum mare, uti secreto umore pateret, 448 seorsus item puri secretique aetheris ignes. 449 Quippe etenim primum terrai corpora quaeque, 450 propterea quod erant gravia et perplexa, coibant	
5.451	451 in medio atque imas capiebant omnia sedes; 452 quae quanto magis inter se perplexa coibant, 453 tam magis expressere ea quae mare sidera solem 454 lunamque efficerent et magni moenia mundi;	

	455 omnia enim magis haec e levibus atque rutundis 456 seminibus multoque minoribus sunt elementis 457 quam tellus. ideo per rara foramina terrae 458 partibus erumpens primus se sustulit aether 459 ignifer et multos secum levis abstulit ignis, 460 non alia longe ratione ac saepe videmus, 461 aurea cum primum gemmantis rore per herbas 462 matutina rubent radiati lumina solis 463 exhalantque lacus nebulam fluviique perennes 464 ipsaque ut inter dum tellus fumare videtur; 465 omnia quae sursum cum conciliantur, in alto 466 corpore concreto subtexunt nubila caelum. 467 sic igitur tum se levis ac diffusilis aether 468 corpore concreto circum datus undique saepsit 469 et late diffusus in omnis undique partis 470 omnia sic avido complexu cetera saepsit. 471 hunc exordia sunt solis lunaeque secuta, 472 interutrasque globi quorum vertuntur in auris; 473 quae neque terra sibi adscivit nec maximus aether, 474 quod neque tam fuerunt gravia ut depressa sederent, 475 nec levia ut possent per summas labier oras, 476 et tamen interutrasque ita sunt, ut corpora viva 477 versent et partes ut mundi totius extent; 478 quod genus in nobis quaedam licet in statione 479 membra manere, tamen cum sint ea quae moveantur. 480 his igitur rebus retractis terra repente,	
5.481	481 maxuma qua nunc se ponti plaga caerula tendit, 482 succidit et salso suffudit gurgite fossas. 483 inque dies quanto circum magis aetheris aestus	Thus, then, the massy weight of earth stood firm With now concreted body, when (as 'twere) All of the slime of the world, heavy and gross, Had run together and settled at the bottom, Like lees or bilge. Then ocean, then the air,

	484 et radii solis cogebant undique terram 485 verberibus crebris extrema ad limina fartam 486 in medio ut propulsa suo condensa coiret, 487 tam magis expressus salsus de corpore sudor 488 augebat mare manando camposque natantis, 489 et tanto magis illa foras elapsa volabant 490 corpora multa vaporis et aerisaëris altaque caeli 491 densabant procul a terris fulgentia templa. 492 sidebant campi, crescebant montibus altis 493 ascensus; neque enim poterant subsidere saxa 494 nec pariter tantundem omnes succumbere partis. 495 Sic igitur terrae concreto corpore pondus 496 constitit atque omnis mundi quasi limus in imum 497 confluxit gravis et subsedit funditus ut faex; 498 inde mare, inde aeraër, inde aether ignifer ipse 499 corporibus liquidis sunt omnia pura relicta 500 et leviora aliis alia, et liquidissimus aether 501 atque levissimus aeriasaërias super influit auras 502 nec liquidum corpus turbantibus aerisaëris auris 503 commiscet; sinit haec violentis omnia verti 504 turbinibus, sinit incertis turbare procellis, 505 ipse suos ignis certo fert impete labens. 506 nam modice fluere atque uno posse aethera nisu 507 significat Pontos, mare certo quod fluit aestu 508 unum labendi conservans usque tenorem. 509 Motibus astrorum nunc quae sit causa canamus. 510 principio magnus caeli si vortitur orbis,	Then ether herself, the fraught-with-fire, were all Left with their liquid bodies pure and free, And each more lighter than the next below; And ether, most light and liquid of the three, Floats on above the long aerial winds, Nor with the brawling of the winds of air Mingles its liquid body. It doth leave All there- those under-realms below her heights- There to be overset in whirlwinds wild,- Doth leave all there to brawl in wayward gusts, Whilst, gliding with a fixed impulse still, Itself it bears its fires along. For, lo, That ether can flow thus steadily on, on, With one unaltered urge, the Pontus proves- That sea which floweth forth with fixed tides, Keeping one onward tenor as it glides. Now let us sing what makes the stars to move. In first place, if the mighty sphere of heaven Revolveth round, then needs we must aver That on the upper and the under pole Presses a certain air, and from without Confines them and encloseth at each end; And that, moreover, another air above Streams on athwart the top of the sphere and tends In same direction as are rolled along The glittering stars of the eternal world; Or that another still streams on below To whirl the sphere from under up and on In opposite direction- as we see The rivers turn the wheels and water-scoops. It may be also that the heavens do all Remain at rest, whilst yet are borne along The lucid constellations; either because Swift tides of ether are by sky enclosed, And whirl around, seeking a passage out, And everywhere make roll the starry fires Through the Summanian regions of the sky; Or else because some air, streaming along From an eternal quarter off beyond, Whileth the driven fires, or, then, because The fires themselves have power to creep along, Going wherever their food invites and calls, And feeding their flaming bodies everywhere Throughout the sky. Yet which of these is cause In this our world 'tis hard to say for sure; But what can be throughout the universe, In divers worlds on divers plan create, This only do I show, and follow on To assign unto the motions of the stars Even several causes which 'tis possible Exist throughout the universal All; Of which yet one must be the cause even

		here Which maketh motion for our constellations. Yet to decide which one of them it be Is not the least the business of a man Advancing step by cautious step, as I.
5.511	511 ex utraque polum parti premere aeraaëra nobis 512 dicendum est extraque tenere et claudere utrimque; 513 inde alium supra fluere atque intendere eodem 514 quo volvenda micant aeterni sidera mundi; 515 aut alium supter, contra qui subvehat orbem, 516 ut fluvios versare rotas atque austra videmus. 517 est etiam quoque uti possit caelum omne manere 518 in statione, tamen cum lucida signa ferantur, 519 sive quod inclusi rapidi sunt aetheris aestus 520 quaerentesque viam circum versantur et ignes 521 passim per caeli volvunt summania templa, 522 sive aliunde fluens alicunde extrinsecus aeraër 523 versat agens ignis, sive ipsi serpere possunt, 524 quo cuiusque cibus vocat atque invitat euntis, 525 flammea per caelum pascentis corpora passim. 526 nam quid in hoc mundo sit eorum ponere certum 527 difficilest; sed quid possit fiatque per omne 528 in variis mundis varia ratione creatis, 529 id doceo plurisque sequor disponere causas, 530 motibus astrorum quae possint esse per omne; 531 e quibus una tamen sit et haec quoque causa necessest, 532 quae vegeat motum signis; sed quae sit earum 533 praecipere haud quaquamst pedetemptim progredientis. 534 Terraque ut in media mundi regione quiescat, 535 evanescere paulatim et decrescere pondus 536 convenit atque aliam naturam supter habere 537 ex ineunte aevo coniunctam atque	And that the earth may there abide at rest In the mid-region of the world, it needs Must vanish bit by bit in weight and lessen, And have another substance underneath, Conjoined to it from its earliest age In linked unison with the vasty world's Realms of the air in which it roots and lives. On this account, the earth is not a load, Nor presses down on winds of air beneath; Even as unto a man his members be Without all weight- the head is not a load Unto the neck; nor do we feel the whole Weight of the body to centre in the feet. But whatso weights come on us from without, Weights laid upon us, these harass and chafe, Though often far lighter. For to such degree It matters always what the innate powers Of any given thing may be. The earth Was, then, no alien substance fetched amain, And from no alien firmament cast down On alien air; but was conceived, like air, In the first origin of this the world, As a fixed portion of the same, as now Our members are seen to be a part of us. Besides, the earth, when of a sudden shook By the big thunder, doth with her motion shake All that's above her- which she ne'er could do By any means, were earth not bounden fast Unto the great world's realms of air and sky: For they cohere together with common roots, Conjoined both, even from their earliest age, In linked unison. Aye, seest thou not That this most subtle energy of soul Supports our body, though so heavy a weight,- Because, indeed, 'tis with it so conjoined In linked unison? What power, in sum, Can raise with agile leap our body aloft, Save energy of mind which steers the limbs? Now seest thou not how powerful may be A subtle nature, when conjoined it is With heavy body, as air is with the earth Conjoined, and energy of mind with us?

	uniter aptam 538 partibus aeriisaëriis mundi, quibus insita vivit. 539 propterea non est oneri neque deprimit auras, 540 ut sua cuique homini nullo sunt pondere membra	
5.541	541 nec caput est oneri collo nec denique totum 542 corporis in pedibus pondus sentimus inesse; 543 at quae cumque foris veniunt inpostaque nobis 544 pondera sunt laedunt, permulto saepe minora. 545 usque adeo magni refert quid quaeque queat res. 546 sic igitur tellus non est aliena repente 547 allata atque auris aliunde obiecta alienis, 548 sed pariter prima concepta ab origine mundi 549 certaque pars eius, quasi nobis membra videntur. 550 Praeterea grandi tonitru concussa repente 551 terra supra quae se sunt concutit omnia motu; 552 quod facere haut ulla posset ratione, nisi esset 553 partibus aeriisaëriis mundi caeloque revincta; 554 nam communibus inter se radicibus haerent 555 ex ineunte aevo coniuncta atque uniter aucta. 556 Nonne vides etiam quam magno pondere nobis 557 sustineat corpus tenuissima vis animai, 558 propterea quia tam coniuncta atque uniter apta est? 559 Denique iam saltu pernici tollere corpus 560 quid potis est nisi vis animae, quae membra gubernat? 561 iamne vides quantum tenuis natura valere 562 possit, ubi est coniuncta gravi cum corpore, ut aeraër 563 coniunctus terris et nobis est animi vis? 564 Nec nimio solis maior rota nec minor ardor 565 esse potest, nostris quam sensibus esse videtur. 566 nam quibus e spatiis cumque ignes	Nor can the sun's wheel larger be by much Nor its own blaze much less than either seems Unto our senses. For from whatso spaces Fires have the power on us to cast their beams And blow their scorching exhalations forth Against our members, those same distances Take nothing by those intervals away From bulk of flames; and to the sight the fire Is nothing shrunken. Therefore, since the heat And the outpoured light of skiey sun Arrive our senses and caress our limbs, Form too and bigness of the sun must look Even here from earth just as they really be, So that thou canst scarce nothing take or add. And whether the journeying moon illuminate The regions round with bastard beams, or throw From off her proper body her own light,- Whichever it be, she journeys with a form Naught larger than the form doth seem to be Which we with eyes of ours perceive. For all The far removed objects of our gaze Seem through much air confused in their look Ere minished in their bigness. Wherefore, moon, Since she presents bright look and clear-cut form, May there on high by us on earth be seen Just as she is with extreme bounds defined, And just of the size. And lastly, whatso fires Of ether thou from earth beholdest, these Thou mayst consider as possibly of size The least bit less, or larger by a hair Than they appear- since whatso fires we view Here in the lands of earth are seen to change From time to time their size to less or more Only the least, when more or less away, So long as still they bicker clear, and still Their glow's perceived.

	lumina possunt 567 adiicere et calidum membris adflare vaporem, 568 nil magnis intervallis de corpore libant 569 flammarum, nihil ad speciem est contractior ignis. 570 proinde, calor quoniam solis lumenque profusum	
5.571	571 perveniunt nostros ad sensus et loca fulgent, 572 forma quoque hinc solis debet filumque videri, 573 nil adeo ut possis plus aut minus addere vere. 574 575 lunaque sive notho fertur loca lumine lustrans, 576 sive suam proprio iactat de corpore lucem, 577 quidquid id est, nihilo fertur maiore figura 578 quam, nostris oculis qua cernimus, esse videtur. 579 nam prius omnia, quae longe semota tuemur 580 aeraaëra per multum, specie confusa videntur 581 quam minui filum. quapropter luna necesse est, 582 quandoquidem claram speciem certamque figuram 583 praebet, ut est oris extremis cumque notata, 584 quanta quoquest, tanta hinc nobis videatur in alto. 585 postremo quos cumque vides hinc aetheris ignes, 586 scire licet perquam pauxillo posse minores 587 esse vel exigua maioris parte brevique. 588 quandoquidem quos cumque in terris cernimus , 589 dum tremor clarus dum cernitur ardor eorum, 590 perparvom quiddam inter dum mutare videntur 591 alteram utram in partem filum, quo longius absunt. 592 Illud item non est mirandum, qua ratione 593 tantulus ille queat tantum sol mittere lumen, 594 quod maria ac terras omnis caelumque rigando 595 compleat et calido perfundat cuncta vapore.	

	596 597 nam licet hinc mundi patefactum totius unum 598 largifluum fontem scatere atque erumpere lumen, 599 ex omni mundo quia sic elementa vaporis 600 undique conveniunt et sic coniectus eorum	
5.601	601 confluit, ex uno capite hic ut profluat ardor. 602 nonne vides etiam quam late parvus aquai 603 prata riget fons inter dum campisque redundet? 604 est etiam quoque uti non magno solis ab igni 605 aeraaëra percipiat calidis fervoribus ardor, 606 opportunus ita est si forte et idoneus aeraër, 607 ut queat accendi parvis ardoribus ictus; 608 quod genus inter dum segetes stipulamque videmus 609 accidere ex una scintilla incendia passim. 610 forsitan et rosea sol alte lampade lucens 611 possideat multum caecis fervoribus ignem 612 circum se, nullo qui sit fulgore notatus, 613 aestifer ut tantum radiorum exaugeat ictum. 614 Nec ratio solis simplex recta patescit, 615 quo pacto aestivis e partibus aegocerotis 616 brumalis adeat flexus atque inde revertens 617 canceris ut vertat metas ad solstitialis, 618 lunaque mensibus id spatium videatur obire, 619 annua sol in quo consumit tempora cursu. 620 non, inquam, simplex his rebus reddita causast. 621 nam fieri vel cum primis id posse videtur, 622 Democriti quod sancta viri sententia ponit, 623 quanto quaeque magis sint terram sidera propter, 624 tanto posse minus cum caeli turbine ferri; 625 evanescere enim rapidas illius et	

	acris 626 imminui supter viris, ideoque relinqui 627 paulatim solem cum posterioribus signis, 628 inferior multo quod sit quam fervida signa. 629 et magis hoc lunam: quanto demissior eius 630 cursus abest procul a caelo terrisque propinquat,	
5.631	631 tanto posse minus cum signis tendere cursum. 632 flaccidiore etiam quanto iam turbine fertur 633 inferior quam sol, tanto magis omnia signa 634 hanc adipiscuntur circum praeterque feruntur. 635 propterea fit ut haec ad signum quodque reverti 636 mobilius videatur, ad hanc quia signa revisunt. 637 fit quoque ut e mundi transversis partibus aeraër 638 alternis certo fluere alter tempore possit, 639 qui queat aestivis solem detrudere signis 640 brumalis usque ad flexus gelidumque rigorem, 641 et qui reiciat gelidis a frigoris umbris 642 aestiferas usque in partis et fervida signa. 643 et ratione pari lunam stellasque putandumst, 644 quae volvunt magnos in magnis orbibus annos, 645 aeribusaëribus posse alternis e partibus ire. 646 nonne vides etiam diversis nubila ventis 647 diversas ire in partis inferna supernis? 648 qui minus illa queant per magnos aetheris orbis 649 aestibus inter se diversis sidera ferri? 650 At nox obruit ingenti caligine terras, 651 aut ubi de longo cursu sol ultima caeli 652 impulit atque suos efflavit languidus ignis 653 concussos itere et labefactos aereaëre multo, 654 aut quia sub terras cursum	But night o'erwhelms the lands with vasty murk Either when sun, after his diurnal course, Hath walked the ultimate regions of the sky And wearily hath panted forth his fires, Shivered by their long journeying and wasted By traversing the multitudinous air, Or else because the self-same force that drave His orb along above the lands compels Him then to turn his course beneath the lands. Matuta also at a fixed hour Spreadeth the roseate morning out along The coasts of heaven and deploys the light, Either because the self-same sun, returning Under the lands, aspires to seize the sky, Striving to set it blazing with his rays Ere he himself appear, or else because Fires then will congregate and many seeds Of heat are wont, even at a fixed time, To stream together- gendering evermore New suns and light. Just so the story goes That from the Idaean mountain-tops are seen Dispersed fires upon the break of day Which thence combine, as 'twere, into one ball And form an orb. Nor yet in these affairs Is aught for wonder that these seeds of fire Can thus together stream at time so fixed And shape anew the splendour of the sun. For many facts we see which come to pass At fixed time in all things: burgeon shrubs At fixed time, and at a fixed time They cast their flowers; and Eld commands the teeth, At time as surely fixed, to drop away, And Youth commands the growing boy to bloom With the soft down and let from both his cheeks The soft beard fall. And lastly, thunder-bolts, Snow, rains, clouds, winds, at seasons of the year Nowise unfixed, all do come to pass. For where, even from their old primordial start Causes have ever worked in such a way, And where, even from the world's first origin, Thuswise have things befallen, so even now After

	convortere cogit 655 vis eadem, supra quae terras pertulit orbem. 656 Tempore item certo roseam Matuta per oras 657 aetheris auroram differt et lumina pandit, 658 aut quia sol idem, sub terras ille revertens, 659 anticipat caelum radiis accendere temptans, 660 aut quia conveniunt ignes et semina multa	a fixed order they come round In sequence also.
5.661	661 confluere ardoris consuerunt tempore certo, 662 quae faciunt solis nova semper lumina gigni; 663 quod genus Idaeis fama est e montibus altis 664 dispersos ignis orienti lumine cerni, 665 inde coire globum quasi in unum et conficere orbem. 666 nec tamen illud in his rebus mirabile debet 667 esse, quod haec ignis tam certo tempore possint 668 semina confluere et solis reparare nitorem. 669 multa videmus enim, certo quae tempore fiunt 670 omnibus in rebus. florescunt tempore certo 671 arbusta et certo dimittunt tempore florem. 672 nec minus in certo dentes cadere imperat aetas 673 tempore et inpubem molli pubescere veste 674 et pariter mollem malis demittere barbam. 675 fulmina postremo nix imbres nubila venti 676 non nimis incertis fiunt in partibus anni. 677 namque ubi sic fuerunt causarum exordia prima 678 atque ita res mundi cecidere ab origine prima, 679 conseque quoque iam redeunt ex ordine certo. 680 Crescere itemque dies licet et tabescere noctes, 681 et minui luces, cum sumant augmina noctis, 682 aut quia sol idem sub terras atque superne 683 imparibus currens amfractibus	

	aetheris oras 684 partit et in partis non aequas dividit orbem, 685 et quod ab alterutra detraxit parte, reponit 686 eius in adversa tanto plus parte relatus, 687 donec ad id signum caeli pervenit, ubi anni 688 nodus nocturnas exaequat lucibus umbras; 689 nam medio cursu flatus aquilonis et austri 690 distinet aequato caelum discrimine metas	
5.691	691 propter signiferi posituram totius orbis, 692 annua sol in quo concludit tempora serpens, 693 obliquo terras et caelum lumine lustrans, 694 ut ratio declarat eorum qui loca caeli 695 omnia dispositis signis ornata notarunt. 696 aut quia crassior est certis in partibus aeraër, 697 sub terris ideo tremulum iubar haesitat ignis 698 nec penetrare potest facile atque emergere ad ortus; 699 propterea noctes hiberno tempore longae 700 cessant, dum veniat radiatum insigne diei. 701 aut etiam, quia sic alternis partibus anni 702 tardius et citius consuerunt confluere ignes, 703 qui faciunt solem certa de surgere parte, 704 propterea fit uti videantur dicere verum. 705 Luna potest solis radiis percussa nitere 706 inque dies magis lumen convertere nobis 707 ad speciem, quantum solis secedit ab orbi, 708 donique eum contra pleno bene lumine fulsit 709 atque oriens obitus eius super edita vidit; 710 inde minutatim retro quasi condere lumen 711 debet item, quanto propius iam solis ad ignem 712 labitur ex alia signorum parte per	

	orbem; 713 ut faciunt, lunam qui fingunt esse pilai 714 consimilem cursusque viam sub sole tenere. 715 est etiam quare proprio cum lumine possit 716 volvier et varias splendoris reddere formas; 717 corpus enim licet esse aliud, quod fertur et una 718 labitur omnimodis occursans officiensque, 719 nec potis est cerni, quia cassum lumine fertur. 720 versarique potest, globus ut, si forte, pilai	
5.721	721 dimidia ex parti candenti lumine tinctus, 722 versandoque globum variantis edere formas, 723 donique eam partem, quae cumque est ignibus aucta, 724 ad speciem vertit nobis oculosque patentis; 725 inde minutatim retro contorquet et aufert 726 luciferam partem glomeraminis atque pilai; 727 ut Babylonica Chaldaeum doctrina refutans 728 astrologorum artem contra convincere tendit, 729 proinde quasi id fieri nequeat quod pugnat uterque 730 aut minus hoc illo sit cur amplectier ausis. 731 denique cur nequeat semper nova luna creari 732 ordine formarum certo certisque figuris 733 inque dies privos aborisci quaeque creata 734 atque alia illius reparari in parte locoque, 735 difficilest ratione docere et vincere verbis, 736 ordine cum tam certo multa creari. 737 it Ver et Venus et Veneris praenuntius ante 738 pennatus graditur, Zephyri vestigia propter 739 Flora quibus mater praespargens ante viai 740 cuncta coloribus egregiis et odoribus opplet. 741 inde loci sequitur Calor aridus et comes una	

	742 pulverulenta Ceres etesia flabra aquilonum. 743 inde Autumnus adit, graditur simul Euhius Euan. 744 inde aliae tempestates ventique secuntur, 745 altitonans Volturnus et Auster fulmine pollens. 746 tandem Bruma nives adfert pigrumque rigorem 747 reddit. Hiemps sequitur crepitans hanc dentibus algu. 748 quo minus est mirum, si certo tempore luna 749 gignitur et certo deletur tempore rusus, 750 cum fieri possint tam certo tempore multa.	
5.751	751 Solis item quoque defectus lunaeque latebras 752 pluribus e causis fieri tibi posse putandumst. 753 nam cur luna queat terram secludere solis 754 lumine et a terris altum caput obstruere ei, 755 obiciens caecum radiis ardentibus orbem, 756 tempore eodem aliut facere id non posse putetur 757 corpus, quod cassum labatur lumine semper? 758 solque suos etiam dimittere languidus ignis 759 tempore cur certo nequeat recreareque lumen, 760 cum loca praeteriit flammis infesta per auras, 761 quae faciunt ignis interstingui atque perire? 762 et cur terra queat lunam spoliare vicissim 763 lumine et oppressum solem super ipsa tenere, 764 menstrua dum rigidas coni perlabitur umbras, 765 tempore eodem aliud nequeat succurrere lunae 766 corpus vel supra solis perlabier orbem, 767 quod radios inter rumpat lumenque profusum? 768 et tamen ipsa suo si fulget luna nitore, 769 cur nequeat certa mundi languescere parte, 770 dum loca luminibus propriis inimica per exit?	As due to several causes. For, indeed, Why should the moon be able to shut out Earth from the light of sun, and on the side To earthward thrust her high head under sun, Opposing dark orb to his glowing beams- And yet, at same time, one suppose the effect Could not result from some one other body Which glides devoid of light forevermore? Again, why could not sun, in weakened state, At fixed time for-lose his fires, and then, When he has passed on along the air Beyond the regions, hostile to his flames, That quench and kill his fires, why could not he Renew his light? And why should earth in turn Have power to rob the moon of light, and there, Herself on high, keep the sun hid beneath, Whilst the moon glideth in her monthly course Athrough the rigid shadows of the cone?- And yet, at same time, some one other body Not have the power to under-pass the moon, Or glide along above the orb of sun, Breaking his rays and outspread light asunder? And still, if moon herself refulgent be With her own sheen, why could she not at times In some one quarter of the mighty world Grow weak and weary, whilst she passeth through Regions unfriendly to the beams her own?

	771 . 772 Quod superest, quoniam magni per caerula mundi 773 qua fieri quicquid posset ratione resolvi, 774 solis uti varios cursus lunaeque meatus 775 noscere possemus quae vis et causa cieret, 776 quove modo offecto lumine obire 777 et neque opinantis tenebris obducere terras, 778 cum quasi conivent et aperto lumine rursum 779 omnia convisunt clara loca candida luce, 780 nunc redeo ad mundi novitatem et mollia terrae	
5.781	781 arva, novo fetu quid primum in luminis oras 782 tollere et incertis crerint committere ventis. 783 Principio genus herbarum viridemque nitorem 784 terra dedit circum collis camposque per omnis, 785 florida fulserunt viridanti prata colore, 786 arboribusque datumst variis exinde per auras 787 crescendi magnum inmissis certamen habenis. 788 ut pluma atque pili primum saetaeque creantur 789 quadripedum membris et corpore pennipotentum, 790 sic nova tum tellus herbas virgultaque primum 791 sustulit, inde loci mortalia saecla creavit 792 multa modis multis varia ratione coorta. 793 nam neque de caelo cecidisse animalia possunt, 794 nec terrestria de salsis exisse lacunis. 795 linquitur ut merito maternum nomen adepta 796 terra sit, e terra quoniam sunt cuncta creata. 797 multaque nunc etiam existunt animalia terris 798 imbribus et calido solis concreta vapore; 799 quo minus est mirum, si tum sunt plura coorta 800 et maiora, nova tellure atque aethere adulta.	

	801 principio genus alituum variaeque volucres 802 ova relinquebant exclusae tempore verno, 803 folliculos ut nunc teretis aestate cicadae 804 lincunt sponte sua victum vitamque petentes. 805 tum tibi terra dedit primum mortalia saecla. 806 multus enim calor atque umor superabat in arvis. 807 hoc ubi quaeque loci regio opportuna dabatur, 808 crescebant uteri terram radicibus apti; 809 quos ubi tempore maturo pate fecerat aetas 810 infantum, fugiens umorem aurasque petessens,	
5.811	811 convertebat ibi natura foramina terrae 812 et sucum venis cogebat fundere apertis 813 consimilem lactis, sicut nunc femina quaeque 814 cum peperit, dulci repletur lacte, quod omnis 815 impetus in mammas convertitur ille alimenti. 816 terra cibum pueris, vestem vapor, herba cubile 817 praebebat multa et molli lanugine abundans. 818 at novitas mundi nec frigora dura ciebat 819 nec nimios aestus nec magnis viribus auras. 820 omnia enim pariter crescunt et robora sumunt. 821 Quare etiam atque etiam maternum nomen adepta 822 terra tenet merito, quoniam genus ipsa creavit 823 humanum atque animal prope certo tempore fudit 824 omne quod in magnis bacchatur montibus passim, 825 aeriasqueaëriasque simul volucres variantibus formis. 826 sed quia finem aliquam pariendi debet habere, 827 destitit, ut mulier spatio defessa vetusto. 828 mutat enim mundi naturam totius aetas 829 ex alioque alius status excipere omnia debet	

	830 nec manet ulla sui similis res: omnia migrant, 831 omnia commutat natura et vertere cogit. 832 namque aliud putrescit et aevo debile languet, 833 porro aliud crescit et contemptibus exit. 834 sic igitur mundi naturam totius aetas 835 mutat, et ex alio terram status excipit alter, 836 quod potuit nequeat, possit quod non tulit ante. 837 Multaque tum tellus etiam portenta creare 838 conatast mira facie membrisque coorta, 839 androgynem, interutras necutrumque utrimque remotum, 840 orba pedum partim, manuum viduata vicissim,	
5.841	841 muta sine ore etiam, sine voltu caeca reperta, 842 vinctaque membrorum per totum corpus adhaesu, 843 nec facere ut possent quicquam nec cedere quoquam 844 nec vitare malum nec sumere quod volet usus. 845 cetera de genere hoc monstra ac portenta creabat, 846 ne quiquam, quoniam natura absterruit auctum 847 nec potuere cupitum aetatis tangere florem 848 nec reperire cibum nec iungi per Veneris res. 849 multa videmus enim rebus concurrere debere, 850 ut propagando possint procudere saecla; 851 pabula primum ut sint, genitalia deinde per artus 852 semina qua possint membris manare remissis, 853 feminaque ut maribus coniungi possit, habere, 854 mutua qui mutent inter se gaudia uterque. 855 Multaque tum interiisse animantum saecla necessest 856 nec potuisse propagando procudere prolem. 857 nam quae cumque vides vesci vitalibus auris, 858 aut dolus aut virtus aut denique mobilitas est	

	859 ex ineunte aevo genus id tutaTA reservans. 860 multaque sunt, nobis ex utilitate sua quae 861 commendata manent, tutelae tradita nostrae. 862 principio genus acre leonum saevaque saecla 863 tutatast virtus, volpes dolus et fuga cervos. 864 at levisomna canum fido cum pectore corda, 865 et genus omne quod est veterino semine partum 866 lanigeraeque simul pecudes et bucera saecla 867 omnia sunt hominum tutelae tradita, Memmi; 868 nam cupide fugere feras pacemque secuta 869 sunt et larga suo sine pabula parta labore, 870 quae damus utilitatis eorum praemia causa.	
5.871	871 at quis nil horum tribuit natura, nec ipsa 872 sponte sua possent ut vivere nec dare nobis 873 utilitatem aliquam, quare pateremur eorum 874 praesidio nostro pasci genus esseque tutum, 875 scilicet haec aliis praedae lucroque iacebant 876 indupedita suis fatalibus omnia vinclis, 877 donec ad interitum genus id natura redegit. 878 Sed neque Centauri fuerunt nec tempore in ullo 879 esse queunt duplici natura et corpore bino 880 ex alienigenis membris compacta, potestas 881 hinc illinc partis ut sat par esse potissit. 882 id licet hinc quamvis hebeti cognoscere corde. 883 principio circum tribus actis impiger annis 884 floret equus, puer haut quaquam; nam saepe etiam nunc 885 ubera mammarum in somnis lactantia quaeret. 886 post ubi equum validae vires aetate senecta 887 membraque deficiunt fugienti languida vita,	

	888 tum demum puerili aevo florenta iuventas 889 officit et molli vestit lanugine malas; 890 ne forte ex homine et veterino semine equorum 891 confieri credas Centauros posse neque esse, 892 aut rapidis canibus succinctas semimarinis 893 corporibus Scyllas et cetera de genere horum, 894 inter se quorum discordia membra videmus; 895 quae neque florescunt pariter nec robora sumunt 896 corporibus neque proiciunt aetate senecta 897 nec simili Venere ardescunt nec moribus unis 898 conveniunt neque sunt eadem iucunda per artus. 899 quippe videre licet pinguescere saepe cicuta 900 barbigeras pecudes, homini quae est acre venenum.	
5.901	901 flamma quidem cum corpora fulva leonum 902 tam soleat torrere atque urere quam genus omne 903 visceris in terris quod cumque et sanguinis extet, 904 qui fieri potuit, triplici cum corpore ut una, 905 prima leo, postrema draco, media ipsa, Chimaera 906 ore foras acrem flaret de corpore flammam? 907 quare etiam tellure nova caeloque recenti 908 talia qui fingit potuisse animalia gigni, 909 nixus in hoc uno novitatis nomine inani, 910 multa licet simili ratione effutiat ore, 911 aurea tum dicat per terras flumina vulgo 912 fluxisse et gemmis florere arbusta suessesuësse 913 aut hominem tanto membrorum esse impete natum, 914 trans maria alta pedum nisus ut ponere posset 915 et manibus totum circum se vertere caelum. 916 nam quod multa fuere in terris semina rerum,	

	917 tempore quo primum tellus animalia fudit, 918 nil tamen est signi mixtas potuisse creari 919 inter se pecudes compactaque membra animantum, 920 propterea quia quae de terris nunc quoque abundant 921 herbarum genera ac fruges arbustaque laeta 922 non tamen inter se possunt complexa creari, 923 sed res quaeque suo ritu procedit et omnes 924 foedere naturae certo discrimina servant. 925 Et genus humanum multo fuit illud in arvis 926 durius, ut decuit, tellus quod dura creasset, 927 et maioribus et solidis magis ossibus intus 928 fundatum, validis aptum per viscera nervis, 929 nec facile ex aestu nec frigore quod caperetur 930 nec novitate cibi nec labi corporis ulla.	
5.931	931 multaque per caelum solis volventia lustra 932 volgivago vitam tractabant more ferarum. 933 nec robustus erat curvi moderator aratri 934 quisquam, nec scibat ferro molirier arva 935 nec nova defodere in terram virgulta neque altis 936 arboribus veteres decidere falcibus ramos. 937 quod sol atque imbres dederant, quod terra crearat 938 sponte sua, satis id placabat pectora donum. 939 glandiferas inter curabant corpora quercus 940 plerumque; et quae nunc hiberno tempore cernis 941 arbita puniceo fieri matura colore, 942 plurima tum tellus etiam maiora ferebat. 943 multaque praeterea novitas tum florida mundi 944 pabula dura tulit, miseris mortalibus ampla. 945 at sedare sitim fluvii fontesque vocabant, 946 ut nunc montibus e magnis	

	decursus aquai 947 claricitat late sitientia saecla ferarum. 948 denique nota vagis silvestria templa tenebant 949 nympharum, quibus e scibant umore fluenta 950 lubrica proluvie larga lavere umida saxa, 951 umida saxa, super viridi stillantia musco, 952 et partim plano scatere atque erumpere campo. 953 necdum res igni scibant tractare neque uti 954 pellibus et spoliis corpus vestire ferarum, 955 sed nemora atque cavos montis silvasque colebant 956 et frutices inter condebant squalida membra 957 verbera ventorum vitare imbrisque coacti. 958 nec commune bonum poterant spectare neque ullis 959 moribus inter se scibant nec legibus uti. 960 quod cuique obtulerat praedae fortuna, ferebat	
5.961	961 sponte sua sibi quisque valere et vivere doctus. 962 et Venus in silvis iungebat corpora amantum; 963 conciliabat enim vel mutua quamque cupido 964 vel violenta viri vis atque inpensa libido 965 vel pretium, glandes atque arbita vel pira lecta. 966 et manuum mira freti virtute pedumque 967 consectabantur silvestria saecla ferarum 968 missilibus saxis et magno pondere clavae. 969 multaque vincebant, vitabant pauca latebris; 970 saetigerisque pares subus silvestria membra 971 nuda dabant terrae nocturno tempore capti, 972 circum se foliis ac frondibus involventes. 973 nec plangore diem magno solemque per agros 974 quaerebant pavidi palantes noctis in umbris, 975 sed taciti respectabant somnoque	And yet in those days not much more than now Would generations of mortality Leave the sweet light of fading life behind. Indeed, in those days here and there a man, More oftener snatched upon, and gulped by fangs, Afforded the beasts a food that roared alive, Echoing through groves and hills and forest-trees, Even as he viewed his living flesh entombed Within a living grave; whilst those whom flight Had saved, with bone and body bitten, shrieked, Pressing their quivering palms to loathsome sores, With horrible voices for eternal death- Until, forlorn of help, and witless what Might medicine their wounds, the writhing pangs Took them from life. But not in those far times Would one lone day give over unto doom A soldiery in thousands marching on Beneath the battle-banners, nor would then The ramping breakers of the main seas dash Whole argosies and crews upon the rocks. But ocean uprisen would often rave in vain, Without all end or outcome, and give up Its empty menacings as lightly too; Nor soft seductions of a serene sea Could lure by laughing billows any man

	sepulti, 976 dum rosea face sol inferret lumina caelo. 977 a parvis quod enim consuerant cernere semper 978 alterno tenebras et lucem tempore gigni, 979 non erat ut fieri posset mirarier umquam 980 nec diffidere, ne terras aeterna teneret 981 nox in perpetuum detracto lumine solis. 982 sed magis illud erat curae, quod saecla ferarum 983 infestam miseris faciebant saepe quietem. 984 eiectique domo fugiebant saxea tecta 985 spumigeri suis adventu validique leonis 986 atque intempesta cedebant nocte paventes 987 hospitibus saevis instrata cubilia fronde. 988 Nec nimio tum plus quam nunc mortalia saecla 989 dulcia linquebant lamentis lumina vitae. 990 unus enim tum quisque magis deprensus eorum	Out to disaster: for the science bold Of ship-sailing lay dark in those far times. Again, 'twas then that lack of food gave o'er Men's fainting limbs to dissolution: now 'Tis plenty overwhelms. Unwary, they Oft for themselves themselves would then outpour The poison; now, with nicer art, themselves They give the drafts to others.
5.991	991 pabula viva feris praebebat, dentibus haustus, 992 et nemora ac montis gemitu silvasque replebat 993 viva videns vivo sepeliri viscera busto. 994 at quos effugium servarat corpore adeso, 995 posterius tremulas super ulcera tetra tenentes 996 palmas horriferis accibant vocibus Orcum, 997 donique eos vita privarant vermina saeva 998 expertis opis, ignaros quid volnera vellent. 999 at non multa virum sub signis milia ducta 1000 una dies dabat exitio nec turbida ponti 1001 aequora lidebant navis ad saxa virosque. 1002 nam temere in cassum frustra mare saepe coortum 1003 saevibat leviterque minas ponebat inanis, 1004 nec poterat quemquam placidi	

	pellacia ponti 1005 subdola pellicere in fraudem ridentibus undis. 1006 improba navigii ratio tum caeca iacebat. 1007 tum penuria deinde cibi languentia leto 1008 membra dabat, contra nunc rerum copia mersat. 1009 illi inprudentes ipsi sibi saepe venenum 1010 vergebant, nunc dant sollertius ipsi. 1011 Inde casas postquam ac pellis ignemque pararunt 1012 et mulier coniuncta viro concessit in unum 1013 cognita sunt, prolemque ex se videre creatam, 1014 tum genus humanum primum mollescere coepit. 1015 ignis enim curavit, ut alsia corpora frigus 1016 non ita iam possent caeli sub tegmine ferre, 1017 et Venus inminuit viris puerique parentum 1018 blanditiis facile ingenium fregere superbum. 1019 tunc et amicitiem coeperunt iungere aventes	
5.1020	1020 finitimi inter se nec laedere nec violari, 1021 et pueros commendarunt muliebreque saeclum, 1022 vocibus et gestu cum balbe significarent 1023 imbecillorum esse aequum misererier omnis. 1024 nec tamen omnimodis poterat concordia gigni, 1025 sed bona magnaque pars servabat foedera caste; 1026 aut genus humanum iam tum foret omne peremptum 1027 nec potuisset adhuc perducere saecla propago. 1028 At varios linguae sonitus natura subegit 1029 mittere et utilitas expressit nomina rerum, 1030 non alia longe ratione atque ipsa videtur 1031 protrahere ad gestum pueros infantia linguae, 1032 cum facit ut digito quae sint praesentia monstrent.	

	1033 sentit enim vim quisque suam quod possit abuti. 1034 cornua nata prius vitulo quam frontibus extent, 1035 illis iratus petit atque infestus inurget. 1036 at catuli pantherarum scymnique leonum 1037 unguibus ac pedibus iam tum morsuque repugnant, 1038 vix etiam cum sunt dentes unguesque creati. 1039 alituum porro genus alis omne videmus 1040 fidere et a pennis tremulum petere auxiliatum. 1041 proinde putare aliquem tum nomina distribuisse 1042 rebus et inde homines didicisse vocabula prima, 1043 desiperest. nam cur hic posset cuncta notare 1044 vocibus et varios sonitus emittere linguae, 1045 tempore eodem alii facere id non quisse putentur? 1046 praeterea si non alii quoque vocibus usi 1047 inter se fuerant, unde insita notities est 1048 utilitatis et unde data est huic prima potestas, 1049 quid vellet facere ut sciret animoque videret?	
5.1050	1050 cogere item pluris unus victosque domare 1051 non poterat, rerum ut perdiscere nomina vellent. 1052 nec ratione docere ulla suadereque surdis, 1053 quid sit opus facto, facilest; neque enim paterentur 1054 nec ratione ulla sibi ferrent amplius auris 1055 vocis inauditos sonitus obtundere frustra. 1056 postremo quid in hac mirabile tantoperest re, 1057 si genus humanum, cui vox et lingua vigeret, 1058 pro vario sensu varia res voce notaret? 1059 cum pecudes mutae, cum denique saecla ferarum 1060 dissimilis soleant voces variasque ciere, 1061 cum metus aut dolor est et cum iam gaudia gliscunt.	

	1062 quippe enim licet id rebus cognoscere apertis. 1063 inritata canum cum primum magna Molossum 1064 mollia ricta fremunt duros nudantia dentes, 1065 longe alio sonitu rabies stricta minatur, 1066 et cum iam latrant et vocibus omnia complent; 1067 at catulos blande cum lingua lambere temptant 1068 aut ubi eos lactant, pedibus morsuque potentes 1069 suspensis teneros imitantur dentibus haustus, 1070 longe alio pacto gannitu vocis adulant, 1071 et cum deserti baubantur in aedibus, aut cum 1072 plorantis fugiunt summisso corpore plagas. 1073 denique non hinnitus item differre videtur, 1074 inter equas ubi equus florenti aetate iuvencus 1075 pinnigeri saevit calcaribus ictus Amoris 1076 et fremitum patulis sub naribus edit ad arma, 1077 et cum sic alias concussis artibus hinnit? 1078 postremo genus alituum variaeque volucres, 1079 accipitres atque ossifragae mergique marinis	
5.1080	1080 fluctibus in salso victum vitamque petentes, 1081 longe alias alio iaciunt in tempore voces, 1082 et quom de victu certant praedaque repugnant. 1083 et partim mutant cum tempestatibus una 1084 raucisonos cantus, cornicum ut saecla vetusta 1085 corvorumque gregis ubi aquam dicuntur et imbris 1086 poscere et inter dum ventos aurasque vocare. 1087 ergo si varii sensus animalia cogunt, 1088 muta tamen cum sint, varias emittere voces, 1089 quanto mortalis magis aequumst tum potuisse 1090 dissimilis alia atque alia res voce notare!	Lest, perchance, Concerning these affairs thou ponderest In silent meditation, let me say 'Twas lightning brought primevally to earth The fire for mortals, and from thence hath spread O'er all the lands the flames of heat. For thus Even now we see so many objects, touched By the celestial flames, to flash aglow, When thunderbolt has dowered them with heat. Yet also when a many-branched tree, Beaten by winds, writhes swaying to and fro, Pressing 'gainst branches of a neighbour tree, There by the power of mighty rub and rub Is fire engendered; and at times out-flares The scorching heat of flame, when boughs do chafe Against the trunks. And of these causes, either May well have given to mortal men the fire. Next, food to cook and soften in the flame The sun instructed, since so oft they saw How

	1091 Illud in his rebus tacitus ne forte requiras, 1092 fulmen detulit in terram mortalibus ignem 1093 primitus, inde omnis flammarum diditur ardor; 1094 multa videmus enim caelestibus insita flammis 1095 fulgere, cum caeli donavit plaga vaporis. 1096 et ramosa tamen cum ventis pulsa vacillans 1097 aestuat in ramos incumbens arboris arbor, 1098 exprimitur validis extritus viribus ignis, 1099 emicat inter dum flammai fervidus ardor, 1100 mutua dum inter se rami stirpesque teruntur. 1101 quorum utrumque dedisse potest mortalibus ignem. 1102 inde cibum quoquere ac flammae mollire vapore 1103 sol docuit, quoniam mitescere multa videbant 1104 verberibus radiorum atque aestu victa per agros. 1105 Inque dies magis hi victum vitamque priorem 1106 commutare novis monstrabant rebus et igni, 1107 ingenio qui praestabant et corde vigebant. 1108 condere coeperunt urbis arcemque locare 1109 praesidium reges ipsi sibi perfugiumque,	objects mellowed, when subdued by warmth And by the raining blows of fiery beams, Through all the fields. And more and more each day Would men more strong in sense, more wise in heart, Teach them to change their earlier mode and life By fire and new devices. Kings began Cities to found and citadels to set, As strongholds and asylums for themselves, And flocks and fields to portion for each man After the beauty, strength, and sense of each- For beauty then imported much, and strength Had its own rights supreme. Thereafter, wealth Discovered was, and gold was brought to light, Which soon of honour stripped both strong and fair; For men, however beautiful in form Or valorous, will follow in the main The rich man's party. Yet were man to steer His life by sounder reasoning, he'd own Abounding riches, if with mind content He lived by thrift; for never, as I guess, Is there a lack of little in the world. But men wished glory for themselves and power Even that their fortunes on foundations firm Might rest forever, and that they themselves, The opulent, might pass a quiet life- In vain, in vain; since, in the strife to climb On to the heights of honour, men do make Their pathway terrible; and even when once They reach them, envy like the thunderbolt At times will smite, O hurling headlong down To murkiest Tartarus, in scorn; for, lo, All summits, all regions loftier than the rest, Smoke, blasted as by envy's thunderbolts; So better far in quiet to obey, Than to desire chief mastery of affairs And ownership of empires. Be it so; And let the weary sweat their life-blood out All to no end, battling in hate along The narrow path of man's ambition; Since all their wisdom is from others' lips, And all they seek is known from what they've heard And less from what they've thought. Nor is this folly Greater to-day, nor greater soon to be, Than' twas of old.
5.1110	1110 et pecudes et agros divisere atque dedere 1111 pro facie cuiusque et viribus ingenioque; 1112 nam facies multum valuit viresque vigebant. 1113 posterius res inventast aurumque repertum,	

	1114 quod facile et validis et pulchris dempsit honorem; 1115 divitioris enim sectam plerumque secuntur 1116 quam lubet et fortes et pulchro corpore creti. 1117 quod siquis vera vitam ratione gubernet, 1118 divitiae grandes homini sunt vivere parce 1119 aequo animo; neque enim est umquam penuria parvi. 1120 at claros homines voluerunt se atque potentes, 1121 ut fundamento stabili fortuna maneret 1122 et placidam possent opulenti degere vitam, 1123 ne quiquam, quoniam ad summum succedere honorem 1124 certantes iter infestum fecere viai, 1125 et tamen e summo, quasi fulmen, deicit ictos 1126 invidia inter dum contemptim in Tartara taetra; 1127 invidia quoniam ceu fulmine summa vaporant 1128 plerumque et quae sunt aliis magis edita cumque; 1129 ut satius multo iam sit parere quietum 1130 quam regere imperio res velle et regna tenere. 1131 proinde sine in cassum defessi sanguine sudent, 1132 angustum per iter luctantes ambitionis; 1133 quandoquidem sapiunt alieno ex ore petuntque 1134 res ex auditis potius quam sensibus ipsis, 1135 nec magis id nunc est neque erit mox quam fuit ante. 1136 Ergo regibus occisis subversa iacebat 1137 pristina maiestas soliorum et sceptra superba, 1138 et capitis summi praeclarum insigne cruentum 1139 sub pedibus vulgi magnum lugebat honorem;	
5.1140	1140 nam cupide conculcatur nimis ante metutum. 1141 res itaque ad summam faecem turbasque redibat, 1142 imperium sibi cum ac summatum quisque petebat.	

	1143 inde magistratum partim docuere creare 1144 iuraque constituere, ut vellent legibus uti. 1145 nam genus humanum, defessum vi colere aevom, 1146 ex inimicitiis languebat; quo magis ipsum 1147 sponte sua cecidit sub leges artaque iura. 1148 acrius ex ira quod enim se quisque parabat 1149 ulcisci quam nunc concessumst legibus aequis, 1150 hanc ob rem est homines pertaesum vi colere aevom. 1151 inde metus maculat poenarum praemia vitae. 1152 circumretit enim vis atque iniuria quemque 1153 atque unde exortast, ad eum plerumque revertit, 1154 nec facilest placidam ac pacatam degere vitam 1155 qui violat factis communia foedera pacis. 1156 etsi fallit enim divom genus humanumque, 1157 perpetuo tamen id fore clam diffidere debet; 1158 quippe ubi se multi per somnia saepe loquentes 1159 aut morbo delirantes protraxe ferantur 1160 et celata in medium et peccata dedisse. 1161 Nunc quae causa deum per magnas numina gentis 1162 pervulgarit et ararum compleverit urbis 1163 suscipiendaque curarit sollemnia sacra, 1164 quae nunc in magnis florent sacra rebus locisque, 1165 unde etiam nunc est mortalibus insitus horror, 1166 qui delubra deum nova toto suscitat orbi 1167 terrarum et festis cogit celebrare diebus, 1168 non ita difficilest rationem reddere verbis. 1169 quippe etenim iam tum divom mortalia saecla	
5.1170	1170 egregias animo facies vigilante videbant 1171 et magis in somnis mirando corporis auctu.	

	1172 his igitur sensum tribuebant propterea quod 1173 membra movere videbantur vocesque superbas 1174 mittere pro facie praeclara et viribus amplis. 1175 aeternamque dabant vitam, quia semper eorum 1176 subpeditabatur facies et forma manebat, 1177 et tamen omnino quod tantis viribus auctos 1178 non temere ulla vi convinci posse putabant. 1179 fortunisque ideo longe praestare putabant, 1180 quod mortis timor haut quemquam vexaret eorum, 1181 et simul in somnis quia multa et mira videbant 1182 efficere et nullum capere ipsos inde laborem. 1183 praeterea caeli rationes ordine certo 1184 et varia annorum cernebant tempora verti 1185 nec poterant quibus id fieret cognoscere causis. 1186 ergo perfugium sibi habebant omnia divis 1187 tradere et illorum nutu facere omnia flecti. 1188 in caeloque deum sedes et templa locarunt, 1189 per caelum volvi quia nox et luna videtur, 1190 luna dies et nox et noctis signa severa 1191 noctivagaeque faces caeli flammaeque volantes, 1192 nubila sol imbres nix venti fulmina grando 1193 et rapidi fremitus et murmura magna minarum. 1194 O genus infelix humanum, talia divis 1195 cum tribuit facta atque iras adiunxit acerbas! 1196 quantos tum gemitus ipsi sibi, quantaque nobis 1197 volnera, quas lacrimas peperere minoribus nostris! 1198 nec pietas ullast velatum saepe videri 1199 vertier ad lapidem atque omnis accedere ad aras	
5.1200	1200 nec procumbere humi prostratum et pandere palmas	

	1201 ante deum delubra nec aras sanguine multo 1202 spargere quadrupedum nec votis nectere vota, 1203 sed mage pacata posse omnia mente tueri. 1204 nam cum suspicimus magni caelestia mundi 1205 templa super stellisque micantibus aethera fixum, 1206 et venit in mentem solis lunaeque viarum, 1207 tunc aliis oppressa malis in pectora cura 1208 illa quoque expergefactum caput erigere infit, 1209 ne quae forte deum nobis inmensa potestas 1210 sit, vario motu quae candida sidera verset; 1211 temptat enim dubiam mentem rationis egestas, 1212 ecquae nam fuerit mundi genitalis origo, 1213 et simul ecquae sit finis, quoad moenia mundi 1214 et taciti motus hunc possint ferre laborem, 1215 an divinitus aeterna donata salute 1216 perpetuo possint aevi labentia tractu 1217 inmensi validas aevi contemnere viris. 1218 praeterea cui non animus formidine divum 1219 contrahitur, cui non correpunt membra pavore, 1220 fulminis horribili cum plaga torrida tellus 1221 contremit et magnum percurrunt murmura caelum? 1222 non populi gentesque tremunt, regesque superbi 1223 corripiunt divum percussi membra timore, 1224 ne quod ob admissum foede dictumve superbe 1225 poenarum grave sit solvendi tempus adauctum? 1226 summa etiam cum vis violenti per mare venti 1227 induperatorem classis super aequora verrit 1228 cum validis pariter legionibus atque elephantis, 1229 non divom pacem votis adit ac prece quaesit	
5.1230	1230 ventorum pavidus paces	

	animasque secundas? 1231 ne quiquam, quoniam violento turbine saepe 1232 correptus nihilo fertur minus ad vada leti. 1233 usque adeo res humanas vis abdita quaedam 1234 opterit et pulchros fascis saevasque secures 1235 proculcare ac ludibrio sibi habere videtur. 1236 denique sub pedibus tellus cum tota vacillat 1237 concussaeque cadunt urbes dubiaeque minantur, 1238 quid mirum si se temnunt mortalia saecla 1239 atque potestatis magnas mirasque relinquunt 1240 in rebus viris divum, quae cuncta gubernent? 1241 Quod super est, aeque aurum ferrumque repertumst 1242 et simul argenti pondus plumbique potestas, 1243 ignis ubi ingentis silvas ardore cremarat 1244 montibus in magnis, seu caelo fulmine misso, 1245 sive quod inter se bellum silvestre gerentes 1246 hostibus intulerant ignem formidinis ergo, 1247 sive quod inducti terrae bonitate volebant 1248 pandere agros pinguis et pascua reddere rura, 1249 sive feras interficere et ditescere praeda; 1250 nam fovea atque igni prius est venarier ortum 1251 quam saepire plagis saltum canibusque ciere. 1252 quicquid id est, qua cumque e causa flammeus ardor 1253 horribili sonitu silvas exederat altis 1254 a radicibus et terram percoxerat igni, 1255 manabat venis ferventibus in loca terrae 1256 concava conveniens argenti rivus et auri, 1257 aeris item et plumbi. quae cum concreta videbant 1258 posterius claro in terra splendere colore, 1259 tollebant nitido capti levique	

	lepore,	
5.1260	1260 et simili formata videbant esse figura 1261 atque lacunarum fuerant vestigia cuique. 1262 tum penetrabat eos posse haec liquefacta calore 1263 quamlibet in formam et faciem decurrere rerum, 1264 et prorsum quamvis in acuta ac tenvia posse 1265 mucronum duci fastigia procudendo, 1266 ut sibi tela parent silvasque ut caedere possint 1267 materiemque dolare et levia radere tigna 1268 et terebrare etiam ac pertundere perque forare. 1269 nec minus argento facere haec auroque parabant 1270 quam validi primum violentis viribus aeris, 1271 ne quiquam, quoniam cedebat victa potestas 1272 nec poterant pariter durum sufferre laborem. 1273 nam fuit in pretio magis aes aurumque iacebat 1274 propter inutilitatem hebeti mucrone retusum; 1275 nunc iacet aes, aurum in summum successit honorem. 1276 sic volvenda aetas commutat tempora rerum. 1277 quod fuit in pretio, fit nullo denique honore; 1278 porro aliud succedit et contemptibus exit 1279 inque dies magis adpetitur floretque repertum 1280 laudibus et miro est mortalis inter honore. 1281 Nunc tibi quo pacto ferri natura reperta 1282 sit facilest ipsi per te cognoscere, Memmi. 1283 arma antiqua manus ungues dentesque fuerunt 1284 et lapides et item silvarum fragmina rami 1285 et flamma atque ignes, post quam sunt cognita primum. 1286 posterius ferri vis est aerisque reperta. 1287 et prior aeris erat quam ferri cognitus usus, 1288 quo facilis magis est natura et	

	copia maior. 1289 aere solum terrae tractabant, aereque belli	
5.1290	1290 miscebant fluctus et vulnera vasta serebant 1291 et pecus atque agros adimebant; nam facile ollis 1292 omnia cedebant armatis nuda et inerma. 1293 inde minutatim processit ferreus ensis 1294 versaque in obprobrium species est falcis ahenae, 1295 et ferro coepere solum proscindere terrae 1296 exaequataque sunt creperi certamina belli. 1297 et prius est armatum in equi conscendere costas 1298 et moderarier hunc frenis dextraque vigere 1299 quam biiugo curru belli temptare pericla. 1300 et biiugo prius est quam bis coniungere binos 1301 et quam falciferos armatum escendere currus. 1302 inde boves Lucas turrito corpore, tetras, 1303 anguimanus, belli docuerunt volnera Poeni 1304 sufferre et magnas Martis turbare catervas. 1305 sic alid ex alio peperit discordia tristis, 1306 horribile humanis quod gentibus esset in armis, 1307 inque dies belli terroribus addidit augmen. 1308 Temptarunt etiam tauros in moenere belli 1309 expertique sues saevos sunt mittere in hostis. 1310 et validos partim prae se misere leones 1311 cum doctoribus armatis saevisque magistris, 1312 qui moderarier his possent vinclisque tenere, 1313 ne quiquam, quoniam permixta caede calentes 1314 turbabant saevi nullo discrimine turmas, 1315 terrificas capitum quatientis undique cristas, 1316 nec poterant equites fremitu perterrita equorum 1317 pectora mulcere et frenis	

	convertere in hostis. 1318 inritata leae iaciebant corpora saltu 1319 undique et adversum venientibus ora patebant	
5.1320	1320 et nec opinantis a tergo deripiebant 1321 deplexaeque dabant in terram volnere victos, 1322 morsibus adfixae validis atque unguibus uncis. 1323 iactabantque suos tauri pedibusque terebant 1324 et latera ac ventres hauribant supter equorum 1325 cornibus et terram minitanti mente ruebant. 1326 et validis socios caedebant dentibus apri 1327 tela infracta suo tinguentes sanguine saevi 1328 1329 permixtasque dabant equitum peditumque ruinas. 1330 nam transversa feros exibant dentis adactus 1331 iumenta aut pedibus ventos erecta petebant, 1332 ne quiquam, quoniam ab nervis succisa videres 1333 concidere atque gravi terram consternere casu. 1334 si quos ante domi domitos satis esse putabant, 1335 effervescere cernebant in rebus agundis 1336 volneribus clamore fuga terrore tumultu, 1337 nec poterant ullam partem redducere eorum; 1338 diffugiebat enim varium genus omne ferarum, 1339 ut nunc saepe boves Lucae ferro male mactae 1340 diffugiunt, fera facta suis cum multa dedere. 1341 Sed facere id non tam vincendi spe voluerunt; 1342 quam dare quod gemerent hostes, ipsique perire, 1343 qui numero diffidebant armisque vacabant, 1344 si fuit ut facerent. sed vix adducor ut ante 1345 non quierint animo praesentire atque videre, 1346 quam commune malum fieret foedumque, futurum.	

	1347 et magis id possis factum contendere in omni 1348 in variis mundis varia ratione creatis, 1349 quam certo atque uno terrarum quolibet orbi.	
5.1350	1350 Nexilis ante fuit vestis quam textile tegmen. 1351 textile post ferrumst, quia ferro tela paratur, 1352 nec ratione alia possunt tam levia gigni 1353 insilia ac fusi, radii, scapique sonantes. 1354 et facere ante viros lanam natura coegitcoëgit 1355 quam muliebre genus; nam longe praestat in arte 1356 et sollertius est multo genus omne virile; 1357 agricolae donec vitio vertere severi, 1358 ut muliebribus id manibus concedere vellent 1359 atque ipsi pariter durum sufferre laborem 1360 atque opere in duro durarent membra manusque. 1361 At specimen sationis et insitionis origo 1362 ipsa fuit rerum primum natura creatrix, 1363 arboribus quoniam bacae glandesque caducae 1364 tempestiva dabant pullorum examina supter; 1365 unde etiam libitumst stirpis committere ramis 1366 et nova defodere in terram virgulta per agros. 1367 inde aliam atque aliam culturam dulcis agelli 1368 temptabant fructusque feros mansuescere terra 1369 cernebant indulgendo blandeque colendo. 1370 inque dies magis in montem succedere silvas 1371 cogebant infraque locum concedere cultis, 1372 prata lacus rivos segetes vinetaque laeta 1373 collibus et campis ut haberent, atque olearum 1374 caerula distinguens inter plaga currere posset 1375 per tumulos et convallis camposque profusa;	Now, clothes of roughly inter-plaited strands Were earlier than loom-wove coverings; The loom-wove later than man's iron is, Since iron is needful in the weaving art, Nor by no other means can there be wrought Such polished tools- the treadles, spindles, shuttles, And sounding yarn-beams. And nature forced the men, Before the woman kind, to work the wool: For all the male kind far excels in skill, And cleverer is by much- until at last The rugged farmer folk jeered at such tasks, And so were eager soon to give them o'er To women's hands, and in more hardy toil To harden arms and hands.

	1376 ut nunc esse vides vario distincta lepore 1377 omnia, quae pomis intersita dulcibus ornant 1378 arbustisque tenent felicibus opsita circum. 1379 At liquidas avium voces imitarier ore	
5.1380	1380 ante fuit multo quam levia carmina cantu 1381 concelebrare homines possent aurisque iuvare. 1382 et zephyri cava per calamorum sibila primum 1383 agrestis docuere cavas inflare cicutas. 1384 inde minutatim dulcis didicere querellas, 1385 tibia quas fundit digitis pulsata canentum, 1386 avia per nemora ac silvas saltusque reperta, 1387 per loca pastorum deserta atque otia dia. 1388 1389 1390 haec animos ollis mulcebant atque iuvabant 1391 cum satiate cibi; nam tum sunt omnia cordi. 1392 saepe itaque inter se prostrati in gramine molli 1393 propter aquae rivom sub ramis arboris altae. 1394 non magnis opibus iucunde corpora habebant, 1395 praesertim cum tempestas ridebat et anni 1396 tempora pingebant viridantis floribus herbas. 1397 tum ioca, tum sermo, tum dulces esse cachinni 1398 consuerant; agrestis enim tum musa vigebat. 1399 tum caput atque umeros plexis redimire coronis 1400 floribus et foliis lascivia laeta movebat, 1401 atque extra numerum procedere membra moventes 1402 duriter et duro terram pede pellere matrem; 1403 unde oriebantur risus dulcesque cachinni, 1404 omnia quod nova tum magis haec et mira vigebant. 1405 et vigilantibus hinc aderant solacia somno	

	1406 ducere multimodis voces et flectere cantus 1407 et supera calamos unco percurrere labro; 1408 unde etiam vigiles nunc haec accepta tuentur. 1409 et numerum servare genus didicere, neque hilo	
5.1410	1410 maiore interea capiunt dulcedine fructum 1411 quam silvestre genus capiebat terrigenarum. 1412 nam quod adest praesto, nisi quid cognovimus ante 1413 suavius, in primis placet et pollere videtur, 1414 posteriorque fere melior res illa reperta 1415 perdit et immutat sensus ad pristina quaeque. 1416 sic odium coepit glandis, sic illa relicta 1417 strata cubilia sunt herbis et frondibus aucta. 1418 pellis item cecidit vestis contempta ferina; 1419 quam reor invidia tali tunc esse repertam, 1420 ut letum insidiis qui gessit primus obiret, 1421 et tamen inter eos distractam sanguine multo 1422 disperiise neque in fructum convertere quisse. 1423 tunc igitur pelles, nunc aurum et purpura curis 1424 exercent hominum vitam belloque fatigant; 1425 quo magis in nobis, ut opinor, culpa resedit. 1426 frigus enim nudos sine pellibus excruciabat 1427 terrigenas; at nos nil laedit veste carere 1428 purpurea atque auro signisque ingentibus apta, 1429 dum plebeia tamen sit, quae defendere possit. 1430 Ergo hominum genus in cassum frustraque laborat 1431 semper et curis consumit inanibus aevom, 1432 ni mirum quia non cognovit quae sit habendi 1433 finis et omnino quoad crescat vera voluptas; 1434 idque minutatim vitam provexit in altum	And thus Began the loathing of the acorn; thus Abandoned were those beds with grasses strewn And with the leaves beladen. Thus, again, Fell into new contempt the pelts of beasts- Erstwhile a robe of honour, which, I guess, Aroused in those days envy so malign That the first wearer went to woeful death By ambuscades,- and yet that hairy prize, Rent into rags by greedy foemen there And splashed by blood, was ruined utterly Beyond all use or vantage. Thus of old 'Twas pelts, and of to-day 'tis purple and gold That cark men's lives with cares and weary with war. Wherefore, methinks, resides the greater blame With us vain men to-day: for cold would rack, Without their pelts, the naked sons of earth; But us it nothing hurts to do without The purple vestment, broidered with gold And with imposing figures, if we still Make shift with some mean garment of the Plebs. So man in vain futilities toils on Forever and wastes in idle cares his years- Because, of very truth, he hath not learnt What the true end of getting is, nor yet At all how far true pleasure may increase. And 'tis desire for better and for more Hath carried by degrees mortality Out onward to the deep, and roused up From the far bottom mighty waves of war. But sun and moon, those watchmen of the world, With their own lanterns traversing around The mighty, the revolving vault, have taught Unto mankind that seasons of the years Return again, and that the Thing takes place After a fixed plan and order fixed. Already would they pass their life, hedged round By the strong towers; and cultivate an earth All portioned out and boundaried; already Would the sea flower and sail-winged ships; Already men had, under treaty pacts, Confederates and allies, when poets began To hand heroic actions down in verse; Nor long ere this had letters been devised- Hence is our age unable to look back On what has gone before,

	1435 et belli magnos commovit funditus aestus. 1436 at vigiles mundi magnum versatile templum 1437 sol et luna suo lustrantes lumine circum 1438 perdocuere homines annorum tempora verti 1439 et certa ratione geri rem atque ordine certo.	except where reason Shows us a footprint. Sailings on the seas, Tillings of fields, walls, laws, and arms, and roads, Dress and the like, all prizes, all delights Of finer life, poems, pictures, chiselled shapes Of polished sculptures- all these arts were learned By practice and the mind's experience, As men walked forward step by eager step. Thus time draws forward each and everything Little by little into the midst of men, And reason uplifts it to the shores of light. For one thing after other did men see Grow clear by intellect, till with their arts They've now achieved the supreme pinnacle.
5.1440	1440 Iam validis saepti degebant turribus aevom, 1441 et divisa colebatur discretaque tellus, 1442 tum mare velivolis florebat navibus ponti, 1443 auxilia ac socios iam pacto foedere habebant, 1444 carminibus cum res gestas coepere poetaepoëtae 1445 tradere; nec multo prius sunt elementa reperta. 1446 propterea quid sit prius actum respicere aetas 1447 nostra nequit, nisi qua ratio vestigia monstrat. 1448 Navigia atque agri culturas moenia leges 1449 arma vias vestes cetera de genere horum, 1450 praemia, delicias quoque vitae funditus omnis, 1451 carmina, picturas et daedala signa polita 1452 usus et impigrae simul experientia mentis 1453 paulatim docuit pedetemptim progredientis. 1454 sic unum quicquid paulatim protrahit aetas 1455 in medium ratioque in luminis erigit oras; 1456 namque alid ex alio clarescere corde videbant, 1457 artibus ad summum donec venere cacumen.	
6.1	1 Primae frugiparos fetus mortalibus aegris 2 dididerunt quondam praeclaro nomine Athenae 3 et recreaverunt vitam legesque	'Twas Athens first, the glorious in name, That whilom gave to hapless sons of men The sheaves of harvest, and re-ordered life, And decreed laws; and she the first that gave Life its

	rogarunt 4 et primae dederunt solacia dulcia vitae, 5 cum genuere virum tali cum corde repertum, 6 omnia veridico qui quondam ex ore profudit; 7 cuius et extincti propter divina reperta 8 divolgata vetus iam ad caelum gloria fertur. 9 nam cum vidit hic ad victum quae flagitat usus 10 omnia iam ferme mortalibus esse parata 11 et, pro quam possent, vitam consistere tutam, 12 divitiis homines et honore et laude potentis 13 affluere atque bona gnatorum excellere fama, 14 nec minus esse domi cuiquam tamen anxia cordi, 15 atque animi ingratis vitam vexare sine ulla 16 pausa atque infestis cogi saevire querellis, 17 intellegit ibi vitium vas efficere ipsum 18 omniaque illius vitio corrumpier intus, 19 quae conlata foris et commoda cumque venirent; 20 partim quod fluxum pertusumque esse videbat, 21 ut nulla posset ratione explerier umquam, 22 partim quod taetro quasi conspurcare sapore 23 omnia cernebat, quae cumque receperat, intus. 24 veridicis igitur purgavit pectora dictis 25 et finem statuit cuppedinis atque timoris 26 exposuitque bonum summum, quo tendimus omnes, 27 quid foret, atque viam monstravit, tramite parvo 28 qua possemus ad id recto contendere cursu, 29 quidve mali foret in rebus mortalibus passim, 30 quod fieret naturali varieque volaret	sweet solaces, when she begat A man of heart so wise, who whilom poured All wisdom forth from his truth-speaking mouth; The glory of whom, though dead, is yet to-day, Because of those discoveries divine Renowned of old, exalted to the sky. For when saw he that well-nigh everything Which needs of man most urgently require Was ready to hand for mortals, and that life, As far as might be, was established safe, That men were lords in riches, honour, praise, And eminent in goodly fame of sons, And that they yet, O yet, within the home, Still had the anxious heart which vexed life Unpausingly with torments of the mind, And raved perforce with angry plaints, then he, Then he, the master, did perceive that 'twas The vessel itself which worked the bane, and all, However wholesome, which from here or there Was gathered into it, was by that bane Spoilt from within,- in part, because he saw The vessel so cracked and leaky that nowise 'T could ever be filled to brim; in part because He marked how it polluted with foul taste Whate'er it got within itself. So he, The master, then by his truth-speaking words, And since I've taught thee that the world's great vaults Are mortal and that sky is fashioned Of frame e'en born in time, and whatsoe'er Therein go on and must perforce go on . . . . . The most I have unravelled; what remains Do thou take in, besides; since once for all To climb into that chariot' renowned . . . . . Of winds arise; and they appeased are So that all things again... . . . . Which were, are changed now, with fury stilled; All other movements through the earth and sky Which mortals gaze upon (O anxious oft In quaking thoughts!), and which abase their minds With dread of deities and press them crushed Down to the earth, because their ignorance Of cosmic causes forces them to yield All things unto the empery of gods And to concede the kingly rule to them. For even those men who have learned full well That godheads lead a long life free of care, If yet meanwhile they wonder by what plan Things can go on (and chiefly yon high things Observed o'erhead on the ethereal coasts), Again are hurried back unto the fears Of old

		religion and adopt again Harsh masters, deemed almighty,- wretched men, Unwitting what can be and what cannot, And, again, In following wise all things seem oft to quake At shock of heavy thunder, and mightiest walls Of the wide reaches of the upper world There on the instant to have sprung apart, Riven asunder, what time a gathered blast Of the fierce hurricane hath all at once Twisted its way into a mass of clouds, And, there enclosed, ever more and more Compelleth by its spinning whirl the cloud To grow all hollow with a thickened crust Surrounding; for thereafter, when the force And the keen onset of the wind have weakened That crust, lo, then the cloud, to-split in twain, Gives forth a hideous crash with bang and boom. No marvel this; since oft a bladder small, Filled up with air, will, when of sudden burst, Give forth a like large sound. There's reason, too, Why clouds make sounds, as through them blow the winds: We see, borne down the sky, oft shapes of clouds Rough-edged or branched many forky ways; And 'tis the same, as when the sudden flaws Of north-west wind through the dense forest blow, Making the leaves to sough and limbs to crash. It happens too at times that roused force Of the fierce hurricane to-rends the cloud, Breaking right through it by a front assault; For what a blast of wind may do up there Is manifest from facts when here on earth The bolts of thunder, then, must be conceived As all begotten in those crasser clouds Up-piled aloft; for, from the sky serene And from the clouds of lighter density, None are sent forth forever. That 'tis so Beyond a doubt, fact plain to sense declares: To wit, at such a time the densed clouds So mass themselves through all the upper air That we might think that round about all murk Had parted forth from Acheron and filled The mighty vaults of sky- so grievously, As gathers thus the storm-clouds' gruesome might, Do faces of black horror hang on high- When tempest begins its thunderbolts to forge. Besides, full often also out at sea A blackest thunderhead, like cataract Of pitch hurled down from heaven, and far away Bulging with murkiness, down on the waves Falls

		with vast uproar, and draws on amain The darkling tempests big with thunderbolts And hurricanes, itself the while so crammed Tremendously with fires and winds, that even Back on the lands the people shudder round And seek for cover. Therefore, as I said, The storm must be conceived as o'er our head Towering most high; for never would the clouds O'erwhelm the lands with such a massy dark, Unless up-builded heap on lofty heap, To shut the round sun off. Nor could the clouds, As on they come, engulf with rain so vast
6.31	31 seu casu seu vi, quod sic natura parasset, 32 et quibus e portis occurri cuique deceret, 33 et genus humanum frustra plerumque probavit 34 volvere curarum tristis in pectore fluctus. 35 nam vel uti pueri trepidant atque omnia caecis 36 in tenebris metuunt, sic nos in luce timemus 37 inter dum, nihilo quae sunt metuenda magis quam 38 quae pueri in tenebris pavitant finguntque futura. 39 hunc igitur terrorem animi tenebrasque necessest 40 non radii solis nec lucida tela diei 41 discutiant, sed naturae species ratioque. 42 quo magis inceptum pergam pertexere dictis. 43 Et quoniam docui mundi mortalia templa 44 esse nativo consistere corpore caelum, 45 et quae cumque in eo fiunt fierique necessest 46 pleraque dissolui, qui restant percipe porro, 47 quandoquidem semel insignem conscendere currum 48 tu mihi supremae praescripta ad candida callis 49 currenti spatium praemonstra, callida musa 50 Calliope, requies hominum divomque voluptas, 51 te duce ut insigni capiam cum laude coronam. 52 ventorum existant, placentur omnia	Purged the breasts of men, and set the bounds Of lust and terror, and exhibited The supreme good whither we all endeavour, And showed the path whereby we might arrive Thereunto by a little cross-cut straight, And what of ills in all affairs of mortals Upsprang and flitted deviously about (Whether by chance or force), since nature thus Had destined; and from out what gates a man Should sally to each combat. And he proved That mostly vainly doth the human race Roll in its bosom the grim waves of care. For just as children tremble and fear all In the viewless dark, so even we at times Dread in the light so many things that be No whit more fearsome than what children feign, Shuddering, will be upon them in the dark. This terror then, this darkness of the mind, Not sunrise with its flaring spokes of light, Nor glittering arrows of morning can disperse, But only nature's aspect and her law. Wherefore the more will I go on to weave In verses this my undertaken task. And by what law to each its scope prescribed, Its boundary stone that clings so deep in Time. Wherefore the more are they borne wandering on By blindfold reason. And, Memmius, unless From out thy mind thou spuest all of this And casteth far from thee all thoughts which be Unworthy gods and alien to their peace, Then often will the holy majesties Of the high gods be harmful unto thee, As by thy thought degraded,- not, indeed, That essence supreme of gods could be by this So outraged as in wrath to thirst to seek Revenges keen; but even because thyself Thou plaguest with the notion that the gods, Even they, the Calm Ones in serene repose, Do roll the

	rursum 53 quae fuerint, sint placato conversa furore. 54 cetera quae fieri in terris caeloque tuentur 55 mortales, pavidis cum pendent mentibus saepe 56 et faciunt animos humilis formidine divom 57 depressosque premunt ad terram propterea quod	mighty waves of wrath on wrath; Nor wilt thou enter with a serene breast Shrines of the gods; nor wilt thou able be In tranquil peace of mind to take and know Those images which from their holy bodies Are carried into intellects of men, As the announcers of their form divine. What sort of life will follow after this 'Tis thine to see. But that afar from us Veriest reason may drive such life away, Much yet remains to be embellished yet In polished verses, albeit hath issued forth So much from me already; lo, there is The law and aspect of the sky to be By reason grasped; there are the tempest times A blast more gentle yet uptwists tall trees And sucks them madly from their deepest roots. Besides, among the clouds are waves, and these Give, as they roughly break, a rumbling roar; As when along deep streams or the great sea Breaks the loud surf. It happens, too, whenever Out from one cloud into another falls The fiery energy of thunderbolt, That straightaway the cloud, if full of wet, Extinguishes the fire with mighty noise; As iron, white from the hot furnaces, Sizzles, when speedily we've plunged its glow Down the cold water. Further, if a cloud More dry receive the fire, 'twill suddenly Kindle to flame and burn with monstrous sound, As if a flame with whirl of winds should range Along the laurel-tressed mountains far, Upburning with its vast assault those trees; Nor is there aught that in the crackling flame Consumes with sound more terrible to man Than Delphic laurel of Apollo lord. Oft, too, the multitudinous crash of ice And down-pour of swift hail gives forth a sound Among the mighty clouds on high; for when The wind hath packed them close, each mountain mass Of rain-cloud, there congealed utterly And mixed with hail-stones, breaks and booms... . . . . . As thus to make the rivers overflow And fields to float, if ether were not thus Furnished with lofty-piled clouds. Lo, then, Here be all things fulfilled with winds and fires- Hence the long lightnings and the thunders loud. For, verily, I've taught thee even now How cavernous clouds hold seeds innumerable Of fiery exhalations, and they must From off the

		sunbeams and the heat of these Take many still. And so, when that same wind (Which, haply, into one region of the sky Collects those clouds) hath pressed from out the same The many fiery seeds, and with that fire Hath at the same time inter-mixed itself, O then and there that wind, a whirlwind now, Deep in the belly of the cloud spins round In narrow confines, and sharpens there inside In glowing furnaces the thunderbolt. For in a two-fold manner is that wind Enkindled all: it trembles into heat Both by its own velocity and by Repeated touch of fire. Thereafter, when The energy of wind is heated through And the fierce impulse of the fire hath sped Deeply within, O then the thunderbolt, Now ripened, so to say, doth suddenly Splinter the cloud, and the aroused flash Leaps onward, lumining with forky light All places round. And followeth anon A clap so heavy that the skiey vaults,
6.58	58 ignorantia causarum conferre deorum 59 cogit ad imperium res et concedere regnum. 60 61 62 nam bene qui didicere deos securum agere aevom, 63 si tamen interea mirantur qua ratione 64 quaeque geri possint, praesertim rebus in illis 65 quae supera caput aetheriis cernuntur in oris, 66 rursus in antiquas referuntur religionis 67 et dominos acris adsciscunt, omnia posse 68 quos miseri credunt, ignari quid queat esse, 69 quid nequeat, finita potestas denique cuique 70 qua nam sit ratione atque alte terminus haerens; 71 quo magis errantes caeca ratione feruntur. 72 quae nisi respuis ex animo longeque remittis 73 dis indigna putare alienaque pacis eorum, 74 delibata deum per te tibi numina sancta 75 saepe oberunt; non quo violari summa deum vis	And the bright lightnings to be hymned now- Even what they do and from what cause soe'er They're borne along- that thou mayst tremble not, Marking off regions of prophetic skies For auguries, O foolishly distraught Even as to whence the flying flame hath come, Or to which half of heaven it turns, or how Through walled places it hath wound its way, Or, after proving its dominion there, How it hath speeded forth from thence amain- Whereof nowise the causes do men know, And think divinities are working there. Do thou, Calliope, ingenious Muse, Solace of mortals and delight of gods, Point out the course before me, as I race On to the white line of the utmost goal, That I may get with signal praise the crown, With thee my guide!

	76 possit, ut ex ira poenas petere inbibat acris, 77 sed quia tute tibi placida cum pace quietos 78 constitues magnos irarum volvere fluctus, 79 nec delubra deum placido cum pectore adibis, 80 nec de corpore quae sancto simulacra feruntur 81 in mentes hominum divinae nuntia formae, 82 suscipere haec animi tranquilla pace valebis. 83 inde videre licet qualis iam vita sequatur. 84 quam quidem ut a nobis ratio verissima longe 85 reiciat, quamquam sunt a me multa profecta, 86 multa tamen restant et sunt ornanda politis 87 versibus; est ratio caeliQUE ignisque tenenda,	
6.88	88 sunt tempestates et fulmina clara canenda, 89 quid faciant et qua de causa cumque ferantur; 90 ne trepides caeli divisis partibus amens, 91 unde volans ignis pervenerit aut in utram se 92 verterit hinc partim, quo pacto per loca saepta 93 insinuarit, et hinc dominatus ut extulerit se. 94 95 96 Principio tonitru quatiuntur caerula caeli 97 propterea quia concurrunt sublime volantes 98 aetheriae nubes contra pugnantibus ventis. 99 nec fit enim sonitus caeli de parte serena, 100 verum ubi cumque magis denso sunt agmine nubes, 101 tam magis hinc magno fremitus fit murmure saepe. 102 praeterea neque tam condenso corpore nubes 103 esse queunt quam sunt lapides ac ligna, neque autem 104 tam tenues quam sunt nebulae fumique volantes; 105 nam cadere aut bruto deberent pondere pressae	

	106 ut lapides, aut ut fumus constare nequirent 107 nec cohibere nives gelidas et grandinis imbris. 108 Dant etiam sonitum patuli super aequora mundi, 109 carbasus ut quondam magnis intenta theatris 110 dat crepitum malos inter iactata trabesque, 111 inter dum perscissa furit petulantibus auris 112 et fragilis chartarum commeditatur; 113 id quoque enim genus in tonitru cognoscere possis, 114 aut ubi suspensam vestem chartasque volantis 115 verberibus venti versant planguntque per auras. 116 fit quoque enim inter dum non tam concurrere nubes 117 frontibus adversis possint quam de latere ire	
6.118	118 diverso motu radentes corpora tractim, 119 aridus unde auris terget sonus ille diuque 120 ducitur, exierunt donec regionibus artis. 121 Hoc etiam pacto tonitru concussa videntur 122 omnia saepe gravi tremere et divolsa repente 123 maxima dissiluisse capacis moenia mundi, 124 cum subito validi venti conlecta procella 125 nubibus intorsit sese conclusaque ibidem 126 turbine versanti magis ac magis undique nubem 127 cogit uti fiat spisso cava corpore circum, 128 post ubi conminuit vis eius et impetus acer, 129 tum perterricrepo sonitu dat scissa fragorem. 130 nec mirum, cum plena animae vensicula parva 131 saepe haud dat parvum sonitum displosa repente. 132 Est etiam ratio, cum venti nubila perflant, 133 ut sonitus faciant; etenim ramosa videmus 134 nubila saepe modis multis atque aspera ferri;	

	135 scilicet ut, crebram silvam cum flamina cauri 136 perflant, dant sonitum frondes ramique fragorem. 137 Fit quoque ut inter dum validi vis incita venti 138 perscindat nubem perfringens impete recto; 139 nam quid possit ibi flatus manifesta docet res, 140 hic, ubi lenior est, in terra cum tamen alta 141 arbusta evolvens radicibus haurit ab imis. 142 sunt etiam fluctus per nubila, qui quasi murmur 143 dant in frangendo graviter; quod item fit in altis 144 fluminibus magnoque mari, cum frangitur aestus. 145 Fit quoque, ubi e nubi in nubem vis incidit ardens 146 fulminis; haec multo si forte umore recepit 147 ignem, continuo magno clamore trucidat;	
6.148	148 ut calidis candens ferrum e fornacibus olim 149 stridit, ubi in gelidum propter demersimus imbrem. 150 Aridior porro si nubes accipit ignem, 151 uritur ingenti sonitu succensa repente, 152 lauricomos ut si per montis flamma vagetur 153 turbine ventorum comburens impete magno; 154 nec res ulla magis quam Phoebi Delphica laurus 155 terribili sonitu flamma crepitante crematur. 156 Denique saepe geli multus fragor atque ruina 157 grandinis in magnis sonitum dat nubibus alte; 158 ventus enim cum confercit, franguntur in artum 159 concreti montes nimborum et grandine mixti. 160 Fulgit item, nubes ignis cum semina multa 161 excussere suo concursu, ceu lapidem si 162 percutiat lapis aut ferrum; nam tum quoque lumen 163 exilit et claras scintillas dissipat ignis.	Likewise, it lightens, when the clouds have struck, By their collision, forth the seeds of fire: As if a stone should smite a stone or steel, For light then too leaps forth and fire then scatters The shining sparks. But with our ears we get The thunder after eyes behold the flash, Because forever things arrive the ears More tardily than the eyes- as thou mayst see From this example too: when markest thou Some man far yonder felling a great tree With double-edged ax, it comes to pass Thine eye beholds the swinging stroke before The blow gives forth a sound athrough thine ears: Thus also we behold the flashing ere We hear the thunder, which discharged is At same time with the fire and by same cause, Born of the same collision. In following wise The clouds suffuse with leaping light the lands, And the storm flashes with tremulous elan: When the wind hath invaded a cloud, and, whirling there, Hath wrought (as I have shown above) the cloud Into a hollow with a thickened crust, It becomes hot of own velocity: Just as thou seest how motion will o'erheat And set ablaze all objects,- verily A leaden ball, hurtling through length of space, Even melts. Therefore, when this same wind a-fire Hath split

	164 sed tonitrum fit uti post auribus accipiamus, 165 fulgere quam cernant oculi, quia semper ad auris 166 tardius adveniunt quam visum quae moveant res. 167 id licet hinc etiam cognoscere: caedere si quem 168 ancipiti videas ferro procul arboris auctum, 169 ante fit ut cernas ictum quam plaga per auris 170 det sonitum; sic fulgorem quoque cernimus ante 171 quam tonitrum accipimus, pariter qui mittitur igni 172 e simili causa, concursu natus eodem. 173 Hoc etiam pacto volucri loca lumine tingunt 174 nubes et tremulo tempestas impete fulgit. 175 ventus ubi invasit nubem et versatus ibidem 176 fecit ut ante cavam docui spissescere nubem, 177 mobilitate sua fervescit; ut omnia motu	black cloud, it scatters the fire-seeds, Which, so to say, have been pressed out by force Of sudden from the cloud;- and these do make The pulsing flashes of flame; thence followeth The detonation which attacks our ears More tardily than aught which comes along Unto the sight of eyeballs. This takes place- As know thou mayst- at times when clouds are dense And one upon the other piled aloft With wonderful upheavings- nor be thou Deceived because we see how broad their base From underneath, and not how high they tower. For make thine observations at a time When winds shall bear athwart the horizon's blue Clouds like to mountain-ranges moving on, Or when about the sides of mighty peaks Thou seest them one upon the other massed And burdening downward, anchored in high repose, With the winds sepulchred on all sides round: Then canst thou know their mighty masses, then Canst view their caverns, as if builded there Of beetling crags; which, when the hurricanes In gathered storm have filled utterly, Then, prisoned in clouds, they rave around With mighty roarings, and within those dens Bluster like savage beasts, and now from here, And now from there, send growlings through the clouds, And seeking an outlet, whirl themselves about, And roll from 'mid the clouds the seeds of fire, And heap them multitudinously there, And in the hollow furnaces within Wheel flame around, until from bursted cloud In forky flashes they have gleamed forth.
6.178	178 percalefacta vides ardescere, plumbea vero 179 glans etiam longo cursu volvenda liquescit. 180 ergo fervidus hic nubem cum perscidit atram, 181 dissipat ardoris quasi per vim expressa repente 182 semina, quae faciunt nictantia fulgura flammae; 183 inde sonus sequitur, qui tardius adlicit auris 184 quam quae perveniunt oculorum ad lumina nostra. 185 scilicet hoc densis fit nubibus et simul alte 186 extructis aliis alias super impete miro. 187 ne tibi sit frudi quod nos inferne	Again, from following cause it comes to pass That yon swift golden hue of liquid fire Darts downward to the earth: because the clouds Themselves must hold abundant seeds of fire; For, when they be without all moisture, then They be for most part of a flamy hue And a resplendent. And, indeed, they must Even from the light of sun unto themselves Take multitudinous seeds, and so perforce Redden and pour their bright fires all abroad. And therefore, when the wind hath driven and thrust, Hath forced and squeezed into one spot these clouds, They pour abroad the seeds of fire pressed out, Which make to flash these colours of the flame. Likewise, it lightens also when the clouds Grow rare and thin along the

	videmus 188 quam sint lata magis quam sursum extructa quid extent. 189 contemplator enim, cum montibus adsimulata 190 nubila portabunt venti transversa per auras, 191 aut ubi per magnos montis cumulata videbis 192 insuper esse aliis alia atque urguere superna 193 in statione locata sepultis undique ventis; 194 tum poteris magnas moles cognoscere eorum 195 speluncasque vel ut saxis pendentibus structas 196 cernere, quas venti cum tempestate coorta 197 conplerunt, magno indignantur murmure clausi 198 nubibus in caveisque ferarum more minantur, 199 nunc hinc nunc illinc fremitus per nubila mittunt, 200 quaerentesque viam circum versantur et ignis 201 semina convolvunt nubibus atque ita cogunt 202 multa rotantque cavis flammam fornacibus intus, 203 donec divolsa fulserunt nube corusci. 204 Hac etiam fit uti de causa mobilis ille 205 devolet in terram liquidi color aureus ignis, 206 semina quod nubes ipsas permulta necessust 207 ignis habere; etenim cum sunt umore sine ullo,	sky; for, when The wind with gentle touch unravels them And breaketh asunder as they move, those seeds Which make the lightnings must by nature fall; At such an hour the horizon lightens round Without the hideous terror of dread noise And skiey uproar.
6.208	208 flammeus plerumque colos et splendidus ollis. 209 quippe etenim solis de lumine multa necessest 210 concipere, ut merito rubeant ignesque profundant. 211 hasce igitur cum ventus agens contrusit in unum 212 compressitque locum cogens, expressa profundunt 213 semina, quae faciunt flammae fulgere colores. 214 Fulgit item, cum rarescunt quoque nubila caeli; 215 nam cum ventus eas leviter diducit euntis 216 dissoluitque, cadant ingratius illa	

	necessest 217 semina quae faciunt fulgorem. tum sine taetro 218 terrore atque sonis fulgit nulloque tumultu. 219 Quod superest, natura praedita constent 220 fulmina, declarant ictus et inusta vaporis 221 signa notaeque gravis halantis sulpuris auras; 222 ignis enim sunt haec non venti signa neque imbris. 223 praeterea saepe accendunt quoque tecta domorum 224 et celeri flamma dominantur in aedibus ipsis. 225 hunc tibi subtilem cum primis ignibus ignem 226 constituit natura minutis mobilibusque 227 corporibus, cui nil omnino obsistere possit. 228 transit enim validum fulmen per saepta domorum 229 clamor ut ac voces, transit per saxa, per aera 230 et liquidum puncto facit aes in tempore et aurum. 231 curat item vasis integris vina repente 232 diffugiant, quia ni mirum facile omnia circum 233 conlaxat rareque facit lateramina vasis 234 adveniens calor eius et insinuatus in ipsum 235 mobiliter soluens differt primordia vini. 236 quod solis vapor aetatem non posse videtur 237 efficere usque adeo pollens fervore corusco.	
6.238	238 tanto mobilior vis et dominantior haec est. 239 Nunc ea quo pacto gignantur et impete tanto 240 fiant ut possint ictu discludere turris, 241 disturbare domos, avellere tigna trabesque 242 et monimenta virum commoliri atque ciere, 243 exanimare homines, pecudes prosternere passim, 244 cetera de genere hoc qua vi facere omnia possint, 245 expediam neque in promissis plura	

	morabor. 246 Fulmina gignier e crassis alteque putandumst 247 nubibus extructis; nam caelo nulla sereno 248 nec leviter densis mittuntur nubibus umquam. 249 nam dubio procul hoc fieri manifesta docet res; 250 quod tunc per totum concrescunt aeeraaeëra nubes, 251 undique uti tenebras omnis Acherunta reamur 252 liquisse et magnas caeli complesse cavernas, 253 aeusqueæusque adeo tetra nimborum nocte coorta 254 inpendent atrae formidinis ora superne,aeæ 255 cum commoliri tempestas fulmina coeptat. 256 praeterea persaepe niger quoque per mare nimbus, 257 ut picis e caelo demissum flumen, in undas 258 sic cadit effertus tenebris procul et trahit atram 259 fulminibus gravidam tempestatem atque procellis, 260 ignibus ac ventis cum primis ipse repletus, 261 in terra quoque ut horrescant ac tecta requirant. 262 sic igitur supera nostrum caput esse putandumst 263 tempestatem altam; neque enim caligine tanta 264 obruerent terras, nisi inaedificata superne 265 multa forent multis exempto nubila sole; 266 nec tanto possent venientes opprimere imbri, 267 flumina abundare ut facerent camposque natare,	
6.268	268 si non extructis foret alte nubibus aether. 269 hic igitur ventis atque ignibus omnia plena 270 sunt; ideo passim fremitus et fulgura fiunt. 271 quippe etenim supra docui permulta vaporis 272 semina habere cavas nubes et multa necessest 273 concipere ex solis radiis ardoreque eorum. 274 hoc ubi ventus eas idem qui cogit	

	in unum 275 forte locum quemvis, expressit multa vaporis 276 semina seque simul cum eo commiscuit igni, 277 insinuatus ibi vortex versatur in arto 278 et calidis acuit fulmen fornacibus intus; 279 nam duplici ratione accenditur: ipse sua cum 280 mobilitate calescit et e contagibus ignis. 281 inde ubi percaluit venti vis gravis ignis 282 impetus incessit, maturum tum quasi fulmen 283 perscindit subito nubem ferturque coruscis 284 omnia luminibus lustrans loca percitus ardor. 285 quem gravis insequitur sonitus, displosa repente 286 opprimere ut caeli videantur templa superne. 287 inde tremor terras graviter pertemptat et altum 288 murmura percurrunt caelum; nam tota fere tum 289 tempestas concussa tremit fremitusque moventur. 290 quo de concussu sequitur gravis imber et uber, 291 omnis uti videatur in imbrem vertier aether 292 atque ita praecipitans ad diluviem revocare; 293 tantus discidio nubis ventique procella 294 mittitur, ardenti sonitus cum provolat ictu. 295 Est etiam cum vis extrinsecus incita venti 296 incidit in validam maturo culmine nubem; 297 quam cum perscidit, extemplo cadit igneus ille	
6.298	298 vertex, quem patrio vocitamus nomine fulmen. 299 hoc fit idem in partis alias, quo cumque tulit vis. 300 Fit quoque ut inter dum venti vis missa sine igni 301 igniscat tamen in spatio longoque meatu, 302 dum venit amittens in cursu corpora quaedam 303 grandia, quae nequeunt pariter	

	penetrare per auras, 304 atque alia ex ipso conradens aeereaeëre portat 305 parvola, quae faciunt ignem commixta volando; 306 non alia longe ratione ac plumbea saepe 307 fervida fit glans in cursu, cum multa rigoris 308 corpora dimittens ignem concepit in auris. 309 Fit quoque ut ipsius plagae vis excitet ignem, 310 frigida cum venti pepulit vis missa sine igni, 311 ni mirum quia, cum vehementi perculit ictu, 312 confluere ex ipso possunt elementa vaporis 313 et simul ex illa quae tum res excipit ictum; 314 ut, lapidem ferro cum caedimus, evolat ignis, 315 nec, quod frigida vis ferrist, hoc setius illi 316 semina concurrunt calidi fulgoris ad ictum. 317 sic igitur quoque res accendi fulmine debet, 318 opportuna fuit si forte et idonea flammis. 319 nec temere omnino plane vis frigida venti 320 esse potest, ea quae tanta vi missa supernest, 321 quin, prius in cursu si non accenditur igni, 322 at tepefacta tamen veniat commixta calore. 323 Mobilitas autem fit fulminis et gravis ictus 324 et celeri ferme percurrunt fulmina lapsu, 325 nubibus ipsa quod omnino prius incita se vis 326 colligit et magnum conamen sumit eundi, 327 inde ubi non potuit nubes capere inpetis auctum,	
6.328	328 exprimitur vis atque ideo volat impete miro, 329 ut validis quae de tormentis missa feruntur. 330 Adde quod e parvis et levibus est elementis, 331 nec facilest tali naturae obsistere quicquam; 332 inter enim fugit ac penetrat per	

	rara viarum, 333 non igitur multis offensibus in remorando 334 haesitat, hanc ob rem celeri volat impete labens. 335 Deinde, quod omnino natura pondera deorsum 336 omnia nituntur, cum plagast addita vero, 337 mobilitas duplicatur et impetus ille gravescit, 338 ut vehementius et citius quae cumque morantur 339 obvia discutiat plagis itinerque sequatur. 340 Denique quod longo venit impete, sumere debet 341 mobilitatem etiam atque etiam, quae crescit eundo 342 et validas auget viris et roborat ictum; 343 nam facit ut quae sint illius semina cumque 344 e regione locum quasi in unum cuncta ferantur, 345 omnia coniciens in eum volventia cursum. 346 Forsitan ex ipso veniens trahat aeereaeëre quaedam 347 corpora, quae plagis incendunt mobilitatem. 348 incolumisque venit per res atque integra transit 349 multa, foraminibus liquidus quia transviat ignis. 350 multaque perfringit, cum corpora fulminis ipsa 351 corporibus rerum inciderunt, qua texta tenentur. 352 dissoluit porro facile aes aurumque repente 353 conferve facit, e parvis quia facta minute 354 corporibus vis est et levibus ex elementis, 355 quae facile insinuantur et insinuata repente 356 dissoluont nodos omnis et vincla relaxant. 357 Autumnoque magis stellis fulgentibus alta	
6.358	358 concutitur caeli domus undique totaque tellus, 359 et cum tempora se veris florentia pandunt. 360 frigore enim desunt ignes ventique calore 361 deficiunt neque sunt tam denso	

	corpore nubes. 362 interutrasque igitur cum caeli tempora constant, 363 tum variae causae concurrunt fulminis omnes. 364 nam fretus ipse anni permiscet frigus aestum. 365 quorum utrumque opus est fabricanda ad fulmina nubi, 366 ut discordia rerum magnoque tumultu 367 ignibus et ventis furibundus fluctuet aeeraeër. 368 prima caloris enim pars est postrema rigoris; 369 tempus id est vernum; quare pugnare necessest 370 dissimilis inter se turbareque mixtas. 371 et calor extremus primo cum frigore mixtus 372 volvitur, autumni quod fertur nomine tempus, 373 hic quoque confligunt hiemes aestatibus acres. 374 propterea sunt haec anni nominitanda, 375 nec mirumst, in eo si tempore plurima fiunt 376 fulmina tempestasque cietur turbida caelo, 377 ancipiti quoniam bello turbatur utrimque, 378 hinc flammis, illinc ventis umoreque mixto. 379 Hoc est igniferi naturam fulminis ipsam 380 perspicere et qua vi faciat rem quamque videre, 381 non Tyrrhena retro volventem carmina frustra 382 indicia occultae divum perquirere mentis, 383 unde volans ignis pervenerit aut in utram se 384 verterit hinc partim, quo pacto per loca saepta 385 insinuarit, et hinc dominatus ut extulerit se, 386 quidve nocere queat de caelo fulminis ictus. 387 quod si Iuppiter atque alii fulgentia divi	
6.388	388 terrifico quatiunt sonitu caelestia templa 389 et iaciunt ignem quo cuiquest cumque voluntas, 390 cur quibus incautum scelus	

	aversabile cumquest 391 non faciunt icti flammas ut fulguris halent 392 pectore perfixo, documen mortalibus acre, 393 et potius nulla sibi turpi conscius in re 394 volvitur in flammis innoxius inque peditur 395 turbine caelesti subito correptus et igni? 396 cur etiam loca sola petunt frustraque laborant? 397 an tum bracchia consuescunt firmantque lacertos? 398 in terraque patris cur telum perpetiuntur 399 optundi? cur ipse sinit neque parcit in hostis? 400 denique cur numquam caelo iacit undique puro 401 Iuppiter in terras fulmen sonitusque profundit? 402 an simul ac nubes successere, ipse in eas tum 403 descendit, prope ut hinc teli determinet ictus? 404 in mare qua porro mittit ratione? quid undas 405 arguit et liquidam molem camposque natantis? 406 praeterea si vult caveamus fulminis ictum, 407 cur dubitat facere ut possimus cernere missum? 408 si nec opinantis autem volt opprimere igni, 409 cur tonat ex illa parte, ut vitare queamus, 410 cur tenebras ante et fremitus et murmura concit? 411 et simul in multas partis qui credere possis 412 mittere? an hoc ausis numquam contendere factum, 413 ut fierent ictus uno sub tempore plures? 414 at saepest numero factum fierique necessest, 415 ut pluere in multis regionibus et cadere imbris, 416 fulmina sic uno fieri sub tempore multa. 417 postremo cur sancta deum delubra suasque	
6.418	418 discutit infesto praeclaras fulmine sedes 419 et bene facta deum frangit	But to return apace, Easy it is from these same facts to know In just what wise those things (which from their sort

	simulacra suisque 420 demit imaginibus violento volnere honorem? 421 altaque cur plerumque petit loca plurimaque eius 422 montibus in summis vestigia cernimus ignis? 423 Quod super est, facilest ex his cognoscere rebus, 424 presteras Graii quos ab re nominitarunt, 425 in mare qua missi veniant ratione superne. 426 nam fit ut inter dum tam quam demissa columna 427 in mare de caelo descendat, quam freta circum 428 fervescunt graviter spirantibus incita flabris, 429 et quae cumque in eo tum sint deprensa tumultu 430 navigia in summum veniant vexata periclum. 431 hoc fit ubi inter dum non quit vis incita venti 432 rumpere quam coepit nubem, sed deprimit, ut sit 433 in mare de caelo tam quam demissa columna, 434 paulatim, quasi quid pugno bracchique superne 435 coniectu trudatur et extendatur in undas; 436 quam cum discidit, hinc prorumpitur in mare venti 437 vis et fervorem mirum concinnat in undis; 438 versabundus enim turbo descendit et illam 439 deducit pariter lento cum corpore nubem; 440 quam simul ac gravidam detrusit ad aequora ponti, 441 ille in aquam subito totum se inmittit et omne 442 excitat ingenti sonitu mare fervere cogens. 443 Fit quoque ut involvat venti se nubibus ipse 444 vertex conradens ex aeereaeëre semina nubis 445 et quasi demissum caelo prestera imitetur; 446 hic ubi se in terras demisit dissoluitque, 447 turbinis immanem vim provomit atque procellae.	The Greeks have named "bellows") do come down, Discharged from on high, upon the seas. For it haps that sometimes from the sky descends Upon the seas a column, as if pushed, Round which the surges seethe, tremendously Aroused by puffing gusts; and whatso'er Of ships are caught within that tumult then Come into extreme peril, dashed along. This haps when sometimes wind's aroused force Can't burst the cloud it tries to, but down-weighs That cloud, until 'tis like a column from sky Upon the seas pushed downward- gradually, As if a Somewhat from on high were shoved By fist and nether thrust of arm, and lengthened Far to the waves. And when the force of wind Hath rived this cloud, from out the cloud it rushes Down on the seas, and starts among the waves A wondrous seething, for the eddying whirl Descends and downward draws along with it That cloud of ductile body. And soon as ever 'Thas shoved unto the levels of the main That laden cloud, the whirl suddenly then Plunges its whole self into the waters there And rouses all the sea with monstrous roar, Constraining it to seethe. It happens too That very vortex of the wind involves Itself in clouds, scraping from out the air The seeds of cloud, and counterfeits, as 'twere, The "bellows" pushed from heaven. And when this shape Hath dropped upon the lands and burst apart, It belches forth immeasurable might Of whirlwind and of blast. Yet since 'tis formed At most but rarely, and on land the hills Must block its way, 'tis seen more oft out there On the broad prospect of the level main Along the free horizons. Into being The clouds condense, when in this upper space Of the high heaven have gathered suddenly, As round they flew, unnumbered particles- World's rougher ones, which can, though interlinked With scanty couplings, yet be fastened firm, The one on other caught. These particles First cause small clouds to form; and, thereupon, These catch the one on other and swarm in a flock And grow by their conjoining, and by winds Are borne along, along, until collects The tempest fury. Happens, too, the nearer The mountain summits neighbour to the

		sky, The more unceasingly their far crags smoke With the thick darkness of swart cloud, because When first the mists do form, ere ever the eyes Can there behold them (tenuous as they be), The carrier-winds will drive them up and on Unto the topmost summits of the mountain; And then at last it happens, when they be In vaster throng upgathered, that they can By this very condensation lie revealed, And that at same time they are seen to surge From very vertex of the mountain up Into far ether. For very fact and feeling, As we up-climb high mountains, proveth clear That windy are those upward regions free.
6.448	448 sed quia fit raro omnino montisque necessest 449 officere in terris, apparet crebrius idem 450 prospectu maris in magno caeloque patenti. 451 Nubila concrescunt, ubi corpora multa volando 452 hoc super in caeli spatio coiere repente 453 asperiora, modis quae possint indupedita 454 exiguis tamen inter se compressa teneri. 455 haec faciunt primum parvas consistere nubes; 456 inde ea comprendunt inter se conque gregantur 457 et coniungendo crescunt ventisque feruntur 458 usque adeo donec tempestas saeva coortast. 459 Fit quoque uti montis vicina cacumina caelo 460 quam sint quoque magis, tanto magis edita fument 461 adsidue fulvae nubis caligine crassa 462 propterea quia, cum consistunt nubila primum, 463 ante videre oculi quam possint tenvia, venti 464 portantes cogunt ad summa cacumina montis; 465 hic demum fit uti turba maiore coorta 466 et condensa queant apparere et simul ipso 467 vertice de montis videantur surgere in aethram. 468 nam loca declarat sursum ventosa	

	patere 469 res ipsa et sensus, montis cum ascendimus altos. 470 Praeterea permulta mari quoque tollere toto 471 corpora naturam declarant litore vestis 472 suspensae, cum concipiunt umoris adhaesum. 473 quo magis ad nubis augendas multa videntur 474 posse quoque e salso consurgere momine ponti; 475 nam ratio consanguineast umoribus omnis. 476 Praeterea fluviis ex omnibus et simul ipsa 477 surgere de terra nebulas aestumque videmus,	
6.478	478 quae vel ut halitus hinc ita sursum expressa feruntur 479 suffunduntque sua caelum caligine et altas 480 sufficiunt nubis paulatim conveniundo; 481 urget enim quoque signiferi super aetheris aestus 482 et quasi densendo subtexit caerula nimbis. 483 Fit quoque ut hunc veniant in caelum extrinsecus illa 484 corpora quae faciunt nubis nimbosque volantis; 485 innumerabilem enim numerum summamque profundi 486 esse infinitam docui, quantaque volarent 487 corpora mobilitate ostendi quamque repente 488 immemorabile spatium transire solerent. 489 haut igitur mirumst, si parvo tempore saepe 490 tam magnis ventis tempestas atque tenebrae 491 coperiant maria ac terras inpensa superne, 492 undique quandoquidem per caulas aetheris omnis 493 et quasi per magni circum spiracula mundi 494 exitus introitusque elementis redditus extat. 495 Nunc age, quo pacto pluvius concrescat in altis 496 nubibus umor et in terras demissus ut imber 497 decidat, expediam. primum iam	

	semina aquai 498 multa simul vincam consurgere nubibus ipsis 499 omnibus ex rebus pariterque ita crescere utrumque 500 et nubis et aquam, quae cumque in nubibus extat, 501 ut pariter nobis corpus cum sanguine crescit, 502 sudor item atque umor qui cumque est denique membris. 503 concipiunt etiam multum quoque saepe marinum 504 umorem, vel uti pendentia vellera lanae, 505 cum supera magnum mare venti nubila portant. 506 consimili ratione ex omnibus amnibus umor 507 tollitur in nubis. quo cum bene semina aquarum	
6.508	508 multa modis multis convenere undique adaucta, 509 confertae nubes umorem mittere certant 510 dupliciter; nam vis venti contrudit et ipsa 511 copia nimborum turba maiore coacta 512 urget et e supero premit ac facit effluere imbris. 513 praeterea cum rarescunt quoque nubila ventis 514 aut dissolvuntur solis super icta calore, 515 mittunt umorem pluvium stillantque, quasi igni 516 cera super calido tabescens multa liquescat. 517 sed vehemens imber fit, ubi vehementer utraque 518 nubila vi cumulata premuntur et impete venti. 519 at retinere diu pluviae longumque morari 520 consuerunt, ubi multa cientur semina aquarum 521 atque aliis aliae nubes nimbique rigantes 522 insuper atque omni vulgo de parte feruntur, 523 terraque cum fumans umorem tota redhalat. 524 hic ubi sol radiis tempestatem inter opacam 525 adversa fulsit nimborum aspargine contra, 526 tum color in nigris existit nubibus	

	arqui. 527 Cetera quae sursum crescunt sursumque creantur, 528 et quae concrescunt in nubibus, omnia, prorsum 529 omnia, nix venti grando gelidaeque pruinae 530 et vis magna geli, magnum duramen aquarum, 531 et mora quae fluvios passim refrenat aventis, 532 perfacilest tamen haec reperire animoque videre, 533 omnia quo pacto fiant quareve creentur, 534 cum bene cognoris elementis reddita quae sint. 535 Nunc age, quae ratio terrai motibus extet 536 percipe. et in primis terram fac ut esse rearis 537 supter item ut supera ventosis undique plenam	
6.538	538 speluncis multosque lacus multasque lucunas 539 in gremio gerere et rupes deruptaque saxa; 540 multaque sub tergo terrai flumina tecta 541 volvere vi fluctus summersos ca putandumst; 542 undique enim similem esse sui res postulat ipsa. 543 his igitur rebus subiunctis suppositisque 544 terra superne tremit magnis concussa ruinis, 545 subter ubi ingentis speluncas subruit aetas; 546 quippe cadunt toti montes magnoque repente 547 concussu late disserpunt inde tremores. 548 et merito, quoniam plaustris concussa tremescunt 549 tecta viam propter non magno pondere tota, 550 nec minus exultant, si quidvis cumque viai 551 ferratos utrimque rotarum succutit orbes. 552 Fit quoque, ubi in magnas aquae vastasque lucunas 553 gleba vetustate e terra provolvitur ingens, 554 ut iactetur aquae fluctu quoque terra vacillans; 555 ut vas inter non quit constare, nisi	

	umor 556 destitit in dubio fluctu iactarier intus. 557 Praeterea ventus cum per loca subcava terrae 558 collectus parte ex una procumbit et urget 559 obnixus magnis speluncas viribus altas, 560 incumbit tellus quo venti prona premit vis. 561 tum supera terram quae sunt extructa domorum 562 ad caelumque magis quanto sunt edita quaeque, 563 inclinata minent in eandem prodita partem 564 protractaeque trabes inpendent ire paratae. 565 et metuunt magni naturam credere mundi 566 exitiale aliquod tempus clademque manere, 567 cum videant tantam terrarum incumbere molem!	
6.568	568 quod nisi respirent venti, nulla refrenet 569 res neque ab exitio possit reprehendere euntis; 570 nunc quia respirant alternis inque gravescunt 571 et quasi collecti redeunt ceduntque repulsi, 572 saepius hanc ob rem minitatur terra ruinas 573 quam facit; inclinatur enim retroque recellit 574 et recipit prolapsa suas in pondere sedes. 575 hac igitur ratione vacillant omnia tecta, 576 summa magis mediis, media imis, ima perhilum. 577 Est haec eiusdem quoque magni causa tremoris. 578 ventus ubi atque animae subito vis maxima quaedam 579 aut extrinsecus aut ipsa tellure coorta 580 in loca se cava terrai coniecit ibique 581 speluncas inter magnas fremit ante tumultu 582 versabundaQUE portatur, post incita cum vis 583 exagitata foras erumpitur et simul altam 584 diffindens terram magnum	

	concinnat hiatum. 585 in Syria Sidone quod accidit et fuit Aegi 586 in Peloponneso, quas exitus hic animai 587 disturbat urbes et terrae motus obortus. 588 multaque praeterea ceciderunt moenia magnis 589 motibus in terris et multae per mare pessum 590 subsedere suis pariter cum civibus urbes. 591 quod nisi prorumpit, tamen impetus ipse animai 592 et fera vis venti per crebra foramina terrae 593 dispertitur ut horror et incutit inde tremorem; 594 frigus uti nostros penitus cum venit in artus, 595 concutit invitos cogens tremere atque movere. 596 ancipiti trepidant igitur terrore per urbis, 597 tecta superne timent, metuunt inferne cavernas	
6.598	598 terrai ne dissoluat natura repente, 599 neu distracta suum late dispandat hiatum 600 idque suis confusa velit complere ruinis. 601 proinde licet quamvis caelum terramque reantur 602 incorrupta fore aeternae mandata saluti: 603 et tamen inter dum praesens vis ipsa pericli 604 subdit et hunc stimulum quadam de parte timoris, 605 ne pedibus raptim tellus subtracta feratur 606 in barathrum rerumque sequatur prodita summa 607 funditus et fiat mundi confusa ruina. 608 Principio mare mirantur non reddere maius 609 naturam, quo sit tantus decursus aquarum, 610 omnia quo veniant ex omni flumina parte. 611 adde vagos imbris tempestatesque volantes, 612 omnia quae maria ac terras sparguntque rigantque; 613 adde suos fontis; tamen ad maris	

	omnia summam 614 guttai vix instar erunt unius adaugmen; 615 quo minus est mirum mare non augescere magnum. 616 Praeterea magnam sol partem detrahit aestu. 617 quippe videmus enim vestis umore madentis 618 exsiccare suis radiis ardentibus solem; 619 at pelage multa et late substrata videmus. 620 proinde licet quamvis ex uno quoque loco sol 621 umoris parvam delibet ab aequore partem, 622 largiter in tanto spatio tamen auferet undis. 623 Tum porro venti quoque magnam tollere partem 624 umoris possunt verrentes aequora, ventis 625 una nocte vias quoniam persaepe videmus 626 siccari mollisque luti concrescere crustas.	
6.627	627 Praeterea docui multum quoque tollere nubes 628 umorem magno conceptum ex aequore ponti 629 et passim toto terrarum spargere in orbi, 630 cum pluit in terris et venti nubila portant. 631 Postremo quoniam raro cum corpore tellus 632 est et coniunctast oras maris undique cingens, 633 debet, ut in mare de terris venit umor aquai, 634 in terras itidem manare ex aequore salso; 635 percolatur enim virus retroque remanat 636 materies umoris et ad caput amnibus omnis 637 confluit, inde super terras redit agmine dulci 638 qua via secta semel liquido pede detulit undas. 639 Nunc ratio quae sit, per fauces montis ut Aetnae 640 expirent ignes inter dum turbine tanto, 641 expediam; neque enim mediocri clade coorta 642 flammae tempestas Siculum	

	dominata per agros 643 finitimis ad se convertit gentibus ora, 644 fumida cum caeli scintillare omnia templa 645 cernentes pavida complebant pectora cura, 646 quid moliretur rerum natura novarum. 647 Hisce tibi in rebus latest alteque videndum 648 et longe cunctas in partis dispiciendum, 649 ut reminiscaris summam rerum esse profundam 650 et videas caelum summai totius unum 651 quam sit parvula pars et quam multesima constet 652 nec tota pars, homo terrai quota totius unus. 653 quod bene propositum si plane contueare 654 ac videas plane, mirari multa relinquas. 655 numquis enim nostrum miratur, siquis in artus 656 accepit calido febrim fervore coortam	
6.657	657 aut alium quemvis morbi per membra dolorem? 658 opturgescit enim subito pes, arripit acer 659 saepe dolor dentes, oculos invadit in ipsos, 660 existit sacer ignis et urit corpore serpens 661 quam cumque arripuit partem repitque per artus, 662 ni mirum quia sunt multarum semina rerum 663 et satis haec tellus morbi caelumque mali fert, 664 unde queat vis immensi procrescere morbi. 665 sic igitur toti caelo terraeque putandumst 666 ex infinito satis omnia suppeditare, 667 unde repente queat tellus concussa moveri 668 perque mare ac terras rapidus percurrere turbo, 669 ignis abundare Aetnaeus, flammescere caelum; 670 id quoque enim fit et ardescunt caelestia templa 671 et tempestates pluviae graviore coortu	

	672 sunt, ubi forte ita se tetulerunt semina aquarum. 673 'at nimis est ingens incendi turbidus ardor.' 674 scilicet et fluvius qui visus maximus ei, 675 qui non ante aliquem maiorem vidit, et ingens 676 arbor homoque videtur et omnia de genere omni 677 maxima quae vidit quisque, haec ingentia fingit, 678 cum tamen omnia cum caelo terraque marique 679 nil sint ad summam summai totius omnem. 680 Nunc tamen illa modis quibus inritata repente 681 flamma foras vastis Aetnae fornacibus efflet, 682 expediam. primum totius subcava montis 683 est natura fere silicum suffulta cavernis. 684 omnibus est porro in speluncis ventus et aeeraeër. 685 ventus enim fit, ubi est agitando percitus aeeraeër. 686 hic ubi percaluit cale fecitque omnia circum	
6.687	687 saxa furens, qua contingit, terramque et ab ollis 688 excussit calidum flammis velocibus ignem, 689 tollit se ac rectis ita faucibus eicit alte. 690 fert itaque ardorem longe longeque favillam 691 differt et crassa volvit caligine fumum 692 extruditque simul mirando pondere saxa; 693 ne dubites quin haec animai turbida sit vis. 694 praeterea magna ex parti mare montis ad eius 695 radices frangit fluctus aestumque resolvit. 696 ex hoc usque mari speluncae montis ad altas 697 perveniunt subter fauces. hac ire fatendumst 698 et penetrare mari penitus res cogit aperto 699 atque efflare foras ideoque extollere flammam 700 saxaque subiectare et arenae	

	tollere nimbos. 701 in summo sunt vertice enim crateres, ut ipsi 702 nominitant, nos quod fauces perhibemus et ora. 703 Sunt aliquot quoque res quarum unam dicere causam 704 non satis est, verum pluris, unde una tamen sit; 705 corpus ut exanimum siquod procul ipse iacere 706 conspicias hominis, fit ut omnis dicere causas 707 conveniat leti, dicatur ut illius una; 708 nam que eum ferro nec frigore vincere possis 709 interiisse neque a morbo neque forte veneno, 710 verum aliquid genere esse ex hoc quod contigit ei 711 scimus. item in multis hoc rebus dicere habemus. 712 Nilus in aestatem crescit campisque redundat 713 unicus in terris, Aegypti totius amnis. 714 is rigat Aegyptum medium per saepe calorem, 715 aut quia sunt aestate aquilones ostia contra,	
6.716	716 anni tempore eo, qui etesiae esse feruntur, 717 et contra fluvium flantes remorantur et undas 718 cogentes sursus replent coguntque manere. 719 nam dubio procul haec adverso flabra feruntur 720 flumine, quae gelidis ab stellis axis aguntur; 721 ille ex aestifera parti venit amnis ab austro 722 inter nigra virum percocto saecla colore 723 exoriens penitus media ab regione diei. 724 est quoque uti possit magnus congestus harenae 725 fluctibus adversis oppilare ostia contra, 726 cum mare permotum ventis ruit intus harenam; 727 quo fit uti pacto liber minus exitus amnis 728 et proclivis item fiat minus impetus undis. 729 fit quoque uti pluviae forsan magis ad caput ei	

	730 tempore eo fiant, quo etesia flabra aquilonum 731 nubila coniciunt in eas tunc omnia partis. 732 scilicet, ad mediam regionem eiecta diei 733 cum convenerunt, ibi ad altos denique montis 734 contrusae nubes coguntur vique premuntur. 735 forsitan Aethiopum penitus de montibus altis 736 crescat, ubi in campos albas descendere ningues 737 tabificis subigit radiis sol omnia lustrans. 738 Nunc age, Averna tibi quae sint loca cumque lacusque, 739 expediam, quali natura praedita constent. 740 principio, quod Averna vocantur nomine, id ab re 741 inpositumst, quia sunt avibus contraria cunctis, 742 e regione ea quod loca cum venere volantes, 743 remigii oblitae pennarum vela remittunt 744 praecipitesque cadunt molli cervice profusae 745 in terram, si forte ita fert natura locorum,	
6.746	746 aut in aquam, si forte lacus substratus Averni. 747 is locus est Cumas aput, acri sulpure montis 748 oppleti calidis ubi fumant fontibus aucti. 749 est et Athenaeis in moenibus, arcis in ipso 750 vertice, Palladis ad templum Tritonidis almae, 751 quo numquam pennis appellunt corpora raucae 752 cornices, non cum fumant altaria donis; 753 usque adeo fugitant non iras Palladis acris 754 pervigili causa, Graium ut cecinere poeetaepoeëtae, 755 sed natura loci opus efficit ipsa suapte. 756 in Syria quoque fertur item locus esse videri, 757 quadripedes quoque quo simul ac vestigia primum 758 intulerint, graviter vis cogat concidere ipsa,	

	759 manibus ut si sint divis mactata repente. 760 omnia quae naturali ratione geruntur, 761 et quibus e fiant causis apparet origo; 762 ianua ne pote eis Orci regionibus esse 763 credatur, post hinc animas Acheruntis in oras 764 ducere forte deos manis inferne reamur, 765 naribus alipedes ut cervi saepe putantur 766 ducere de latebris serpentia saecla ferarum. 767 quod procul a vera quam sit ratione repulsum 768 percipe; nam de re nunc ipsa dicere conor. 769 Principio hoc dico, quod dixi saepe quoque ante, 770 in terra cuiusque modi rerum esse figuras; 771 multa, cibo quae sunt, vitalia multaque, morbos 772 incutere et mortem quae possint adcelerare. 773 et magis esse aliis alias animantibus aptas 774 res ad vitai rationem ostendimus ante 775 propter dissimilem naturam dissimilisque	
6.776	776 texturas inter sese primasque figuras. 777 multa meant inimica per auris, multa per ipsas 778 insinuant naris infesta atque aspera tactu, 779 nec sunt multa parum tactu vitanda neque autem 780 aspectu fugienda saporeque tristia quae sint. 781 Deinde videre licet quam multae sint homini res 782 acriter infesto sensu spurcaeque gravisque; 783 arboribus primum certis gravis umbra tributa 784 usque adeo, capitis faciant ut saepe dolores, 785 siquis eas subter iacuit prostratus in herbis. 786 est etiam magnis Heliconis montibus arbos 787 floris odore hominem taetro consueta necare.	

	788 scilicet haec ideo terris ex omnia surgunt, 789 multa modis multis multarum semina rerum 790 quod permixta gerit tellus discretaque tradit. 791 nocturnumque recens extinctum lumen ubi acri 792 nidore offendit nares, consopit ibidem, 793 concidere et spumas qui morbo mittere suevit. 794 castoreoque gravi mulier sopita recumbit, 795 et manibus nitidum teneris opus effluit ei, 796 tempore eo si odoratast quo menstrua solvit. 797 multaque praeterea languentia membra per artus 798 solvunt atque animam labefactant sedibus intus. 799 denique si calidis etiam cunctere lavabris 800 plenior et lueris, solio ferventis aquai 801 quam facile in medio fit uti des saepe ruinas! 802 carbonumque gravis vis atque odor insinuatur 803 quam facile in cerebrum, nisi aqua praecepimus ante! 804 at cum membra domans percepit fervida febris, 805 tum fit odor vini plagae mactabilis instar.	
6.806	806 nonne vides etiam terra quoque sulpur in ipsa 807 gignier et taetro concrescere odore bitumen, 808 denique ubi argenti venas aurique secuntur, 809 terrai penitus scrutantes abdita ferro, 810 qualis expiret Scaptensula subter odores? 811 quidve mali fit ut exalent aurata metalla! 812 quas hominum reddunt facies qualisque colores! 813 nonne vides audisve perire in tempore parvo 814 quam soleant et quam vitai copia desit, 815 quos opere in tali cohibet vis magna necessis? 816 hos igitur tellus omnis exaestuat aestus	

	817 expiratque foras in apertum promptaque caeli. 818 Sic et Averna loca alitibus summittere debent 819 mortiferam vim. de terra quae surgit in auras, 820 ut spatium caeli quadam de parte venenet; 821 quo simul ac primum pennis delata sit ales, 822 impediatur ibi caeco correpta veneno, 823 ut cadat e regione loci, qua derigit aestus. 824 quo cum conruit, hic eadem vis illius aestus 825 reliquias vitae membris ex omnibus aufert. 826 quippe etenim primo quasi quendam conciet aestum; 827 posterius fit uti. cum iam cecidere veneni 828 in fontis ipsos, ibi sit quoque vita vomenda, 829 propterea quod magna mali fit copia circum. 830 Fit quoque ut inter dum vis haec atque aestus Averni 831 aeeraaeëra, qui inter avis cumquest terramque locatus. 832 discutiat, prope uti locus hic linquatur inanis. 833 cuius ubi e regione loci venere volantis, 834 claudicat extemplo pinnarum nisus inanis 835 et conamen utrimque alarum proditur omne.	
6.836	836 hic ubi nixari nequeunt insistereque alis, 837 scilicet in terram delabi pondere cogit 838 natura, et vacuum prope iam per inane iacentes 839 dispergunt animas per caulas corporis omnis. 840 frigidior porro in puteis aestate fit umor, 841 arescit quia terra calore et semina si qua 842 forte vaporis habet proprie, dimittit in auras. 843 quo magis est igitur tellus effeta calore, 844 fit quoque frigidior qui in terrast abditus umor. 845 frigore cum premitur porro omnis	

	terra coitque 846 et quasi concrescit, fit scilicet ut coeundo 847 exprimat in puteos si quem gerit ipsa calorem. 848 Esse apud Hammonis fanum fons luce diurna 849 frigidus et calidus nocturno tempore fertur. 850 hunc homines fontem nimis admirantur et acri 851 sole putant subter terras fervescere partim, 852 nox ubi terribili terras caligine texit. 853 quod nimis a verast longe ratione remotum. 854 quippe ubi sol nudum contractans corpus aquai 855 non quierit calidum supera de reddere parte, 856 cum superum lumen tanto fervore fruatur, 857 qui queat hic supter tam crasso corpore terram 858 perquoquere umorem et calido focilare vapore? 859 praesertim cum vix possit per saepta domorum 860 insinuare suum radiis ardentibus aestum. 861 quae ratiost igitur? ni mirum terra magis quod 862 rara tenet circum fontem quam cetera tellus 863 multaque sunt ignis prope semina corpus aquai. 864 hoc ubi roriferis terram nox obruit undis,	
6.865	865 extemplo penitus frigescit terra coitque. 866 hac ratione fit ut, tam quam compressa manu sit, 867 exprimat in fontem quae semina cumque habet ignis, 868 quae calidum faciunt laticis tactum atque vaporem. 869 inde ubi sol radiis terram dimovit obortus 870 et rare fecit calido miscente vapore, 871 rursus in antiquas redeunt primordia sedes 872 ignis et in terram cedit calor omnis aquai. 873 frigidus hanc ob rem fit fons in luce diurna. 874 praeterea solis radiis iactatur aquai	There is, moreover, a fountain cold in kind That makes a bit of tow (above it held) Take fire forthwith and shoot a flame; so, too, A pitch-pine torch will kindle and flare round Along its waves, wherever 'tis impelled Afloat before the breeze. No marvel, this: Because full many seeds of heat there be Within the water; and, from earth itself Out of the deeps must particles of fire Athrough the entire fountain surge aloft, And speed in exhalations into air Forth and abroad (yet not in numbers enow As to make hot the fountain). And, moreo'er, Some force constrains them, scattered through the water, Forthwith to burst abroad, and to combine In flame above. Even as a fountain far There is at Aradus amid the sea, Which bubbles

	875 umor et in lucem tremulo rarescit ab aestu; 876 propterea fit uti quae semina cumque habet ignis 877 dimittat; quasi saepe gelum, quod continet in se, 878 mittit et exsolvit glaciem nodosque relaxat. 879 Frigidus est etiam fons, supra quem sita saepe 880 stuppa iacit flammam concepto protinus igni, 881 taedaque consimili ratione accensa per undas 882 conlucet, quo cumque natans impellitur auris. 883 ni mirum quia sunt in aqua permulta vaporis 884 semina de terraque necessest funditus ipsa 885 ignis corpora per totum consurgere fontem 886 et simul exspirare foras exireque in auras, 887 non ita multa tamen, calidus queat ut fieri fons; 888 praeterea dispersa foras erumpere cogit 889 vis per aquam subito sursumque ea conciliari. 890 quod genus endo marist Aradi fons, dulcis aquai 891 qui scatit et salsas circum se dimovet undas; 892 et multis aliis praebet regionibus aequor 893 utilitatem opportunam sitientibus nautis, 894 quod dulcis inter salsas intervomit undas.	out sweet water and disparts From round itself the salt waves; and, behold, In many another region the broad main Yields to the thirsty mariners timely help, Belching sweet waters forth amid salt waves. Just so, then, can those seeds of fire burst forth Athrough that other fount, and bubble out Abroad against the bit of tow; and when They there collect or cleave unto the torch, Forthwith they readily flash aflame, because The tow and torches, also, in themselves Have many seeds of latent fire. Indeed, And seest thou not, when near the nightly lamps Thou bringest a flaxen wick, extinguished A moment since, it catches fire before 'Thas touched the flame, and in same wise a torch? And many another object flashes aflame When at a distance, touched by heat alone, Before 'tis steeped in veritable fire. This, then, we must suppose to come to pass In that spring also.
6.895	895 sic igitur per eum possunt erumpere fontem 896 et scatere illa foras; in stuppam semina quae cum 897 conveniunt aut in taedai corpore adhaerent, 898 ardescunt facile extemplo, quia multa quoque in se 899 semina habent ignis stuppae taedaeque tenentes. 900 nonne vides etiam, nocturna ad lumina linum 901 nuper ubi extinctum admoveas, accendier ante 902 quam tetigit flammam, taedamque pari ratione? 903 multaque praeterea prius ipso tacta vapore	Now to other things! And I'll begin to treat by what decree Of nature it came to pass that iron can be By that stone drawn which Greeks the magnet call After the country's name (its origin Being in country of Magnesian folk). This stone men marvel at; and sure it oft Maketh a chain of rings, depending, lo, From off itself! Nay, thou mayest see at times Five or yet more in order dangling down And swaying in the delicate winds, whilst one Depends from other, cleaving to under-side, And ilk one feels the stone's own power and bonds- So over-masteringly its power flows down. In things of this sort, much must be made sure Ere thou account of the thing itself canst give, And the

	904 eminus ardescunt quam comminus imbuat ignis. 905 hoc igitur fieri quoque in illo fonte putandumst. 906 Quod super est, agere incipiam quo foedere fiat 907 naturae, lapis hic ut ferrum ducere possit, 908 quem Magneta vocant patrio de nomine Grai, 909 Magnetum quia sit patriis in finibus ortus. 910 hunc homines lapidem mirantur; quippe catenam 911 saepe ex anellis reddit pendentibus ex se. 912 quinque etenim licet inter dum pluresque videre 913 ordine demisso levibus iactarier auris, 914 unus ubi ex uno dependet supter adhaerens 915 ex alioque alius lapidis vim vinclaque noscit; 916 usque adeo permananter vis pervalet eius. 917 Hoc genus in rebus firmandumst multa prius quam 918 ipsius rei rationem reddere possis, 919 et nimium longis ambagibus est adeundum; 920 quo magis attentas auris animumque reposco. 921 Principio omnibus ab rebus, quas cumque videmus, 922 perpetuo fluere ac mitti spargique necessest 923 corpora quae feriant oculos visumque lacessant. 924 perpetuoque fluunt certis ab rebus odores;	approaches roundabout must be; Wherefore the more do I exact of thee A mind and ears attent. First, from all things We see soever, evermore must flow, Must be discharged and strewn about, about, Bodies that strike the eyes, awaking sight. From certain things flow odours evermore, As cold from rivers, heat from sun, and spray From waves of ocean, eater-out of walls Along the coasts. Nor ever cease to seep The varied echoings athrough the air. Then, too, there comes into the mouth at times The wet of a salt taste, when by the sea We roam about; and so, whene'er we watch The wormwood being mixed, its bitter stings. To such degree from all things is each thing Borne streamingly along, and sent about To every region round; and nature grants Nor rest nor respite of the onward flow, Since 'tis incessantly we feeling have, And all the time are suffered to descry And smell all things at hand, and hear them sound.
6.925	925 frigus ut fluviis, calor a sole, aestus ab undis 926 aequoris, exesor moerorum, litora propter; 927 nec varii cessant sonitus manare per auras; 928 denique in os salsi venit umor saepe saporis, 929 cum mare versamur propter, dilutaque contra 930 cum tuimur misceri absinthia, tangit amaror. 931 usque adeo omnibus ab rebus res quaeque fluenter 932 fertur et in cunctas dimittitur undique partis 933 nec mora nec requies interdatur	Now will I seek again to bring to mind How porous a body all things have- a fact Made manifest in my first canto, too. For, truly, though to know this doth import For many things, yet for this very thing On which straightway I'm going to discourse, 'Tis needful most of all to make it sure That naught's at hand but body mixed with void. A first ensample: in grottos, rocks o'erhead Sweat moisture and distil the oozy drops; Likewise, from all our body seeps the sweat; There grows the beard, and along our members all And along our frame the hairs. Through all our veins Disseminates the foods, and gives increase And aliment down to the

	ulla fluendi, 934 perpetuo quoniam sentimus et omnia semper 935 cernere odorari licet et sentire sonare. 936 Nunc omnis repetam quam raro corpore sint res 937 commemorare; quod in primo quoque carmine claret. 938 quippe etenim, quamquam multas hoc pertinet ad res 939 noscere, cum primis hanc ad rem protinus ipsam, 940 qua de disserere adgredior, firmare necessest 941 nil esse in promptu nisi mixtum corpus inani. 942 principio fit ut in speluncis saxa superna 943 sudent umore et guttis manantibus stillent. 944 manat item nobis e toto corpore sudor, 945 crescit barba pilique per omnia membra, per artus. 946 diditur in venas cibus omnis, auget alitque 947 corporis extremas quoque partis unguiculosque. 948 frigus item transire per aes calidumque vaporem 949 sentimus, sentimus item transire per aurum 950 atque per argentum, cum pocula plena tenemus. 951 denique per dissaepta domorum saxea voces 952 pervolitant, permanat odor frigusque vaposque 953 ignis, qui ferri quoque vim penetrare sueevitsueëvit, 954 denique qua circum caeli lorica coeercetcoeërcet,	extreme parts, Even to the tiniest finger-nails. Likewise, Through solid bronze the cold and fiery heat We feel to pass; likewise, we feel them pass Through gold, through silver, when we clasp in hand The brimming goblets. And, again, there flit Voices through houses' hedging walls of stone; Odour seeps through, and cold, and heat of fire That's wont to penetrate even strength of iron. Again, where corselet of the sky girds round . . . . . And at same time, some Influence of bane, When from Beyond 'thas stolen into [our world]. And tempests, gathering from the earth and sky, Back to the sky and earth absorbed retire- With reason, since there's naught that's fashioned not With body porous.
6.955	955 morbida visque simul, cum extrinsecus insinuatur; 956 et tempestate in terra caeloque coorta 957 in caelum terrasque remotae iure facessunt; 958 quandoquidem nihil est nisi raro corpore nexum. 959 Huc accedit uti non omnia, quae iaciuntur 960 corpora cumque ab rebus, eodem praedita sensu 961 atque eodem pacto rebus sint omnibus apta. 962 principio terram sol excoquit et	Furthermore, not all The particles which be from things thrown off Are furnished with same qualities for sense, Nor be for all things equally adapt. A first ensample: the sun doth bake and parch The earth; but ice he thaws, and with his beams Compels the lofty snows, up-reared white Upon the lofty hills, to waste away; Then, wax, if set beneath the heat of him, Melts to a liquid. And the fire, likewise, Will melt the copper and will fuse the gold, But hides and flesh it shrivels up and shrinks. The water hardens the iron just off the fire, But hides and flesh

	facit are, 963 at glaciem dissolvit et altis montibus altas 964 extructas nives radiis tabescere cogit; 965 denique cera lique fit in eius posta vapore. 966 ignis item liquidum facit aes aurumque resolvit, 967 at coria et carnem trahit et conducit in unum. 968 umor aquae porro ferrum condurat ab igni, 969 at coria et carnem mollit durata calore. 970 barbigeras oleaster eo iuvat usque capellas, 971 effluat ambrosias quasi vero et nectare tinctus; 972 qua nihil est homini quod amarius fronde ac extet. 973 denique amaracinum fugitat sus et timet omne 974 unguentum; nam saetigeris subus acre venenumst; 975 quod nos inter dum tam quam recreare videtur. 976 at contra nobis caenum taeterrima cum sit 977 spurcities, eadem subus haec iucunda videtur, 978 insatiabiliter toti ut volvantur ibidem. 979 Hoc etiam super est, ipsa quam dicere de re 980 adgredior, quod dicendum prius esse videtur. 981 multa foramina cum variis sint reddita rebus, 982 dissimili inter se natura praedita debent 983 esse et habere suam naturam quaeque viasque. 984 quippe etenim varii sensus animantibus insunt,	(made hard by heat) it softens. The oleaster-tree as much delights The bearded she-goats, verily as though 'Twere nectar-steeped and shed ambrosia; Than which is naught that burgeons into leaf More bitter food for man. A hog draws back For marjoram oil, and every unguent fears Fierce poison these unto the bristled hogs, Yet unto us from time to time they seem, As 'twere, to give new life. But, contrariwise, Though unto us the mire be filth most foul, To hogs that mire doth so delightsome seem That they with wallowing from belly to back Are never cloyed.
6.985	985 quorum quisque suam proprie rem percipit in se; 986 nam penetrare alio sonitus alioque saporem 987 cernimus e sucis, alio nidoris odores. 988 989 990 praeterea manare aliud per saxa videtur, 991 atque aliud lignis, aliud transire per aurum, 992 argentoque foras aliud vitroque	

	meare; 993 nam fluere hac species, illac calor ire videtur, 994 atque aliis aliud citius transmittere eadem. 995 scilicet id fieri cogit natura viarum 996 multimodis varians, ut paulo ostendimus ante, 997 propter dissimilem naturam textaque rerum. 998 Qua propter, bene ubi haec confirmata atque locata 999 omnia constiterint nobis praeposta parata, 1000 quod super est, facile hinc ratio reddetur et omnis 1001 causa pate fiet, quae ferri pelliciat vim. 1002 Principio fluere e lapide hoc permulta necessest 1003 semina sive aestum, qui discutit aeeraaeëra plagis, 1004 inter qui lapidem ferrumque est cumque locatus. 1005 hoc ubi inanitur spatium multusque vace fit 1006 in medio locus, extemplo primordia ferri 1007 in vacuum prolapsa cadunt coniuncta, fit utque 1008 anulus ipse sequatur eatque ita corpore toto. 1009 nec res ulla magis primoribus ex elementis 1010 indupedita suis arte conexa cohaeret 1011 quam validi ferri natura et frigidus horror. 1012 quo minus est mirum, quod dicitur esse alienum, 1013 corpora si nequeunt e ferro plura coorta 1014 in vacuum ferri, quin anulus ipse sequatur;	
6.1015	1015 quod facit et sequitur, donec pervenit ad ipsum 1016 iam lapidem caecisque in eo compagibus haesit. 1017 hoc fit idem cunctas in partis; unde vace fit 1018 cumque locus, sive e transverso sive superne, 1019 corpora continuo in vacuum vicina feruntur; 1020 quippe agitantur enim plagis aliunde nec ipsa 1021 sponte sua sursum possunt consurgere in auras.	It happens, too, at times that nature of iron Shrinks from this stone away, accustomed By turns to flee and follow. Yea, I've seen Those Samothracian iron rings leap up, And iron filings in the brazen bowls Seethe furiously, when underneath was set The magnet stone. So strongly iron seems To crave to flee that rock. Such discord great Is gendered by the interposed brass, Because, forsooth, when first the tide of brass Hath seized upon and held possession of The iron's open passage-ways, thereafter Cometh the tide of the

	1022 huc accedit item, quare queat id magis esse, 1023 haec quoque res adiumento motuque iuvatur, 1024 quod, simul a fronte est anelli rarior aeeraeër 1025 factus inanitusque locus magis ac vacuatus, 1026 continuo fit uti qui post est cumque locatus 1027 aeeraeër a tergo quasi provehat atque propellat. 1028 semper enim circum positus res verberat aeeraeër; 1029 sed tali fit uti propellat tempore ferrum, 1030 parte quod ex una spatium vacat et capit in se. 1031 hic, tibi quem memoro, per crebra foramina ferri 1032 parvas ad partis subtiliter insinuatus 1033 trudit et inpellit, quasi navem velaque ventus. 1034 denique res omnes debent in corpore habere 1035 aeeraaeëra, quandoquidem raro sunt corpore et aeeraeër 1036 omnibus est rebus circum datus adpositusque. 1037 hic igitur, penitus qui in ferrost abditus aeeraeër, 1038 sollicito motu semper iactatur eoque 1039 verberat anellum dubio procul et ciet intus, 1040 scilicet illo eodem fertur, quo praecipitavit 1041 iam semel et partem in vacuam conamina sumpsit. 1042 Fit quoque ut a lapide hoc ferri natura recedat 1043 inter dum, fugere atque sequi consueta vicissim. 1044 exultare etiam Samothracia ferrea vidi	stone, and in that iron Findeth all spaces full, nor now hath holes To swim through, as before. 'Tis thus constrained With its own current 'gainst the iron's fabric To dash and beat; by means whereof it spues Forth from itself- and through the brass stirs up- The things which otherwise without the brass It sucks into itself. In these affairs Marvel thou not that from this stone the tide Prevails not likewise other things to move With its own blows: for some stand firm by weight, As gold; and some cannot be moved forever, Because so porous in their framework they That there the tide streams through without a break, Of which sort stuff of wood is seen to be. Therefore, when iron (which lies between the two) Hath taken in some atoms of the brass, Then do the streams of that Magnesian rock Move iron by their smitings.
6.1045	1045 et ramenta simul ferri furere intus ahenis 1046 in scaphiis, lapis hic Magnes cum subditus esset; 1047 usque adeo fugere a saxo gestire videtur. 1048 aere interposito discordia tanta creatur 1049 propterea quia ni mirum prius aestus ubi aeris 1050 praecepit ferrique vias possedit apertas,	

	1051 posterior lapidis venit aestus et omnia plena 1052 invenit in ferro neque habet qua tranet ut ante; 1053 cogitur offensare igitur pulsareque fluctu 1054 ferrea texta suo; quo pacto respuit ab se 1055 atque per aes agitat, sine eo quod saepe resorbet. 1056 Illud in his rebus mirari mitte, quod aestus 1057 non valet e lapide hoc alias impellere item res. 1058 pondere enim fretae partim stant, quod genus aurum; 1059 at partim raro quia sunt cum corpore, ut aestus 1060 pervolet intactus, nequeunt inpellier usquam, 1061 lignea materies in quo genere esse videtur. 1062 interutrasque igitur ferri natura locata 1063 aeris ubi accepit quaedam corpuscula, tum fit, 1064 inpellant ut eo Magnesia flumine saxa. 1065 nec tamen haec ita sunt aliarum rerum aliena, 1066 ut mihi multa parum genere ex hoc suppeditentur, 1067 quae memorare queam inter se singlariter apta. 1068 saxa vides primum sola colescere calce. 1069 glutine materies taurino iungitur una, 1070 ut vitio venae tabularum saepius hiscant 1071 quam laxare queant compages taurea vincla. 1072 vitigeni latices aquai fontibus audent 1073 misceri, cum pix nequeat gravis et leve olivom. 1074 purpureusque colos conchyli iungitur uno	
6.1075	1075 corpore cum lanae, dirimi qui non queat usquam, 1076 non si Neptuni fluctu renovare operam des, 1077 non mare si totum velit eluere omnibus undis. 1078 denique res auro non aurum copulat una, 1079 aerique plumbo fit uti iungatur ab albo?	

	1080 cetera iam quam multa licet reperire! quid ergo? 1081 nec tibi tam longis opus est ambagibus usquam 1082 nec me tam multam hic operam consumere par est, 1083 sed breviter paucis praestat comprendere multa. 1084 quorum ita texturae ceciderunt mutua contra, 1085 ut cava conveniant plenis haec illius illa 1086 huiusque inter se, iunctura haec optima constat. 1087 est etiam, quasi ut anellis hamisque plicata 1088 inter se quaedam possint coplata teneri; 1089 quod magis in lapide hoc fieri ferroque videtur. 1090 Nunc ratio quae sit morbis aut unde repente 1091 mortiferam possit cladem conflare coorta 1092 morbida vis hominum generi pecudumque catervis, 1093 expediam, primum multarum semina rerum 1094 esse supra docui quae sint vitalia nobis, 1095 et contra quae sint morbo mortique necessest 1096 multa volare; ea cum casu sunt forte coorta 1097 et perturbarunt caelum, fit morbidus aeeraeër. 1098 atque ea vis omnis morborum pestilitasque 1099 aut extrinsecus ut nubes nebulaeque superne 1100 per caelum veniunt aut ipsa saepe coorta 1101 de terra surgunt, ubi putorem umida nactast 1102 intempestivis pluviisque et solibus icta. 1103 nonne vides etiam caeli novitate et aquarum 1104 temptari procul a patria qui cumque domoque	
6.1105	1105 adveniunt ideo quia longe discrepitant res? 1106 nam quid Brittannis caelum differre putamus, 1107 et quod in Aegypto est, qua mundi claudicat axis, 1108 quidve quod in Ponto est differre et Gadibus atque	

	1109 usque ad nigra virum percocto saecla colore? 1110 quae cum quattuor inter se diversa videmus 1111 quattuor a ventis et caeli partibus esse, 1112 tum color et facies hominum distare videntur 1113 largiter et morbi generatim saecla tenere. 1114 est elephas morbus qui propter flumina Nili 1115 gignitur Aegypto in media neque praeterea usquam. 1116 Atthide temptantur gressus oculique in Achaeis 1117 finibus. inde aliis alius locus est inimicus 1118 partibus ac membris; varius concinnat id aeeraeër. 1119 proinde ubi se caelum, quod nobis forte alienum, 1120 commovet atque aeeraeër inimicus serpere coepit, 1121 ut nebula ac nubes paulatim repit et omne 1122 qua graditur conturbat et immutare coactat, 1123 fit quoque ut, in nostrum cum venit denique caelum, 1124 corrumpat reddatque sui simile atque alienum. 1125 haec igitur subito clades nova pestilitasque 1126 aut in aquas cadit aut fruges persidit in ipsas 1127 aut alios hominum pastus pecudumque cibatus, 1128 aut etiam suspensa manet vis aeereaeëre in ipso 1129 et, cum spirantes mixtas hinc ducimus auras, 1130 illa quoque in corpus pariter sorbere necessest. 1131 consimili ratione venit bubus quoque saepe 1132 pestilitas et iam pigris balantibus aegror. 1133 nec refert utrum nos in loca deveniamus 1134 nobis adversa et caeli mutemus amictum,	
6.1135	1135 an caelum nobis ultro natura corumptum 1136 deferat aut aliquid quo non consuevimus uti, 1137 quod nos adventu possit temptare recenti.	

	1138 Haec ratio quondam morborum et mortifer aestus 1139 finibus in Cecropis funestos reddidit agros 1140 vastavitque vias, exhausit civibus urbem. 1141 nam penitus veniens Aegypti finibus ortus, 1142 aeeraaeëra permensus multum camposque natantis, 1143 incubuit tandem populo Pandionis omni. 1144 inde catervatim morbo mortique dabantur. 1145 principio caput incensum fervore gerebant 1146 et duplicis oculos suffusa luce rubentes. 1147 sudabant etiam fauces intrinsecus atrae 1148 sanguine et ulceribus vocis via saepta coibat 1149 atque animi interpres manabat lingua cruore 1150 debilitata malis, motu gravis, aspera tactu. 1151 inde ubi per fauces pectus complerat et ipsum 1152 morbida vis in cor maestum confluxerat aegris, 1153 omnia tum vero vitai claustra lababant. 1154 spiritus ore foras taetrum volvebat odorem, 1155 rancida quo perolent proiecta cadavera ritu. 1156 atque animi prorsum vires totius, omne 1157 languebat corpus leti iam limine in ipso. 1158 intolerabilibusque malis erat anxius angor 1159 adsidue comes et gemitu commixta querella, 1160 singultusque frequens noctem per saepe diemque 1161 corripere adsidue nervos et membra coactans 1162 dissoluebat eos, defessos ante, fatigans. 1163 nec nimio cuiquam posses ardore tueri 1164 corporis in summo summam fervescere partem,	
6.1165	1165 sed potius tepidum manibus proponere tactum 1166 et simul ulceribus quasi inustis omne rubere	Many would headlong fling them deeply down The water-pits, tumbling with eager mouth Already agape. The insatiable thirst That whelmed their

	1167 corpus, ut est per membra sacer dum diditur ignis. 1168 intima pars hominum vero flagrabat ad ossa, 1169 flagrabat stomacho flamma ut fornacibus intus. 1170 nil adeo posses cuiquam leve tenveque membris 1171 vertere in utilitatem, at ventum et frigora semper. 1172 in fluvios partim gelidos ardentia morbo 1173 membra dabant nudum iacientes corpus in undas. 1174 multi praecipites nymphis putealibus alte 1175 inciderunt ipso venientes ore patente: 1176 insedabiliter sitis arida corpora mersans 1177 aequabat multum parvis umoribus imbrem. 1178 nec requies erat ulla mali: defessa iacebant 1179 corpora. mussabat tacito medicina timore, 1180 quippe patentia cum totiens ardentia morbis 1181 lumina versarent oculorum expertia somno. 1182 multaque praeterea mortis tum signa dabantur: 1183 perturbata animi mens in maerore metuque, 1184 triste supercilium, furiosus voltus et acer, 1185 sollicitae porro plenaeque sonoribus aures, 1186 creber spiritus aut ingens raroque coortus, 1187 sudorisque madens per collum splendidus umor, 1188 tenvia sputa minuta, croci contacta colore 1189 salsaque per fauces rauca vix edita tussi. 1190 in manibus vero nervi trahere et tremere artus 1191 a pedibusque minutatim succedere frigus 1192 non dubitabat. item ad supremum denique tempus 1193 conpressae nares, nasi primoris acumen 1194 tenve, cavati oculi, cava tempora, frigida pellis	parched bodies, lo, would make A goodly shower seem like to scanty drops. Respite of torment was there none. Their frames Forspent lay prone. With silent lips of fear Would Medicine mumble low, the while she saw So many a time men roll their eyeballs round, Staring wide-open, unvisited of sleep, The heralds of old death. And in those months Was given many another sign of death: The intellect of mind by sorrow and dread Deranged, the sad brow, the countenance Fierce and delirious, the tormented ears Beset with ringings, the breath quick and short Or huge and intermittent, soaking sweat A-glisten on neck, the spittle in fine gouts Tainted with colour of crocus and so salt, The cough scarce wheezing through the rattling throat. Aye, and the sinews in the fingered hands Were sure to contract, and sure the jointed frame To shiver, and up from feet the cold to mount Inch after inch: and toward the supreme hour At last the pinched nostrils, nose's tip A very point, eyes sunken, temples hollow, Skin cold and hard, the shuddering grimace, The pulled and puffy flesh above the brows!- O not long after would their frames lie prone In rigid death. And by about the eighth Resplendent light of sun, or at the most On the ninth flaming of his flambeau, they Would render up the life. If any then Had 'scaped the doom of that destruction, yet Him there awaited in the after days A wasting and a death from ulcers vile And black discharges of the belly, or else Through the clogged nostrils would there ooze along Much fouled blood, oft with an aching head: Hither would stream a man's whole strength and flesh.
6.1195	1195 duraque in ore, iacens rictu, frons tenta manebat.	And whoso had survived that virulent flow Of the vile blood, yet into thews of

	1196 nec nimio rigida post artus morte iacebant. 1197 octavoque fere candenti lumine solis 1198 aut etiam nona reddebant lampade vitam. 1199 quorum siquis, ut est, vitarat funera leti, 1200 ulceribus taetris et nigra proluvie alvi 1201 posterius tamen hunc tabes letumque manebat, 1202 aut etiam multus capitis cum saepe dolore 1203 corruptus sanguis expletis naribus ibat. 1204 huc hominis totae vires corpusque fluebat. 1205 profluvium porro qui taetri sanguinis acre 1206 exierat, tamen in nervos huic morbus et artus 1207 ibat et in partis genitalis corporis ipsas. 1208 et graviter partim metuentes limina leti 1209 vivebant ferro privati parte virili, 1210 et manibus sine non nulli pedibusque manebant 1211 in vita tamen et perdebant lumina partim. 1212 usque adeo mortis metus iis incesserat acer. 1213 atque etiam quosdam cepere oblivia rerum 1214 cunctarum, neque se possent cognoscere ut ipsi. 1215 multaque humi cum inhumata iacerent corpora supra 1216 corporibus, tamen alituum genus atque ferarum 1217 aut procul absiliebat, ut acrem exiret odorem, 1218 aut, ubi gustarat, languebat morte propinqua. 1219 nec tamen omnino temere illis solibus ulla 1220 comparebat avis, nec tristia saecla ferarum 1221 exibant silvis. languebant pleraque morbo 1222 et moriebantur. cum primis fida canum vis 1223 strata viis animam ponebat in omnibus aegre; 1224 extorquebat enim vitam vis morbida membris.	him And into his joints and very genitals Would pass the old disease. And some there were, Dreading the doorways of destruction So much, lived on, deprived by the knife Of the male member; not a few, though lopped Of hands and feet, would yet persist in life, And some there were who lost their eyeballs: O So fierce a fear of death had fallen on them! And some, besides, were by oblivion Of all things seized, that even themselves they knew No longer. And though corpse on corpse lay piled Unburied on ground, the race of birds and beasts Would or spring back, scurrying to escape The virulent stench, or, if they'd tasted there, Would languish in approaching death. But yet Hardly at all during those many suns Appeared a fowl, nor from the woods went forth The sullen generations of wild beasts- They languished with disease and died and died. In chief, the faithful dogs, in all the streets Outstretched, would yield their breath distressfully For so that Influence of bane would twist Life from their members. Nor was found one sure And universal principle of cure: For what to one had given the power to take The vital winds of air into his mouth, And to gaze upward at the vaults of sky, The same to others was their death and doom.
6.1225	1225 incomitata rapi certabant funera	

	vasta 1226 nec ratio remedii communis certa dabatur; 1227 nam quod ali dederat vitalis aeerisaeëris auras 1228 volvere in ore licere et caeli templa tueri, 1229 hoc aliis erat exitio letumque parabat. 1230 Illud in his rebus miserandum magnopere unum 1231 aerumnabile erat, quod ubi se quisque videbat 1232 implicitum morbo, morti damnatus ut esset, 1233 deficiens animo maesto cum corde iacebat, 1234 funera respectans animam amittebat ibidem. 1235 quippe etenim nullo cessabant tempore apisci 1236 ex aliis alios avidi contagia morbi, 1237 lanigeras tam quam pecudes et bucera saecla, 1238 idque vel in primis cumulabat funere funus 1239 nam qui cumque suos fugitabant visere ad aegros, 1240 vitai nimium cupidos mortisque timentis 1241 poenibat paulo post turpi morte malaque, 1242 desertos, opis expertis, incuria mactans. 1243 qui fuerant autem praesto, contagibus ibant 1244 atque labore, pudor quem tum cogebat obire 1245 blandaque lassorum vox mixta voce querellae. 1246 optimus hoc leti genus ergo quisque subibat. 1247 Praeterea iam pastor et armentarius omnis 1248 et robustus item curvi moderator aratri 1249 languebat, penitusque casa contrusa iacebant 1250 corpora paupertate et morbo dedita morti. 1251 exanimis pueris super exanimata parentum 1252 corpora non numquam posses retroque videre 1253 matribus et patribus natos super edere vitam. 1254 nec minimam partem ex agris maeror is in urbem	

6.1255	1255 confluxit, languens quem contulit agricolarum 1256 copia conveniens ex omni morbida parte. 1257 omnia conplebant loca tectaque quo magis aestu, 1258 confertos ita acervatim mors accumulabat. 1259 multa siti prostrata viam per proque voluta 1260 corpora silanos ad aquarum strata iacebant 1261 interclusa anima nimia ab dulcedine aquarum, 1262 multaque per populi passim loca prompta viasque 1263 languida semanimo cum corpore membra videres 1264 horrida paedore et pannis cooperta perire, 1265 corporis inluvie, pelli super ossibus una, 1266 ulceribus taetris prope iam sordeque sepulta. 1267 omnia denique sancta deum delubra replerat 1268 corporibus mors exanimis onerataque passim 1269 cuncta cadaveribus caelestum templa manebant, 1270 hospitibus loca quae complerant aedituentes. 1271 nec iam religio divom nec numina magni 1272 pendebantur enim: praesens dolor exsuperabat. 1273 nec mos ille sepulturae remanebat in urbe, 1274 quo prius hic populus semper consuerat humari; 1275 perturbatus enim totus trepidabat et unus 1276 quisque suum pro re maestus humabat. 1277 multaque subita et paupertas horrida suasit; 1278 namque suos consanguineos aliena rogorum 1279 insuper extructa ingenti clamore locabant 1280 subdebantque faces, multo cum sanguine saepe 1281 rixantes, potius quam corpora desererentur, 1282 inque aliis alium populum sepelire suorum 1283 certantes; lacrimis lassi luctuque redibant;	

	1284 inde bonam partem in lectum maerore dabantur;	
6.1285	1285 nec poterat quisquam reperiri, quem neque morbus 1286 nec mors nec luctus temptaret tempore tali.	